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Working with Discourses: Corpus and Systemic Functional Perspectives

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Edited by

Josef Schmied
Chang Chenguang
Matthias Hofmann

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Nonnenstieg 8, 37075 Göttingen, Germany
Telephone: +49 (0)551-54724-0
Telefax: +49 (0)551-54724-21
www.cuvillier.de

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Preface

The contributions in this volume are the result of the intensive collaboration that has developed over the last ten years between the English Department and the Faculty of Humanities at Chemnitz University of Technology in Germany and the School of Foreign Languages and the School of International Studies at Sun Yat-sen University in China. This volume is the first documentation that illustrates that both partners have been able to develop a real partnership from student and teaching exchange to research coordination in many areas, starting from the theoretical basis in Systemic Functional Grammar to current approaches in discourse analysis and corpus-linguistic methodologies (cf. Nartey & Mwinlaaru 2019). The contributions by professors and graduates show generally that research traditions from both schools can be applied to current issues to the mutual benefit of both partners and can stand for the truly international cooperation of modern Departments using English in non-native academic contexts.

The individual contributions show, also in their domestic styles, the different research and style traditions in Chinese and European universities. We particularly observed that Chinese authors tend towards declarative style, where European authors might prefer the conventionalized share of hedging in academic writing, and that conclusions are often shorter and weaker than introductions.

The emphasis on practical approaches in teaching academic writing to novice researchers allows us to take theoretical backgrounds into consideration wherever needed while maintaining the accessibility of this volume to young researchers. Author-specific idiomaticity and some grammatical special features were left untouched, when the general understanding was not affected. Even formatting of references was only harmonized when functional necessities appeared prominent (e.g., to distinguish independent publications like books from independent publications like articles).

It must be made clear at the very beginning of this volume that this is not intended as a model that must be followed by graduates in various parts of China and/or Europe, but that is a documentation of the different conventions and practices of academic writing in non-native academic contexts in different parts of the world. Graduates in this field must be aware of these conventions and practices, so that they can make their own decisions about which conventions to follow and which to neglect in their own writings, decisions that have to be taken in the contexts of publishing in journal- or (sub-)genre-specific conventions. Thus, they may find a good compromise between the necessities of the field and their own identity as independent scholars.

In the opening section of this volume, Schmied applies the well-known approaches to appraisal within Systemic Functional Grammar to academic reviews, combing these approaches with concepts from professional discourse analysis and textlinguistics, using qualitative and quantitative corpuslinguistic methodologies.

He argues that this increasingly important academic genre must find a balance between solidarity and constructive criticism, especially in the new forms of open peer review.

His section is followed by Hofmann's methodological contribution to unifying the different research quality criteria regarding qualitative studies and mixed-method research designs. He shows that while the discussion of the necessity of such research quality criteria within qualitative research paradigms is very vivid and calls for standards, such a discussion within the mixed-method paradigm is far from any agreement. Subsequently, he transfers the general discussion of quality criteria to linguistic research, namely to the combination of corpus linguistics and the various approaches to Critical Discourse Analysis.

The two contributions above take a metalevel to reflect on conventions, best practice examples, and illustrations of conducting and documenting research on such a level that novice scholars at the beginning of their careers have access to a substantial resource they can consult before the submission of their manuscripts to academic journals. The contributions that follow are examples for case studies that have been conceptualised and conducted by European, African, and Chinese scholars in combining corpus linguistics with discourse analysis in many different ways. The next three contributions are corpus-assisted discourse-analytical studies, which exemplify a qualitative analysis of language use in religious, institutional, academic, and political contexts after a corpus helped to assess the relevance of the discourse.

The first of these contributions, section 3, is Ebermann's discourse-historical approach of critical discourse analysis, in which a corpus of U.S. President Trump's weekly addresses is analysed qualitatively and quantitatively. Ebermann uses statistical means, such as the mutual information score, to investigate lexemes and collocations that represent Trump's "America First" policy best. This investigation serves as starting point for the analysis of the discoursive strategies in Trump's addresses. She concludes that his rhetoric creates his *us* vs. *them* ideology.

In section 4, Guo Ya uses a ChAcE, a corpus of Chinese MA theses and PhD dissertations written by English major students to investigate instantiations of expansion patterns, which include elaboration, extension, and enhancement, within the Systemic Functional Grammar framework. She investigates the corpus qualitatively using *SysFan* (Wu 2000) and quantitatively using *AntConc* (Anthony 2019) in order to find examples of similarities and differences between MA these and PhD dissertations, writing skill development, and errors as well as their underlying reasons. Through the qualitative part of the analysis, Ya is able to identify four types of untypical clause compositions: unrelated addition, unequal addition, implicit addition, and wrong addition.

Representing the African perspective, Ademilokun presents a self-compiled corpus of texts from governmental and non-governmental institutions and "actors", covering the period of 2013 to 2018, which essentially cover social transformation

processes in Nigeria. He investigates the use of pronouns in these texts qualitatively, combining critical discourse analysis, and quantitatively, using *AntConc* (Anthony 2019) and *R* (R Core Team 2019). His analysis reveals that Nigerian authors deliberately use pronominal resources for sharing the responsibilty of social transformation, bearing civic resistance against political leadership, and asserting governmental authority.

Using a small self-compiled corpus of European online newspapers from different countries, Dheskali finds in her critical discourse analysis a predominantely negative news coverage of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macau Bidge, which opened in 2018. Her findings show, that the articles concentrated on negative aspects of the bridge, such as delays, budget overrun, corruption, etc. She additionally analyes collocations with and expressions for the lexemes *bridge* and *project* quantitatively to find more negative examples than positive ones. In conclusion, the European online newspapers greatly invested in forming surprisingly negative opinions among their readers towards the construction of the bridge.

Dheskali's contribution is followed by a contribution by Xinlei Zhang, who argues that *Bejing Review* – an international communication magazine – uses a writing style that concentrates on modal verbs with a medium value and indirect speech with accurate sources. She additionally analysed the data in her self-compiled corpus qualitatively in order to identify the underlying reasons for the use of the writing style she could identifiy. She concludes that the use of reported speech with explicit and clearly stated sources represents Chinese cultural values of avoiding uncertainty and ambiguities.

The next four contributions all centre on media constructions of Hong Kong. Liu Ming conducts a corpus-assisted discourse study of the representations of post-colonial Hong Kong from 2000 to 2017 in *China Daily*, the *New York Times*, and the *Washington Post*. Through a combination of corpus linguistics and the discourse-historical approach of critical discourse analysis, Liu examines the preferential choice for frames, topics, and discourses as well as the discursive strategies employed in these newspapers for the constructions of the key parties concerning Hong Kong, i.e., people, government, and Chinese mainland. The findings suggest that these newspapers tend to align with their respective national interests in constructing their own stories of post-colonial Hong Kong.

Wang Yunzhe's corpus-assisted discourse analysis of the representations of Hong Kong is based on similar data, from *China Daily*, *The New York Times* and *The Washington Post* during an 18-year period from 2000 to 2017. Her findings suggest that both Chinese and American news media cover a wide range of topics on Hong Kong but reflect different ideologies through certain linguistic patterns and semantic choices. The Chinese media shows preferences for economic interactions and cooperation between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland and reinforces their solidarity. The American newspapers, however, show preferences for conflicts and tensions between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. The general discursive strategy of positive-self and negative-other representations has been used in both corpora to construct their respective ideological positions.

Jiang Cong's contribution focuses on how Hong Kong is represented by the British media based on the four dimensions of British colonial discourse summarized by Flowerdew (2012). By adopting the theoretical framework of modern diachronic corpus-assisted discourse study (MD-CADS), this article examines reports about Hong Kong in *The Times* during a period of twenty years from July 1997 to July 2017 and captures the diachronic British perceptions of the "former colony". It is shown that the four dimensions of British colonial discourse are preserved so as to maintain the British legacy and promote the liberal identity of Hong Kong in contrast with the Chinese Mainland.

The final contribution is on the Chinese perception of Hong Kong and the relations between Hong Kong and the mainland of China after Hong Kong's handover in 1997, based on data from the Chinese mainstream newspaper, *People's Daily*. Adopting discourse-historical analysis and corpus linguistics methodologies, Huang Jingyi conducts her analysis at both the macro- and the micro levels, focusing on the topics and specific linguistic strategies respectively. Her findings indicate that Chinese perception of Hong Kong has been constantly positive during 1997 to 2017 and Hong Kong is discursively constructed as a prosperous and stable city.

The next two contributions are Appraisal analysis conducted within the Systemic Functional Linguistics framework, concerning Chinese tourists and the Confucius Institute respectively. Yao Ye's study looks into British and American news reports on Chinese tourists. Her data are relevant reports on Chinese outbound tourists from 2001 to September 2018 from *New York Times*, *Washington Post, the Guardian*, and *the Independent*. It is found that these newspapers have both positive and negative attitudes towards Chinese tourists. The positive evaluation mainly concentrates on the economic contribution of the tourists, whereas the negative evaluation mainly stresses their uncivilized behaviors. The evalution of Chinese government is mostly negative. Yao also discusses the hidden relationship between news language and ideology.

Wang Liwei's article investigates the Appraisal strategies in the western media coverage of Confucius Institutes from 2004 to 2018. Through descriptive and qualitative analysis of the news reports and editorials in five influential western media, the study identifies the most frequent topics concerning Confucius Institutes and three dominant evaluative strategies. It is found that (1) Judgement is the most frequently used kind of attitude in the media; (2) Attributed resources are prominent in the examples, and monoglossia is strategically intermingled with heteroglossia to present a multiple-voiced representation; and (3) Graduation is closely related to the expressions of attitude and engagement to achieve an intensified evaluation.

The final contribution is a more general theoretical and methodological discussion. In this chapter, Chang Chenguang focuses on the complementary and synergistic relationship between Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL) and corpus linguistics, with particular reference to discourse analysis. The contribution starts

with a comparison of the formal and functional approaches to the study of language, especially in terms of their different views on the nature of the data for linguistic enquiries. Then it discusses the complementarities between Systemic Functional Linguistics and corpus linguistics, highlighting both their commonalities and differences. Finally, Chang Chenguang proposes that an SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis approach, which combines the strengths of SFL and CL, can make a useful contribution to discourse studies.

April 2020 Josef Schmied, Chang Chenguang & Matthias Hofmann

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Applying Appraisal Theory to Conference Reviews: Systemic Functional Perspectives in Corpus-Based Genre-Specific Discourse Analyses[1]

Josef Schmied

Chemnitz University of Technology

Abstract

This contribution combines five linguistic approaches: systemic functional linguistics as a general grammar theory, appraisal theory as an application in evaluative contexts, genre theory from a textlinguistic perspective, discourse analysis for professional discourse, and corpus-linguistics as an empirical methodology. The genre of reviews has been chosen because it has diversified in the last few decades from a journalistic to an academic context. At the same time, conventions have become professionalised in the sense of awareness of good communicative behaviour of discourse. Based on a small corpus of open reviews of conference proposals, the features of concessive constructions and politeness are analysed because they show the necessary cooperative interaction between reviewers and authors.

Keywords: review, evaluation, concessive, politeness, solidarity, judgement

1. Introduction

1.1. Symbiotic Approaches in Systemic-Functional Linguistics

If we define genre (with Bhatia 2004: 26) as "situated linguistic behaviour in institutionalised academic or professional settings", we find many examples in academic discourse communities. The genre of reviews and more specifically of academic (research article and conference) reviews that come across as professional allows us to combine many different approaches to language. We can choose approaches that are not mutually exclusive, but have their focus on theory (e.g., systemic functional linguistics - SFL, mainly as in Halliday & Matthiessen 2014), on register or discourse types (e.g., genre), on methodology (e.g., corpus linguistics), etc. Such symbiotic approaches have been applied fruitfully for many years: Lentz & Pander Maat (1997), for example, demonstrated that functional approaches to the study of language may be used not only to characterise discourse structures,

1 This is an up-dated version of my guest lecture at the University of Pavia on 04/12/19. I wish to thank my partners Maria Freddy, Guo Ya and Andrew Tollet for discussions and suggestions of improvement. Marina Ivanova allowed me to reuse data from her MA thesis, recoded them according to my project and found the most suitable examples.

but also to assess their communicative quality, since discourse analysis and evaluation are conceptually related activities. The combination of corpus-linguistic methodology and academic writing has been explored in Camiciotti & Togniini-Bonelli (eds. 2004), the combination of evaluation and corpus-linguistics by Hunston & Thompson (2000). Hunston (2011: 10f) discusses the key terms appraisal, evaluation, and stance on a systemic functional basis. The current theoretical summary on synergy of SFL and Corpus Linguistics is provided by Chang (2020) and several other contributions in this volume.

1.2. Reviews in Systemic-Functional Linguistics

Halliday & Matthiessen (2014: 42) mention reviews in their section on context:

> Reviews range from opinions that might be shared in casual conversation to analytical evaluations of the kind we would expect from expert reviewers contributing to quality newspapers. Since both 'sharing' and 'exploring' contexts are important sites for the instantiation, and (in the phylogenetic time-frame) for the evolution, of interpersonal meaning, there are likely to be interesting changes in patterns of interpersonal meaning-making – more profound than the addition of 'emoticons' to written conversation to make up for some of the loss of intonation and voice quality in spoken language. Of course, technological advances do not affect only 'sharing' and 'exploring' contexts, but also the other types of situation characterized in terms of sociosemiotic activities in Figure 1-1. However, the development of social media does indicate the extent to which companies are trying to leverage people's need for 'sharing' and orientation towards the interpersonal.

Of course, this is a modern concept of reviews, as it includes social media, but it is also very broad. This 'sharing' and 'exploring' includes any opinion, whereas 'reviews" require a certain level of expertise (at least through user experience) as a basis for 'exploring', i.e., a critical analysis and analytical evaluation. Although author and reader of reviews must be on a similar level to be able to 'share' in a discourse community, the reviewer must usually indicate some experience to come across as credibly useful. In contrast to personal opinions expressed in conversation, today's reviews are digital and distanced, so that this lack of personal acquaintance must be balanced by language clues indicating 'expertise' or 'experience'. Halliday & Matthiessen (2014: 51) emphasise the "fundamental" role of a corpus and its stratification for language analysis, but they do not include the genre model and genre-specific language in their discussions of text and register and rather refer to other works by Martin and Matthiessen (e.g., Martin & Rose 2008). The language of analytical evaluation received a new functional impact in the seminal contribution by Martin & White (2005). They locate appraisal mainly in the interpersonal function with a focus on tenor, which may signal power and solidarity (Figure 1.17, p. 34) and recontextualise Halliday's register in their stratified model of social context "to include a more abstract level of patterning called genre" (ibid: 32). They provide the greater frame for the semantics of reviews. Appraisal is comprised of attitude (including affect, judgement, appreciation), engagement, and graduation (Martin & White 2005: 35) and "the development of engagement as a resource for managing the play of voices in discourse" (Martin & White 2005: xi). In reviews, this "play of voices" is the negotiation of evaluation through a

writer – (construed) reader dialogue with argumentation, assertion, concession, counter-expectation, etc.:

> Broadly speaking **engagement** is concerned with the ways in which resources such as projection, modality, polarity, concession and various comment adverbials position the speaker/writer with respect to the value position being advanced and with respect to potential responses to that value position.
>
> **Judgement** is concerned with resources for assessing behaviour according to various normative principles, for example criticism …
>
> **Appreciation** looks at resources for construing the value of things (Martin & White 2005: 35-6)

For our purposes of analysing reviews from this power (status) perspective, we can combine engagement and appreciation as solidarity and judgement as distancing evaluation aspects or face (cf. 2.2 below).

Although this view seems central to academic reviews, Martin & White mention the genre of reviews only in two contexts, namely film and news reviews:

> We find unexceptional all manner of publicly-presented positive evaluations – for example, favourable arts reviews, positively-disposed journalistic commentaries, obituaries, and 'this-is-your-life' style television programmes. (Martin & White 2005: 5)

The related Appraisal Website, developed by P. R. R. White, also focusses on media and not on academic discourse. Even in his more recent publications (like White 2015), White does not mention academic texts and academic reviews. The methodological and genre limitation of appraisal and evaluation studies is further discussed by Thompson (2008: 185), who rightly argues in favour of a broadening of perspectives towards discourse and corpus analysis:

> I would argue strongly in favor of a recognition that it is important, as far as is practical, to sharpen the definition of the categories, and to tether analyses of evaluation firmly to the wording selected by the writer or speaker. Only by doing that can we avoid the charge that we are merely providing an idiosyncratic and impressionistic commentary on discourse rather than a replicable linguistic analysis.

Recent research has expanded SFL to the evaluation of academic reviews. In terms of Xu & Nesi (2017: 1), reviews are a clear case of "the research world, where the choice of evaluation must be affected by the writer's argumentative intention".

2. Concepts

2.1. The Genre of Reviews

The current (02/06/20) entry s.v. *review* in the Oxford English Dictionary online makes it clear that although the lexeme *review* is very old in English (from Middle French), the entry as a text type or genre only comes considerably later:

> 7.
>
> a. An account or critical appraisal of a book or (now also) a play, film, concert, etc. [1649-]
>
> b. A periodical publication consisting mainly of critical articles on current and cultural events, new books, the arts, etc. Frequently in the titles of such publications. [1705-]
>
> c. A critical appraisal of a product, service, etc., intended for the guidance of consumers. [1914-]

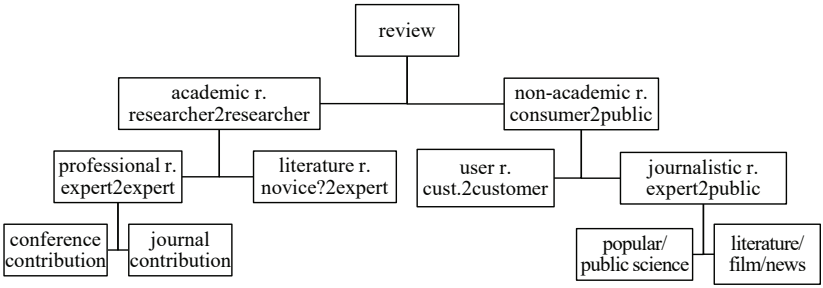


Figure 1 Types of review by author-reader relationship

The military meanings in the OED seem more prominent than the text meanings – and not a word of digital or on-line review, although this seems most prominent in the 21st century, at least in academic circles.

If we see genres as community-specific "professional practices" (Bhatia 2004), we can perceive reviews today always in digital form and developing in two directions: user, consumer or customer reviews should be written "peer-to-peer" (or p2p) in non-professional style (although cheating or even 'professional' fake reviews in on-line commerce seems big business), and peer reviews of (proposals of) journal articles or conference abstracts should be written in professional style. Since both review genres are gaining in importance and popularity, they need "guidelines" to integrate novices into the business in a satisfactory way. Whether a review is accepted or helpful (cf. Filieri 2015, Skalicky 2013, Mudambi & Schuff 2010) depends on the pragmatic impact on the readers of reviews in a reviewer – author dialogue that balances solidarity and constructive criticism, i.e., the positive face of positive appreciation and the negative face of negative judgement. To measure the "strength" of a review, graded opinions can be found on both sides of the dialogue: reviewers may indicate explicitly how confident they feel about their expertise, and consumers may indicate how useful they found a review.

Figure 1 may clarify the complex system of reviews, although even this is a simplified version. We discuss in detail conference (contribution/presentation) reviews as special cases of (professional) academic reviews, i.e., reviews as an independent text type written in an academic context by specialists for their colleagues, which is why they can also be called peer reviews, together with reviews of journal articles. Related texts are expert-to-expert reviews of other publications like book, film or news(paper) reviews, again either public reviews in journals or on www pages or internal (pre-publication) reviews of book proposals or journal article proposals for publishers. Literature reviews written by young academics as part of their theses, often as a chapter on concepts and methodology after the introduction, are only partial texts and less peer-to-peer. Of course, a brief literature review is included in all conference and journal contributions and state-of-the-art articles

may be even a complete text in between a journal article and book review, for instance. Completely different conventions apply to non-academic reviews, as they are consumer-to-public communication, written either by people involved in political discourse or customers in commercial discourse. The difference between consumer and customer review is that the latter focusses not only on the product, but also the shop or service. Neither concept is yet included in the standard dictionaries such as the OED or Miriam-Webster online because all the non-professional2public options have expanded enormously since the internet revolution. On this new platform, the entire ideal of the public understanding of science is a relatively new and important concept that covers several genres and readerships. In all these types of reviews, the functional context is quite different: expert-to-expert reviews are written for peers to advance research (through oral papers at conferences and written papers in journals). Literature reviews in this sense are written in a hierarchical setting to (demonstrate that the author can) digest research (or find a research gap); customer reviews are written to share an experience with peers; and the public discourse on news includes news reviews, usually by professional journalists to the general public, but possibly even letters-to-the-editor and the (infamous?) social media tweets or posts, where the hierarchy is reversed and where sections of 'the public' reject the cooperative discourse we have taken for granted (Schmied fc). New digital affordances, as usual, bring both opportunities and threats …

Of course, there are also many exceptions to the types presented in Figure 1: literature reviews may be discussed by students peer-to-peer so that they learn from one another before learning from the teacher; book or film reviews may be "sponsored", news reviews may be biased "propaganda", and hotel reviews may not be written by real customers, but bought from a "service". All these different purposes require different linguistic usages that can be analysed.

As modern on-line reviews lack a direct personal relationship, this can be achieved by appropriate interactive metadiscourse strategies. For consumer reviews (e.g., TripAdvisor, Amazon, Netflix, Epicurious, and Yelp), this has been analysed by Vásquez (2015), who found mainly oral discourse markers (e.g., *well*, *you know*), but also (simulated) questions and answers – all features that help to focus on interesting interpersonal dialogue functions (cf. Text 2 and Table 2 below). Similarly, Tian (2013) focusses on engagement features in hotel reviews.

Even if we focus on academic texts, a wide audience or readership of reviews with different functional needs is possible. Relatively few books on academic literature reviews take a perspective as wide as Efron & Ravid (2019: 30), who list professors or dissertation committees, faculty, private or public grant committees, publishers, practitioners in the field, policymakers, workplace colleagues, scholarly community, and general public – but they include neither SFL nor face, concessions or politeness, the key concepts of this contribution.

2.2. Academic Peer Reviews

Traditionally, academic peer reviews are double-blind (sometimes also called double-anonymous (e.g., by publishers such as Taylor & Francis). Figure 2 illustrates the system. It applies to all subgenres, i.e proposed contributions to journals or edited books as well as to conferences today: an author submits a text that must be anonymised and follow the formal guidelines of the text genre of academic article or conference abstract (length, content sections/moves, references, keywords etc.), usually through a submission system to an editor or conference organiser, who chooses two reviewers and they return a text (sometimes also a standardised form) in the genre (academic) review to the editor or organiser, who decides on this basis whether to accept the proposal (or not!) and which reviewer comments to pass on to the author. The comments basically serve as guidelines for improvement, but they usually include a "clear verdict", such as "reject" (i.e., not appropriate for this journal/conference or too much work to make it fit), "accept", which can be qualified "as is" or "publishable/presentable with minor corrections" or "publishable or presentable after extensive revision" (for phraseological examples of all these categories see Paltridge 2017). Both sides are "blind" in the sense that the reviewers do not know the author(s), although they may guess from self-citations (if they have not been removed) or specialisation, and that the authors do not know the reviewer, although they may guess from a list of professional specialists published as journal advisors or academic conference committee. Of course, "blind" does not mean that the two sides do not know each other in principle, because specialists are part of the same academic discourse community, i.e., they publish in the same journals and attend the same conferences, so that the reviewer usually gets to know the author later. However, the direct connection between author and reviewer is blocked in this text evaluation process (indicated by two strokes in Figure 1). Even then, the review process, like all academic gate-keeping, includes face-threatening acts, risks for cooperative professional communication, which the editor/organiser has to handle professionally, especially in the case of rejections or critical comments by the editor/organiser. As gate-keepers, they are responsible for ensuring that journal readers, and conference participants feel well-served professionally.

In open peer reviews, reviewers may choose themselves to comment on reviews professionally, and they can not only indicate their professional judgement in their rating, but also their confidence openly. As in traditional peer reviews, open peer reviews can be single-blind, where the reviewer does know the author, or double-blind, where the reviewer does not know the author (or fully open, where both reviewer and author are known). Still, the professional dialogue between author and reviewer in Figure 2 below is not blocked by an editor, so authors can rebut reviews and improve their contributions, although finally the conference organiser (or editor) remains the ultimate gate-keeper and decides. This opportunity of open dialogue makes an objective, unbiased, constructive professional academic discourse even more necessary, hence our emphasis on balancing the solidarity and judgement functions of open reviews.

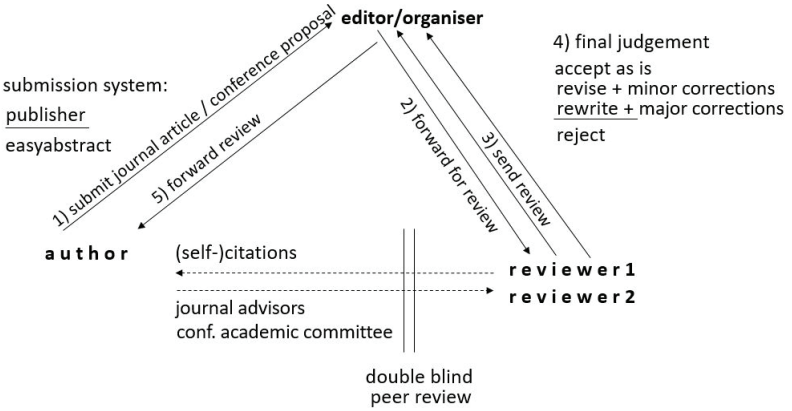


Figure 2 Processes in double-blind peer review

Conference reviews are good examples of research-oriented evaluation in the sense of Thetela (1997), where the worthiness of a proposal is discussed and hopefully increased through a complex evaluation process including more or less fixed and transparent variables like significance of topic, methodological rigour, innovative character in the field, clarity and appropriateness of presentation, etc.

Interestingly, the contributions on "Academic Evaluation and Review Genres" in Hyland & Diani (eds. 2009) hardly mention conference reviews and focus on literature and book reviews – and this is normal in a rich and expanding field. A very vivid presentation of the challenges of reviewer – author interaction can be found in Tardy (2019).

The most detailed analysis of peer reviews is Paltridge (2017). He uses a phraseological SFL perspective (with many concrete examples), also focuses on reviews as face-threatening interaction and has a whole chapter on politeness, in which he even identifies features of accepted and rejected reviews (esp. Paltridge 2017: 100-111), but he analyses a small corpus of academic journal reviews (71,661 words). Although he emphasises that reviewers may want to minimise the imposition on authors in relation to the changes they require and may "bracket" their negative comment in an otherwise overall positive review (ibid: 101), he does not mention concessive constructions. It is important to bear in mind that in journal reviews reviewers may direct their comments to the author directly or leave it to the editor to decide and communicate criticism to the author.

2.3. Professional Discourse

Professional discourse is a relatively new term in genre discussions (in contrast to language learning). It has been defined by Gunnarson (2009: 5) and Schnurr (2013: 14) simply as text and talk "in professional contexts for professional purposes" and they have emphasised that expectations and norms of what is considered appropriate change over time with technological affordances and occupational or institutional contexts. When we analyse these current linguistic technological-institutional usages in academic (conference proposal) reviews, we see on the one hand the dialogic character, which is essential for the advancement of science, and on the other hand the business-like relationship and communication (in contrast to personal or private communication). Professional communication among peers must be characterised by the common aim of guaranteeing conference contributions that are appreciated by conference participants, as well as maintaining a good working relationship between peers, e.g., for future conferences. Thus, although the evaluative character of reviews makes the negative elements face-threatening, they must be brought across in un-emotional, polite style and the constructive character must be felt through a good balance between praise and criticism (solidarity and critical judgement), which is guaranteed by polite elements in the interpersonal metafunctions and contrastive and concessive elements in the textual metafunctions. Halliday & Matthiesen (2014: 38) summarise: "Tenor considerations thus include the range of 'voices' taking part in the different socio-semiotic activities, including degrees of expertise and of professionalism".

2.4. Functional Elements for Professional Reviews

For professional reviews, we expect a dialogic process of reviewing to lead to a better conference or journal contribution. This is why the final message "accept" (or "reject") must be clearly based on a polite and transparent argumentation in logical metafunctions. From functional linguistics perspectives, several concepts can be applied to reviews: here we focus on theme-rheme patterns, concessive/contrastive argumentation structures from the intertextual metafunction and (grammatical) politeness features from the interpersonal metafunction.

The semantic relationship between the system of information and the system of theme is explained by Halliday & Matthiesen (2014: 120):

> But although they are related, Given + New and Theme + Rheme are not the same thing. The Theme is what I, the speaker, choose to take as my point of departure. The Given is what you, the listener, already know about or have accessible to you. Theme + Rheme is speaker-oriented, while Given + New is listener-oriented.

Normally, the theme–rheme refers to the order of clause elements, but in the clause complex it can refer to clause sequence (Halliday & Matthiesen 2014: 51-53), where enhancing hypotactic, dependent clauses (e.g., *although*) may serve as theme. Of course, from the clausal level we can move up to the textual level where such sequences may be an important element to lead the reader to the final evaluation rheme, "accept" or "reject". All these sequences and chains contribute to an

overall cohesion in the genre of academic reviews, especially for conferences and journals.

A major functional feature of professional reviews are concessives (cf. König 1988 and 2006), since they serve as quick contrastive moves in the information progression, balancing positive evaluations of solidarity with negative evaluations of judgement. Halliday & Matthiessen (2014: 478) subsume concessives under enhancement and distinguish at least three types of indicators: paratactic (prototypical *but* and *yet, still, nevertheless*), which is often also called contrastive and has only regressive function, hypotactic (prototypical *although* and *though, even though/if*, and parts of *while*), which can be used finite or non-finite with gerunds and (non-finite) prepositions (prototypical *despite* and *in spite of, without*) – in the following comparison we concentrate on the prototypical lexemes *but*, *(al)though*, and *despite/in spite of*, which are also the most frequent.

The role of concession and counter-assertion in reviews has been demonstrated by Hunston (2011: 46f). Martin & White (2005: 134) include concessions in their diagram "The engagement system" (Figure 3.3): contract → disclaim → counter (including the diverse lexical examples *yet, although, amazingly, but*).

However, established textbooks on literature reviews (e.g., Galvan & Galvan 2015) do not focus on concessive constructions. But they do include politeness features (usually based on Brown & Levinson 1987) because reviews can be perceived as face threatening (Galvan & Galvan 2015: 28-35) and they distinguish, just like us: "Face work that is aimed at positive face is called "solidarity politeness … Face work that deals with negative face is known as "respect politeness" (ibid: 29).

Finally, although Halliday & Matthiessen do not focus on reviews, reviews are full of positive and negative proposals (2014: 697). For them (2014:705), "[t]he tenor variables are usually discussed in terms of status, formality, face, tact and politeness". From the politeness features investigated in this paper, they include *I would, you/he could/should*, convenient indicators in many genres, not only reviews (cf. 3.5 below). They are also prominent in the empirical examples from journal reviews in Paltridge (2017: 100-111).

3. Conference Reviews: A Case Study in Academic Evaluation

3.1. Open Reviews as a Data-Base

3.1.1. *Developments in Digital/On-Line Reviews*

Traditionally the principle of double-blind peer review meant that only journal editors or conference organisers had access to a wide range of comparative texts, which usually remain anonymous and unpublished. The development of open peer reviews offers an initial opportunity to collect systematically such texts and relevant criteria, at least in some academic fields. This procedure should create transparency and increase professional discourse as described above. Corpus linguistic research can thus compare linguistic features indicating professionality in this specific genre for the first time.

Professionality here can be defined as a combination of transparent criteria and constructive style. In many reviews, fit (to conference audience or journal readership), novelty, size (of study), scope, and relevance (in the field or wider application context) are valuable criteria, which do not have to have the same weight in the final rating and can always be adapted. In a complex appraisal approach, this judgement must be balanced out by solidarity features (e.g., compliments in Johnson 1992).

The final criterion for every reviewer should always be "Would you like to receive this review yourself and find it useful not only in a short-term perspective (this conference or this journal number), but in a long-term perspective for scientific and personal development". Thus, polite language is the necessary basis for a constructive critical style in conference proposal reviews, which are a major stepping stone towards a successful conference paper and conference. The argumentation in the review must fit the evaluative judgement between "accept" and "reject". Professional reviewers must encourage authors to continue improving their work by construing partnership as well as accepted expertise in their professional discourse community, based on solidarity and judgement.

Many professional discourse specialists have emphasised the desire of young scholars to gain acceptance (Belcher 2007) and the gate-keeping role of reviews (e.g., Habibie & Hyland Eds. 2019) in the advancement of professional knowledge:

> Whatever its origins, a knowledge claim's 'career progression' towards the status of an accepted theory depends on academic publication and the preceding gate-keeping activity of editors and peer-reviewers, with further validation of the knowledge claim, or new theory, occurring when other researchers take it up in their own work as if it were true. (Smart, Currie & Falconer 2014: 86)

3.1.2. *A Corpus of Open Peer Reviews in Conferences on* Learning Representations

Since conference contributions are usually chosen on the basis of conference abstracts, i.e., short presentation proposals that have to be handed in months before the conference is opened, they usually do not have to prove that the underlying research project is finished, but only that it is "promising" according to transparent criteria (such as originality or centrality in the field) and academically sound (such as methodologically rigorous or conceptually sophisticated in the field). Here group-specific language use plays a major role in the choice of technical terms and presentation style, but many features of professional metalanguage can be analysed on a broader academic basis. At least this perspective is open for general academic researchers and open for comparison on the basis of a good (machine-readable) corpus.

As most conference abstracts today have to be submitted via an on-line submission system, they are always available in digital form and can be compiled easily, which is often difficult for professional discourse (e.g., Cheng 2014). This is particularly true when open reviews are encouraged, as is established practice in some conferences today, e.g., the International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)[2]. This provides a good opportunity to compare reviews. Table 1 gives details of our data-base. This shows that the ICLR organisers changed the review process[3] from single- (2017) to double-blind (2018 and 2019), and interestingly, this does not seem to have a major impact on the pragmatics of the review texts, so that this difference is ignored in the following calculations, except when it is particularly striking. The relative figures show that every year half of the proposals were rejected and only a third was accepted as oral presentations in 2018 and 2019, the rest was accepted as a poster (but they were not all included in the database). The average length of the reviews increased over the years (300 – 400 – 450 words/text), but this did not affect the acceptance (in 2017 accepted proposal reviews were shorter than those of rejected ones, in 2018 they were longer).

The figures also show that the reviews are relatively long. This may be due to the fact that ICLR contributions are much longer than other conference abstracts, in fact with "strong recommendation" of keeping the length at eight pages (plus one-page references + appendices). The abstracts are basically short papers and thus the reviews analysed here are a compromise between abstract and conference paper. This makes this type of review more generally a more rewarding read than ordinary short reviews, which may only be of interest to the conference organiser and the author. Thus, it is also more valuable in terms of the overarching aim of advancing science in discourse. An additional advantage of the open review is that they can be commented on anonymously, even by the authors. As it is a special feature of ICLR conferences to have a six-week "rebuttal period" after the submission, these comments are not included in the following analysis.

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[2] In addition to publishing their conference reviews, ICLR encourages transparency and public discourse through internal and external comments. They even guide their readers to "great in-depth resources on reviewing" with programmatic titles like "Criticising with Kindness" or "Mistakes Reviewers Make" (https://iclr.cc/Conferences/2020/ReviewerGuide, 01/04/20). The link to the "Last minute reviewing advice" even focusses on multiple-reviews ICLR style. Many personalised comments by "excellent reviewers" provide valuable insights; e.g., Yoav Artzi writes:

> Treating reviewing as a dialog is key to clarify reviewer confusion and refine the criticism. This is a dialog between the reviewers, but also the authors. I find discussion between reviewers useful to understanding muddled parts paper, and better identifying its strengths and weaknesses.

[3] This procedure "double-blind but open" is explained on the webpage: "reviewers cannot see author names when performing reviews, and authors cannot see reviewer names. While we will still use Open Review to host papers and allow for public discussions that can be seen by all, comments that are posted by reviewers will remain anonymous".
https://iclr.cc/archive/www/doku.php%3Fid=iclr2018:conference_cfp.html (last accessed 28/04/20)

	Single-blind 2017		Double-blind 2018		Double-blind 2019		Sum	
	#	words	#	words	#	words	#	words
Accept Oral	36	9,400	60	22,787	33	16,419	129	48,606
Accept Poster	86	24,609	29	14,923	15	6,892	130	46,424
Reject	120	36,533	109	43,231	54	22,691	283	102,455
Sum	242	70,542	198	80,941	102	46,002	542	197,485

Table 1 The ICLR review corpus

3.2. Qualitative Analyses of Concessive Sentences

The following examples from the ICLR review corpus illustrate different types of concessive structures in the wider argumentation. The concession can be in the first or the second clause, i.e., a progressive or regressive sequence. M/H (2014: 551) argue that "the sequence of clauses is iconic with the sequence of events" and Diessel (2008) identifies iconicity as the most influential factor for sequencing. If we apply this concept from temporal to concessive constructions in reviews, we may be able to interpret the sequences in terms of an iconic drift towards the final verdict "accept" or "reject": in "accept" reviews negative concessions are only small asides in an overall "positive" argumentation and in "reject" reviews positive concessions are only asides in an overall "negative" argumentation (this is why the Rating and Confidence scores are included in the following examples). The final verdict "accept" or "reject" is also the overall rheme in a conference review. The reviewer argues towards this judgement through a carefully structured sequence of positive and negative theme-rheme chains. The conference organisers and proposal writers must be convinced that this is good for the conference and the presenter, and ultimately contributes to the advancement of science.

In such an ideal constructive interactive discourse, concessives are particularly useful because they allow a balanced presentation of positive and negative critical aspects. Here the sequence may be important for a constructive interpersonal atmosphere. Concessive conjunctions like *although* can be used in the first or the second clause, i.e. progressive or regressive orientation; contrastive constructions like *but* can only be used in regressive orientation; both can be used for positive or negative evaluation. The following examples are just a short introduction into the complexities of argumentative chains in the open reviews analysed.

(1), also extended to 1Rn[4], includes a regressive *although*, a concessive conjunction in the second negative, critical clause that refers back to a positive clause with a more general praise and continues with further critical points:

[4] The indices after the sentence number indicate the direction (the concessive conjunct refers back to the first clause or forward to the second clause) and the evaluation of the concessive clause: R=regressive, P=progressive and n=negative, p=positive.

(1) 1Rn "Presentation is in general good *although* at parts readability is hindered. I feel that the notation is unnecessarily complicated, and some parts of the text too". (ICLR17_R1_R357, Rating 5/10, Confidence 3/5)

In (2), a negative clause is followed by a positive concessive clause, but this does not really constitute praise, and the review continues with another complex sentence with contrastive clauses – so, again not surprisingly, the rating is low and the proposal not accepted:

(2) 2Rp "The algorithm introduces too many hyper-hyperparameters, *although* the authors do acknowledge this. While I do believe that projecting into a compact domain is necessary (see […]), the other parameters should ideally be relaxed or estimated from the evolution of the algorithm". (ICLR18_R1_R487, Rating 5/10, Confidence 3/5)

In (3), the (hedged!) positive concessive clause leads on to a negative main clause and more criticism – this leads clearly to a convinced "reject" in the end:

(3) 3Pp "*Although* point 2 seems novel, I am not convinced that it is significant enough for ICLR. I was also not sure …". (ICLR18_R1_R302, Rating 4/10, Confidence 4/5)

(4) starts with a negative concessive and ends with a positive argument, so that the two are balanced out, although the overall rating is "intermediate":

(4) 4Pn "*Although* the experimental results are not quite persuasive, the method is nice and promising". (ICLR18_R3_R118, Rating 6/10, Confidence 4/5)

But conjunctions can only be used with regressive orientation, the difference between the two *but* clauses (5) & (6) is that they may contain a positive (5) or negative (6) evaluation and the concessive evaluation is embedded in the same overall review evaluation, which is also made explicit in the following sentences. An interesting contrast between (5) & (6) is also that the negation in (5) is a form of praise, followed by others and a doubly hedged *complaint* (*only* + *bit*) – leading to an overall positive rating, whereas in (6) the negation is clearly a criticism (*not convinced*!), emphasised by the critical noun *claims* and the following list of negative *Minor points*:

(5) 5Rp To conclude, I like the paper: (1) is not really novel *but* it doesn't seem other papers have done this before so it's nice to know it works well, and (2) is quite neat and also works well. The paper is easy to follow, results are good. My only complaint is that it's a bit too long. (ICLR17_R3_P100, Rating 7/10, Confidence 4/5)

(6) 6Rn I very much like the idea of the paper, *but* I am simply not convinced by its claims. Minor points: - There are quite a few typos… (ICLR17_R3_R279, Rating 4/10, Confidence 4/5)

Since both these *but*s do not seem strong nor introduce an important contrast in argumentation ((5) does not even include a comma to set off the following *but*

contrast clearly), it may be worth contrasting them with two sentence-initial strong negative *but* clauses in (7) (where the negative taken up by *this* from the preceding clause is strongly hedged by *might*) and (8), which lead on to completely different positive and negative overall evaluations, respectively:

(7) 7Rn The SOTA [state of the art] claim might not hold if baselines are given the same capacity. *But* regardless of this, the paper has very strong contributions and deserves acceptance at ICLR. (ICLR18_R1_O831, Rating 8/10, Confidence 4/5)
(8) 8Rn According to the paper, it may give better generalization performance. *But* there is no theoretical or experimental evidence provided by this paper to support this argument. (ICLR18_R1_R118, Rating 4/10, Confidence 4/5)

Equally, the concessive prepositions *despite/in spite of* introduce short concessive phrases. (9) can be seen as a prototypical case: the argumentation runs towards a clear rejection, so the "promising" is only a short positive friendly aside. (10) is interesting because the *claim* signals that the phrase is not really positive, which is elaborated on by *far from exhaustive*; this is stressed by reiterating the same lexeme later in the phrase *extensive discussion* and the hypothetical *would expect* – and this polite but clear rejection is backed up by a strong confidence rate. (11) is interesting because the *cons* are just mentioned and counterbalanced immediately by the following *given*, the final rating is positive – but with the explicit hedge *I think* and only with low Confidence:

(9) 9Pp Despite promising results, the proposed technique is quite unclear from the paper. (ICLR18_R3_R748, Rating 4/10, Confidence 4/5)
(10) 10Pp? *Despite* claims to the contrary, the experiments are far from extensive; they explore two models, with variations in context for embeddings, with 3 optimizers, on just one task. To be an extensive discussion of "text", I would expect to see language-modeling and seq-to-seq tasks as well. (ICLR18_R3_Wd265, Rating 4/10, Confidence 5/5)
(11) 11Pn "*Despite* the cons and given that more modeling details are provided, I think this paper will be a valuable contribution." (ICLR17_R3_P9, Rating 8/10, Confidence 3/5)

When *despite* is used regressively, it usually refers to a minor, subordinate aspect, be it negative (in (12)) or slightly ambiguous (in (13)) as the *much simpler model* comes across as negative at first sight, but if it really produces impressive gains this must be seen as positive in the end:

(12) 12Rn "Ablation studies with large numbers of tweaks are always difficult and this one is welcome and useful *despite* the ambiguity. On a related note, it would be nice…" (ICLR18_O2_O447, Rating 8/10, Confidence 4/5)
(13) 13Rp? "The results show impressive gains over the baseline, *despite* using a much simpler model. I appreciated …" (ICLR18_R2_R247. Rating 7/10, Confidence 4/5)

3.3. Qualitative Text Analyses

As many of these sentence-based examples show, all these important review elements have to be seen in the context of the complete review text. This is why at least two examples may illustrate that the interplay of logical, interpersonal and textual elements is complex. The overall judgement is positive in one example and negative in the other. So the theme-rheme chain of evaluative phrases and moves must convincingly lead to this overall verdict in the end.

The following text (Text 1 with evaluative phrases highlighted) offers a particularly interesting example of a very positive and still critical-constructive review. Going through the individual paragraphs and moves, we notice:

The summative paragraph at the beginning gives top marks for quality, high marks for style and topic. The following sentence enhances the excellent rating with implicit "state-of the-art" praise and slightly hedged positive marks for style (*quite well-written*) and method (*relatively thorough*).

The next three paragraphs are basically all negative moves. The first two point out two major weaknesses called "caveat": the concessive *although* clause does not mitigate the following criticism, but queries the claim *general* by writing *intended*; the criticism "no" seems harsh, but the idealistic *guarantees* make it easy for the readers/authors and the reviewer to continue in a constructive, *encourage*ing mode (other *papers often* and *future*) with a positive aside on the valuable data sets. The reviewer even leaves the authors an easy way out by the conditional *if*, the polite *please* and the double suggestion *justify* or *clarify*, both presupposing a basically correct, possibly only under-explained procedure. The second caveat points out a detail that the authors have already *note*d, which is not explicitly called a problem, though it is treated as a problem through the use of the collocate *resolved* to make a *comparison* with *related work meaningful* – this could have been called a "contradiction" or worse. Even the phrase *would need* is much more polite than the aggressive alternative *must*. *Finally*, the reviewer obviously reiterates the authors' self-critical limitations, questioning in generalisability to other (natural) data, for which the data sets used would have to be known – a surprisingly polite and decent criticism, as transparency is a standard academic virtue.

Overall, this very positive review has only relatively few unhedged absolute words of praise and surprisingly many critical points, but they are always "wrapped up" in polite phrases. An automatic analysis of concessive constructions or negative lexemes would not provide clear evidence that this proposal is ranked as top with confidence; however, the negative phrases are always constructive recommendations for further improvement. This positive review also shows that concessives are not used very often, and that *although* is used here as a positive "intention" that is not "guaranteed" in an overall negative argumentation. This contradicts the expectation that in positive reviews concessives are included as small negative elements in an overall positive argumentation flow of theme-rheme chains towards the final rheme "accept" (even if in an executive summary style, the final judgment in this review style is at the beginning and not the end of the text).

Text 1: Prototypical positive review from the ICLR review corpus
Model accept (ICLR17_R2_O5, Rating 9/10, Confidence 4/5)
A nice contribution to differentially-private deep learning
ICLR 2017 conference AnonReviewer2
16 Dec 2016 ICLR 2017 conference official review
Rating: 9: Top 15% of accepted papers, strong accept
Review: Altogether a very good paper, a nice read, and interesting. The work advances the state of the art on differentially-private deep learning, is quite well-written, and relatively thorough.
One caveat is that although the approach is intended to be general, no theoretical guarantees are provided about the learning performance. Privacy-preserving machine learning papers often analyze both the privacy (in the worst case, DP setting) and the learning performance (often under different assumptions). Since the learning performance might depend on the choice of architecture; future experimentation is encouraged, even using the same data sets, with different architectures. If this will not be added, then please justify the choice of architecture used, and/or clarify what can be generalised about the observed learning performance.
Another caveat is that the reported epsilons are not those that can be privately released; the authors note that their technique for doing so would change the resulting epsilon. However this would need to be resolved in order to have a meaningful comparison to the epsilon-delta values reported in related work.
Finally, as has been acknowledged in the paper, the present approach may not work on other natural data types. Experiments on other data sets is strongly encouraged. Also, please cite the data sets used.

Text 2 exemplifies a negative review (again with evaluative statements highlighted). This can be seen from the large number of polite hedges, from the prototypical *tries* and *seems* to many *can* constructions and questions. Structurally, the first three *Review* sentences (after the bad rating in the polite words *marginally below acceptance threshold*) are a relatively neutral evaluation; then five paragraphs list general comments/questions, four with negation (*no, mis-, not, n't*), but also with polite down-toners (*a bit, please, should/should*); and finally, three comment paragraphs list clear instructions in hedged verb forms (*should, would, seems*). In contrast to the positive review in Text 1, the frequency of these "critical" features clearly indicate that this is a "reject". Thus, in this text the argumentation flow is clearly indicated by a series of negative chains that justify the final rheme "marginally below" (in the executive rating at the beginning of the text again).

Text 2: Prototypical negative review from the ICLR review corpus
Model reject (ICLR17_R1_R203, Rating 5/10, Confidence 4/5)
ICLR 2017 conference AnonReviewer1
20 Dec 2016 ICLR 2017 conference official review
Rating: 5: Marginally below acceptance threshold

Review: This paper proposes a method for transfer learning, i.e. leveraging a network trained on some original task A in learning a new task B, which not only improves performance on the new task B, but also tries to avoid degradation in performance on A. The general idea is based on encouraging a model trained on A, while training on the new task B, to match fake targets produced by the model itself but when it is trained only on the original task A.
Experiments show that this method can help in improving the result on task B, and is better than other baselines, including standard fine-tuning.

General comments/questions:
- As far as I can tell, there is no experimental result supporting the claim that your model still performs well on the original task. All experiments show that you can improve on the new task only.
- The introduction makes a strong statements [sic] about the distilling logical rule engine into a neural network, which I find a bit misleading. The approach in the paper is not specific to transferring from logical rules (as stated in the Sec 2) and is simply relying on the rule engine to provide labels for unlabelled data.
- One of the obvious baselines to compare with your approach is standard multi-task learning on both tasks A and B together. That is, you train the model from scratch on both tasks simultaneously (which sharing parameters). It is not clear this is the same as what is referred to in Sec. 8 as "joint training". Can you please explain more clearly what you refer to as joint training?
- Why can't we find the same baselines in both Table 2 and Table 3? For example Table 2 is missing "joint training", and Table 3 is missing GRU trained on the target task.
- While the idea is presented as a general method for transfer learning, experiments are focused on one domain (sentiment analysis on SemEval task). I think that either experiments should include applying the idea on at least one other different domain, or the writing of the paper should be modified to make the focus more specific to this domain/task.

Writing comments
- The writing of the paper in general needs some improvement, but more specifically in the experiment section, where experiment setting and baselines should be explained more concisely.
- Ensemble methodology paragraph does not fit the flow of the paper. I would rather explain it in the experiments section, rather than including it as part of your approach.
- Table 1 seems like reporting cross-validation results, and I do not think is very informative to general reader.

3.4. Quantitative Analyses of Concessive Lexemes in Reviews

As explained in 2.4. above, the function of concessives in the widest sense, i.e., balancing out the general final positive or negative decision, can be signalled by

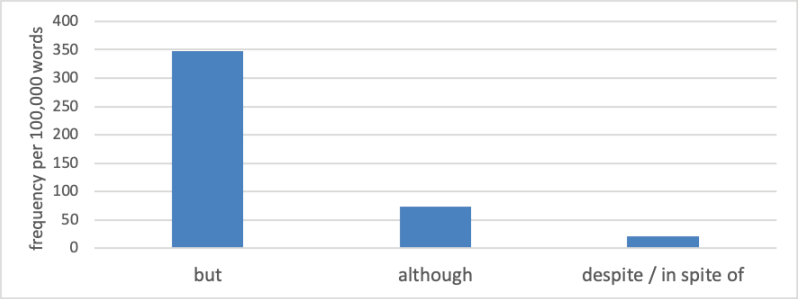


Figure 3 Frequency of concessive conjunctions *but*, *although* and *despite*/*in spite of* (per 100,000)

different indicators. Figure 3 shows the prototypical concessives *but*, *(al)though*, and *despite/in spite of* in the ICLR review corpus. It demonstrates that by far the most frequent linker in absolute and relative terms is the contrastive *but*. Interestingly, it occurs in single-blind 2017 reviews twice as often as in others, whereas the frequencies of other linkers are similar. This may be related to its prototypical unmarked character, which is chosen *ad hoc* in informal styles (which is clearly indicated by the colloquial contractions *n't* and vague phrases like *bit*). Since *but* clauses may only be used regressively, we can only analyse the 58 *although* clauses to find out whether they are used regressively or progressively and it is not surprising that they are used more often progressively (38:20) and clearly in negative argumentation (42:16). Unfortunately, the data-base is too small to analyse *although* clauses further. For instance, negation occurs only eight times in *although* clauses, usually in negative clauses (such as (4) above), but also in three positive clauses and lexemes like *lack* or *hinder* signal implicit negation. Thus, we cannot count automatically the number of positive and negative features, the number of concessives or the number of positive and negative features in rheme position in concessives in order to predict the final judgement.

3.5. Quantitative Analyses of Politeness Features in Reviews

Since academic peer reviews are a face-threatening act (cf. 2.2) with many "challenges" (Tardy 2019), it is not surprising that reviewers include interpersonal "tenor variables" (Halliday & Matthiesen 2014: 704) that may be interpreted as threats, but also politeness strategies to mitigate these threats (cf. Hyland 2004 or Diani 2017).

		accept oral			accept poster			reject		
	Sum	**#**	**/100,000**	**%**	**#**	**/100,000**	**%**	**#**	**/100,000**	**%**
please	104	30	62	29	20	43	19	54	53	52
***ould**	1,509	425	874	28	408	879	27	676	660	45
no*	2,691	599	1,232	22	618	1,331	23	1474	1,439	55
only	382	74	152	19	83	179	22	225	220	59
question*	263	57	117	22	54	116	21	152	148	58
wh*	710	151	311	21	149	321	21	410	400	58
(?)	979	239	492	24	219	472	22	521	509	53

Table 2 Selected politeness features in positive and negative reviews

Table 2 lists absolute and relative frequencies of the most prominent (im)politeness features in our data-base. Since negative reviews are more frequent in our data-base, all features occur most often in the negative part, but the relative frequency depends on their interpersonal function.

Of course, *please* is the most obvious lexeme here and used in "reject" texts most often, but relatively (per 100,000 words) it occurs even more often in "accept oral presentation" texts, because constructive advice is provided even in those texts (as in *Can you please explain more clearly*… in Text 1).

Modal auxiliaries in the tentative past tense form (*could/should/would*) are among the most frequent, but also among the ambiguous indicators of tone in reviews – they occur more frequently in accepted oral and poster presentations than in rejections.

By contrast, negated forms (*no/-body/-one/-thing*) occur in rejections more frequently than in accepted oral presentations with accepted posters in between, as might be expected. Negations are not such a clear indicator if we look at the clause level (as discussed above).

The restrictive *only* is used in negative reviews clearly more often than in positive ones, although they may have different functions: encouragement in positive contexts (*only a little more* …) and disappointment in negative contexts (*only … but not more/all/complete*).

The next three features, the lexeme *question**, *wh-* forms and formal question marks occur most frequently in rejections, as they tend to cast doubt on propositions, but the relative differences are not as dramatic as one might expect.

Overall, we can summarise that the most frequent tenor variables are obviously important in reviews because they maintain the interpersonal relationship in the academic community, but cannot be interpreted automatically as clear indicators of "reject" (for negative features like negations) or "accept" (for positive features like *please*) in academic reviews and thus each usage has to be analysed qualitatively in the sentence context. We cannot count automatically the number of positive and negative interpersonal evaluative markers or politeness features and predict the final judgement.

4. Conclusion

This study has tried to show that Halliday's SFL (as in Halliday & Matthiesen 2014) is a roomy theory to throw new light on an increasingly important genre in academic discourse, the review of conference (contributions) and journal (articles) proposals. These evaluative texts can be analysed in a similar way as appraisals in non-academic reviews (as in Martin & White 2005). A small case study of open double-blind reviews in one modern academic field has analysed interpersonal language features in conference reviews as they can make important contributions to knowledge generation and the advancement of science. Since our small and specific database has allowed us only to establish some important variables for qualitative and quantitative analyses, similar studies are necessary to test this procedure in other academic fields and contexts. Then we may also be able to see whether the conventions indicated here become 'more expected', i.e., rigid as an academic genre.

In view of future developments, it is interesting that traditional (double-blind peer) reviews have been questioned recently in the context of "Corona research". The long and thorough review process has been publically criticised in newspapers, even tabloids, because politicians and the general public wanted to have immediate results of small quick Corona studies on "infection rates" or "virus loads"[5]. The "publications" on pre-publication servers sometimes included little more than expected or preliminary results or descriptive statistics, without any thorough and critical statistic or peer substantiation. Unfortunately, this crisis has also shown that the established mechanisms of professional community-specific evaluation cannot be transferred so easily. Of course, the main difference between professional and public, non-professional discourses on crisis issues is that the functions are radically different: professional discourse aims at careful intragroup construction of preliminary truths, including the constant awareness of uncertainty and falsification; non-professional discourse aims at convincing public construction of established truths that can be used for (political) decision making and action (in media) – even fast reaction in times of crisis. Thus, new studies of non- or semi-professional discourses, such as public views on research or academic reviews for politicians (cf. Efron & Ravid 2019), would be interesting in contrast to the professional peer-to-peer reviews analysed here. The main question is whether these discourses are also driven by the need for constructive polite communication to balance solidarity and critical judgement and to what extent they have the same genre features, or whether these review discourses include enough positive evaluation so that they can still be called appraisal.

[5] An example is the article in *Der Tagespiegel* (25/05/20, 2) *Kritik und Selbstkritik Einst reiften wissenschaftliche Erkenntnisse im kleinen Kreis der Experten.* [Criticism and self-criticism. Scientific findings once matured in a small circle of experts].

Although we can find surprisingly little on intragroup vs. public discourse or "discourse communities" (only "research communities") in Halliday & Matthiessen (2014), such studies could use the established SFL concepts of metadiscourse, theme-rheme, cohesion, concession, etc. Martin & White analyse film reviews which are partly professional-to-professional (e.g., from the New York Film Academy) or professional-to-public (e.g., in *The Guardian*), but also customer-to-customer (e.g., on Amazon web pages). Reviews discussions among the general public could also be expanded to include narratives where professionalism is challenged drastically by claiming that "media reviewers" who have not published for a long time or not at all on the narrow topic are not allowed to contribute to the debate. It is important for a publically acknowledged open science or citizen science that the discussion is balanced and constructive, that criticism is mitigated and community-specific discourse opened up to include transparency and clarity, including all the necessary uncertainty in the case of preliminary results and in case they are used as direct input to policy statements. Here too, a thorough analysis of corpus data within the systemic functional paradigm could make an important contribution.

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Standards in qualitative research: An attempt at unification and transfer

Matthias Hofmann

Chemnitz University of Technology

Abstract

Empirical research is quite varied in terms of being scientific in nature on the one hand and of being of high quality on the other hand. Depending on the methodology, different criteria have been established in the academic literature for measuring and assuring the quality of research in general. These criteria are embedded in the larger framework of operationalising variables and illustrated in detail using linguistic examples in this contribution. Its focus lies on functional qualitative studies. The objective is to arrive at a rather general description and illustration of qualitative research quality criteria as well as to combine them with the quantitative research quality criteria of objectivity, reliability, and validity in order to situate quality criteria in a mixed methods approach. Meeting such criteria places much responsibility on the shoulders of the novice researcher. It can be addressed by a thorough reflection and description of the functional research process as well as a thorough review of existing academic literature on the object of investigation. This contribution explains the implicit requirements for scientific study of excellent quality.

Keywords: academic writing, qualitative research, mixed-methods, rigour, structure, quality criteria

1. Introduction

This contribution aims at shedding light on methodological criteria in empirical research that enhance the quality of a study. Most documentation of empirical research follows a structure, which is usually comprised of an introduction, a literature review, methodology, results and discussion sections, and a conclusion. This structure is particularly conventionalized in journal articles, and may be complemented further by several sub-level headings in monographs or similar works (cf. Hofmann 2019). While functional quantitative empirical research typically follows an epistemological research-theoretical position, in which a thorough literature review provides a sound basis for a potential identification of research gaps or follow-up work, functional qualitative empirical research typically foregrounds a deeper understanding, an interpretation, a reconstruction of empirical phenomena in their context which includes the perspectives, intentions, and attributions of meaning by the participants in such an empirical phenomenon. It is hence less formalized and less strict with regard to structure and methodological rigour, although research gaps are identified, hypotheses are developed, and suitable methods are selected as well.

While, according to Popper's ([1934] 1989) critical rationalism, quantitative research aims at falsification of informed scientific hypotheses, qualitative research derives hypotheses usually on the basis of positive evidence and claims generalisability. However, the hallmark of qualitative research is to find explanations through detailed interpretations of written, verbal, and non-verbal communication as well as observation-based data. The relative confidence scholars have in their interpretations is typically derived from repeated occurrences of the same evidence in their data and repeated interpretative circles. Such indicators and such a procedure help to reach a certain level of validity, although this term is typically used to measure the quality of science in quantitative research designs. A translation of the term validity to be used in qualitative research designs might be the accuracy of interpretations in the sense of contextual credibility. That is, is a certain interpretation, explanation, or sense acceptable given the context of the empirical phenomenon and its human interlocutors under investigation or does it ignore important contextual information.

The above description of qualitative research designs implicitly suggests that qualitative research is a homogeneous research paradigm, which is of course misleading. Qualitative research approaches are comprised of a multitude of different research strategies, scientific theories, and ways of thinking, which came from different disciplines, periods, and national research traditions (cf. Breuer 2018; Creswell 2014; Döring et al. 2016). In this paper, I will focus on basic qualitative research principles and criteria for research quality in qualitative designs which are shared to a certain degree by most qualitative research philosophies such as hermeneutics, phenomenology, praxeology, post-structuralism, grounded-theory-methodology, etc. Various handbooks seem to suggest five basic principles of the qualitative research philosophy: (1) holistic and reconstructive investigations of real-world phenomena; (2) reflective theoretical open-mindedness for the formation of new theories; (3) circularity and flexibility of the research process to approach the object of investigation; (4) a research process based on cooperation and communication between researcher and respondents; (5) self-reflection of the researcher's subjectivity and perspectives (e.g., cf. Bohnsack 2014; Breuer 2018; Döring et al. 2016; Kruse 2020; Lamnek 2016).

In the next part, I will define key concepts such as the criteria for research quality in qualitative research designs, after a brief summary of the controversy associated with it, and in mixed-methods research design. In part three, I bring together the basic principles of quantitative research designs as outlined in Hofmann (2019) and the basic principles outlined in this paper to arrive at a foundation for mixed-methods approaches. Further, I will outline one possible scenario for mixing the two research paradigms within linguistics, bridging the disciplines of corpus linguistics and discourse analysis.

2. Key concepts of research quality in the qualitative paradigm

2.1. The controversy

While the core or main criteria for research quality can be pinned down to objectivity, reliability, and validity within the quantitative research paradigm, such criteria have not been asked for until rather recently in the qualitative research paradigm. This naturally is due to the rather recent increase in the general acceptance of the qualitative research paradigm, and leads to the question of how to derive such criteria: (1) use the criteria from the quantitative paradigm as a role-model and adapt them, or (2) develop qualitative criteria from scratch. The controversy, however, revolves around the question of whether or not such criteria are in fact feasible, given the heterogeneous nature of the paradigm. While subject-specific catalogues for quality criteria by many different authors have accumulated to more than 100 in the social sciences (Noyes et al. 2008), only a few scholars doubt the use and practicability of such uniform criteria for such a heterogeneous paradigm altogether (cf. Collingridge & Gantt 2008; Mays & Pope 2000). In fact, uniformity in this sense contradicts the flexibility and openness of the qualitative paradigm in selection and use of methods as well as the formation of theories.

Instead of contemplating about the normative instalment of uniform criteria and attempting to live up to such standards, there has been an increase in empirical studies which investigate whether and how qualitative studies are marked for their research quality (Döring et al. 2016). Empirical investigations of quality features in peer-reviewed and published qualitative studies has shown, that the quality of qualitative research is as heterogeneous as the research paradigm itself (cf. Grunenberg 2007). Especially the analysis of the data is more often than not vaguely described, so much so that the descriptions or the lack thereof leave readers puzzled.

Qualitative studies are increasingly part of applied research, which is typically the basis for best practices outside of academia. Academic laypeople who have to put academic results into practical application are known to demand transparency and clarity to an extent which allows them to recognize the quality of a qualitative study without having to rely on experts or members of the academic community. Such external pressures may ultimately make a uniform set of criteria necessary for qualitative research.

2.2. Four criteria of trustworthiness

A rather dated, but relevant attempt at providing unvaryingly applicable criteria for methodological rigour in the qualitative research paradigm is the frequently cited model of trustworthiness by Lincoln & Guba (1985; also cf. Casanave 2015). As already mentioned above, trustworthiness is the most important, overarching criterion for the quality of qualitative research and encompasses four criterion areas: (1) truth value, (2) applicability, (3) consistency, and (4) neutrality.

Truth value means that a qualitative study's ultimate goal is to discover and display an isomorphism, i.e., a one-to-one relationship, of the findings with the reality such an investigation is analysing. Truth value should be demonstrated by the qualitative scholar through showing that their reconstructions of the reality (findings and interpretations) arrived at by their analysis are credible to the constructors of the original reality. The criterion in this area is credibility, which can be met by verifying findings and interpretations of a study with the respondents (Lincoln & Guba 1985: 295–296).

The criterion area of applicability refers to the amount of information about a qualitative investigation's contextual setting necessary to enable other qualitative scholars to judge whether the findings and interpretations derived in the original investigation are applicable to other contexts. It is therefore the responsibility of any qualitative scholar to describe the context of their investigation in sufficient detail, so that other qualitative scholars can abstract working hypotheses from the original investigation, assess "the degree of similarity between sending and receiving contexts" (Lincoln & Guba 1985: 297), and transfer them to the receiving contexts. The knowledge of both contexts determines the possibility of making transferability inferences, which constitute the criterion in this area.

Consistency means stability, an unchanging real world that can be analysed multiple times to yield similar results. Since such a conceptualisation is unrealistic, qualitative research must be dependable. That is, the qualitative research process is to be trustworthy, dependable, responsibly carried out, so that both types of factors – factors of instability or changes in the real world and factors of phenomenal or research-design induced changes – can be investigated within a qualitative research design (Lincoln & Guba 1985: 299). Dependability is the criterion in this area.

Neutrality in a qualitative understanding refers to the data themselves. Are the data confirmable in the sense that other qualitative scholars would come to similar results? The role of the researcher has to be made explicit, the theories taken as inspiration to interpret the data have to be explained, and reflexive essays and research diaries exist to trace or comprehend the findings and interpretations of a qualitative study (Lincoln & Guba 1985: 301; Döring et al. 2016: 110). The criterion in this area to reach trustworthiness is confirmability.

The most important criterion in this model of trustworthiness is that of credibility. The advantage of this model and partly the reason for its success in the social sciences is that it is directly relatable to the research quality criteria in the quantitative paradigm (cf. Hofmann 2019). The authors explicitly refer to the Campbell-tradition's typology of validity and relate credibility to internal validity and transferability to external validity (cf. Shadish et al. 2007). Furthermore, they relate their consistency to reliability and their neutrality to objectivity, which both constitute research quality criteria in the quantitative paradigm. At the same time, they clearly refute the quantitative conceptualization of research criteria and establish their own, based on their qualitative axiological convictions. According to Döring et al. (2016), the success of this model of credibility is probably due to its ability

to directly connect to the established discourse of standards in the quantitative research philosophy through these relations of terms. Other factors may be the rather concrete suggestions of how to operationalize these criteria in empirical research (Lincoln & Guba 1985: 301-327; also cf. Teddlie & Tashakkori 2009: 256–257), the world-wide recognition of the model, and the availability of indicators and checklists used by international journals to assess the level of conformity to these criteria (cf. Döring et al. 2016; Schou et al. 2012).

2.3. A seven-point checklist for careful planning

Based on vigilant observation of criteria in the quantitative paradigm, Steinke (1999) suggests seven criteria for the evaluation and assessment of qualitative research designs. The nature of these criteria allows for using them as a checklist during the planning stages of such research projects. They are not uniformly binding and should be selected, contemplated, and adapted as the specific research context and circumstances necessitate.

The criteria are as follows: (1) intersubjective comprehensibility, which refers to the level of detail and quality of the documentation of the research process, so that other scholars can assess its quality; (2) indication, which means the suitability of the methodological decisions to address the object of investigation; (3) empirical embedding and testing of the hypotheses and interpretations in the collected data; (4) limitation, which refers to the explicit generalisability of the findings to other circumstances, such as context, cases, phenomena, respondents, etc.; (5) reflective subjectivity, which means the level of detail and credibility at which researchers reflect their own interests and socio-biographical background in the process of interpreting the data; (6) coherence, which aims at the embeddedness of theory formation and/or interpretations in the data; and (7) relevance, which refers to the theoretical or practical contribution of a qualitative study to the formation of new knowledge (Steinke 1999: 207–254).

While Lincoln & Guba's model addresses methodological rigor only, Steinke's criteria additionally attend to the questions of relevance and quality of representation (intersubjective comprehensibility). Ethical criteria are, however, also not addressed in Steinke's criteria (cf. Phakiti & Paltridge 2015 for a very brief discussion). Steinke's criteria relating to methodological rigor are quite similar to those of Lincoln & Guba: relevance of research methods, a detailed and documented reflection of the role of the researcher and their perspectives, and the credibility of the findings and interpretations in the sense of consistency with the data express similar kinds of responsibilities placed on the part of the qualitative researcher (additional criteria with a similar focus on methodological rigor an be found in e.g., Mayring 2016). Responsible and careful analysis of data is especially important in qualitative studies, since most methods are semi-structured at best and need thorough training before their application.

2.4. Quality criteria for mixed-methods approaches

Quality criteria in mixed-method research designs are not only a mix of quality criteria of qualitative research (cf. above) and of quantitative research (cf. Hofmann 2019; also cf. Dörnyei 2007 for the combination of the two research strands), but also criteria specific to such designs, which follow two steps that are unique to mixed-methods studies in general: 1) mixed-methods design quality, and 2) mixed-methods interpretative quality.

The design quality is determined by the degree to which the scholar has combined qualitative and quantitative studies or aspects of a study such that it is appropriate for answering the research questions, that it matches the stated purpose, and that both strands address the same research questions or closely related aspects of the research questions. It further has to be explicated why a mixed-methods design is indicated by the research endeavour and which type of mixed-methods design has been selected for which reasons (also cf. Creswell 2014; Flick 2014 for three common types of mixed-methods research). Subsequently, it is the researcher's responsibility to show that the design is implemented consistently, i.e., the components of the study fit together in a seamless manner.

Interpretative quality refers to the way in which partial qualitative and quantitative findings are derived, related to one another, and combined so that meta-inferences adequately incorporate the inference made in each strand of the study. If there are any inconsistencies between the inferences made within or across the two strands, it is the responsibility of the researcher to address them adequately, explore theoretical explanations, and offer possible ones to the reader. Finally, researchers have to show that the meta-inferences meet the suggested need for a mixed-method design (Döring et al. 2016; Teddlie & Tashakkori 2009).

If both of these steps are of high quality, then the quality of inferences is high as well. This criterion relates to the internal validity of the Campbell tradition in the quantitative paradigm and Lincoln & Guba's credibility in the qualitative paradigm. Another mixed-methods criterion which refers to methodological rigor is the inference transferability and relates to external validity in quantitative design and transferability in Lincoln and Guba's model of credibility in qualitative designs. In addition to methodological rigor, other criteria can be identified in the literature which relate to the quality of the whole research process in mixed-method designs, including the quality of presentation of the results as well as the usefulness of such a study (Döring et al. 2016: 115; also cf. Creswell & Plano Clark 2018).

In summary, despite the qualitative research paradigm's heterogeneity, emphasis is placed on methodological rigor in the same vein, as in the quantitative paradigm, although epistemological, ontological, and axiological positions differ fundamentally. That is, research criteria of the quantitative paradigm greatly influenced the selection and definition of those in the qualitative paradigm, which places much more emphasis on the responsibility of the qualitatively working scholar, than it does on the quantitatively working one.

3. Combining theory and linguistic reality

3.1. Corpus Linguistics

Corpus Linguistics is a rather quantitative strand of linguistic research with a lot of potential for qualitative complementation. Quantitative aspects of the applied linguistics discipline are the nature of the data, the data collection procedures, and the analysis of the data.

3.1.1. *The nature of the data*

Unlike a text archive, a corpus is not only a body or collection of written or spoken material upon which a linguistic analysis is based, it is also machine readable and representative. That is, a corpus is a stratified model of a real language or a language variety, which are resembled by selected bits of spoken and written texts, of film and/or radio, of informal and formal conversations, of different genres, different disciplines, etc. A corpus is typically compiled for computer-based language analysis, which in language awareness or English language teaching scenarios is conducted corpus-informed. In other research scenarios, it is conducted corpus-based versus corpus-driven.

Corpora can be considered to have developed out of Murray et al.'s (1884 – 1933) attempt to collect dictionary entries for all the English words which could derived from their usage in written texts, covering several hundred years (The Oxford English Dictionary). The next milestone in this developmental course are Jespersen's shoeboxes, in which he kept thousands of notes of real English language data from literary texts (cf. Lindquist 2009). He was the first to use such authentic language examples in his grammar (Jespersen 1909 – 1949). The advantage of using such collected data, instead of the commonly used introspection-based "data" before the 1960s, is the marginalization of personal language preferences and idiolects by the educated elite and self-proclaimed experts, the consideration of language variation, and the investigation of language tendencies and frequency effects. An example of such personal language preferences can be found in Jones's textbook on how to pronounce 'Received Pronunciation': "In cases of doubt, references may be made to the authors English Pronouncing [sic]", (1966: 214). In addition, such a machine-readable and representative model of authentic language use is made available to a large academic community, so that corpus-based studies can be replicated. Such an option increases and adheres naturally to the quantitative research quality criteria of objectivity (the corpus-based study is independent of the researcher) and of reliability (the corpus-based study yields similar results; cf. Hofmann 2019).

Representativeness of corpora is achieved primarily through balance, but also through sampling. Balance refers to the range of different text types, genres, registers, but also periods of time. Depending on the type of corpus, the ranges differ greatly. For example, the discipline traditionally differentiated the two main types of reference corpora from specialised corpora. Reference corpora were typically

large, such as the BNC with 90 million written and 10 million spoken words, and covered five different spheres: domain (subject field), time, medium (book vs. script) for written texts, and demography and context-governance (lecture vs. radio broadcast) for spoken texts. Specialised corpora were limited in including different spheres. They typically only differentiated spheres, which are necessary for the purpose of the corpus. A specialized corpus to investigate academic student writing might only include BA and MA thesis from one university. The only purpose it can serve in terms of analysis is the investigation of the development of academic writing skills at the particular university it was compiled at, while of course these skills can include a whole range of linguistic features to be analysed. However, today, the internet allows for huge mega corpora, which cannot be considered reference corpora, since they exhibit the same range of spheres or lack thereof as the traditionally small specialised corpora. One example of such a mega-corpus is *iWeb – the intelligent web-based corpus* with 14 billion words (Davies 2018-), covering only websites (i.e. one medium) in 2017, albeit from 6 different countries.

Balance thus depends on the intended uses of a corpus (predominantly when used as a static corpus), which means, for instance, that a corpus, covering written English can be considered balanced although it does not cover spoken English. Balance is, however, "largely an act of faith rather than a statement of fact as, at present, there is no reliable scientific measure of corpus balance". (McEnery et al. 2006: 16). In order to arrive at a balance nevertheless, researchers typically adopt earlier corpus construction procedures, like those of the BNC, or carefully plan compilation principles.

3.1.2. *Data collection and analysis*

Since a corpus is a sample or model of a larger language variety (population), the same characteristics apply to the sample as well as the whole variety as close as possible. In a first step of the sampling procedure, the sampling unit, sampling frame, and the population have to be defined. In case of the Brown corpus (Nelson & Kučera 1964, 1971, 1979), the sampling unit was written English texts published in the calendar year 1961 in the United states. The assembly of all sampling units constitutes the population. The list of sampling units is the sampling frame. In case of the Brown corpus, the sampling frame was a list of all the books and periodicals in Brown University Library and Providence Athenaeum.

A population can be defined in terms of social variables, like age, sex, and social class, and the corresponding uses/receptions of language or in terms of text category/genre of language data. Once these three aspects of the sampling procedure have been defined, two different sampling techniques can be employed: simple random sampling and stratified random sampling. In the first technique, low-frequency units (e.g., rare books) tend to remain unsampled, so that, in the second technique, different strata or groups can be defined, which include high-frequency, mid-frequency, and low-frequency units, and random sampling takes place within these groups. Since corpora are supposed to include different genres, a typical issue in sampling is the size of the samples: An e-mail is typically much shorter than a

monograph. Such differences are typically "normalized" by using a fixed number of words from each medium, such as a 2,000-word text chunk from the middle of larger documents (cf. Greenbaum 1996; Schmied 1990). Similarly, when stratified sampling is employed, the proportion and number of samples per group should be related to the frequencies of occurrence in the target population. The fact that corpora are, in fact, representative, makes the findings derived in a corpus linguistic study generalisable. Consequently, corpus linguistic studies are of high validity.

Typical analyses in corpus linguistics are concerned with basic counting of frequencies for certain linguistic features, like hedges, prepositions, pronouns, adverbials, etc. Within one corpus, such analyses allow for identification of key words in contexts (KWIC, a special form of a permuted index), also concordances, or of low- versus high-frequency usages, including over- and underuse of features in English as a second/foreign language settings, prototypical uses, syntactic structures, and differences between genres, modes, media, etc. When two corpora are compared, analyses often look for similarities and differences, with regard to the features mentioned above, between different English proficiency levels, different English varieties, different national usages, different periods of time, etc.

In summary, most analyses are quantitative in nature, employing also analytical statistics, such as Mutual Information score, chi-squared tests, log-likelihood tests, and more recently also regression modelling (e.g., Gries & Deshors 2020). However, corpora also allow for qualitative investigations, such as looking for collocates (*milk* gets *sour*, but *butter rancid*) or looking at the context of a particular pronoun, like a low-frequency subject pronoun, in order to interpret structural features associated with it. More recently, corpora are used as complementation to discourse analysis, a typical qualitative approach to linguistic investigations.

3.2. Discourse Analysis

Discourse Analysis considers language to be a form of social practice, in which language acts to constitute and reflect social realities. This view is shared by Labov's Variationist Sociolinguistics (e.g., 1972), and Hymes' Ethnography of Communication (1974). All of these three approaches to social aspects in linguistic investigations can be considered as a paradigm shift in Linguistics, before which social aspects were considered "[…] grammatically irrelevant conditions, such as memory limitations, distractions, shifts of attention and interest, and errors […]" (Chomsky 1965: 3–4) within generativist theory.

The approaches to discourse analysis can be schematized according to their relationship between a microanalytical research focus and macroanalytic one: conversation analysis is a microanalytic approach which concentrates on the fine detail of linguistic interactions, critical discourse analysis is a macroanalytic approach which concentrates on the language used to constitute social processes, and discourse analysis combines both of these approaches.

3.2.1. *Conversation Analysis*

Pioneered by sociologist Harvey Sacks (1992), one key feature of this approach is the orderliness in talk-in-interaction, which reflects a socially organized structure of interpersonal action, instead of being governed by innate cognitive structures of a language. In focus is the investigation of adjacency pairs, which represent the orderliness and roughly correspond to sequential speaker turns in conversations, using a scientific transcription system (Jefferson 1984).

The use of transcript data reveals the approach's methodological rigor and data centricity, focusing on how meaning is produced through verbal, vocal, prosodic, and paralinguistic means. It takes a rather objective stance, as qualitative scholars are explicitly discouraged from bringing any pre-conceived idea to the data, in order to form *a posteriori* theories or philosophies exclusively from the data. The backgrounds of the speakers and their relationships are disregarded, until it is made relevant in the conversation (Baxter 2010; Ehrlich & Romaniuk 2013; Paltridge & Wang 2015).

With its strong emphasis of "data authenticity", this qualitative approach scores very high in Lincoln & Guba's (1985) criterion of confirmability, as well as Steinke's (1999) criterion of empirical embedding and testing of the hypotheses and the interpretations in the data. Similarly, the criteria of dependability (Lincoln & Guba 1985) as well as reflective subjectivity and coherence (Steinke 1999), seem well achieved through the methodological stance of this qualitative approach. Credibility (Lincoln & Guba 1985), however, seems to be not necessarily important in this approach, as the focus on the data is much more emphasized than the verification of the interpretations and reconstructions by the respondents. The same can be stated about the criteria of transferability (Lincoln & Guba 1985) and limitation (Steinke 1999). Indication seems to be "controlled for" by the methodological makeup of the approach, as language is considered to constitute social realities. The remainder of Steinke's (1999) criteria, intersubjective comprehensibility and relevance seem to be realizable on a more individual level, as their achievement depends heavily on the analysts – at least in this methodological approach (cf. section 2).

3.2.2. *Critical Discourse Analysis*

In contrast to Conversation Analysis, Critical Discourse Analysis extends to the notion of discourse to refer to it as a social and ideological practice, representing a macroanalytical view of the world. In such a view, the focus of investigations lies on institutional and political discourses, such as in government, education, and the media, as well as specific discourses around gender and social class. Also, unlike Conversation Analysis, research endeavours within Critical Discourse Analysis specifically start from theoretical presuppositions of imbalanced social power relations, waiting to be uncovered. It hence cannot be considered a coherent theory, subdiscipline of Discourse Analysis or as a methodological approach, but simply a critical perspective, which sets it further apart from conversation analysis.

Forerunner of Critical Discourse Analysis is Fowler et al.'s (1979) Critical Linguistics. Among the key features of Critical Discourse Analysis are that language is seen as a social practice which relates to power, macro-social issues are typically the starting point for linguistic investigations within this 'critical' perspective, qualitative scholars have to be explicitly self-referential about *a priori* perspectives and values, analyses emphasise the interdiscursive/intertextual nature of discourse and texts, and finally deconstruction of social inequalities forms the core of the critical analysis. Typical linguistic features analysed are sentence structure, verb tense, syntax, lexical choice, coherence, and cohesion, etc. (Baxter 2010; Ehrlich & Romaniuk 2013; Paltridge & Wang 2015).

As a mere 'perspective', Critical Discourse Analysis automatically underachieves most of the research quality criteria mentioned in section 2 above. Noteworthy are the rather high achievements with regard to Steinke's (1999) criterion of reflective subjectivity, as this is mandatory for being 'critical', and limitation as well as Lincoln & Guba's (1985) transferability, as power inequalities can be virtually found everywhere in a society. Similarly, Lincoln & Guba's (1985) criterion of credibility is not neglected, because of the makeup of the research procedure. While confirmability as well as Steinke's (1999) relevance and indication appear to be unimportant criteria, coherence seems virtually reversed in this approach, because the theory is already formed before the data is looked at. This also leaves one wonder how Lincoln & Guba's (1985) criterion of dependability is regarded in individual studies. Steinke's (1999) empirical embedding and testing are "controlled for" by the research process, and intersubjective comprehensibility is rather bound to individual analysts' performances (cf. section 2).

3.2.3. *Discourse Analysis*

Pioneered by the sociologists Gilbert and Mulkay (1984), the hallmark of this approach is its recognition of the great variability in discourse and its context-dependence as well as its distinct repertoires. That is, audience, purpose, and context determine the portrayal or description of essentially the same phenomenon, such as a popular scientific presentation and a conference presentation on the same study. Another key feature is the re-construction of social realities through a context-dependent use of linguistic events, such as narratives, comments, or jokes.

Such linguistic events are often presented in recurrently used systems of terms, stylistic and grammatical features, as well as distinct idiomatic expressions and metaphors. These systems are referred to as interpretative repertoire.

Finally, discourse-analytical interpretations are derived from a combination of micro- and macroanalytical approaches. When using unstructured interviews, for instance, the interpretative repertoires serve as tool to identify linguistic events, such as professional terminology or figures of speech, which in turn provide clues for speculating about the effects of psychological, social or political factors that may influence the language of the interviewees (Baxter 2010; Ehrlich & Romaniuk 2013; Paltridge & Wang 2015).

This methodological makeup puts particular emphasis on Lincoln & Guba's (1985) criterion of transferability and Steinke's (1999) limitation due to its focus on context-dependence of linguistic events. Similarly, the criteria of empirical embedding and testing, as well as reflective subjectivity and coherence seem to be met by the methodological design of the approach. The same is true for Lincoln & Guba's (1985) criteria of credibility and dependability, as the reconstruction of the interpretative repertoires is likely to be shared by those experts who constructed the phenomenon under investigation. In this approach, Lincoln & Guba's (1985) confirmability as well as Steinke's (1999) intersubjective comprehensibility lie closer to the performance of the analyst than within the research approach itself. Indication and relevance appear to be unimportant (cf. section 2).

3.3. Systemic Functional Perspectives

The above-mentioned, critical perspective of Discourse Analysis (cf. section 3.2.2) is particularly associated with Halliday's view on language as a social semiotic system, which is used to construe every facet of human experience to be transformed into reflective meaning – the ideational metafunction, into propositional meaning – the interpersonal metafunction, and into constructive meaning – the textual metafunction (Halliday & Matthiessen 2014). Especially Fairclough's (1995) Critical Discourse Analysis places its analytical focus on the textual metafunction of language, seeking support for socially imbalanced propositions. But also the function actor, the embodiment of the experiential, i.e., ideational metafunction, constitutes a vital analysis frame in Critical Discourse Analysis.

Halliday & Matthiessen (2014) emphasise the suitability of corpora to conduct high-level analyses, involving function structures and systemic features, manually (using a subset of a corpus), with tools like *SysFan* (Wu 2000), and low-level analyses of syntagms automatically, using standard parsers. On a methodological note, they tentatively suggest that a sorting of the registerial composition of corpora, such as the Brown corpus (Nelson & Kučera 1964, 1971, 1979), using the contextual categories of field (the situational setting and topic), tenor (participants in a situation), and mode (role of language and other semiotic systems), would arrive at a better corpus balance (cf. Halliday & Matthiessen 2014: 33, 72), and consequently at a better representativeness, i.e., higher validity.

3.4. Unification and Transfer via Corpus-assisted Discourse Analysis

As outlined in the previous section, Systemic Functional Grammar specifically emphasizes the complementarity of combining a corpus with a critical discourse analysis approach. In this mixed-methods research, it is particularly important for the analysis to be situated within the different approaches of discourse analysis (cf. Baxter 2010; Ehrlich & Romaniuk 2013; Paltridge & Wang 2015) as well as within the different types of mixed-methods research (cf. Creswell & Plano Clark 2018; Flick 2014; Phakiti & Paltridge 2015; Teddlie & Tashakkori 2009), fulfilling the

relevance criterion (Steinke 1999). One such type could be a sequential mixed-method design, in which a qualitative study informs a quantitative one or vice versa. Following the dialectical thesis, a sequential type of mixed-methods design should emphasise the diversity of the perspectives the analyst(s) can take in order to investigate the complexity of language use in a pluralistic society. Dialectical here means that thinking about an object of investigation or phenomenon "[…] involves considering opposing viewpoints and interacting with the tensions caused by their juxtaposition". (Teddlie & Tashakkori 2009: 92).

In such an understanding of the mixed-methods paradigm, both uni-method paradigms have strengths and weaknesses, so that they should be combined such that the differences and issues between the two enrich the investigation and improve the formation of new knowledge. Possible scenarios could for instance be the improvement of transferability (Lincoln & Guba 1985)/limitation and indication (Steinke 1999) by using corpora that are representative for several contexts, cases, or phenomena. These contexts could subsequently be juxtaposed in a detailed analysis employing hermeneutics (recursive interpretation), following the criteria of credibility (Lincoln & Guba 1985)/intersubjective comprehensibility and reflective subjectivity (Steinke 1999), which puts great responsibility upon the shoulders of the empirical scholars. At the same time, such corpora could be extended in a balanced way, so that more data for hermeneutics is available. The frequencies at which opposing phenomena occur in the corpus data could be statistically assessed for differences.

4. Conclusion

Orienting functional qualitative research to the research criteria that have been suggested in the past decades becomes increasingly important. This is especially true in applied research strands, as non-members of academia need to be able to recognize valuable investigations and differentiate them from other contributions. An adherence to quality criteria is emphasised for the qualitative paradigm due to the nature of its methodology. Methods are typically less formalised, if at all, and semi-structured at best. As such, the methodological skeleton in such studies does not support the achievement of quality criteria *qua* method, so that more and continued training seems indicated to the novice qualitative scholar to meet the criteria. Such training naturally requires the explication of such research quality criteria in the first place, especially since available techniques to meet the criteria (research diaries, peer debriefing, triangulation, negative case analysis, referential adequacy, respondent audits, to name only a few) are neither mandatory nor standard. Using these techniques to improve the quality of qualitative research lies in the responsibility of the individual analyst. While the same is true for the quantitative scholar, some basic standard is already achieved by the methodological rigor of the paradigm(s). Having stated that, it is important to stress that abstract concepts and those that are comprised of several variables as well as sub-concepts can pose serious threats to the validity of a quantitative study. In any regard, the key to successful research for novice researchers is to invest enough time and effort into a thorough

literature review of methodological, theoretical, and research-philosophical sources as well as similar previous studies (e.g., Moorkens 2013), and a careful, informed choice of research questions.

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A Critical Discourse Analysis of Donald Trump's Weekly Addresses

Dana Ebermann

Chemnitz University of Technology

Abstract

Trump's "American First" policy has become a synonym for his disconnecting relationship with the rest of the world. This America-centered view is mainly reflected in Trump's foreign policy agenda. One genre of political discourse, which Trump uses regularly to address his "America First" policy, are his weekly addresses to the nation. The present paper will investigate 48 weekly addresses given by Trump qualitatively according to the discourse-historical approach (DHA) of critical discourse analysis (Wodak & Reisigl, 2009) and quantitatively by applying corpus-linguistic methods. This very approach refers "to the socio-political orientation of critical theory" (Wodak & Reisigl, 2009, p. 88). Similar to traditional CDA, critique, power and ideology are the key concepts in DHA to uncover inequalities and power abuse in communication. The paper will try to reveal which ideologies are used and which of the lexemes represent Trump's "American First" policy best. The focus of the discussion will be on the seven lexemes, such as *jobs*, *people* and *tax* and their respective collocations found in the corpus of the 48 weekly addresses. The lexemes were taken from a word list and their respective collocations were used as a starting point to analyze excerpts of Trump's addresses according to the discourse-historical approach (DHA), which critically evaluates discursive strategies. The results of the analysis show that Trump mainly uses his "America First" rhetoric to create his *us* vs. *them* ideology. Furthermore, the predication and nomination strategies were applied most often in Trump's excerpts.

Keywords: critical discourse analysis, discourse-historical approach, political discourse, presidential weekly addresses, corpus linguistics

1. Introduction

Political rhetoric has always been of interest for linguists and this particular interest even seems to grow since Donald Trump has taken the oath of office in January 2017 (Smith, 2010; Charteris-Black, 2014; Partington & Taylor, 2018; Sclafani, 2018). The genre political discourse may trigger terms, such as campaign pledges, formulaic addresses, metaphors, ideology or manipulative language. These forms and characteristics of political discourse unifies that they are used with particular discursive strategies. Discursive strategies may be best defined by "a more or less intentional plan of practices (including discursive practices) adopted to achieve a particular social, political, psychological or linguistic goal" (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 94). A more detailed discussion of the discourse-historical approach, to which these discursive strategies belong to, will be given in section 2.3. Ideologies are strongly connected with discursive strategies because it is the speaker's aim to

convince listeners of their beliefs and worldviews. These mostly one-sided convictions are shared by one group, i.e., Trump's supporters in the present study, and "serve as an important means of establishing and maintaining unequal power relations through discourse" (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 88). In order to find out which discursive strategies Trump uses to influence his supporters or even his opponents and which ideologies he spreads with these strategies, a corpus of the US President's weekly addresses was compiled. A word list of the most frequent content words was generated, which was then used for the creation of a collocation list. To elicit whether the collocations from the list occur more often together than just by chance, the *t* and MI scores were calculated. Only those collocations with a *t*-score higher than 2.0 and an MI score higher than 3.0 were chosen for a qualitative critical discourse analysis. Section 4.1 explains the quantitative part of the present study followed by the qualitative analysis of select excerpts from the US President's addresses. The subsequent section 2 will set the theoretical framework of the present study by beginning to explain briefly what weekly addresses are and illustrate the most important characteristics of critical discourse analysis.

2. Theoretical Framework

2.1. The Presidential Weekly Address

The genre of the weekly addresses are speeches made by the US president on current and future events as well as on topics of interest ("The president's weekly radio address", n.d.). In 1933, Franklin D. Roosevelt started to establish his fireside chats, which resulted in 30 evening radio addresses until 1944 ("The president's weekly radio address", n.d.). However, Ronald Reagan, the 40th US President, was the first to introduce the genre of the weekly address to the nation. Back then, the addresses were broadcast on radio. Beginning with Barack Obama's term of office, the weekly address transformed from an audio-only format to video format available on the internet ("The president's weekly address", n.d.). Today, the weekly addresses are accessible through YouTube and the official White House website.

2.2. Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA)

In general, CDA is a critical linguistic approach that investigates how societal power relations and ideologies are expressed through language use in text (Wodak & Meyer, 2009). Furthermore, CDA sees "language as social practice" (Fairclough, Mulderrig & Wodak, 2011) which indicates that language is not powerful on its own, but that it becomes powerful through powerful and dominant people who use it to communicate (Wodak, 2001). The analyzed genre of presidential weekly addresses is an example of discourse that becomes powerful through the US president, believed to be one of the most powerful people in the world. CDA does not only analyze hidden ideologies, but it also deals "with the discourse dimensions of power abuse and the injustice and inequality that result from it" (van Dijk, 1993, p. 252). However, language cannot only be applied to show power and

dominance, but it can also be used to challenge, subvert, and even change distributions of power and dominance (Wodak, 2001). Due to the fact that the following analysis will take on the discourse-historical approach, section 2.3 will introduce the main characteristics of this approach.

2.3. The Discourse-Historical Approach (DHA)

The key notions of DHA and therefore CDA are critique, power, and ideology (Wodak, 2001). Reisigl & Wodak (2009) refer to 'critique' under the DHA framework as the analyst's distant view on data, "embedding the data in the social context, clarifying the political positioning of discourse participants and having a focus on continuous self-reflection while undertaking research" (p. 87). Additionally, they distinguish between three different types of critique: text or discourse-immanent critique, socio-diagnostic critique and prospective critique (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). The first form of critique refers to the discovery of "inconsistencies, self-contradictions, paradoxes and dilemmas in the text-internal or discourse-internal structures" (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 88). The second one focusses on the demystification of persuasion and manipulation in discourse (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). This form of critique comprises "critique of ideology, the critique of the ethos of social actors, pragmatic critique, political critique and social critique" (Reisigl, 2017, p. 51). The third form has a clear focus on improving communication in the future, e.g., guidelines against sexist language (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). Power as one of the key concepts of DHA and CDA concentrates on the unequal relationship among different social actors occupying different social roles or belonging to distinct social groups (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). Reisigl & Wodak (2009) adapt Weber's (1980) understanding of power by claiming that power is a person's possibility of forcing their will on someone else within a social relationship against the will of the forced one (Weber, 1980, p. 28). Although power may be most clearly executed through grammatical forms in discourse, it can also be exerted by a person's control over a certain genre of text or "by the regulation of access to certain public spheres" (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 89). The third concept central to DHA and CDA is ideology. Especially in DHA, ideology is seen as a usually "one-sided world view composed of related mental representations, convictions, opinions, attitudes and evaluations, which is shared by members of a specific social group" (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 88). This shared world view, i.e., ideology, is used to retain asymmetric power relations through discourse and to influence a more or less radical transformation of power relations (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009).

DHA defines discourse as "socially constituted as well as constitutive semiotic practice" (Reisigl, 2017, p. 51). Socially constituted means that discourse is understood as representing, creating, reproducing, and changing social reality (Reisigl, 2017), whereas the semiotic character refers to discourse that is a communicative macro-unit, which goes beyond the unit of a text or conversation (Reisigl, 2017). This fact is also connected to the pluri-perspectivity of discourse, which states that several distinct social actors have different opinions and point of views on the

macro-topic that is open for discussion in DHA (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). Furthermore, it is important to note that DHA makes a clear distinction between text and discourse, i.e., a text is always seen as a part of discourse, which makes speech acts last over time and brings together two speech situations (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). These speech situations are the speech production and the speech reception (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). Moreover, Reisigl (2017) adds that discourse is always positioned within fields of action, such as economy, politics among others, which create frames of discourse. Another characteristic of discourse in DHA is that all discourses evolve from social problems, i.e., these problems are starting points for discussion (Reisigl, 2017). Finally, yet importantly, discourse in DHA "undergoes historical change relating to social change" (Reisigl, 2017, p. 52).

As DHA is one approach of CDA, it draws on similar concepts and refines them accordingly. This is also the case for context, which is a crucial element for CDA in general, but also for the discourse-historical approach. Context is inevitable because CDA as well as DHA draw answers for their analyses from several different disciplines. Reisigl's & Wodak's (2009) framework for context is four-dimensional: firstly, texts and discourses discussed critically are situated into "the broader sociopolitical and historical context, which discursive practices are embedded in and related to" (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 93). This dimension receives most attention in DHA since events from that past may be related to the present text/discourse that is analyzed. Secondly, DHA takes collocations, connotations, implications, presuppositions as well as thematic and syntactic coherences as a starting point for the critical analysis of the immediate, language internal co-text and co-discourse (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009; Reisigl, 2017). Thirdly, "social factors and institutional frames of a specific context of situation include: degree of formality, place, time, addressees, interactive and political roles, political and ideological orientation, gender, age, profession, […]" (Reisigl, 2017, p. 53). Fourthly, intertextual and interdiscursive connections between utterances, texts, genres, and discourses are also a dimension of research concerning context (Reisigl, 2017). An analysis of statements about the past made by a social actor and a comparison of these statements to a historian's statement about the same past event may be an example of intertextual and interdiscursive connections (cf. Reisigl, 2017).

3. Methodology

3.1. The Corpus & Data Collection

The corpus for this study was compiled with the help of the database *The American Presidency Project*[1]. It has to be said that the corpus is a highly specialized and

1 The American Presidency Project is a database that consists of a huge archive of US presidential speeches ranging from inauguration addresses to state of the union addresses. The digital archive was created at the University of California Santa Barbara and is accessible through this website: https://www.presidency.ucsb.edu/.

rather restricted in both size and genre. Due to its small size, it is impossible to generalize findings and assumptions. The entire corpus contains 48 weekly addresses by Donald Trump. The addresses collected were held between January 2017 (shortly after Trump's inauguration as US President) and September 2018. However, the addresses have an uneven spread between 2017 and 2018, i.e., 37 addresses were given in 2017 and 11 addresses in 2018. At the point of data collection in September 2018, all available addresses of 2017 and 2018 were downloaded. The overall size of the corpus is 23,056 words with a mean length of 480 words per address. In order to compare the results from the Trump corpus with an already existing corpus, the 2006 American English corpus [2] from the University of Lancaster was chosen as a reference corpus. As Mautner (2009) notes, it is essential for CDA analysts to use a reference corpus for comparison because first of all, "the smaller your own corpus, the more important it becomes to validate interpretations by checking them against evidence from larger corpora" (Mautner, 2009, p. 133). Secondly, she remarks that certain lexemes or phrases are used in a particular text because they may carry a certain ideological or evaluative connotation that may not be reflected in general language use in a reference corpus (Mautner, 2009). However, Mautner (2009) also claims that the analyst still needs to do the interpretation of the comparative texts from both corpora since meaning does not emerge be itself from the text (Mautner, 2009). It is, nevertheless, most of the time very hard to find a fitting reference corpus for comparison especially if the analyst's own corpus is a specialized one mostly containing one text genre. This is the case for the Trump corpus, which consists of weekly addresses being one representative of political discourse. The results of the comparison between the Trump and the reference corpus remain to be seen in section 4.

3.2. Data Analysis

The corpus analysis was carried out with the help of the concordance program AntConc (Anthony, 2014). In order to be able to extract a reliable list of collocations ordered according to frequency, in a first step, a stop word list[3] was uploaded to the program to filter out the most frequent English words, mostly function words. These function words do not contribute much to the meaning of sentences and do not play a huge role when investigating collocations. After the stop word list had been uploaded to the program, a word list was created to elicit the top 15 content words occurring in the corpus, which can be seen in Figure 4.

2 The corpus has an overall size of 1,175,965 words and can be accessed through this website after registration: https://cqpweb.lancs.ac.uk/.
3 The English stop word list was downloaded from https://www.ranks.nl/stopwords.

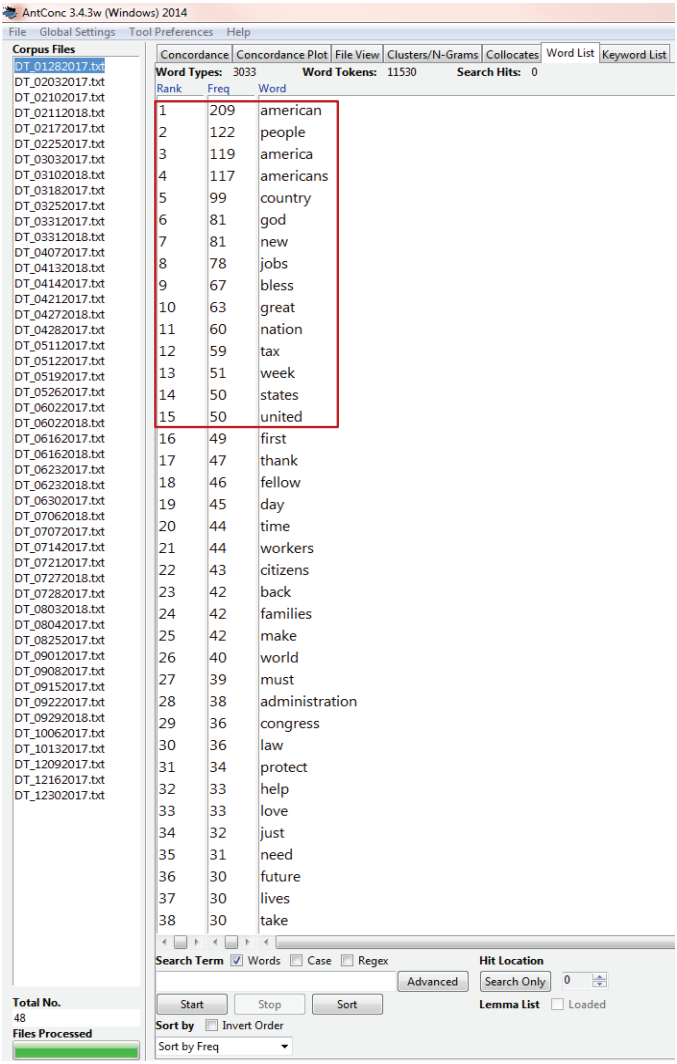


Figure 4 Screenshot AntConc of the Top 15 Content Words in the Trump Corpus

In a second step, the collocations of the 15 lexemes were elicited by choosing the collocate function in AntConc and setting the search parameters to one collocate to the left and one collocate to the right. These 15 lexemes had the highest frequencies in the corpus. A table listing all collocations of the 15 lexemes can be found

Questions to approach discursive features	*Discursive strategies*	*Purpose*
How are persons, objects, phenomena, events, processes and actions named and referred to linguistically in the discourse in question?	**nomination**	discursive construction of social actors discursive construction of objects, phenomena, events discursive construction of processes and actions
What characteristics or qualities are attributed to social actors, objects, phenomena, events, processes and actions mentioned in the discourse?	**predication**	discursive characterization of social actors, objects, phenomena, events processes and actions (e.g., positively or negatively)
What arguments are employed in discourse?	**argumentation**	persuading addressees of the validity of specific claims of truth and normative rightness
From what perspective are these nominations, attributions, arguments expressed?	**perspectivisation**	positioning the speaker's or writer's point of view and expressing involvement or distance
Are the respective utterances articulated overtly, are they intensified or mitigated?	**mitigation and intensification**	modifying the illocutionary force of utterances in respect to their epistemic or deontic status

Table 3 Discursive Strategies in DHA (adapted from Reisigl, 2017, p. 52)

in section 4. In a third step, the eight lexemes were selected for closer qualitative analysis. These lexemes were chosen according to their representativeness of Trump's "America First" policy because it is assumed that these lexemes carry the most evaluative content for a critical discourse analysis. The lexemes that were selected were *American*, *people*, *America*, *Americans*, *country*, *jobs*, *nation* and *tax*. These lexemes were contrasted with the 2006 American English corpus by Lancaster University to see whether these lexemes trigger similar collocations as in the Trump corpus or whether they are found with other collocations in general language use. These lexemes were then quantitatively analyzed with the help of AntConc's Stat function, which calculates the MI scores of collocations by default as well as their t-scores. These calculated results were contrasted to the mere frequencies to see whether the collocations found in the Trump corpus are statistically significant or whether they occur together by chance. As in section 2.3 already indicated, the method of analysis is the discourse-historical approach. In order to find out which ideologies Donald Trump's expresses through his word choice, the select lexemes, their collocations and the context in which they occurred were analyzed according to the questions listed in Table 3. The analysis according to discursive strategies should give an insight into which techniques are employed by Trump to convince listeners of his addresses. The above questions in Table 3 may also act as research questions for this paper.

In a previous publication to Reisigl's 2017 text on the discourse-historical approach, Reisigl & Wodak (2009) list numerous examples for the individual discursive strategies displayed in Table 3. I will merely give a short overview of possible

discursive devices that may be found in the texts collected for a discourse-historical analysis. Examples of devices that show the discursive strategy of nomination can be metaphors, metonymies, and verbs and nouns that "denote processes and actions, etc." (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 94). For the predication strategy, feasible discursive devices could be "stereotypical, evaluative attributions of negative or positive traits […], collocations, explicit comparisons, similes, metaphors, euphemisms, allusions, evocations, presuppositions and implicatures" (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009, p. 94). Fallacies and deictics are instances of the argumentation strategy, whereas direct, indirect speech, quotation marks, discourse markers and prosody are examples of the perspectivisation strategy. For the discursive strategy of mitigation and intensification, typical representatives are indirect speech acts, such as questions instead of statements, hesitations, vague expressions, and verbs of emotion (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). Although these discursive devices are common representatives for the five strategies, it has to be said that the occurrence of these devices also depends on the genre of texts to be analyzed and it may be the case that not all of these devices are found in the Trump corpus.

4. Results & Discussion

4.1. Comparison of Collocations in the Trump Corpus and the 2006 American English Corpus

In order to have a balanced discussion of the findings in the Trump corpus, it is essential that the Lancaster corpus of American English is used as reference corpus. After the compilation of a word list, a list of collocations of the eight select lexemes from the Trump corpus was generated and contrasted with the reference corpus. Table 4 illustrates the three most frequent collocations in both corpora for the eight lexemes.

As can be seen in the third column, *country* and *nation*, did not occur with content words in the Lancaster corpus and can therefore not be compared to the Trump corpus collocations. When comparing the remaining six lexemes and their collocations, it becomes obvious that merely two of the lexemes occurred with the same collocations in both corpora namely *American people* and *new jobs*. Although Mautner (2009) stated that a reference corpus is inevitable for critical discourse analysts to see the broad picture of general language use and compare these results to their own corpus, it seems that the highly specialized corpus of weekly addresses influences language use. Due to the fact that weekly addresses can be categorized under the broad term of political discourse, it appears that language use is rather domain and context-specific and uses different collocations than everyday language. To gain a better understanding of the usage of collocations in political discourse, it might be helpful for further studies in the field to consult a corpus compiled of different genres of political discourse.

lexeme	**most frequent collocations Trump corpus (top 3; excl. stop words)**	**most frequent collocations 2006 American English corpus (top 3; excl. stop words)**
American	people; workers; families	history; African; people
people	American; Jewish, hard-working	Black; young; American
America	bless; great; first; (make)	North; Latin; South
Americans	fellow; young; hard-working	African; native; white
country	great; respect; defend	*stop words only*
jobs	new; paying/high-paying/good-paying; American	new
nation	great; young; willing	*stop words only*
tax	reform; code; cut	sales; rate; receipts

Table 4 Most Frequent Collocations in the Trump and Lancaster Corpus

4.2. Quantitative Analysis of the Collocations in the Trump Corpus

In order to gain insight into the usage of collocations in the Trump corpus, it seems essential to take a quantitative look at the data. Xiao (2015) provides a short and dense overview of common methods in collocation research by summarizing the most important standpoints: "Particularly for obvious cases of collocation" speakers can clearly identify them by intuition (Greenbaum, 1974, p. 83). However, sometimes intuition is not enough for corpus linguistics because "each of us has only partial knowledge of the language, we have prejudices and preferences, our memory is weak, our imagination powerful […], and we tend to notice unusual words or structures but often overlook ordinary ones" (Krishnamurthy, 2000, p. 32ff.). Hunston (2002) claims that a statistical measurement of collocations is much more reliable and a corpus may reveal semantic patterns across many speakers of a language to which individual speakers usually do not have access to (Hunston, 2002; Stubbs, 2001). Another method for collocation research contrary to the "collocation-via-significance" is the "collocation-via-concordance" approach (McEnery & Hardie, 2012, p. 126ff.). The latter approach merely counts frequencies of collocations and tries to make inferences from that. The collocation-via-significance method "depends on more rigorous inferential statistical tests than simple frequency counts and is now extensively used in collocation analysis" (Xiao, 2015, p. 108). Two common statistical measures for determining statistically significant collocations in corpus linguistics are mutual information (MI) and

the *t*-test[4], which calculates the *t*-score (Xiao, 2015). The MI score measures collocational strength and the direction of association, i.e., the attraction or repulsion between two words (Xiao, 2015). In general, "the higher the MI score, the stronger the association between two items; the closer to 0 the MI score gets, the more likely it is that the two items co-occur by chance" (Xiao, 2015, p. 109). A MI score of 3.0 or higher is said to be statistically significant (Hunston, 2002, p. 71ff.) Nevertheless, Hunston (2002) remarks that collocational strength may not always be enough to make reliable assumptions about meaningful collocations (Hunston, 2002, p. 72). Corpus size is inevitable to determine "how certain a collocation is"; thus, a *t*-test, which considers corpus size, is a helpful instrument (Xiao, 2015, p. 109). A *t*-score of 2.0 or above is statistically significant (Hunston, 2002, p. 71ff.). In general, it is claimed that the *t*-test puts function words at the top of each list, whereas the MI score prefers rarely occurring lexemes and places them on top of each list (Cheng, 2012, p. 95). To avoid this, function words were filtered out with the help of a stop word list.

Since raw frequencies do not give away much about collocations and how strongly lexemes correlate with one another, the t-scores and MI scores calculated by AntConc were used for quantitative analyses. Tables 5 to 12 show the *t*-scores and the MI scores of the eight collocations picked from the word list in AntConc. An issue with the MI score is that it "is known to inflate with low expected frequencies", whereas "*t* is known to prefer more frequent collocations" (Gries, 2015, p. 56ff.).

rank / collocate	***t*-score**	**rank / collocate**	**MI score**
1. ***people***	5.10614	1. *disabled*	6.90747
2. ***workers***	4.30822	2. *woman*	5.90747
3. ***families***	2.94101	3. *voter*	5.90747
4. *worker*	2.58278	4. *unleashing*	5.90747
5. *African*	2.39508	5. *thrilling*	5.90747
6. *dream*	2.38828	6. *striving*	5.90747
7. *citizens*	2.37498	7. *schoolchildren*	5.90747
8. *industry*	2.37467	8. *revitalize*	5.90747
		41. ***workers***	4.76996
		60. ***people***	3.88362
		61. ***families***	3.83708

Table 5 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *American*

4 A more detailed description of the formulas and the calculation of the MI and t-scores can be found in Xiao (2015), p. 107ff.

rank / collocate	***t*-score**	**rank / collocate**	**MI score**
1. ***American***	5.10614	1. *unbelievable*	6.68409
2. *one*	1.92728	2. *reasonable*	6.68409
3. ***Jewish***	1.70398	3. *governing*	6.68409
4. *thank*	1.46816	4. *enter*	6.68409
5. *bad*	1.38671	5. ***Jewish***	5.94712
6. *amazing*	1.36608	6. *bad*	5.68409
7. ***hard-working***	1.20792	7. *sending*	5.09913
8. *first*	1.07726	8. *qualified*	5.09913
		20. ***American***	3.88362
		30. ***hard-working***	2.77720

Table 6 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *people*

rank / collocate	***t*-score**	**rank / collocate**	**MI score**
1. ***bless***	5.17139	1. *whenever*	5.46127
2. ***first***	2.02820	2. *unlocking*	3.06466
3. ***great***	1.96881	3. *suffered*	3.42723
4. *make*	1.80080	4. *pulls*	3.32769
5. *restoring*	1.37397	5. *philosophy*	1.65392
6. *restore*	1.36055	6. *label*	2.16542
7. *now*	1.21970	7. *central*	5.13504
8. *love*	1.19287	8. *wealthy*	4.72001
		12. ***bless***	5.44648
		27. ***first***	3.41243
		35. ***great***	3.04986

Table 7 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *America*

rank / collocate	***t*-score**	**rank / collocate**	**MI score**
1. ***fellow***	6.33612	*1. struggling*	6.74446
2. ***young***	2.17768	*2. spiral*	6.74446
3. everyday	1.71051	*3. filed*	6.74446
4. innocent	1.68897	*4. defied*	6.74446
5. ***hard-working***	1.57051	*5.* ***fellow***	6.57845
6. African	1.36146	*6. everyday*	6.32942
7. wonderful	1.35486	*7. rescue*	5.74446
8. next	1.35486	*8. encouraged*	5.74446
		13. ***young***	5.25903
		33. ***hard-working***	3.42253

Table 8 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *Americans*

rank / collocate	*t*-score	rank / collocate	MI score
1. ***great***	1.44501	*1. routinely*	6.98547
2. ***respect***	1.38631	*2. owes*	6.98547
3. come	1.25797	*3. aboard*	6.98547
4. protect	1.22449	*4.* ***respect***	5.66354
5. routinely	0.99211	*5. illegally*	4.98547
6. owes	0.99211	*6. called*	4.17811
7. aboard	0.99211	*7. won*	3.81554
8. illegally	0.96843	*8. beautiful*	3.28503
		15. ***great***	2.59315

Table 9 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *country*

rank / collocate	*t*-score	rank / collocate	MI score
1. ***new***	2.45540	*1. shipping*	7.32942
2. ****paying***[5]	2.21104	*2. sends*	7.32942
3. more	2.06367	*3. magnet*	7.32942
4. create	1.93472	*4. machine*	7.32942
5. jobs	1.75751	*5. disappearing*	7.32942
6. million	1.69615	*6. disappear*	7.32942
7. ***American***	1.65492	*7.* ****paying***	6.48143
8. magnet	1.40542	*8. ship*	6.32942
		28. ***new***	3.79693
		39. ***American***	1.94399

Table 10 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *jobs*

rank / collocate	*t*-score	rank / collocate	MI score
1. under	1.35672	*1.* ***willing***	7.70793
2. ***great***	1.20115	*2. remembers*	7.70793
3. one	1.17410	*3. went*	6.70793
4. ***willing***	0.99522	*4. magnificent*	6.70793
5. remembers	0.99522	*5. prosperous*	6.12297
6. Kenosha	0.99522	*6. brandnew*	6.12297
7. went	0.99043	*7. run*	5.70793
8. magnificent	0.99043	*8. rebuilding*	5.12297
18. ***young***	0.93304	*13.* ***young***	3.90058
		19. ***great***	2.73065

Table 11 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *nation*

5 The asterisk (*) refers to the three collocates paying, high-paying and good-paying.

rank / collocate	*t*-score	rank / collocate	MI score
1. ***reform***	2.97648	*1. maze*	7.73218
2. ***code***	2.62798	*2. lasting*	7.73218
3. ***cut***	2.41877	*3. interest*	7.73218
4. cuts	2.21714	*4. dramatic*	7.73218
5. rate	2.21504	*5. broken*	7.73218
6. credit	1.98354	*6. breaks*	7.73218
7. relief	1.71304	*7. archaic*	7.73218
8. massive	1.71033	*8.* ***code***	7.21761
		10. ***reform***	6.99522
		20. ***cut***	6.31714

Table 12 *t*-scores and MI scores for collocates of *tax*

American people, *American families* and *American workers* have *t*-scores ranging from 2.9 to 5.1 and MI scores of 3.8 to 4.7. Similar values were calculated for *tax reform*, *tax code* and *tax cut* with *t*-scores from 2.4 to 2.9 and MI scores from 6.3 to 7.2. Although the MI scores for the Trump corpus are usually higher than the *t*-scores, just considering these values in isolation may be more than misleading. Therefore, it is more reliable to have a look at both values in combination. Significant correlations can be seen in Tables 5 and 12 for the lexemes *American* and *tax* and their respective collocations. Similar tendencies *bless America* (Table 7; t = 5.7; MI = 5.4) and *fellow Americans* (Table 8; t = 6.3; MI = 6.5). Additional collocations that do not occur randomly are *America first* (Table 9; t =2.0; MI =3.4), *young Americans* (Table 8; t = 2.1, MI = 5.2), *new jobs* (Table 10; t = 2.2; MI = 3.7) and **paying jobs* (Table 10; t = 2.2; MI = 6.4). Nevertheless, the latter collocations show higher in some cases twice as high MI scores compared to the t-scores, which shows that the collocations do not occur as frequent in the corpus as the raw frequencies indicated it. This impression is reinforced in particular in Tables 9, 10 and 11, in which all MI scores are higher than the *t*-scores. The collocations in these tables are found rarely in the corpus, but if they occur, they are likely to co-occur together, i.e., *young nation* or *new jobs*.

4.3. Qualitative Analysis of the Collocations in the Trump Corpus

The subsequent qualitative analysis will only discuss collocations that have a *t*-score of 2.0 and above as well as an MI score of 3.0 and above. i.e., collocations, such as *willing nation* (t = 0.9; MI = 7.7), *American jobs* (t = 1.6; MI = 1.9) and *great country* (t = 1.4; MI = 2.5).

The first four lexemes from Table 4, i.e., *American*, *people*, *America* and *Americans*, and their respective collocations will be analyzed and discussed according to the discourse-historical approach discussed in 3.2. Examples (1) & (2) show the nomination and predication strategy in DHA.

(1) "It is time for Senate Democrats to stop resisting the will of the *American people*. So, very simply, stop resisting the will of the *American people* and to start working across the aisle to deliver for all citizens. We love our country; we want to keep our country great". (394 - Weekly address, June 2, 2018)

(2) "My fellow Americans, a new optimism is sweeping our country as we return power from Washington and give it back to the *American people*, where it belongs. […] Since day one, I have been fighting for the *hard-working people* of this country, and this week, we took historic action to continue delivering on that promise". (262 - Weekly address, April 21, 2017)

Both examples clearly show how social actors and events are discursively constructed and how these actors and events are qualified. In (1), Trump constructs three different social actor groups: firstly, the Senate Democrats, who are portrayed as a negative force "resisting the will of the *American people*"; secondly, the American people, who are neither positively nor negatively evaluated by Trump and thirdly, the *we*-group, which may be interpreted as the government in Washington including Trump. The *we*-group certainly carries a positive connotation because Trump insists that the government loves the country and intends to do no harm to it. This stands in stark contrast to the Senate Democrats who seem, in Donald Trump's opinion, to prevent a positive development of the US. This portrayal is also an indicator for the predication strategy, which creates stereotypical groups and attributes negative evaluative traits (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). This is even emphasized when he 'orders' the Democrats to "deliver for all citizens". These directive speech acts, "such as commands or orders, may be used to enact power, and hence also to exercise and to reproduce dominance" (Van Dijk, 1993, p. 250). Additionally, he seems to blame the Democrats only for not making enough progress and by that "leaving implicit and understating responsible agency" on his and the Republicans' part (Van Dijk, 1993, p. 250). Back then, the Democrats neither held the majority in the Senate nor the House of Representatives, which reduced the Democrats' impact on American politics largely. Naturally, this fact does not fit to Trump's argumentation of "delivering to all citizens".

What may be interpreted from this short phrase is that he implies that the Democrats work for the upper and middle class only, but do not care about the working class at all. This in turn, creates another dimension of a social group, namely the in-group of the upper and middle class and the out-group of the working class that seems to be disadvantaged in the US. This is also linked to example (2), which originates from a weekly address from April 2017 issued prior to example (1). Trump claims that Washington's power is transferred to the American citizens and creates the impression that the American people are in charge of power to make nationwide decisions. Trump goes from a very general mentioning of *American people* to a more specific usage of "*hard-working people* of this country". Although, the calculations of the t and MI scores showed that this collocation is not statistically significant, I would like to discuss this one instance here critically. The usage of the collocation *hard-working people* stands for the predication strategy

(Reisigl, 2017), which portrays the working class as social actors, who have supposedly been neglected by the Democrats, but who now receive a chance to positively influence future decisions of the government. Furthermore, the reader may also interpret it as a mitigation technique where Trump pretends to shift the power of the government to the citizens to make up for the alleged misuse of power and the class inequality created by the Democrats. By applying "my fellow Americans" at the beginning of the sentence, Trump actively engages all Americans and tries to reduce the distance between himself as the President of the United States and his voters respectively the citizens of the US (cp. perspectivisation strategy (Reisigl, 2017)). Reducing the distance between the leader of a country and the country's citizens is a common technique in political discourse. Since the president tries to "transform[ing] political will into social action", he employs inclusive personal pronouns to do so (Partington & Taylor, 2018, p. 1).

The last remaining lexeme of the first group is *America* and its three respective collocations *bless*, *great*, and *first*. The reason why *bless America* (sentence (16)) occurred 28 times in the Trump Corpus is that this is a formulaic phrase the address and other speeches of the US President mostly end with. Judging from the results of the Lancaster corpus, this phrase seems to be rather political discourse specific because it does not occur in the reference corpus at all. Domke & Coe (2008) refer to the phrase as nothing more than

> […] a simple way for Presidents and politicians of all stripes to pass the God and Country test; to sate the appetites of those in the public and press corps who want assurance that this person is a real, God-fearing American. It's the verbal equivalent of donning an American flag lapel pin: few notice if you do it, but many notice if you don't (Domke & Coe, 2008, para. 6).

Overall, this phrase does not carry an implicit ideology with regards to Trump's "America First" policy and can be merely interpreted as keeping the traditions of previous presidents by uttering *God bless America* at the end of speeches and addresses.

(3) "Thank you, God bless you, and God *bless America*." (240 - Weekly address April 13, 2018)

(4) "We want tax reform that puts *America first*. We want tax reform that makes *America great* again." (677 - Weekly address, September 22, 2017)

(5) "Foreign nations got rich at America's expense, and many special interests profited from this great global theft of American wealth. Since taking the oath of office, our Government has adopted a new philosophy: *America first*. And believe me, it's about time. The era of economic surrender is over, and a new national pride is sweeping across our land." (455 - Weekly address, July 7, 2017)

Examples (4) & (5) are good examples of Trump's "America first" rhetoric. Both sentences carry the ideology of prioritizing the United States concerning taxes and economy and establishing a border between itself and other countries. The discursive strategies that Trump employs in examples (4) & (5) are predication and ar-

gumentation. In (4), he repeatedly applies the pronoun *we*, which can be interpreted as having an inclusive character because theoretically *we* could be replaced by *you*. This would also support the notion that tax reform in favor of US citizens is something they would support. Furthermore, the public would feel heard by the government. In (5), Trump clearly illustrates the argumentation strategy by explaining and justifying his "America first" policy. He legitimates the exclusion of other countries from trade with the US by claiming that "foreign nations got rich at America's expense, and many special interests profited from this great global theft of American wealth". Statements (4) & (5) illustrate Trump's ideology of exclusion and create the image that other countries are to blame for America's economy. Trump intends to reduce tax rates for wealthy citizens and businesses in order to convince them of keeping their production sites in the US (DeLorenzo, 2017). He directly refers to his America-exclusive policy by using his campaign motto "America first" repeatedly in both example sentences. In sentence (5), Trump uses the phrase *believe me*, which has become a Trumpism since his election campaign in 2015 (Phillips, 2015). As Viser (2016) suggests that Trump "by being one of the most inconsistent and non-ideological candidates in modern political history […]" applies this phrase to convince people that he is speaking the truth (Viser, 2016, para. 6). In his article, Viser (2016) quotes Lakoff, who says that *believe me* is used as an evidential marker with "knowledge com[ing] from direct experience" (Lakoff in: Viser, 2016, para. 15). Its usage implies that the source is authoritative, tells the truth (Sclafani, 2018) and also intensifies their statement, i.e., the intensification strategy (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009).

Examples (6), (7), and (8) display the most frequent usages of jobs + collocation. As already discussed in previous example sentences, the predication and nomination strategies are the most obvious discursive strategies in sentence (6). Trump praises himself and his administration for creating "nearly half a million new jobs" (predication). He could have used the more neutral, objective "US administration" or a more inclusive version "our administration" to include US citizens, but instead he speaks of "my administration" (nomination), which creates the impression that he is solely responsible for the increase of the employment rate. The critical observer may notice that Trump's inauguration took place on January 20, 2017. He gave the respective address eight weeks later, which makes it nearly impossible that the newly added jobs to the US economy are his personal merits only, but may also be the merits of his predecessor Barack Obama or may even result from seasonal fluctuations on the US job market[6].

(6) "The first two job reports of my administration show that we've already added nearly half a million *new jobs*." (180 - Weekly Address, March 18, 2017)

6 Monthly employment statistics can be accessed from the US Department of Labor – Bureau of Labor Statistics via their website https://www.bls.gov/.

(7) "On trade, we have also taken historic action to protect American industry and bring back the kinds of *high-paying jobs* that can support a middle class family and, in fact, most families." (328 - Weekly Address, May 12, 2017)

(8) "I want America to be the great jobs magnet of the world, but we can't do that if we don't stop the wasteful rules and excessive taxes that make it impossible for companies to compete. Every hour of every day, my administration is focused on creating jobs for our people, and I mean good jobs, more jobs, better jobs, *higher paying jobs*. That's our mission." (111 - Weekly Address, February 10, 2017)

Two months later in his weekly address from May 12, 2017 (example (7)), Donald Trump hints at the positive development of the US job market by mentioning that "we have taken historic action to protect American industry". The nomination strategy becomes obvious again by applying the inclusive pronoun *we* denoting a certain kind of membership in this case the US government (cf. Reisigl & Wodak, 2009). Furthermore, this strategy also discursively constructs processes, i.e., the administration and the US President have been trying to convince the American industry to remain in or even return to the US to save or create new jobs. Apart from expressing nomination, the pronoun *we* also illustrates the perspectivisation strategy, which clearly shows Trump's involvement in the process of saving jobs and providing a decent payment for middle-class families. The phrase "historic action" emphasizes that Trump pretends to be the first president who takes the US trade seriously and intends to stop companies from relocating their production sites to China and to stop an excessive import of Chinese products for instance. Although higher tariffs on Chinese products may be a starting point to support the purchase of US products instead of imported Chinese goods, Donnan (2019) explains that the US may lose $40 billion a year in exports to China due to Chinese counter-tariffs imposed on US products. One characteristic of Trump's rhetoric and comparable to the usage of the phrase *believe me* is the usage of *can* in the relative clause of sentence (7). He used the modal verb in its deontic meaning, which intensifies his claim that *high-paying jobs* help middle-class families to survive. According to Reisigl & Wodak (2009), this can be grouped under the intensification strategy in DHA. Additionally, Trump intensifies and almost boosts his claim towards the end of the sentence by saying that "a middle class family, in fact, most families" are being supported by high-paying jobs in the industry.

In sentence (8), Trump begins with the personal pronoun *I*, but soon switches to *we*. By doing that, he develops an implicit good versus bad scenario or even an *us* versus *them* ideology. This belongs to the perspectivisation strategy in which Trump positions himself and his administration on the good side, whereas he implies that the Democrats hinder a positive development of the job market by holding on to "excessive taxes" for companies. Although he does not mention it directly, he emphasizes his standpoint by using the phrase "my administration", which clearly hints at the Republicans instead of the entire government consisting of the Democrats as well. He frames the current US job market as something negative, but positions himself and his administration as the leading force to change

this situation to the better, i.e., "every hour of every day, my administration is focused on creating jobs […]". Moreover, he uses the metaphor "jobs magnet" to underline his "America First" policy concerning US trade and economy. The last two sentences of the excerpt carry the main message. Trump repeats the noun *jobs* four times and combines it with different adjectives. It seems that he intended to create a range of importance for the chosen adjectives. He starts with *good jobs*, goes on with *more jobs*, then continues with *better jobs* and ends with *higher paying jobs*. The latter three *job* phrases are comparative and directly refer to the current situation on the job market that means that Trump's intention is the creation of additional, better, and better paid jobs to the US job market.

The last lexeme and its statistically significant collocations is *tax* + *reform*, *tax* + *cut* and *tax* + *code*. What all three sentences have in common is that they perfectly represent Trump's "America First" policy. However, what seems striking in terms of Trump's usual rhetoric is example (9). Although he begins in his usual manner of repetitions and "America First" slogans, he goes on with asking both, the Republicans and the Democrats, to work together peacefully to reform the US tax system and to unitedly serve the citizens of the country. He uses positive terms, such as *one people*, and metaphors, such as *one team* and *one American family*, to frame a positive relationship between the two parties. Frames and metaphors, in this specific sentence, share the characteristic of the abstraction into general or even familiar patterns (Dahinden, 2006), i.e., a team and a family have several different members with distinct opinions and tasks to be fulfilled, but they should be united and usually work towards one goal. Trump repeatedly applied inclusive *we* as part of the nomination strategy in DHA. In contrast to the usage of *we* in sentence (8), *we* in sentence (9) includes the Republicans, the Democrats as well as all US citizens. In that particular sentence, US citizens may perceive a united government as something positive concerning decision-making processes.

(9) "We want *tax reform* that puts America first. We want *tax reform* that makes America great again. […] I'm asking members in both parties to come together, to put aside partisan differences, and to pass historic *tax reform* and *tax cuts* for the great citizens of our Nation. That's how we will all succeed and thrive together: as one team, one people, and one American family". (677 - Weekly Address, September 22, 2017)

(10) "Last week, my economic team outlined another step in our economic renewal: a massive *tax cut* to bring jobs and prosperity back to the U.S.A. […] I am proposing, actually, the single largest *tax cut* in American history". (311 - Weekly Address, May 5, 2017)

(11) "First, we are going to make the *Tax Code* simple and fair so that families can spend more time with their children and less time wading through pages of paperwork. […] We have a once-in-a-generation opportunity to reform our *Tax Code* and pave the way to unprecedented prosperity". (677 - Weekly Address, September 22, 2017)

As already mentioned above, Trump prefers to apply metaphors to illustrate negative as well as positive events and actions. In example (9), he uses *one American family*, which certainly has a very positive connotation, whereas he applies the

quite negatively connoted metaphor *wading through pages of paperwork* in example (11) to emphasize the time-consuming completion of tax forms in the US. Later in his address, he refers to the *once-in-a-generation opportunity to reform our tax code* and Trump and his administration (usage of inclusive *we*) are the main actors to drive the change. He ends example (11) with the positive metaphor *pave the way to unprecedented prosperity*.

A further common characteristic that the three sentences share is the usage of adjectives in front of the lexemes and their collocations. These adjectives all seem to have a rather exaggerated nature, which may be characteristic of Donald Trump's rhetoric (Sclafani, 2018). Similar to other examples above, Trump applies *massive*, *historic*, *single largest* and *once-in-a-generation* to reinforce the nouns and praise the immense improvements his administrative actions will have on the public (example (10)). These evaluative attributions of positive traits (Reisigl & Wodak, 2009) are part of the predication strategy, which discursively qualifies events and actions positively in these specific sentences. Whether these tax cuts respectively the tax reform will be "historic" or "massive" remains to be seen (DeLorenzo, 2017).

Although the above discussed examples 9-11 deal with one issue of Trump's "America First" policy, they are not the prototypical statements people would expect of Donald Trump. These address excerpts do not contain accusations or even insults against individuals, the Democrats or any other entity. Thus, they draw a rather positive picture of the future of the US, at least concerning the tax issues, by Trump's request to come together as *one team* and work united towards a better tax system.

5. Conclusion

The present study tried to combine qualitative and quantitative methods to critically analyze political discourse in particular US presidential weekly addresses by Donald Trump. The corpus compiled for the study consisted of 48 weekly addresses from 2017 and 2018. The 2006 American English corpus from Lancaster University was chosen as a reference corpus. In order to find out whether Trump uses ideologically loaded rhetoric, in this case his "America First" slogans, a word list was compiled with the help of the concordance program AntConc. The first 15 lexemes were selected for a closer analysis. Next, a collocation list of these 15 lexemes was generated. The collocations from the Trump corpus were compared to the Lancaster corpus. Due to the specific genre of the Trump corpus, the collocation results were not comparable at all. The quantitative part calculated the t and MI scores of the select collocations and showed that 7 of the 15 lexemes occur together more often than merely by chance for instance *American people*, *hard-working people*, *high-paying jobs* and *tax reform*. The qualitative analysis was carried out according to the DHA framework in CDA, which mainly focusses on discursive strategies. All five discursive strategies were found in the select sentences. However, the nomination and predication strategies occurred most often, followed by the perspectivisation, argumentation and mitigation & intensification strategies.

What was apparent about Trump's rhetoric is that he frequently applied his "America First" statements to support his *we* versus *they* ideology of the "good" America and the "bad" rest of the world or the "good" Republicans that drive change versus the "bad" Democrats that hinder change. In the above discussed examples, he made it very clear who is in charge of the government and what his respectively their changes for the US will be like in the future. These "America First" examples made up the majority of his rhetoric with only one exception for the collocation *tax reform*, where he asked Democrats and Republicans to put aside their differences and work together as one unit to change the American tax system. This example stood out and was rather the exception to the rule.

For future CDA analyses of political discourse, a fitting reference corpus should be found and used. Additionally, the classification of lexemes into semantic fields may be helpful to contrast the semantic meanings of words to their pragmatic ones and the possible differences between the two. A further intriguing analysis could be a cross-cultural comparison of weekly addresses for instance between the US, China, and Great Britain to elicit differences in political rhetoric styles and the usage of ideologies in political discourses.

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A Socio-Semantic Approach to Corpus Compilation: The Case of Chinese Academic English

Guo Ya

Chemnitz University of Technology

Abstract

Based on the probabilistic theory of grammar (Halliday, 1991, 1992, 1993; Halliday and James 1993, collected in Halliday, 2005) that 'the grammatical system is inherently probabilistic and that it can be invested through the relative frequency of selections of systemic terms' (Matthiessen, 2007: 780) goes back to Halliday (1959), this paper discussed the cline of instantiation of expansion (elaborating, extending, enhancing) patterns (interpreted either as macro-logogenetic or as micro-phylogenetic) in Chinese Academic English corpus by adopting a two-pronged approach which involves both manual text analysis in SysFan and automated corpus analysis in AntConc (cf. Matthiessen, 2006; Hartley & Paris, 1995) after Matthiessen's (2002, 2006) researches on systemic intersection of clause complexes and Sellami – Baklouti's (2011, 2013) study of systemic choices in variable contexts, as noted by J. Schmied (1990) that 'by applying more sophisticated statistical programs…the development and frequency of (linguistic) features in texts of different educational levels may be followed', in order to investigate firstly similarities and differences between M.A. theses and Ph.D. dissertations written by English major students from Chinese Universities, secondly possibilities of writing developments from Master's level to Ph.D.'s level, and thirdly errors emerged from both levels and related reasons. Thus, diversities in paratactic enhancements are further compared; scarcely ever developments can be deduced from tests of statistics due to limitations of sample size and discontinuity of authors; and four kinds of additions for academic writing, i.e. unrelated addition, unequal addition, wrongly addition, and implicit addition are temporarily presented in the paper.

Keywords: Probabilistic Theory, Expansion, Chinese Academic Writing

1. Introduction

Since Halliday advocated that 'the grammatical system is inherently probabilistic and that it can be invested through the relative frequency of selections of systemic terms' (Matthiessen, 2007: 780) and certified this viewpoint by using observed frequencies in Chinese grammar corpus and estimating probabilities of terms in grammatical systems (1956, 1959), many researchers have contributed to the probability of instantiation studies from the perspective of clause complexes systems: Nesbitt and Plum (1988) not only explained the partial association of patterns in simultaneous system i.e. elaboration prefers to parataxis while enhancing favours hypotaxis from 2,733 clause nexuses, but also revealed how register variation af-

fected quantifications of instantiations on accounting of their grammatical patterns; Matthiessen (2002, 2006) explored intersections of simultaneous systems and then investigated 'correlations between patterns of instantiation along the cline of instantiation and patterns of systemic elaboration of along the paradigmatic axis' manually; Sellami – Baklouti's (2011, 2013) studies showed that 'contextual factors, i.e. the discipline of research and the RAA (research article abstracts) genre, affect the probabilities of choice of clause structure' in her corpus of 100 abstracts by counting the conditional probability (Grinstead & Snell, 1997: 133) through annotation from UAM Corpus Tool (V. 2.8.3). Studies (Rodriguez-Vergara, 2015; Srinon & White, 2011; Charisma, 2013; Huang, 2015) also discussed clause complexes in academic writing discourses, especially projection on Chinese academic discourse (Zeng & Hu, 2007). But few works on probabilistic theory of academic writing discourse have been done to compare instantial and systematic differences from clause complexing grammatical patterns, so this research starts from the probability theory to taxis and expansion systems, from PhD dissertations and MA theses written by English major students in China to academic writing error analysis, in order to qualitatively and quantitatively investigate systemic realizations from two poles of the cline of instantiation (lexical and grammatical poles).

2. The Probabilistic Theory

2.1. History

After Sapir (1921: 147) put forward an idea of comparing two speakers' different usages "in choice of words, in sentence structure, in the relative frequency with which particular forms or combinations of words are used," it was Chomsky (1969: 57; 1956) who mostly criticised the probabilistic viewpoint by advocating "it must be recognized that the notion 'probability of a sentence' is an entirely useless one, under any known interpretation of this term", and even remarked for syntax that "1. Probabilistic models wrongly mix in world knowledge; 2. Probabilistic models don't model grammaticality; 3. Use of probabilities does not meet the goal of describing the mind-internal I-language as opposed to the observed-in-the-world E-knowledge". (Manning, 2003: 290) But Svartvik held the opposite view that "corpus studies will help to promote descriptively more adequate grammars" (1966: vii) and calculated the percentage of passive vs. active clauses and also compared the frequency of passives across a range of different genres. (Halliday, 2005: 63) In addition, the linguistic system, in Halliday's point of view, is "inherently probabilistic, and the frequency in text was the instantiation of probability in the grammar". (ibid, 2005: 64)

2.2. Definition of Halliday

On the relationship of grammar and probability, Halliday thought that "the grammar has to be paradigmatic: it has to be able to represent language as choice, since

probability is that of 'choosing' one thing rather than another" (Halliday, 1991: 42). Thus, the process of counting the probabilities of each category within a system is also the process of showing how and why each category is chosen by users. And based on his corpora counting, a bimodal distribution of the system was hypothesized that it can either be 'equiprobable' (0.5/05) or 'skew' (0.1/0.9).

For Halliday, register variation "can in fact be defined as systemic variation in probabilities; a register is a tendency to select certain combinations of meanings with certain frequencies, and this can be formulated as the probabilities attached to grammatical systems, provided such systems are integrated into an overall system network in a paradigmatic interpretation of the grammar". (Halliday, 2005: 66)

In the process of showing "how each instance maintains and perturbs the system", (ibid) frequency patterns can diachronically explain language change if regarded as probabilities. System is the language, which is "potential, with its set of probabilities attached; and appears constant through time" (Halliday, 2005:67); instance is the text, which "redefines the system, however infinitesimally, maintaining its present state or shifting its probabilities in one direction or the other" (ibid). From corpus of instances, diachronic changes of the system can be perceived by calculating frequencies of categories or patterns.

2.3. Implications

And by researching grammatical relative frequencies, the probability configuration of grammatical systems can be speculated, thus provide implications for theoretical development in at least five points, as Halliday suggested: developmental, diatypic, systemic, historical and metatheoretic. 'Developmental' means that a probabilistic model can help children make clear of the growth of lexicogrammatical meaning potential when they are confronted with diverse texts frequencies; 'diatypic' means that 'diatypic variation or register is the major resource for systematically construing variation in the environment (the situation)'; systemically, choice probabilities contain 'information'; historically, 'both semogenesis, the creation and maintenance of meaning, and its opposite, the destruction of meaning, can be explained in terms of probabilities, in the way grammatical systems evolve towards more, or less, informative states'; and metatheoretically, by focusing on realization and instantiation, corpus analysis can reveal "how a semiotic system, as a stratified dynamic open system, persists through being constantly perturbed, with each instance reconstructing the potential of the whole" (Halliday, 2005: 73).

3. Expansion in Clause Complex Framework

Clause complex is a combination of two or more clauses into a larger unit, with their interdependence normally shown by explicit signals such as conjunctions (Thompson, 2014: 186), and it covers two regions: (1) Being closer to the pole of circumstantial augmentation, there are clause combinations where one clause is dependent on a dominant clause, the two thus being of unequal status; (2) Being

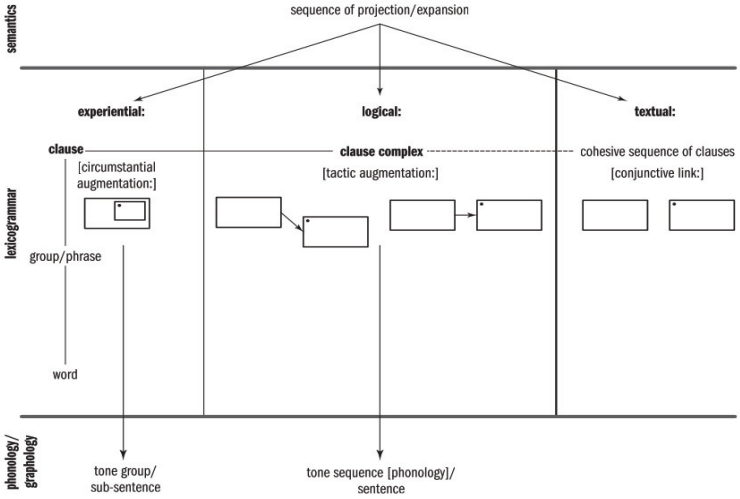


Figure 5 The location of the clause complex in terms of stratification, metafunction and rank (Halliday, 2014: 435).

closer to the pole of cohesive sequences, there are clause combinations where the two clauses are interdependent on one another, the two having equal status. (Halliday, 2014: 434 – 35)

3.1. The location of clause complex

In terms of metafunction, it is organized by the logical mode of the ideational metafunction, contrasting with circumstantial augmentations of the clause (experiential) and cohesive sequences (textual); in terms of rank, it is located at the highest rank of the grammar – clause rank; and it is thus related to the clause in terms of logical complexing rather than in terms of experiential constituency; in terms of stratification, a clause complex realizes a semantic sequence of projection or expansion; and it is, in turn, realized by a sentence in writing, as shown in Figure 5.

3.2. The location of expansion and its definition

Expansion, which means that "the secondary clause expands the primary clause" (Halliday, 2014: 443), belongs to a kind of logico-semantic relation with projection, e.g.:

(1) ||| Zhang Jian-li (1995) has clarified* || that antonyms refer to pairs of adjectives varying in qualities in most cases and not an umbrella term for the opposition of meaning, || **which*** we will follow in the thesis, || **and hence*** in this way we don't employ 'adjective antonym', but just the term 'antonym' for short. ||| [CMAC10SE_18_139]

3.2.1. *Hypotaxis and parataxis*

Besides logico-semantic relations in clause complex, taxis (degree of interdependency) is another type of relational structure, including parataxis (two clauses related as interdependent in a complex being of equal status) and hypotaxis (two clauses related as interdependent being of unequal status), in which the former consists of initiating and continuing clauses while the latter includes dominant and dependent clauses. (Halliday, 2014: 440) E.g.:

(2) ||| Their wisdom and expertise inspired me in my research || **and*** [1] their encouragement supported me from applying for the doctoral program to the completion of this dissertation. ||| [CPhD08_0012_7]

'And' in the clause complex connects the primary clause as an initiating one and the secondary clause as a continuing one.

(3) ||| The Eve of St. Agnes is a good example || **because*** it has the most obvious dramatic tendency among Keats's lyric poems. ||| [CPhD17_0003_571]

'Because' indicates a traditional adverbial clause of cause that the primary clause is a dominant one and the secondary clause depends on it. Figure 6 below shows the taxis and logico-semantic types in clause complexing system. The components of expansion: elaboration, extension and enhancement and its definition.

Back to expansion, as shown in Figure 6, one clause can enlarge or develop the other by the three following ways: elaborating (equals to, relations of restatement or equivalence, marked by '='), extending (is added to, marked by '+'), and enhancing (is multiplied by, option of development, marked by 'x'). (Halliday, 2014: 444)

(4) ||| [1:] Generally speaking, we divide a scale of degrees into halves, with zero point as an idealized state of no quality || [+2] **and*** [2α:] **as*** the left half extends, || [2xβ1:] qualities decrease || [2xβ+2:] **and*** the right half shows the strengthening of qualities. ||| [CMAC10SE_18_29]

Both 'and' mark paratactic expansion, to be specific addition and 'as' is regarded as hypotactic expansion, specifically causal relationship in enhancement.

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[1] The boldface and * signify markers for judging logico-semantic relations throughout the paper. They are usually are conjunctions.

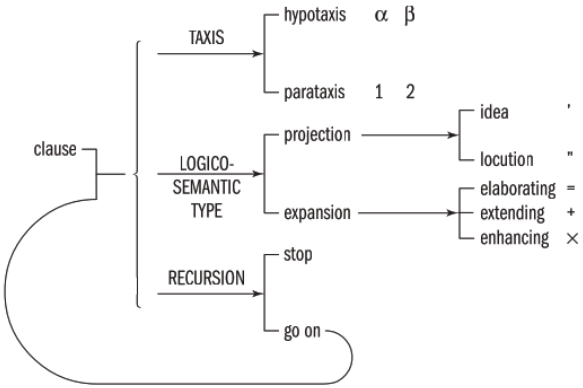


Figure 6 The clause complexing system (Halliday, 2014: 438)

3.2.2. *Elaboration: exposition, exemplification, clarification.*

When "one clause elaborates on the meaning of another by further specifying or describing it", we refer this kind of clause relationship as elaboration, that according to Halliday (2014: 461), "the secondary clause…provides a further characterization of one that is already there, restating it, clarifying it, refining it, or adding a descriptive attribute or comment", thus the secondary clause usually gives more information than the initial one. To describe it in more details, paratactic elaboration covers exposition (the secondary clause restates the thesis of the primary one in different words, to represent it from another point of view, or perhaps just to reinforce the message, like 'in other words', 'that is to say', 'I mean', etc.), exemplification (the secondary clause develops the thesis of the primary one by becoming more specific about it, often citing an actual example, like 'for example', 'for instance', 'in particular', etc.) and clarification (the secondary clause clarifies the thesis of the primary one by backing it up with some form of explanation or explanatory comment', such as 'to be precise', 'in fact', 'indeed', etc.); while hypotactic elaboration means description, which in traditional grammar system was called 'relative clauses' that were introduced by 'WH-' elements and non-finite clauses (Halliday, 2014: 461 – 470). For example:

(5) ||| [1:] …and often it is a synthesis of views [[that proves more enduring and forceful than a single extreme position in our explanation]], || [=2:] **that is***, compromise and blending of ways of construal is the core and guideline throughout the thesis. ||| [CMAC10SE_18_53]

In example (5), 'that is' marks paratactic exposition that the second clause gives further explanation to the theme described in the first clause, and they have the same topic.

(6) ||| [1:] Let's read one more example: || [=2:] This text is a detailed description of the great religious fair at the Earth God's Temple on Chingliang Mountain in Nanjing around the twenty-ninth of the seventh month. ||| [CMAC07CU_35_499]

Though the second clause is introduced implicitly through a noun 'example', followed with a colon, it is an actual example, thus the clause complex is defined as a paratactic exemplification.

(7) ||| [α1:] People tend to divide humor into situation humor and verbal humor, || [α=2:] the former one was produced by situation and situation related actors; || [+β:] **while*** the second one is closely related to semantic and pragmatic theories. ||| [CMAC14PR_4_125]

Before the semicolon, the second clause does back the first clause up with detailed explanatory comments though explicit markers cannot be found. If we tell from the semantic relationship, phrases like 'to be precise', 'precisely', 'i.e.,' can be added between two clauses to demonstrate their paratactic clarification relationship.

(8) ||| [α:] Linguistic typological theories and universals in SLA have provided us with a new approach to second language research, || [=β:] **whose*** application may bring to light some novel discoveries in language transfer studies. ||| [CPhD08_0005_137]

In example (8), 'whose' refers to the whole first clause, which shows their relative relationship that the secondary clause hypotactically described the first one clearly.

3.2.3. *Extension: addition, variation, alternation.*

Extension means that "one clause extends the meaning or another by adding something new to it", it can include addition (one process is simply adjoined to another; there is no implication of any causal or temporal relationship between them. Paratactic addition includes positive and negative additive marked by 'and', 'not only...but also…', 'neither…nor…', and adversative marked by 'but' and 'yet'; hypotactic addition is usually marked by 'while', 'whereas', 'besides', 'without', etc.), variation (one clause is represented as being in total or partial replacement of another. It covers replacive and subtractive marked by 'but not', 'instead of', 'rather than' and 'only', 'but', 'except', 'except that', etc., respectively), and alternation (one clause is represented as an alternative to another. Paratactic alternation is often marked by 'or' and hypotactic one is introduced by 'if…not (…then)'.) (Halliday, 2014: 471 – 476) For example:

(9) ||| [1:] A language is closely related to the culture behind it, || [+2:] **and*** words and phrases, the basic element of a language, inevitably bear cultural characteristics. ||| [CMAC07CU_35_7]

(10) ||| [α:] Many efforts have also been taken to analyze some Chinese traditional novels–sometimes Chinese version of foreign novels as well–and especially the four Chinese classics, || [+β:] **while*** few efforts have been taken on the English version of The Scholars. ||| [CMAC07CU_35_43]

Paratactic positive addition can be found from 'and' and hypotactic addition can be inferred from 'while' in the above examples.

(11) ||| Thus, [+β:] **rather than*** attempting to neutralize texts, || [αα:] it would seem more suitable to prepare students || [αxβ:] by "helping them build background knowledge on the topic which is new to them but accessible to them". ||| [CMAC07LI_20_603]

(12) ||| [+β1:] **If*** the activated schema does **not** help comprehension, || [+β+2:] **or*** it even results in misunderstanding, || [α:] the listener needs revise his schema from the continuing input data. ||| [CMAC07LI_20_253]

Hypotactic variation is marked by 'rather than' to indicate replacement, paratactic alternation is marked by 'or', and hypotactic alternation can be showed by 'if…not' to indicate he author's choice of research methods.

3.2.4. *Enhancement: temporal, spatial, manner, causal, conditional.*

Halliday (2014: 476) defined enhancement as "one clause enhances the meaning of another by qualifying it in one of a number of possible ways: by reference to time, place, manner, cause or condition". Enhancement clauses are traditionally regarded as adverbial clauses, but when considering taxis, hypotactic temporal, spatial, manner clause complexes prefer to finite clauses while hypotactic causal-conditional can more be found as non-finite conjunctive and prepositional clauses. For example:

(13) ||| Therefore, [xβ:] **as far as*** NECC is concerned, || [α:] learners and teachers prefer to work more at the listening, reading and vocabulary. ||| [CMAC05WR_20_69]

Hypotactic spatial relationship can be found through 'as far as' to indicate the extent.

(14) ||| [xβ:] **When*** the students get to the second year, || [α1:] teachers can guide them to further their study || [α1xβ:] **by*** analyzing the connotations behind the cultural phenomena, || [α+2:] and* guide them to think more, such as ways of thinking, views of values, religions, and so on. ||| [CMAC08CU_33_503]

Hypotactic temporal can be conveyed by 'when' and hypotactic manner (means) by 'by' to show the way that teachers use for guiding students' study.

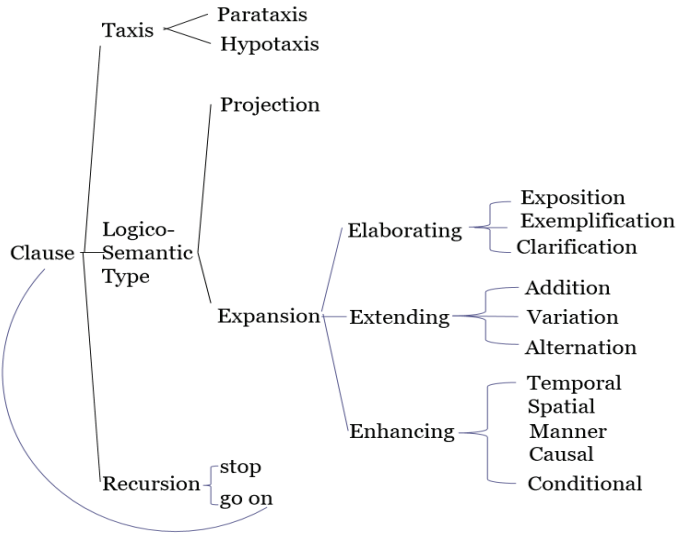


Figure 7 The analysing theoretical framework for taxis and expansion clause complexes.

(15) ||| [αα:] He goes abroad in person || [αxβ:] **in order to*** figure out Oliver's identity || [xβα:] **in that*** he found out || [xβ'β:] there is a great resemblance between Oliver and the portrait of a lady [[left by his late friend]]. ||| [CMAC10LIT_7_155]

Though two hypotactic enhancements can be found in this example, 'in that' indicates hypotactic causal (reason) relationship while 'in order to' is hypotactic causal (purpose) relationship for Oliver's going abroad in person.

(16) ||| [xβ:] **If*** the way of face-to-face discussion wants to achieve better than the way of thinking independently, || [α:] there might be enough training of group discussion and collaborative learning. ||| [CMAC09ME_24_553]

Hypotactic condition (positive) is often marked by 'if'. In order to give a short conclusion, the analyzing theoretical framework for this thesis can be illustrated in Figure 7.

After describing the expansion system with examples from the chosen corpus, this paper is mainly to answer the following quantitative and comparative questions:

1. On the expansion and taxis level, what is the distribution for their intersection for the whole chosen corpus and what are the difference and similarities between MA theses and PhD dissertations regarding to their intersection?

2. What is the percentage of choosing elaboration, extension and enhancement in MA and PhD corpus respectively, and why differences on expansion level and educational level can be found?

3. On choosing words and phrases to convey enhancement relationship, do MA theses and PhD dissertations have diversities in category like temporal or conditional, and is there any educational development in regards to any specific category, for example temporal?

Though research questions can be quite general, this paper is going to answer each by choosing representative outcomes. The whole corpus i.e., the Chinese Academic English (ChAcE) Corpus, under the guidance of Professor Dr. Josef Schmied and the help of two of my colleagues: Xinlei Zhang and Jessica Dheskali, was compiled in 2015 as a data base for PhD researches. It includes 303 MA theses (around 5.1 million words) and 112 PhD dissertations (around 5.3 million words) written by Chinese students of English major ranging from the year 2005 to 2014 in total 104 universities downloaded from CNKI (China National Knowledge Infrastructure) and Duxiu Net, and these theses are scattered equally in linguistics, translation, literature, culture, writing, reading, speaking, and listening part. For this research, 25 MA theses and 10 PhD dissertations, partly from the corpus and partly from CNKI directly written from year 2015 to 2018, are chosen as the research object.

Classification	No. of Theses	Words	(No. of CC)	Analyzing No.
MA	25	368,784	15,874	7,939
PhD	10	517,063	20,969	10,488

Table 13 General information of the chosen corpus

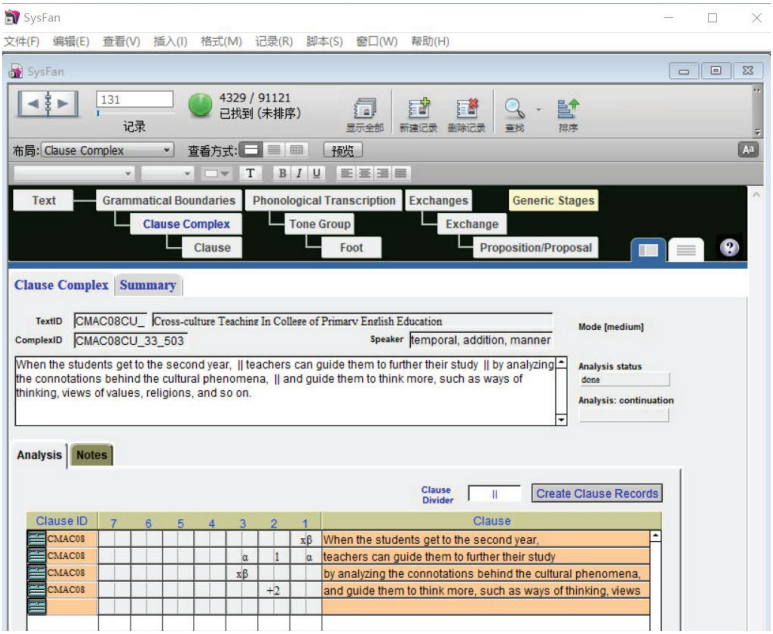


Figure 8 The work interface of SysFan with examples

After cleaning all unnecessary information (not the authors' original written clauses) such as: personal information, notes, appendix, references, etc., the chosen corpus are imported in SysFan (Wu, 2000) for analysis and annotation of each clause complex. Then statistics is calculated by SPSS 22.0 (The number of all clause complexes is 18,427.) For lexis choice quantifying, AntConc 3.5.8 (Anthony 2019) is adopted and then filtrated manually according to semantic and contextual conditions.

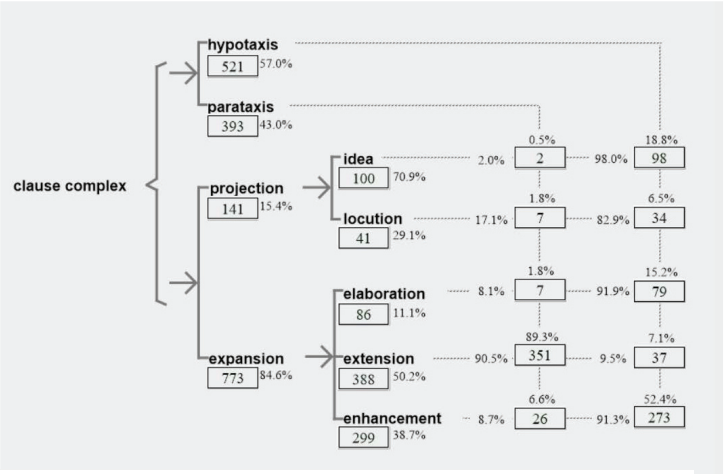


Figure 9 The summary of clause complexes of one text (CPhD13_0010)

4. Grammatical Comparison

4.1. The distribution of Taxis and Expansion intersection

After recording all numbers and the percentage of each category as shown in Figure 9, we can see from Figure 12, that around 41 percent of parataxis is used by group 1 (MA students) and it is approximately 37 percent used by group 2 (PhD students), it is also the same condition as to paratactic expansion that less are used by PhD students. But the difference of 4% and 2.8% of each could not give out enough evidence for confirmation of their diversity. By Mann-Whitney U test from Figure 12, a conclusion can be drawn out that MA students and PhD students have no difference in choosing parataxis, paratactic expansion, and their counterparts because their 2-tailed Asymp. Sig. are larger than 0.05, with 0.13 and 0.258 respectively. Compared with parataxis (paratactic expansion), both MA students and PhD students choose more hypotaxis (hypotactic expansion) in their theses.

One-Sample Test

	Test Value = 50					
	t	df	Sig. (2-tailed)	Mean Difference	95% Confidence Interval of the Difference	
					Lower	Upper
Paraexpansion	-3.454	34	.001	-4.81971	-7.6556	-1.9838
Parataxis	-7.137	34	.000	-9.83886	-12.6404	-7.0374

Figure 10 The one-sample test of paratactic expansion and parataxis in chosen corpus

Report

group		Parataxis	Hypotaxis	Expansion	Paraexpansion	Hypoexpansion
1	N	25	25	25	25	25
	Maximum	262.19	392.07	492.05	254.02	351.63
	Minimum	83.41	109.66	168.71	74.63	75.92
	Range	178.78	282.41	323.35	179.40	275.71
	Mean	158.0278	228.6019	322.4167	147.5560	174.8607
	Std. Deviation	42.17397	65.01790	74.23683	43.98729	53.51432
	Variance	1778.644	4227.327	5511.107	1934.882	2863.782
	Kurtosis	.847	.634	.510	.707	4.173
	Skewness	.828	.233	.588	.871	1.270
2	N	10	10	10	10	10
	Maximum	197.13	458.71	498.46	177.25	321.20
	Minimum	72.59	121.62	161.78	71.04	90.74
	Range	124.54	337.08	336.68	106.21	230.47
	Mean	127.6520	224.3783	281.6988	119.5975	162.1014
	Std. Deviation	31.31571	91.70530	87.37601	29.20510	62.81950
	Variance	980.674	8409.862	7634.567	852.938	3946.289
	Kurtosis	3.089	5.393	4.741	1.136	5.096
	Skewness	.729	2.043	1.717	.234	1.974

Figure 11 Descriptive statistics of the data set.

After one-sample test and setting the test value as 50 (half of 100 % as '%' is omitted), the *p*-value is 0.001 for paratactic expansion and 0.000 for parataxis (see Figure 10), and so we can confirm that the hypotaxis (hypotactic expansion) and parataxis (paratactic expansion) differs greatly in both MA theses and PhD dissertations. As the percentage refers to each category within the clause complex system, for example in Figure 11, the percentage of parataxis is 43% vs. hypotaxis (57%); expansion (84.57%) vs. projection (15.43%); paratactic expansion (49.68%) vs. hyotactic expansion (50.32%), etc.

We further have confirmed that MA students and PhD students have no difference in choosing each category from the system, a hypothesis can be put forward

Report

group		Parataxis	Hypotaxis	Paraexpansion	Hypoexpansion
1	N	25	25	25	25
	Maximum	58.93	74.21	61.31	71.67
	Minimum	25.79	41.07	28.33	38.69
	Range	33.14	33.14	32.98	32.98
	Mean	41.3756	58.6244	45.9788	54.0212
	Std. Deviation	8.97283	8.97283	9.08987	9.08987
	Variance	80.512	80.512	82.626	82.626
	Kurtosis	-.643	-.643	-.553	-.553
	Skewness	.179	-.179	-.395	.395
2	N	10	10	10	10
	Maximum	46.20	69.94	51.99	64.44
	Minimum	30.06	53.80	35.56	48.01
	Range	16.14	16.14	16.43	16.43
	Mean	37.1250	62.8750	43.1840	56.8160
	Std. Deviation	4.71486	4.71486	5.56195	5.56195
	Variance	22.230	22.230	30.935	30.935
	Kurtosis	.397	.397	-.841	-.841
	Skewness	.696	-.696	.148	-.148

Figure 12 The percentage information of parataxis, hypotaxis, paratactic expansion and hypotactic expansion in chosen corpus

Test Statistics[a]

	Parataxis	Hypotaxis	Paraexpansion	Hypoexpansion
Mann-Whitney U	83.500	83.500	94.000	94.000
Wilcoxon W	138.500	408.500	149.000	419.000
Z	-1.515	-1.515	-1.132	-1.132
Asymp. Sig. (2-tailed)	.130	.130	.258	.258
Exact Sig. [2*(1-tailed Sig.)]	.131[b]	.131[b]	.270[b]	.270[b]

a. Grouping Variable: group

b. Not corrected for ties.

Figure 13 The Mann-Whitney U test result of parataxis, hypotaxis, paratactic expansion and hypotactic expansion in chosen corpus

here that in academic writing texts written by MA and PhD students from English major in China, the mean percentage of parataxis in total corpus is between 35% and 45%, with hypotaxis from 55% to 65%; the mean percentage of expansion in the whole corpus is between 75% and 85%, with projection from 15% to 25%; and the mean percentage of paratactic expansion of the whole corpus ranges from 40% to 48%, with hypotactic expansion from 52% to 60%. Though different students may not have the same writing habits, for example, the percentage of hypotaxis in some texts can reach up to 74% and expansion up to 90%, the average percentage of each category is located in the scopes as shown above.

Independent Samples Test

		Levene's Test for Equality of Variances		t-test for Equality of Means				
		F	Sig.	t	df	Sig. (2-tailed)	Mean Difference	Std. Error Difference
Parataxis	Equal variances assumed	1.317	.259	2.055	33	.048	30.37578	14.78317
	Equal variances not assumed			2.335	22.379	.029	30.37578	13.00819
Paraexpansion	Equal variances assumed	1.745	.196	1.845	33	.074	27.95851	15.15166
	Equal variances not assumed			2.192	25.019	.038	27.95851	12.75496

Figure 14 The independent samples test result of parataxis and paratactic expansion in chosen corpus

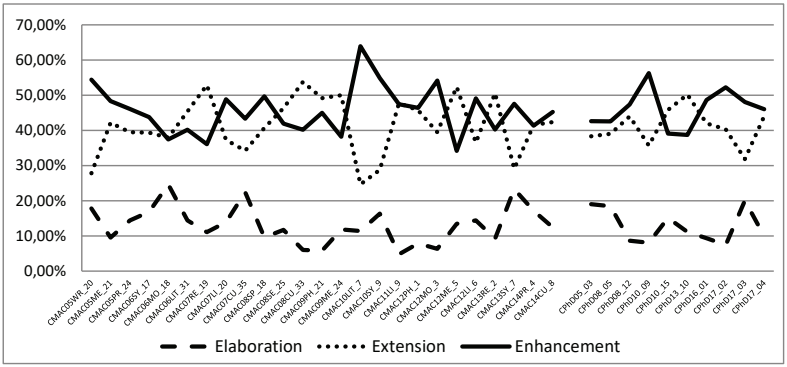


Figure 15 The percentage of elaboration, extension and enhancement in expansion of the chosen corpus

Another dimension is to compare between MA theses and PhD dissertations the choice of each category by dividing the number of words in each text per ten thousand words. From the independent samples test in Figure 14, the *p*-value of parataxis (0.048) is less than 0.05, and paratactic expansion (0.074) is not very far away from 0.05 as their equal variances are assumed, and from Figure 11, the mean of these two categories of MA theses are larger than those of PhD's, so a conclusion can be drawn that MA students applied more parataxis and paratactic expansion in their theses per thousand words than PhD candidates.

4.2. The distribution of three kinds of expansion

In Figure 15, around 13% of the expansion is elaboration used in both MA theses and PhD dissertation, with average 41% extension and 46% enhancement. The difference between less elaboration and more other two counterparts mainly lies in the language itself as the grammatical scope of elaboration is narrower than the

MA(%) / PhD(%)	Hypotactic Elaboration	Paratactic Extension	Hypotactic Enhancement
Maximum	92.86 / 95.24	100 / 96.45	98.39 / 96.93
Minimum	25 / 63.64	83.33 / 82.31	66.67 / 87.08
Average	71.64 / 79.54	92.24 / 89.52	89.96 / 92.24
Variance	354.18 / 101.58	25.18 / 17.14	51.87 / 10.19

Table 14 The percentage conditions of hypotactic elaboration, paratactic extension and hypotactic enhancement in MA and PhD chosen texts

others, students often apply it in describing figures and charts, introducing examples and explaining theory backgrounds. An interesting phenomenon is that the percentage of extension is the same as enhancement. As extension includes more conjunctive words and phrases, we have sufficient reasons to discuss the usage even unsuitable or wrongly used conditions of its categories such as addition in section 6 in this paper.

Table 14 shows the condition of the intersection of taxis and three categories of expansion that elaboration and enhancement prefer to hypotaxis while extension tends to parataxis in both MA theses and PhD dissertations, which differs from Nesbitt & Plum (1988) that elaboration has more paratactic percentage in their sociolinguistic interviews, and Stuart Smith (2001) that the percentage of hypotactic elaboration is as equal as that of paratactic elaboration. The biggest reason of this difference resides in genre diversity of corpora that in academic writing corpus, students employ more –WH relative clauses in demonstrating relationships between clauses instead of irregular phrases (to them) which marker paratactic elaboration, to make the language of written texts more condense and also save energy in writing. This coincides with Zipf's Force of Unification of the principle of least effort that 'speakers will tend to reduce the size of the vocabulary to a single word by unifying all meanings behind a single word' (1949: 21) and Martinet's principle of language economy 'that the amount of energy spent toward linguistic ends will tend to be proportionate to the amount of information to be conveyed' (1961: 139 - 143).

Independent Samples Test								
		Levene's Test for Equality of Variances		t-test for Equality of Means				
		F	Sig.	t	df	Sig. (2-tailed)	Mean Difference	Std. Error Difference
Paraenhancement	Equal variances assumed	7.668	.009	1.644	33	.110	5.83885	3.55239
	Equal variances not assumed			2.516	28.392	.018	5.83885	2.32050
Paraelaboration	Equal variances assumed	.012	.913	1.449	33	.157	3.04121	2.09847
	Equal variances not assumed			1.536	18.901	.141	3.04121	1.98010
Paraextension	Equal variances assumed	.585	.450	1.474	33	.150	19.07845	12.94054
	Equal variances not assumed			1.597	19.893	.126	19.07845	11.94727

Figure 16 The independent samples test results of paratactic enhancement, paratactic elaboration and paratactic extension in chosen corpus

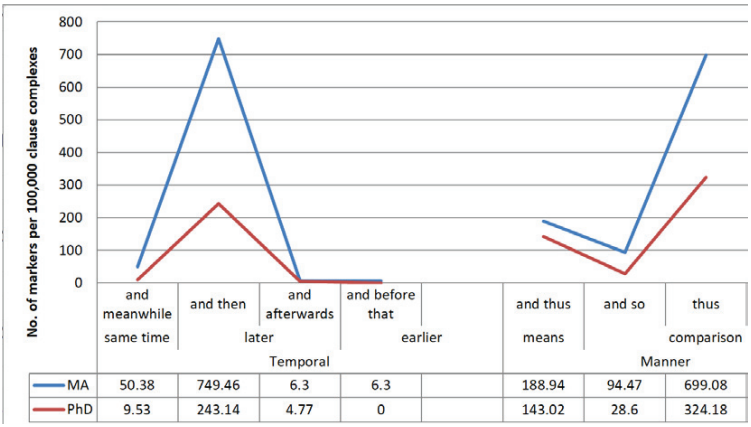
	group	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error Mean
Paraenhancement	1	25	14.8879	11.04794	2.20959
	2	10	9.0491	2.24152	.70883

Figure 17 The basic conditions of paratactic enhancement in MA (1) and PhD (2) chosen texts

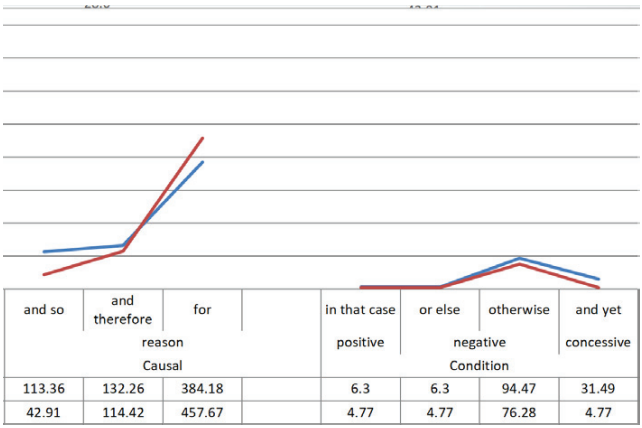
As the number of parataxis per thousand words found in MA theses is higher than that in PhD dissertations, then which category, i.e., paratactic enhancement, paratactic elaboration or paratactic extension causes this difference is of great significance. After conducting independent samples *t*-tests by comparing the number of each category per thousand words between MA theses and PhD dissertations, we can see from Figure 16 that the *p*-value of paratactic enhancement is 0.018 as the significance of equality of variances is 0.009 (not assumed), which is far less than 0.05, and from Figure 17, the mean of group 1 (MA) is 14.89, which is larger than that of group 2 (PhD) with 9.05, so the great difference of paratactic enhancement variation that MA theses employ more than that of PhD dissertations is one reason that leads to the variety of parataxis between these two groups. The principal markers of paratactic enhancement as listed in Halliday (2014: 477) are: 'and meanwhile', 'and then', 'before that' (temporal); 'and there' (spatial); 'and thus', 'and so' (manner); 'and therefore', 'for' (causal); 'or otherwise', 'and yet', 'but nevertheless' (conditional), but which kind(s) and which words or paraphrases are overused in MA theses thus need further researches.

5. Lexical Comparison

Once grammatical category like paratactic enhancement - temporal has been chosen within a clause complex, another choice that the writer faces is more lexical which looks different but actually on the same facet with grammatical level, i.e.,



	and meanwhile	and then	and afterwards	and before that		and thus	and so	thus
	same time	later		earlier		means	comparison	
	Temporal					Manner		
MA	50.38	749.46	6.3	6.3		188.94	94.47	699.08
PhD	9.53	243.14	4.77	0		143.02	28.6	324.18



and so	and therefore	for		in that case	or else	otherwise	and yet
reason				positive	negative		concessive
Causal				Condition			
113.36	132.26	384.18		6.3	6.3	94.47	31.49
42.91	114.42	457.67		4.77	4.77	76.28	4.77

Figure 18 The number of principal paratactic enhancement markers per 100,000 clause complexes in chosen corpus

they are just at the two poles of a single cline of 'lexicogrammar' (Halliday, 2014: 64). As 'it is the function of lexicogrammatical stratum to map the structures one on to another so as to form a single integrated structure that represents all components simultaneously' (Halliday, 2009: 311), after discussing differences and similarities of grammatical potential of academic writing texts, this chapter is designed to answer the third question about diversities in lexical choices. Following up the end of Chapter 5, the number of principal paratactic enhancement markers per 100,000 clause complexes in chosen corpus is listed in Figure 18.

First, it is shown that Manner > Causal > Temporal > Conditional > Spatial on counting the total number of both MA and PhD's words in each category of paratactic enhancement. (No Spatial is found in both groups.) Second, 'and then', 'thus', 'for' and 'otherwise' take up the highest proportion in each category in which the former three are in conspicuous position. Third, MA theses and PhD dissertations differ from each other in Temporal, Manner and Causal. Fourth, MA students use much more 'and then' and 'thus' while slightly less 'for' than PhD candidates. Before explaining the triple or double quantity variance, a point is necessary to be clarified here that 'and' in these words or phrases is not a must for calculation, i.e., 'and then' also include 'then' here. So back to the fourth phenomenon, one reasonable explanation is that PhD students choose other ways to convey temporal sequence and comparison, either explicit words or phrases like 'go on', 'follow up', 'subsequently', 'ensuing', etc. or implicit, semantical markers. For example:

(17) ||| [1α:] I begin || [1xβ:] by looking briefly at the concept of academic discourse and academic discourse community, || [x2:] **and go on*** to sketch out different terminologies related to stance and evaluation, the cover term I have selected about how writers convey their attitudes and credibility, and engagement, or the ways [they bring their readers into the discourse]. ||| [CPhD13_0010_670]

The PhD candidate chooses 'go on' instead of 'and then' to express chronological behaviours.

Another reason can be that by conveying the same meaning like different time (later), students can also choose hypotactic enhancement with markers like 'after' and 'since', Master students just prefer to employing the easiest and simplest 'and then'. In addition, word like 'thus' can be put in the middle or at the beginning of a clause complex to convey manner (comparison) relation as a conjunction, (see Figure 19) PhD students might more likely to divide a semantic groups into two clause complexes and put 'thus' at the beginning of a clause, thus regard it as a cohesive marker.

Based on the statistical outcome that Chinese MA students have a higher tendency to apply paratactic enhancement in their theses for conveying the same meanings than PhD candidates, a hypothesis that the latter have developments compared to the former need more confirmation from hypotactic enhancement comparison. But this is not going to be presented in the article.

6. Four kinds of Additions

During the process of corpus annotation, it is found that both Master students and PhD candidates from English major in China are not so clear about logico-semantic relations and would sometimes write ambiguous or wrong clause complexes. To take addition from extension for example, at least four kinds of positive addition relations: unrelated addition, unequal addition, implicit addition and wrongly addition (temporarily) can be found trough annotating the chosen corpus. When two

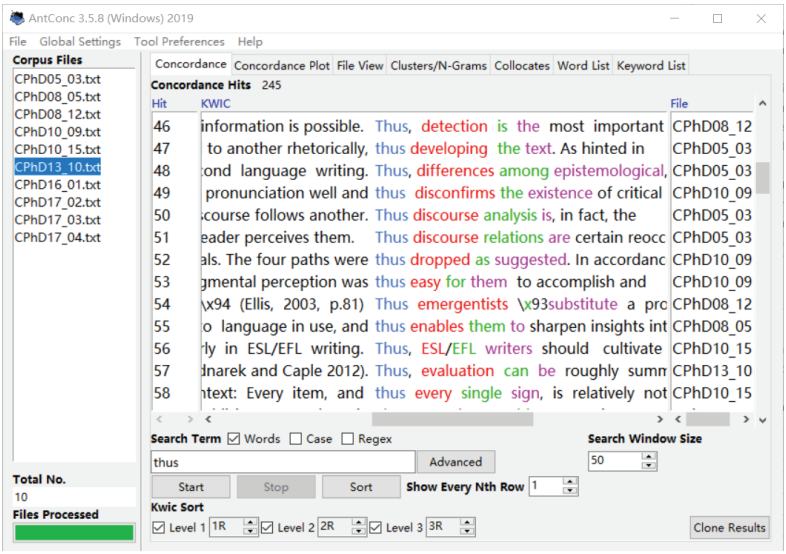


Figure 19 The work interface of AntConc for searching for keyword in corpus (example 'thus')

clauses are adjoined together without any causal or temporal relationship, and they are even not so related or they are totally taking about different things or have different themes, then the addition is unrelated. For example:

(18) ||| [1:] Foreign language study is a continuous process, || [+21:] **and*** learners should improve the four abilities step by step || [+2+2:] **and*** make use of them every day.||| [CMAC08CU_33_377]

[1] clause and [+21] clause are connected with 'and', their relationship is indeed positive additive. But the theme of the former clause is 'foreign language study' while that of the latter is 'learners'. If the writer adjoins them by 'and' in a clause complex, then the two clauses are unrelated positive addition, which can be re-write into two independent clauses: [1:] Foreign language study is a continuous process.; and [2:] Learners should improve…. By deeply thinking, [1:] and [2:] clauses after transcription represent the writer's causal-result relationship that [1:] is the reason of doings of [2:]. Thus, we can also regard the original clause complex as a wrongly addition because the logico-semantic relation is actually hypotactic causal (reason) that 'as' can be a substitute and put at the beginning of the clause complex.

Thus, wrongly addition means that the logico-semantic relation between two clauses should not be simply addition, but the writer uses conjunctions especially like 'and', 'or'. For example:

(19) ||| [1:] One group majors in primary English education in the three years, || [+2:] **and*** the other groups do not. ||| [CMAC08CU_33_499]

Apparently, a comparative relation can be found in the two clauses, but the writer chooses 'and' to represent adversative addition instead of 'but', 'yet' or 'while', which mark conversional relationship usually. Another unrelated addition example can be:

(20) ||| [1:] Many students choose comprehensive English || [+2:] **and*** the reason is the same as the above.||| [CMAC08CU_33_429]

Though we know that the theme of the second clause, i.e., 'the reason' refers to that of the 'students' choosing comprehensive English', the two clauses are actually taking about different things. A full stop is better to be put between the two clauses or the clause complex can be transcribed into: 'The reason that many students choose comprehensive English is the same as the above', in which the former is embedded into the latter clause, or be clearly, into the word 'reason'.

If unrelated and wrongly additive clause complexes are not so suitable to be categorized into 'addition', unequal relation and implicit addition are indeed addition that the location or the scope of these four kinds can be compared to earth layers that the inner core is addition, the outer core is implicit addition, then unequal addition belongs to the mantle; unrelated addition is marginal because it can either be regarded as an addition or as other relations; wrongly addition should absolutely not be included and thus needs modification. (See Figure 20 below).

In an additional clause complex, sometimes one clause can be absolutely embedded into another clause semantically, that is, there is an unequal status between clauses. For example:

(21) ||| [1:] We can always see the picture of human body in the book of anatomy, || [+2:] **and*** the motor image given by "ribs" is "something resembling a rib in shape or function". ||| [CMAC06MO_18_449]

As the second clause is describing 'the motor image given by 'ribs'', which belongs to 'the picture of human body', the clause complex can also be written as: 'We can see..., in which the motor image given by …', or two dependent clauses. However, the clause complex with 'in which' indicates hypotactic elaboration (description). So when analysing the logico-semantic relations, a principle comes out here that the writer's original logics should be adhered to as much as possible firstly.

(22) ||| [xβ:] As I see it, || [α1:] the supplementary note should give the denotation of paku essays: eight-legged essay; || [α+2:] each composition is composed of eight parts: setting the theme, exposition, explanation, proceeding to set hand, the starting leg, the middle leg, the rear leg and the ending leg. ||| [CMAC07CU_35_531]

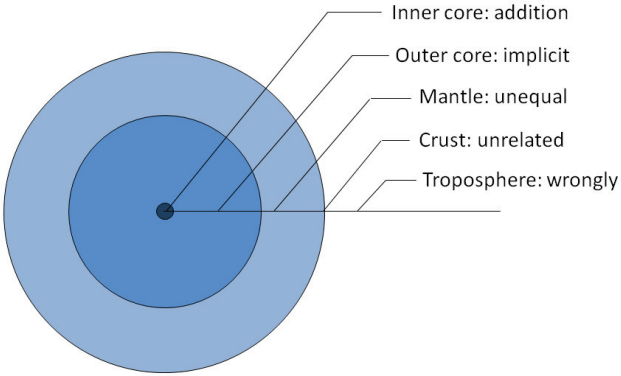


Figure 20 The sphere of addition and the location of four kinds of addition in academic writing

[α1] leads to a clause and [α+2] leads to another with a semicolon in between. They are joined together in a clause complex and then are regarded as a hypotactic enhancement (manner, comparison) to 'as I see it'. But the former is discussing on 'the supplementary note' while the latter is talking about or explaining the composition of paku essays. By only judging from their diverse themes, the clause complex can easily be divided into unrelated addition, thus another principle arises from here that the sequence of deciding the additional relation starts from the inner core to outside until to the troposphere. So, unequal addition is better for describing the clause complex that the latter is imbedded in the former one semantically.

The fourth addition, located at 'the outer core of earth layers', is not as explicit as other relations with obvious conjunctions or markers, but is important as it locates at the closest hierarchy to the core addition. For example:

(23) ||| For example, in most cases, [1:] a greeting usually receives another greeting, || [+2:] a question is met by an answer. ||| [CPhD17_0002_1195]

(24) ||| [1α:] Sartorius uses 'Dr Trench' || [1xβ:] when he asks about the quarrel, || [+2:] explains his business as well as Trench's relation with his business. ||| [CPhD17_0002_1354]

(25) ||| In the traditional micro-teaching classroom, [xβ:] teaching skills training are mainly based on the explanation and evaluation of teacher, || [αα:] students train their teaching skills with the guidance of teacher's instruction and demand, || [αxβ1:] the atmosphere is always nervous and oppressive, || [αxβ+2:] students' training is lack of creativity and actively. ||| [CMAC12ME_5_551]

Example (23) lists two examples, thus the former clause and the latter one are adjoined with equal status. In example (24), the two clauses have the same theme,

i.e., 'Sartorius' and the whole clause complex explains his behaviours in parataxis. The last two clauses in example (25) both present disadvantages of traditional teaching modes in micro-teaching classroom, and they do not have any subordinate semantic relation. In a result, all of them are implicit additions.

7. Conclusion

To make a conclusion, through investigating firstly similarities and differences between M.A. theses and Ph.D. dissertations written by English major students from Chinese Universities; secondly possibilities of writing developments from Master's level to Ph.D.'s level; and thirdly errors emerged from both levels and related reasons, diversities in paratactic enhancements are further compared; scarcely ever developments can be deduced from tests of statistics due to limitations of sample size and discontinuity of authors (the corpus doesn't consist of any MA thesis and PhD dissertation from the same person); and four kinds of additions for academic writing, i.e., unrelated addition, unequal addition, wrongly addition, and implicit addition are temporarily put forward. Developmental, probabilities of grammatical patterns in the corpus demonstrate the tendency of improvement by level; diatypic, the variation of probabilities from other corpora makes academic writing texts a register that some probabilities can be explained in this unique environment; systemically, the probabilistic of each item is construed meaningful with its counterpart within a system and all probabilities construct a dynamic grammatical system; historically, the choice of meaning can change through time and then explain for the current situation of systemic grammatical choices, which inspires us to conduct diachronic researches in academic writing register; and metatheoretically, each instantiation is a realization and in return a potential construction of the grammatical system.

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A Corpus-assisted Discourse Study of Pronouns in Social Transformation Campaigns in Nigeria

Mohammed Ademilokun

Obafemi Awolowo University & Chemnitz University of Technology

Abstract

This article examines the usage of pronouns in select mediatised discourse of social transformation in Nigeria with a view to showing how pronominal resources are strategically used for impactful delivery of the message of social change in the nation. Data for the study comprises texts on aspects of social transformation campaign in Nigeria in the context of democracy, insecurity, gender inequality, and restoration of values compiled as a small corpus. The data are texts produced by government and non-governmental actors consisting of speeches, radio commentaries, jingles, printed texts, interviews, tweets and online newspaper comments and covered the period from March 2013 to March 2018. The five-year span was informed by the wide gamut of negative realities in the nation during the time frame which led to increased mediatisation of social transformation messages. The analysis of the data is grounded in corpus-assisted discourse approach while the corpus linguistic tool of *Antconc* and the statistical calculation software of *R* are employed for the analysis of the data gathered. Data analysis reveals that pronominal resources are used in the discourse for sharing the responsibility of social transformation in Nigeria, bearing civic resistance against political leadership of the nation and asserting governmental authority for the legitimation of certain views regarding the social transformation ideal of Nigeria. The study concludes that participants in the social transformation campaigns of Nigeria are mindful of the role of pronouns, and deploy them, in strengthening the advocacy for social change in the country.

Keywords: advocacy, civic engagement, corpus linguistic analysis, Nigeria, pronouns, social transformation

1. Introduction

The inextricable relationship between language and society makes language a major agent for social construction owing to its ability to influence human ideas and thoughts. This study projects the role of language in shaping the society grounded in the Sapir-Whorfian idea of linguistic determinism which says that our thinking is determined by our language (van Troyer 1994: 164). Of particular interest in this paper is the role of language in fostering social change in human societies. Social change is an important feature of human societies, which has profound impact on the totality of a particular society and its people. Greenwood and Guner (2008: 1) simply define social change as "a shift in the fraction of society ascribing to a particular attitude or mode of behavior". Social change could thus be either positive or negative. While the literature shows that there are many predisposing factors of social change, this study pays attention to the role of language as an agent

provocateur of social change in the Nigerian society. Since language is an aspect of culture and, at the same time, an index of culture, we argue, very strongly, that it can provoke social change.

Specifically, this paper investigates the agency of pronouns in reinforcing the message of social transformation, which is rife in Nigerian public discourse, in order to highlight its persuasive properties and other discursive features. This focus on the use of pronouns in the study is predicated on the awareness of the tremendous roles that pronouns serve in discourses. Pronouns have generally been found in discourse analysis to be useful tools for participants in discourses to convey strategic meanings, exert power and influence, and show solidarity to the listeners or interlocutors. A wide range of studies, for instance, exist on the use of pronouns by politicians for the purpose of manipulating the electorate and the citizenry (see Adetunji 2006; Bramley 2001; Tyrkko 2016). The discourse of civic engagement and social transformation advocacy in Nigeria is also characterised by strategic use of pronouns by the participants, due to the politically sensitive nature of the discourse, as it is largely a democratic discourse. However, the character of the usage of pronouns in the discourse has been largely neglected in linguistic research. Therefore, in this study, attention has been paid to the discursive roles and character of pronouns in small corpora of the discourse of social transformation in Nigeria. Specifically, the present study seeks to identify the significant pronouns in the discourse of social transformation in Nigeria, the associations between the pronouns and their producers and, finally, their uses in the discourse.

2. Literature Review

Social transformation campaigns are no doubt popular in Nigeria across military and civilian political systems. Omilusi (2017: 75) captures this fact when he says that "rebranding Nigeria every time a new government comes to power is becoming a permanent feature of the country´s political life". The pervasive character of such campaign is a fallout of the penetrating nature of moral decay and loss of values in the nation. Such campaigns have largely emanated from the government over the years even though in recent years there is increased citizen participation in such campaigns. Some of such campaigns initiated by the government in the country are Reconstruction, Rehabilitation and Reconciliation by General Yakubu Gowon (1971), Ethical Revolution by Shehu Shagari (1979-1983), War Against Indiscipline by General Buhari (1984), Mass Mobilisation for Social and Economic Recovery by General Ibrahim Babangida (1985), National Re-Orientation by General Sani Abacha and, most recently, *Change Begins with Me* by President Muhammadu Buhari. All of these initiatives were informed by the various national and social problems in the nation at the respective times that they were introduced.

The subject of social transformation in Nigeria has been examined from different perspectives. Scholars (e.g., Agang 2014; Ajiwe, Okwuosa & Chukwu-Okoronkwo 2015; Burgess 2012) have generally studied the discourse from sociological and religious perspectives. From the sociological perspective, scholars have studied the usefulness of citizen participation for the purpose of stemming anomalies in the Nigerian society (Eniayejuni & Evcan 2015), the agency of social

media for youth civic engagement (Mustapha, Gbonegun & Mustapha 2016; Uzuegbulam 2015), and the role of citizen participation in improvement of healthcare delivery (Ogbuabor & Onwujekwe 2018). Similarly, there have also been studies on the role of online journalism in fostering citizen participation and social change in Nigeria (Kperogi 2016) and the agency of home videos in promoting social transformation in Nigeria (Ajiwe, Okwuosa & Okoronkwo 2015). Most of the studies generally attest to the effectiveness of citizen participation through new media for influencing the decisions of the political class and leaders, including people of diverse backgrounds in the society, in the affairs of the society and engendering a more vigorous and balanced reporting of, and engagement with, realities in the Nigerian society. From the religious angle, in reflection of the centrality of religion to the life of most Nigerians, there is appeal to religious concepts such as prayer and counselling for combating the social problems in Nigeria. For instance, the role of prayer and the church in social transformation for national development has received scholarly attention (see Akanbi & Beyers 2017; Saale 2014). Also, scholars have explored the building of strong character through religious values (Raphael 2014) and the role of Charismatic Christian preaching in engendering social transformation, especially in Nigeria (Burgess 2012).

Linguistic studies on civic engagement and social transformation advocacy in Nigeria have focused on the place of language generally in social transformation and nation building (Adedimeji 2005; Fakuade 2015), political participation and new media (Ifukor 2010; Opeibi 2015), online political cartoons (Oamen & Fajuyigbe 2016; Oludele 2016 etc.), sentence patterns in Nairaland civic engagement (Idehen & Taiwo 2016), conflict resolution advocacy (Oyebamiji 2013) and discursive strategies in social transformation advocacy in Nigeria (Ademilokun 2018). These studies have generally emphasised the relevance of language in fostering social transformation in human societies and examined the discourse features, sentence typologies and multimodal elements of aspects of civic engagement in Nigeria in political, online, and public contexts.

However, there is dearth of research on the use of pronouns as a rhetorical tool in the discourse of social transformation in Nigeria, even though pronouns are significantly used in the discourse. This paper therefore fills this lacuna by examining the discursive significance of pronouns in select social transformation discourse in Nigeria. The corpus-based discourse dimension in fact seeks to provide more scientific and rigorous explanation of the use of pronouns by participants in the discourse and the associations between the pronouns used and their sources.

3. Methodology

Data for the study comprise advocacy on social transformation in Nigeria from state actors and non-state actors. For the purpose of this study, state actors are considered as government functionaries from the President down to government parastatals (National Orientation Agency, Ministry of Information, Nigeria Police, Independent National Electoral Commission and National Drug Law Enforcement Agency). The non-state actors are the citizens and non-governmental organisations

who seek to influence the actions of the government through their civic engagement. The target population are speeches, interviews, radio programmes, television advertisements, jingles, online discourses, banners, flyers, and posters conveying messages of social transformation that border on democratic impropriety, restoration of values, gender inequality and insurgency/security. The focus on the four issues is borne out of their topicality in Nigeria.

Small specialised corpora are, however, used for the study due to peculiar challenges of obtaining large data from relevant Nigerian government agencies and media houses which largely have poor record-keeping culture. To build the specialised corpora for state and non-state actors, the stratified sampling method was favoured because "stratified samples are almost always more representative than non-stratified samples" (Biber 1993:245). Therefore, we tried to represent the groups of the population by purposively obtaining data from speeches, jingles, radio commentaries, printed materials, online texts, and interviews. Data collected span the different sub-genres of media and were produced between March 2013 and March 2018. The five-year span was premised on the fact that Nigeria witnessed numerous challenges in the areas of insurgency, Fulani killings, financial misappropriation and democratic impropriety which led to the intensification of the campaign for social transformation in the nation within the time frame. Below are the small specialised corpora for the study:

Text Type	**Number**	**Text Tokens**
Speeches	5	1,082
Interviews	5	7,552
Jingles	5	455
Newspaper Comments	45	1,629
Tweets and Facebook Posts	45	2,047
Total	**105**	**12,765**

Table 15 State actor corpus (SA)

Text Type	**Number**	**Text Tokens**
Speech	8	6,079
Radio Commentaries	8	2,855
Jingles	15	1,829
Printed Materials	8	2,132
Total	**39**	**12,895**

Table 16 Non-state actor corpus (NSA)

The corpus creation was influenced by the nature of communication peculiar to state actors and non-state actors. For instance, while non-state actors often use tweets and Facebook posts, state actors often use jingles and speeches. Also, the difference in the number of text samples from tweets and jingles as opposed to others is motivated by the fact that the contributions in the various text sources

vary in word counts. For example, while tweets are usually limited in word count, speeches and interviews often have high word counts.

More importantly, it should be stated that data for the qualitative aspects of the analysis were purposively obtained from the corpus to serve the purpose of analysis at every analytical level. Here attention was paid to the relevance of the fragments of the discourse to the analytical level concerned and their richness for the explication of the nuances of meaning to be examined in the usage of such pronouns. On the other hand, where corpus tools are employed in the study, the analysis is based on the entire corpus, i.e., all texts on restoration of values, insecurity, gender inequality and democratic improprieties constitute data for the study.

In order to account for gender differences in the contributions of the discourse participants, we try to segment the data based on gender, where possible. For instance, while the discourse of state actors is characterised by data from governmental bodies that are not gendered and also shows a domination of male voice owing to the gender imbalance in the occupation of political positions in Nigeria, we were able to map contributions of female non-state actors to Nigeria's discourse of social change through sentiment analysis, by paying attention to the topics of the discussions and verifying the twitter handles that appear to be those of females. There are also instances in which it is evident that parts of the discourse are produced by females as in speeches and interviews. Therefore, our categorisation of the non-state actor corpus goes as follows:

Text Type	**Number**	**Word Tokens**
Tweets and Facebook Posts	39	1,734
Interview	4	4,513
Newspaper comments	45	1,629
Total	**88**	**7,876**

Table 17 Male non-state actor sub-corpus (MNSA)

Text Type	**Number**	**Word Tokens**
Speeches	5	1,082
Interview	1	3,039
Tweets	6	313
Total	**12**	**4,434**

Table 18 Female non-state actor sub-corpus (FNSA)

Since the corpora (SA and NSA) and the sub-corpora (MNSA & FNSA) do not have exactly the same amount of text tokens, in order to obtain accurate information on the level of usage of the pronominals by the discourse participants, we calculated the normalised relative frequencies of the pronouns in the corpora. This afforded us the opportunity to compare the usages of the pronouns by the discourse participants and the implications of their differences. The calculation was done per 10,000 words. Also, to examine the relationship between the pronouns in the dis-

course and the text participants, we carried out the chi-square test using the statistical tool of R in order to establish the associations between the pronouns and their sources.

4. Analytical Framework

The analytical framework for this study is corpus-assisted discourse approach. According to Jaworski (2016: 7), corpus assisted discourse studies (CADS) was first introduced by Partington (2004) "in order to account for the growing body of research interested in discourse and adopting the techniques of corpus linguistics". Jaworski (2016: 7) further states that the CADS approach "utilizes tools offered by corpus linguistics but it extends the methodological paradigm by integrating techniques commonly associated with qualitative discourse analysis in order to understand the discourse in question and its context as much as possible".

The deployment of corpus linguistics for the complementation of discourse studies is due to the fact that it allows for objective interpretation of data devoid of biases of the analyst. This approach to the analysis of discourses pays attention to the employment of quantitative methods to validate the meanings inherent in the linguistic resources employed by discourse producers. However, the relationship between discourse analysis and the quantitative methods afforded by corpus linguistics can be said to be symbiotic in the sense that as there is the quantification of linguistic features, there is also qualitative interpretation of the quantified linguistic and discursive features. Biber, Conrad and Reppen (1998: 4) strengthen this argument by stating that "Association patterns represent quantitative relations, measuring the extent to which features and variants are associated with contextual factors. However functional qualitative interpretation is also an essential step in any corpus-based analysis".

The major analytical tools in corpus assisted discourse analysis are frequency, keywords, collocation and concordance (Jaworski 2016: 7). Although the present study reflects most of the foci of corpus assisted discourse study, it focuses more on frequency, concordance and keyword in context using *Antconc*. *Antconc* is used to generate concordance hits for the respective pronouns, foreground the key words in context and the collocates of the pronouns. *Rstudio* is also employed in the study to carry out chi-square test on the data in order to show the frequencies of the pronouns in the corpora, the significance of the usage of prominent pronominal resources in the discourse and the association between such pronominal resources and their producers.

5. Findings and Discussion

The analysis of the pronominal resources in the discourse of social transformation advocacy in Nigeria is presented in this section. It considers in turn the quantitative and qualitative features of the discourse and demonstrates aspects of their interaction.

5.1. Statistical Analysis of the Usage of Pronouns in the Discourse

The chi-square test is carried out and reported here in order to show the associations of the pronouns in the discourse and their producers. In what follows shortly, we therefore present the results of the chi-square test as given in the cross table and association plot.

	I	**Me**	**My**	**Our**	**Us**	**We**	**You**	**Your**	**Row Total**
FNSA									
N	59	9	9	9	10	63	50	18	**227**
χ^2 contribution	10.263	1.710	0.540	12.617	0.412	1.345	0.633	0.270	
N/row total	0.240	0.040	0.040	0.040	0.044	0.278	0.220	0.079	**0.188**
N/column total	0.285	0.290	0.148	0.061	0.154	0.218	0.168	0.167	
N/table total	0.049	0.007	0.007	0.007	0.008	0.052	0.041	0.015	
MNSA									
N	65	7	20	44	14	89	101	24	**364**
χ^2 contribution	0.098	0.597	0.134	0.004	1.617	0.003	1.419	2.280	
N/row total	0.179	0.019	0.055	0.121	0.038	0.245	0.277	0.066	**0.302**
N/column total	0.314	0.226	0.328	0.299	0.215	0.308	0.340	0.222	
N/table total	0.054	0.006	0.017	0.037	0.012	0.074	0.084	0.020	
SA									
N	83	15	32	94	41	137	146	66	**614**
χ^2 contribution	4.789	0.040	0.027	4.869	1.875	0.715	0.188	2.187	
N/row total	0.135	0.024	0.052	0.153	0.067	0.223	0.238	0.107	**0.510**
N/column total	0.401	0.484	0.525	0.639	0.631	0.474	0.492	0.611	
N/table total	0.069	0.012	0.027	0.078	0.034	0.114	0.121	0.055	
Column Total	**207**	**31**	**61**	**147**	**65**	**289**	**297**	**108**	**1205**

Table 19 Chi-square contributions within FNSA, MNSA, and SA corpora.

As can be seen in Table 19, the use of pronouns in the discourse attracts a *p*-value much smaller than 0.001 in chi-square test ($\chi^2 = 48.661$, $df = 14$). Thus, this implies that the use of pronouns in the discourse is statistically significant, showing that indeed there is correlation between the text sources and the pronominal resources (see Gries 2013: 189). However, the Cramer's V is low (0.142), showing that even though there is association between the text sources in the discourse and the pronominal choices made, the effect is not particularly strong (Gries 2013: 189). The implication of this is that there may be other factors that contributed to the pronominal choices made in the discourse.

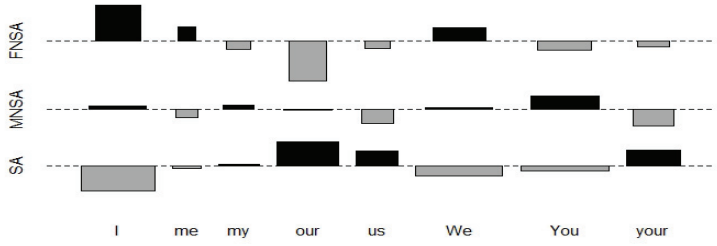


Figure 21 Association plot for pronouns.

The association plot, however, reveals that the greatest contribution to the chi-square value of the pronouns, as reflected in the table and the plot, is made by the pronouns *I* and *our* as the two features most significantly in the contributions of female non-state actors and state actors respectively. Following these two, however, are the second person pronouns *you* and *your* in the male non-state and state actor contributions, respectively, and the inclusive pronouns *we* and *us* in female non-state actors´ and state actors´ contributions respectively. This is because, as Gries (2013: 188) observes, "the black rectangles above the dashed lines indicate observed frequencies exceeding expected frequencies; grey rectangles below the dashed lines indicate observed frequencies smaller than expected frequencies; the heights of the boxes are proportional to the above Pearson residuals and the widths are proportional to the square roots of the expected frequencies".

The use of *I* by females in the discourse thus surpasses expectation, while the favoured use of *our* and *us* by the state actors only confirms the strategy of inclusion used to achieve popularity by state actors. In fact, the columns for *I* and *our,* in particular in the table, evidence the fact that the two pronouns make the greatest contribution to the chi-square value of the entire table, as the former produces a chi-square value of 15.15, while the latter produces a chi-square value of 17.49. Therefore, of the total chi-square value of the entire table, both pronouns contribute a great chi-square value of 32.64, showing the centrality of the two pronouns to meaning production in the discourse.

5.2. Pronouns as a Tool for Sharing the Responsibility of Social Transformation in Nigeria

A major feature of pronominal use in the discourse is its deployment for inclusion by the discourse participants. The participants strategically involve all Nigerians in the ideas they express being mindful of the fact that the question of social transformation in Nigeria is one that necessitates the active involvement of all Nigerians. Therefore, one finds the use of the pronoun *we* to generally include Nigerians

and sometimes members of the government or a particular team being referenced in connection with the subject of social change in Nigeria. Below are examples of the inclusive *we* in the corpus:

(1) We must rise up now. NSA Tweet (Twitter Nigeria, January 24, 2018)
(2) What are we fighting for? The soul of Nigeria. What are we fighting for? The soul of Nigeria NSA Tweet (Twitter Nigeria, January 23, 2018)
(3) So we need to work towards preventing as much as possible and also bringing to book the perpetrators to send a strong message that violence against women does not pay. NSA Interview, Channels Television (December 13, 2014)
(4) We understand that the government is trying to enforce a law which they have already passed into law. NSA Speech, Web Nigeria TV (September 6, 2013)

The texts above are instances of the deployment of the inclusive *we* by the non-state participants in the discourse for the purpose of creating solidarity between themselves and Nigerians generally in pursuing transformation in different facets of the Nigerian life. For the non-state actors, such action expressed through the pronoun is important in view of the fact that they need sufficient moral and physical support in order to succeed in their bid to mount pressure on the government of Nigeria, with a superior power to do what is right.

The first two examples of inclusive pronouns above (1) & (2), for instance, clearly depict the invocation of the pronoun to evoke collective sensibility towards actions deemed beneficial to the totality of Nigerians. The verbal expressions in the two examples *rise* and *fighting* indicate actions that the people deem necessary for their emancipation and, to achieve the two acts, there is need for a lot of people to be involved, which explains the significance of the inclusive first-person pronoun.

The third example is also aimed at involving all Nigerians in the campaign against gender abuse which is presented in the example, since such popular condemnation of it suggested by the pronoun would enhance the success of the campaign. The last example also is an appeal to the collective to give substance to the understanding that the text producer claims of the plan of the government to enforce a particular law. The text producer could have used the pronoun *I* but opts for the collective pronoun *we* to enhance the credibility of his proposition. The use of the inclusive *we* in the texts above can be said to align with Bello's (2013) observation that such pronoun is used to create a sense of shared destiny among a people. However, while Bello (2013) focuses on the use of the pronouns in political discourse for gaining political relevance, in the present discourse, the examples of the use of pronouns to create a sense of shared history are meant to engender the spirit of collective resistance against forces such as the government and men who abuse their wives. The discourse of state actors on Nigeria's social transformation also features this linguistic feature:

(5) We must resist the temptation to fall back on the same partisanship, pettiness and immaturity that have poisoned the country for so long. *Change Begins with Me* SA Speech (September 8, 2016)
(6) We would have saved the nation's judiciary from the embarrassment of the raging disparaging comments and ridicule. SA News Commentary, Radio Nigeria (ND)
(7) Let the peace that we have been praying for materialise. Let us support INEC to ensure a peaceful election. SA Jingle (June 25, 2014)
(8) This we believe can best be maintained through attitudinal change, and the change of our mindset in private and public life. *Change Begins with Me* SA Speech (September 8, 2016)

The highlighted instances of the use of the inclusive *we* are just some of the many cases of the use of the pronoun in the discourse. The first instance is similar to the use of the pronoun for stimulating civil action such as the one rampant in the corpus of the non-state actors. Here, the text producer, being the President of Nigeria, aligns the political class with all other Nigerians and indicates an action that they all had to take in order for the country to develop. The second and third examples of the use of the inclusive pronoun *we* are also designed to appeal to the conscience of the generality of Nigerians to act in certain ways for the growth of the country. Even though the involvement of the generality of Nigerians invoked in this context is not as forceful as the first, the idea is also that the collective action and conscientiousness of all Nigerians would contribute to the development of the nation. Such use of the plural pronoun *we* aligns with the position of Alavidze (2017: 355) that politicians use such pronouns when they want to "share responsibility and create involvement with the audience and to give a sense of collectivity and sharing responsibility".

The last example reflects the point earlier made that inclusive pronouns are also used in the discourse to reflect a speaker and members of his group or, more specifically, a state actor and members of his or her government. In this case, the *we* refers to the government of Nigeria who conceived the idea of *Change Begins with Me* campaign in Nigeria. However, even though the *we* in this instance is not as broad in scope as the ones earlier discussed, it still shows some measure of inclusion as it portrays the speaker as considering his position in relation to other members of his government. Even though it may be a cheap political strategy of appearing people-oriented or not power-driven, it still shows inclusivity.

As can be seen from Table 19, the inclusive pronoun *we* occurs 289 times in the state corpus, male non-state sub-corpus and female non-state corpus. This gives us a normalised relative frequency of 112.6. When one compares this figure with those of other pronouns in the corpora (*our*-147, with 57.3 normalised relative frequency; *I*-207, with 80.7 normalised relative frequency; *us*-65, with 25.3 normalised relative frequency; *you*-297, with 115.7 normalised relative frequency; *my*-61, with 23.8 normalised relative frequency; *me*-31, with a normalised relative frequency of 12; *your*-108, with a normalised relative frequency of 42), it can be said that there is indeed extensive use of the inclusive pronoun *we* to show solidarity



Figure 22 Concordances and KWIC of the search term *we*.

and make everyone feel involved in the national transformation advocacy projected in the discourse in focus. The pronoun has normalised relative frequencies of 106.2 and 119 in the corpora of state actors and non-state actors, respectively. It is remarkable that both state actors and non-state actors use the pronoun remarkably well. This shows that both the state actors and the non-state actors are conscious of the need to inject a deep sense of collectivity into the discourse for its purpose to be realised.

Based on the figures in Table 19, one can see that the pronoun *we* in the discourse of non-state actors has a normalised relative frequency of 142 in the contribution of females and 113 in the contribution of males. This shows that there is a relatively higher use of the pronoun by females. This of course is confirmed by the black rectangle in the column for women productions of the pronoun in Figure 21, which shows that the pronoun is favoured by women more than any other category of participants in the discourse. While this finding runs against expectations in the Nigerian society, it may be seen as a sign that women are being more politically active in the Nigerian socio-political context and are becoming more efficient and strategic in their contributions to social issues through the use of pronouns for inclusion, among others. Nevertheless, the results still show that both genders are aware of the significance of inclusive use of *we* for mobilising the public for the pursuit of social transformation in Nigeria.

To show the context of the inclusive *we* in the corpus, we present the concordance analysis in Figure 22. The keyword in context in the concordance for the pronoun confirms the inclusivity engendered by the use of the pronoun as there are certain words around the pronoun that reflect the collective and collective action. Examples of such words are *all*, *ourselves*, *activists*, among others, which show a group of people being involved in certain matters being referenced. Below, we

present a table indicating significant collocates of *we* obtained from the contexts of the pronoun in the corpus and their prominence:

Positive Collocates of *we*	**Neutral Collocates of *we***	**Negative Collocates of *we***
need to+positive verbs (XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXXXXXXXXXX)	Should + (verb) XXXXXXXX)	began to+N.verb (XXXXXX)
must+positive verb (XXXXXXXXXXXXX)	Are saying that (XXXX)	will live to regret
need +positive noun (XXXXXX)	Are going to (XXX)	are guilty
fighting (XXX)	Had to (XX)	Celebrate criminality
were not (XX)	Know (XX)	
believe in prevention (XX)		
were able to launch		
remain the lubricants		

Table 20 Collocates of *we.* X indicates one occurrence of a particular pronominal object.

As can be seen from Table 20, the collocate *need* attracts positive verbs such as *to build*, *to understand*, *to cooperate with*, *to work towards*, etc., to emphasise the set of actions required for meaningful change to take place in Nigeria. There are also many verbal groups with the modal *must* which co-occur with the pronoun *we* and are indicative of positive actions. Examples of such verbal expressions are *must commend, must check, must find, give practical, learn to interrogate*, etc. Such expressions show that in addressing the collective in the discourse, the text producers basically mobilise them to embrace positive actions that will lead to the regeneration of the Nigerian nation.

On the other hand, the text producers also create the feeling of soberness in the discourse through few negative collocates of the inclusive pronoun *we.* The predicates *are guilty, celebrate criminality, began to deteriorate, began to nosedive, etc.,* are all indexical of the negative conditions of Nigerians and their culpability in the festering of the negative situation.

However, there are also other pronouns used to mark inclusion and involvement in the discourse apart from *we*. For instance, the pronouns *us* and *our* are also used in the discourse to show participation of Nigerians in general, or a large group of people in certain actions or matters in the discourse. Below, we present instances of the use of such pronouns to mark inclusivity:

(9) Big international, **our** products are going. SA Jingle (April 1, 2016)

(10) In view of the current security and terrorist threats in **our** country, the Nigeria Police Force and NOA are calling on the citizens to stay vigilant. SA Printed Material (ND)

(11) We have made some progress, but not good enough to situate **us** on the pedestal we so desirously crave for. SA Speech (February 4, 2018)

(12) This Nigeria belongs to all of **us**. It must not spoil because there is nowhere for **us** to go to. SA (INEC) Jingle (June 25, 2014)

The short texts above feature the use of the possessive pronoun *our* and the plural objective pronoun *us* in the discourse. In the first two sentences, *our* is used to give every Nigerian a sense of belonging and collectivity in order to recognise the problems facing their nation as a collective one and be determined to put in their effort towards solving the problems. The sense of collectivity is actually concretely conveyed in the MH nominal groups *our public life*, *our country* and *our products*. The association plot in figure 1 shows that the pronoun is favoured by state actors as the black rectangle in the column for state actors´ usage of the pronoun shows the penchant of state actors to use the pronominal for showing solidarity and connection with the people. By using the nominal groups with the possessive pronoun modifier, Nigerians generally are invited to show interest in the various meanings being passed across by the text producers, even though one can say that such use of the pronoun is only political. This is so in the sense that every Nigerian cannot really claim to be adequately taken care of as expected of those that are believed to own a place. Such detachment from the nation in fact can be said to be largely responsible for the deepening of negative behaviour in the nation.

The last two texts also demonstrate the use of the pronoun *us* to create the impression of belongingness among Nigerians. In fact, the sense of ownership of Nigeria being ascribed to all Nigerians is fully expressed in the last example where it is stated that Nigeria belongs to all Nigerians. Indeed, that is the sense that the text producers seek to convey through the various inclusive pronouns we have shed light upon. The above uses of the pronouns *our* and *us* are similar to Hasan's (2011) finding that the pronouns are used by Hosni Mubarak in his speeches to promote unity and sense of belongingness. The similarity between Hasan's finding and this study shows the universal concern of politicians to involve the people in the meanings they make. However, the difference lies in the fact that while Hasan's work sees such tendency as altruistic, this work views such deployment of pronouns as manipulative in some ways in view of the fact that despite such public display of alignment with the public by political actors in Nigeria, the people are still immensely disconnected from the government.

Non-state actors also deploy such inclusive pronouns in their discourse on Nigeria's social transformation. Let us consider the following examples:

(13) In **our** beloved country, people are afraid to criticise elected leaders. God put **us** in this country for a reason. It is ours because God ordained **us** here to fulfill his purpose. NSA Tweet, Twitter Nigeria (January 24, 2018)

(14) I have said that until we get to the state where I don't see political appointment as an avenue to enrich myself, **our** fight against corruption will be a lip service. NSA Interview (January 3, 2017)

(15) I'm surprised that **our** prof Osinbajo has now become brain-dead to be advancing the course of Islam! See what the love of money and power has caused. Newspaper Comment, Vanguard Newspaper (January 19, 2018)

(16) We can't continue like this. I will expect **our** senators to know better. Child Not Bride, Web Nigeria TV (September 6, 2013)

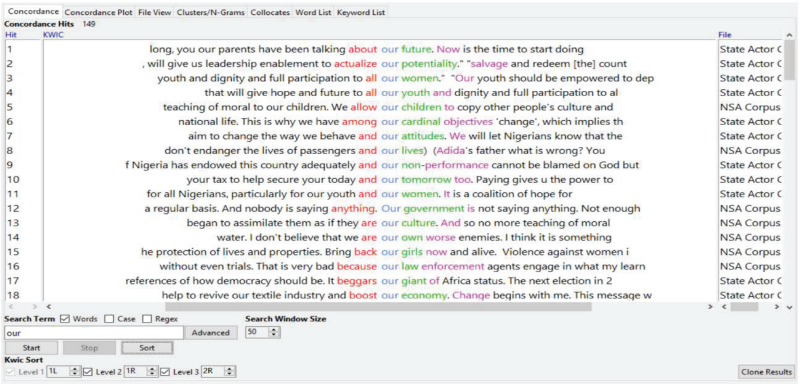


Figure 23 Concordances and KWIC for *our*.

The texts above all feature the use of either *our* or *us* by non-state actors in Nigeria to involve all Nigerians in their discourse as active partakers in the affairs of Nigeria and owners of the nation. This strategy, as earlier said, has the motivation of making the general public feel a sense of strong affiliation to the text producers and the ideas that they radiate with regard to the transformation of the Nigerian nation.

As earlier indicated, the possessive pronoun *our* has a normalised relative frequency of 57.3 in the corpora showing that the participants in the discourse intentionally use the pronoun, given the small sizes of the corpora. This further shows that the participants really recognise the need to involve all Nigerians in their propositions since the subject of their engagement affects all Nigerians. It is however significant that, while the pronoun has a relative frequency of 41.5 in the corpus of non-state actors, it has a frequency of 72.9 in that of the state actors. This thus shows that state actors tend to appeal to the audience strongly by giving them the feeling that the various social issues they touch on in the discourse affect every Nigerian, including themselves, and that they are working in the interest of the collective. Also, by using the possessive pronoun in reference to Nigerians, the text producer tries to make Nigerians feel a sense of ownership of whatever subject is accompanied with the pronoun. On the other hand, however, the low level of usage of the pronoun by non-state actors might be attributed to the fact that they are generally seen as naturally belonging to the Nigerian society by the public and, therefore, act upon the will of the people.

Interestingly, unlike the results for *we*, which show a slightly higher use of the pronoun by female non-state actors, the male participants use the pronoun *our* more than their female counterparts in the discourse. While the pronoun has a relative frequency of 20.3 in the corpus of female non-state actors, it has a frequency of 55.9 in the corpus of the males. This further shows that both genders are sensitive to the role of inclusive pronouns in making the citizens to perceive the problems of Nigeria and the solutions to them are a collective responsibility. In Figure 23, we present a concordance analysis of the pronoun *our*.

The keyword in context for the pronoun shows that some words around the pronoun indicate the collective spirit which the text producers desire to strategically employ to fully involve the citizens of Nigeria in the ideal of social transformation that they are canvassing for. For instance, participants in the discourse use words indicative of the collective such as *future, women, children,* etc., which collocate with *our* in the discourse. Below, there is a table containing the different kinds of collocates around the pronoun in the corpus:

Positive Collocates of *our*	**Neutral Collocates of *our***	**Negative Collocates of *our***
Potentiality	country (XXXXXX)	non-performance
giant of Africa´s status	value system (XXXXX)	non-existent
effort to re-engineer	people (XXXX)	present polluted leadership
Dear native land, dear nation	our youth (XXX)	lack-lustre performance
beloved country	children (XXX)	worse enemies
shared commitment	diversity (XXX)	old ways
civic responsibility	our laws (XX)	boys proper home training
economic, social progress	national history (XX)	developmental problems
Initiatives	leadership (XX)	lack-lustre performance
common good	our leaders (XX)	Indifference
nationalistic fervour	Attitudes	
Favour	Lives	
Strength	Tomorrow	
huge investments	Women	

Table 21 Collocates of *our*.

A close look at Table 21 shows that there are many significant words that collocate with the pronoun *our* even though there are more of such words that convey neutral meanings. Some of the seemingly neutral words collocating with the pronoun such as *law, children, youth, value system, leaders* and *leadership* occur more than once, indicating that they are topical aspects of social transformation campaigns in Nigeria. More significantly, however, some of the collocates of *our* have positive and negative associations. While the positive collocates are used to motivate the public and call their attention to the good things about themselves and the nation in general, the negative ones are used to highlight the negative realities about Nigerians, Nigeria and its leaders. For instance, the collocates *dear nation, Giant of Africa´s status* and *beloved country* are used to evoke the feelings of patriotism in the audience as they eulogise the nation in a manner that makes the citizens proud of their country. Also, some other positive collocates of *our* such as strength, common good, effort to re-engineer, etc., are used to engrain in the consciousness of the people the positive actions required for Nigeria to experience the real positive transformation that both the government and the citizens desire for the nation. On the other hand, some of the negative collocates such as *old ways, non-performance, present polluted leadership, developmental problems*, etc., are indexical of the

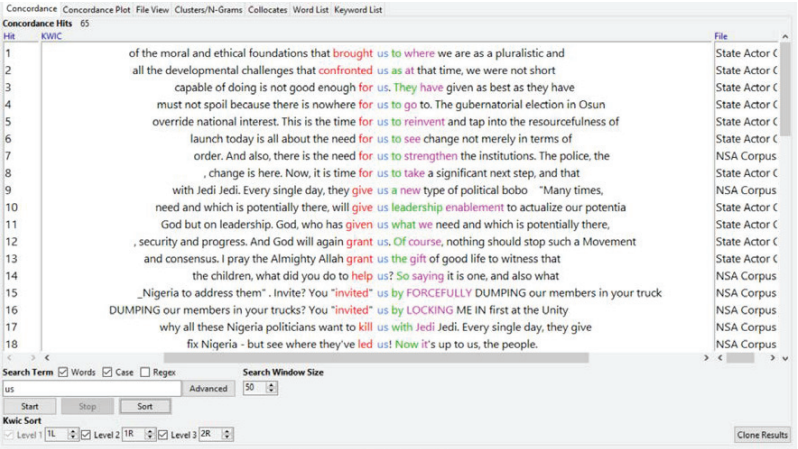


Figure 24 *Keyword hits for* us.

negative realities in Nigeria which informed the campaign for social transformation in the nation. Therefore, such collocates bring into focus some of the nation´s problems and the collective impact on all the people of Nigeria.

Another pronoun that is used to create the sense of collective and belongingness in the people is *us.* As can be seen from Table 21, the plural object pronoun *us* has the lowest number of observations in the corpora with a normalised relative frequency of 25.3. In spite of its low frequency in the corpora compared to other pronouns, it also shows how participants not only refer to themselves, but also to all Nigerians in the discourse. This reinforces the observation that the discourse participants are really mindful of the fact that for the ideas they espouse in the discourse to be well received by people, everybody in the nation must be able to relate to the texts they produce to disseminate those ideas. However, based on the figures from the table, the pronoun has a normalised relative frequency of 18.8 in the corpus of non-state actors, while it has a normalised relative frequency of 31.8 in that of state actors. This further confirms that state actors tend to use inclusive pronouns more, even though the difference in this instance is small. Such small difference, however, shows that non-state actors are also mindful of the need to use the pronoun. To validate our opinion on gender difference in the use of pronouns for inclusion by state actors, we also carry out a gender-based analysis on the differences in the usage of *us* by female and male non-state actors.

The figures in the columns for male and female non-state actors in the corpora in Table 21 show a marginal difference in the way the pronoun is used by both genders in the corpus of non-state actors, as it has a relative frequency of 22.6 in the corpus of female non-state actors, while it has 17.8 in that of male non-state actors. Therefore, it can be said that the use of the pronoun by male and female participants in the discourse is relatively even, showing that both genders are aware

of, and sensitive to the political and functional utility or maybe rhetorical gimmick of including people in actions and plans through the use of inclusive pronouns.

In Figure 24 above, we present the concordance for *us* in order to highlight the key words in the context of the pronoun in the discourse. The keyword in context for *us* shows that certain issues, positive, neutral, and negative, are also foregrounded by the collocates of the pronoun. Below, there is a table with the significant collocates of the pronoun in the corpus:

Positive Collocates of *us*	**Neutral Collocates of *us***	**Negative Collocates of *us***
let ... + positive verb, e.g., give peace (XXXXXXXXXXXX XXXXXX)	tell (XXX)	invited... + neg. Verb (XX)
for ... + positive verb (XXXX)	everyone (XXX)	
give ...leadership enablement	put (XXX)	
	all (XX)	
	leaders owe	

Table 22 Collocates of *us*.

As can be seen from Table 22, certain collocates of the pronoun *us* are indicative of positive actions that the text producers implore Nigerians to embrace in order to transform the nation. The most dominant of such positive collocates of *let…give peace a chance* speaks about the need to quell the restlessness in the Nigerian society by acting positively for the entrenchment of peace in the nation. From the collocates, it also can be seen that certain lexemes are indicative of the idea of the collective as lexemes such as *all* and *everyone* foreground the implications of the problems in Nigeria and possible resolution of such problems for the collective – all Nigerians.

5.3. Pronouns as a Tool for Resistance and Citizen Assertion

Civic engagement as part of social transformation discourse in Nigeria is characterised by resistance and citizen assertion which reflect the frustration of the citizens with the leadership of their country. In this regard, pronouns are also used by the average citizens who partake in the discourse for the purposes of resistance and reinforcement of citizen will and power. Below are instances of such usage of pronouns in the discourse:

(17) **I** am a protagonist for protecting the DIGNITY of our Institutions BUT how can Citizens trust a Law Enforcement institution that LIES BOLDLY like this? NSA Tweet, Twitter Nigeria (January 24, 2018)

(18) **Nigeria** should celebrate this great activist rather than denigrating her. **I** respect the office of the President and **I** will choose my words carefully-NOTHING MUST HAPPEN TO OBY! NSA Tweet, Twitter Nigeria (January 23, 2018)

(19) **I** believe they elected you as their governor or spokesperson. NSA Newspaper Comment, Vanguard Newspaper (January 20, 2018)

(20) So as far as **I** am concerned, anybody that is accused of corruption must face the music. NSA Interview, TVC Breakfast Show (January 3, 2017)

The texts above present instances of the use of pronouns, particularly the personal pronoun *I,* for the purpose of expressing citizen power and assertion. In example (17), the text producer uses the pronoun to present himself in the light of a particular positive ideology which is the protection of institutions in Nigeria. The pronoun usage reflects the confidence exuded by the text producer about his alignment with the positive ideology. The assertive will of the text producer manifests further in the juxtaposition of the ideal of dignity of institutions canvassed by the referent of the personal pronoun *I* as a typical progressive citizen of Nigeria with the insincerity of the law enforcement institutions in Nigeria presented as liars. Also, the verbal choice, *am,* further elucidates the assertive tone of the text.

In excerpt (18), the text producer uses the personal pronoun *I* to present his opinion on the denigration of a particular woman activist, whose name is given in the text as OBY. Since the matter is such that portrays the government of Nigeria in a bad light, the text producer shows caution without losing confidence as shown in his repeated use of the pronoun *I* in the short excerpt. Therefore, even though there is some subtlety in the portrayal of the President, and government of Nigeria in general, as bad in arresting the woman activist, there is also a significant level of self-presentation through the use of the personal pronoun *I.*

Example (19) presents a case in which the pronoun is used to present a personal perspective on the election of a particular governor. The thematic fronting of the personal pronoun *I* and the use of the verb *believe* are meant to emphasise the perspective of the speaker. Such use of pronoun sets the opinion of the speaker apart from other possible opinions. It is also a way by which the text producer tacitly *knocks* the political elite in Nigeria for not delivering.

Example (20) reflects the use of pronoun for self-assertion, as in this instance, the text producer strongly gives his opinion without giving regard to any alternative opinion on the matter. The tone of the pronoun *I* is no doubt emphatic and it even aligns with the linguistic context of the text in the adverbial phrase *as far* and the verbal group *am concerned*, which show the unapologetic stance of the text producer on the subject matter of his talk.

Table 19 shows that there are 207 (normalised relative frequency of 80.7) occurrences of the pronoun in the state actor, male non-state actor and female non-state actor corpora. Given the small sizes of the corpora, this can be considered some important use of the pronoun. However, the pronoun seems to be used more in the discourse of the non-state actors than that of the state actors, as the pronoun has a normalised relative frequency of 97.1 in the corpus of non-state actors compared to 64.4 in the corpus of state actors. This shows that non-state actors tend to be more assertive in the use of the personal pronoun *I* in the discourse than state actors. This may not be so surprising in view of the fact that, while state actors naturally exude their authority through the pronoun, they are also pragmatically mindful of the need to show solidarity with Nigerians more in the discourse in order to cajole them to see the change being sought as theirs and for their good.

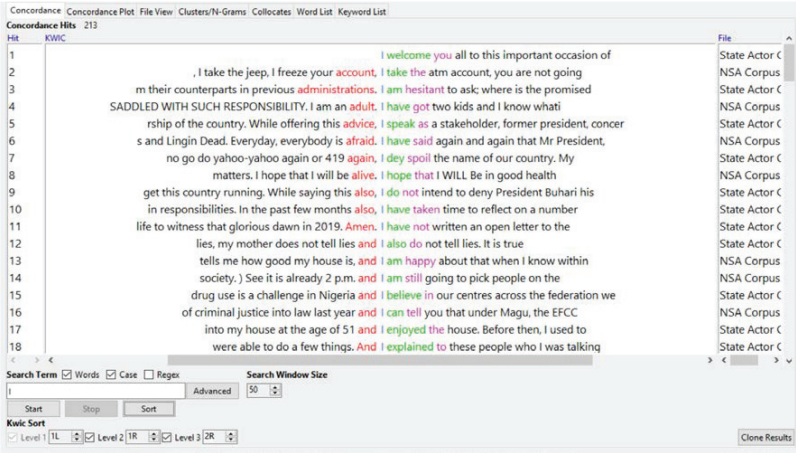


Figure 25 Concordances and KWIC of the search term *I*.

On the other hand, since non-state actors are generally resistant and assertive, passing the buck of the blame on the negative situation of the country to the leaders of the country, as a way of showing the anger of the people in the nation, they tend to use the personal pronoun *I*.

We also attempt to show whether there are gender differences in the use of the pronoun *I* by female and male non-state actors given the fact that there is the general belief that men are more powerful and visible in the Nigerian socio-cultural milieu. Against popular expectations since Nigeria is a patriarchal society, figure 1 clearly shows that the pronoun *I* is favoured in the corpus of female non-state actors. While the pronoun has a relative frequency of 133 in the female corpus, it has a normalised relative frequency of 82.5 in the corpus of males. This shows that female non-state actors are more assertive than their male counterparts in their use of the personal pronoun *I* for arguing for social change in Nigeria in the discourse in focus. This tendency may be said to be a reflection of the fact that there is increasing female assertion in the Nigerian society generally.

In Figure 25 above, we present a concordance for the pronoun *I* in the discourse to show its linguistic context and their significations. The keyword in context analysis also shows that many of the words around the pronoun *I* in the discourse show confidence as revealed by the pronoun itself. One can see, for instance, many occurrences of am in the company of the pronoun from the screenshot. Below is a table containing the significant collocates of the pronoun *I* in the corpus:

Collocates of *I*
am (XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX)
think (XXXXXXXXXXX)
don´t know/know (XXXXXX)
have/have said (XXXXXX)
meant (XXXXX)
can tell (XXXX)
must (XXX
believe (XX)

Table 23 Collocates of *I*.

As can be seen from Table 23, there are verbs such as *am, know, enjoyed, have, explained, tell* and *believe* which all reflect high level of confidence on the part of the text producers on the issues they address. Such lexemes are used to give attention to the views of the individual contributors to the discourse of social transformation in Nigeria. The large occurrence of *am* in the company of the pronoun also reinforces the assertion expressed by the pronoun. The verbal expressions *think, can tell, meant* and *believe* are also illustrative of the candid and confident expression of the views of the text producers on various social and national issues in the country. Furthermore, the verbal expression *have said* also shows the assertion of the text producer which aligns with the assertive nature of the pronoun *I* itself.

Apart from the personal pronoun *I,* other pronouns used in the discourse for citizen assertion are the possessive pronoun *my* and the objective singular personal pronoun *me*. Below are examples of such usage of the pronouns in the discourse:

(21) Question: Have you heard about the saying that women are their own worst enemies? Answer: I don't buy that. For me, it doesn't hold water. NSA Interview (Channels Television, December 13, 2014)

(22) So for me, the war against corruption is not yet being fought in the manner it ought to be fought because there are some people who ought not to be in the corridors of power that they are there. NSA Interview (TVC Breakfast Show, January 3, 2017)

(23) Today it saddens my heart that this government has gotten to the point where they intimidate and threaten the lives of its citizens instead of addressing the concerns of the killings and abduction of its citizens. NSA Tweet (Twitter Nigeria, January 23, 2018)

The texts above illustrate how the variants of the personal pronoun *I,* especially the objective form *me* and the possessive form *my* are used for citizen assertion in the discourse. In the first excerpt for instance, the pronoun *me* is used by the text producer to particularise his view on the issue of women being the arch enemies to fellow women. Such construction gives greater force to the opinion of the text producer.

The second excerpt further illustrates the use of *me* for personal assertion on an issue. In this instance, the text producer is assessing the anti-corruption crusade in Nigeria and gives his opinion on its success in an assertive way by foregrounding the particularity of his opinion on it. The third excerpt gives an example of the use

of possessive pronoun *my* in a mildly assertive way just to give the humble opinion of the text producer on the inactions of the government of Nigeria.

Based on the figures for the observations of *me* in the corpora, the pronoun has a rather low normalised frequency of 12.9. It has a normalised frequency of 11.6 in the corpus of state actors and 12.5 in that of non-state actors, showing that its use is rather minimal in both corpora. However, as shown by Figure 21, the use of *me* is slightly favoured in the sub-corpus of female non-state actors, as it has a normalised relative frequency of 20.3 in the female non-state sub-corpus as opposed to 8.9 in the male non-state sub-corpus. This seems to confirm the earlier observation in the analysis of the personal pronoun *I* that female non-state actors tend to be more assertive in their use of personal pronouns in arguing their perspectives on the social transformation agenda of Nigeria.

The possessive pronoun *my* which is also used for citizen assertion in the discourse has a normalised relative frequency of 23.8 in the corpora. However, while it has a frequency of 22.7 in the non-state corpus, it has a 24.8 frequency in the corpus of state actors, showing relatively even usage of the pronoun by both categories of participants in the discourse. Similarly, there is not any significant gender difference in the usage of the pronoun as it has normalised relative frequencies of 20.3 and 25.4 in the female non-state and male non-state actors´ sub-corpora respectively.

5.4. Pronouns as a Tool for Expressing Personal Responsibility and Authority by State Actors

The discourse of social transformation in Nigeria is also characterised by the use of pronouns by state actors for the purpose of conveying a sense of personal responsibility in addressing the social problems of Nigeria in order to appeal positively to the people. In addition, the state actors naturally express the power vested on them through their use of pronouns. The major pronouns that are typically used for these purposes in the discourse are the first-person personal pronoun *I,* the first-person possessive pronoun*, my,* and the second-person pronoun *you* and its possessive form *your*. Bramley (2001: 27) states that *I* can serve to show authority, solidarity with the audience and convey the opinion of a speaker, among others. Below, we present instances of the use of the pronoun for assertion by participants in the discourse:

(24) I need not mention the serious effort we have engaged in since the inception of this administration on the fight against corruption in our public life. SA Speech (September 8, 2016)

(25) I knew President Buhari before he became President and said that he is weak in the knowledge and understanding of the economy, but I thought that he could make good use of good Nigerians in that area that could help. SA Speech (January 23, 2018)

(26) It is often ridiculous for me when people use smaller countries in our West Africa sub-region as handy references of how democracy should be. SA Speech (February 4, 2018)

(27) In my own case, if I give birth to a child who does not say the truth, I am sure that such a child is not my blood. SA News Commentary (November 16, 2017)

In example (24), the pronoun *I* is emphatic as it asserts the personality of the participant in relation to the proposition he makes in the sentence. The expression of power through the pronoun is further reinforced by the deviational nature of the verbal expression that follows it (*need not mention*) which has an assertive tone, making the listeners to notice what the text producer is saying. However, beyond the authority expressed through the use of the pronoun, the text producer also projects himself and his government as responsible by attending to the social transformation needs of Nigeria. This, of course, could also be a manipulative way by which the political actor intends to gain further goodwill from the citizens.

In excerpt (25), the text producer asserts himself being a former President and a member of the Council of State of Nigeria by using the pronoun *I* in view of the sensitive information he provides about the President of Nigeria being incompetent in the aspect of the economy. So, given the nature of the information, the pronoun is used to portray the text producer as not scared of providing that information, thus elucidating the power of the text producer in the socio-political space in Nigeria.

In example (26), the state actor tries to assert his opinion that Nigeria should not be compared with small African countries in order to measure its democratic success. The emphasis expressed by the text producer is further heightened by the presence of the preposition *for* in the linguistic context, as it is used to give greater focus to the personality captured by the pronoun *me*.

Likewise, in the last example, there is particularisation of an issue through the possessive pronoun *my*. However, in addition to the use of the possessive pronoun to emphasise the opinion of the text producer, the particularity of the case is further intensified through the juxtaposition of the word *own* with the pronoun. This illustrates Greenbaum´s (1996) assertion that *own* can be used to emphasise possessive pronouns and to avoid ambiguity in a construction. Below are more examples of the use of pronouns for governmental authority:

(28) You must be determined to work. You must be determined to be a person of integrity. SA Speech (January 10, 2018)
(29) Ladies and gentlemen, the impending campaign will task your ingenuity, resourcefulness, competence and capacity. SA Speech (September 8, 2016)
(30) Just do your normal hygiene practices and don't chop anyhow bush meat. This message na from the National Orientation Agency. National Orientation Agency (ND)

Example (28) focuses on the use of *you* to assert as a mark of superiority by the text producer in relation to the audience. In this context of the particular text from which the excerpt is drawn, there is a direct instruction being given to Nigerian youths by the Vice President of the country. Since there is a clear power inequality between the text producer and the addressees, the text producer uses the second person pronoun *you* to directly refer to the youths without any politeness markers to hedge such effects. The Nigerian communicative culture of course will forbid such language practice if the text producer were addressing the elderly or people much older or more highly placed than him. However, since he is superior to the



Figure 26 Concordances and KWIC of the search term *you.*

audience not only in terms of age but also social status, the pronoun is used to mark such superiority.

Excerpts (29) & (30) illustrate the use of the possessive second person pronoun, *your*, in a similar manner as the use of *you* discussed above. In these instances, the text producers, being state actors, distance themselves from the people while handing down instructions to them from a higher pedestal to that of the people addressed. For instance, in the second example, since the campaign for social transformation being referenced by the text producer is supposed to involve all Nigerians, state actors inclusive, the text producer should not have reflected any hegemonic tendency by using *your* to push the burden of social change in Nigeria to the people. Also, the last example from the National Orientation Agency in Nigeria, which is meant to offer advice to Nigerians in general, rather targets only the citizens through the use of *your*, producing the implicature that the hygiene practices of state actors and the elites in general are good, while it is that of non-state actors that are bad.

The pronoun *you* has a relative frequency of 115.7 in the corpora with a balanced representation, as it has normalised relative frequencies of 113.2 and 118.3 in the state and non-state actors´ corpora respectively. In Figure 26, we present the KWIC for the pronoun *you* in the corpora:

As can be seen, certain words occur in the context of the pronoun *you*, showing the nature of meanings made when text producers sound somewhat authoritative. For instance, verbs such as *add*, *act,* and *are* are used by the text producers to give directions and advice to the citizens, showing the negative repercussions of their negative actions or why they are supposed to behave in certain ideal ways. Below, we present a table with some collocates for *you* in the corpora:

Significant Collocates of *You*
are (XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX)
if (XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX)
must (XXXXXXXXXXXXXXX)
can (XXXXXXXXXXXXXX)
have (XXXXXXXXXXX)
when (XXXXXXXXX)
will (XXXXXXXXX)
act (XX)
were (hypothetical condition)XX
may (XX)
speak (XX)
should (XX)
build (XX)

Table 24 Collocates of *you.*

Many of the collocates of *you* highlighted above reflect the instructional motivation of the usage of the pronoun in the discourse. For instance, the modals *must* and *should* reflect the authority of the text producers which reflects in their mode of addressing the audience through the pronoun *you.* However, apart from sounding like a superior, the text producers also try to convince their audience of the merits of his proposition by trying to paint certain pictures and letting the audience imagine consequences of some actions. This is achieved through the use of the conditional word *if,* the hypothetical conditional *were,* and the adverb *when.* These linguistic items and the full expressions in which they occur serve the ideal of public education which is central to advocacy for social transformation in Nigeria. Also, there are certain expressions that give value to the audience (citizens) by giving them a sense of worth. For instance, the primary auxiliary verbs *are* and *have* give some recognition to the audience as further collocates of such words are positive for the people. In addition, while the modal, *will,* shows the strength of the commitment of the text producers to their propositions, the text producers also use some less assertive pronouns such as *may* and *can* to accommodate alternative opinions which may be contrary to theirs and might even proceed from the addressees. Finally, the table also shows certain actions that are expected of the citizens for the development of Nigeria through the use of lexemes such as *build*, *speak* and *act*. In fact, the three words are quite significant as developing Nigeria and Nigerians entails building. Similarly, for things to be right in the country, it is imperative that citizens have to speak out about the ills in the society and act right.

The second person possessive pronoun, *your,* which serves a related function to *you* in the discourse has a normalised relative frequency of 42 in the corpora. However, while the pronoun has a relative frequency of 51.2 in the corpus of state actors, it has a relative frequency of 32.9 in that of non-state actors. This shows that the usage of the pronoun is slightly higher than that of the non-state actors.

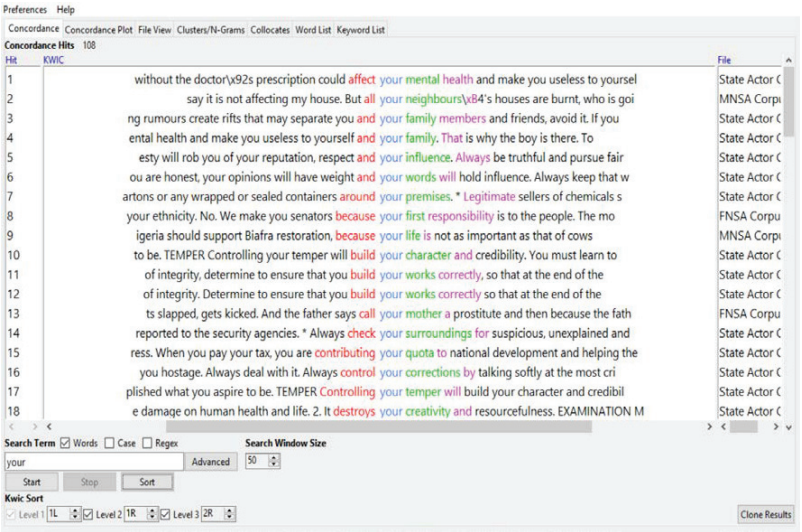


Figure 27 Concordances and KWIC of the search term *your*.

This actually agrees with expectations in view of the fact that state actors are expected to sound more authoritative than their non-state actor counterparts. To show the linguistic context of the pronoun in the discourse, we present Figure 27.

It shows some of the words co-occurring with the possessive pronoun *your* in the corpora, thus showing aspects of the lives of the citizens that the text producers reference in their discourse and certain actions that they expect of them in relation to those aspects of their lives. Nominal collocates of the pronoun as can be seen from the screenshot are *family*, *character, works, mother, surroundings, temper*, etc., while verbal collocates such as *call, control, check, build,* etc., are used to highlight some actions, especially positive actions that the people are supposed to take in order to improve on or maintain positively those aspects of their lives. For instance, for the security of people, there is the emphasis of the need for people to check their surroundings in which both *check* and *surroundings* collocate with *your*. Below is a table containing some of the significant collocates of *your* in the corpora:

Significant Nominal Collocates of *Your*	**Significant Verbal Collocates of *Your***
tax (XXXXXX)	pay (XXXXXX)
Neighbours (XXXXX)	build (XXX)
family (XXX)	use (XXX)
Works (XX)	love (XX)
Country	control (XX)
Time and resources	do (XX)

Table 25 Collocates of *your*

As can be seen from Table 25, some of the significant nominal collocates of the second-person possessive pronoun *your* in the corpora are *tax, neighbours, family, works, country* and *resources*. These lexemes signify certain important aspects of the lives of the citizens that deserve great attention for the transformation being sought to be successful. Also, the verbal lexemes *pay, build, use, love, control, do, discipline, check* and *never waste* are indexical of positive actions that Nigerians need to take for them to achieve transformation in their personal lives and contribute to the national transformation process.

6. Conclusion

The study has examined the pronominal resources deployed in the discourse of social transformation in Nigeria. The study draws on corpus-assisted discourse approach to quantitatively and qualitatively demonstrate how the participants in the discourse use pronouns to influence the attitudes of Nigerians about the social transformation agenda in the nation and mobilise them to embrace and work towards the ideal of social transformation in the nation. The study also shows how participants in the discourse tacitly assert and resist power in relation to the various issues of social transformation in Nigeria.

The study shows that there is indeed association between the pronouns used and the text sources as the *p*-value of 0.01 generated from the chi-square test shows the significance of the pronouns and their usages. While pronouns are largely used for the purposes of sharing the vision and responsibility of social transformation in Nigeria, bearing the resistance of the people against the government officials whom they perceive as having failed in their duties of entrenching positive social transformation in the country, and expressing personal responsibility and authority. While the pronouns *we*, *our* and *us* are largely used for involvement of the citizens and responsibility sharing with respect to social transformation concerns, *I, me and my* are mainly used for citizen resistance and assertion. Also, the second person pronouns *you* and *your* and the first person pronoun are used for the expression of governmental power and assertion by the state actors.

The study further reveals that even though non-state actors record a relatively higher use of the inclusive pronoun *we*, there is greater deployment of pronouns for inclusivity in the corpus of state actors as they clearly use the inclusive pronouns *our* and *us* more than the non-state actors. However, it is evident that both categories of participants recognise the importance of making the general public see the campaign as their own. Regarding the use of the personal pronouns, while there is relatively balanced usage of *me* and *my* by both categories of discourse participants, non-state actors use the personal pronoun *I* more than state actors contrary to expectations, showing the height of resistance ideology of the non-state actor participants in the discourse. It is however remarkable that female non-state contributors to the discourse are significantly free and strategic in expressing their views and contributing to important issues. While they are equally sensitive to the need for inclusive use of pronouns for achieving the goal of social transformation in Nigeria, they are in fact more convincing in their use of the personal pronouns

I and *me* than their male counterparts. This thus reflects the growing women assertion and contribution to social issues in the Nigerian context which might be seen as some justification for their advocacy for 35% affirmative action on women inclusion in governance in Nigeria.

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China and Hong Kong in European Discourse: A Qualitative Study of European Online Newspapers Reporting on the Opening of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macau Bridge

Jessica Dheskali

Chemnitz University of Technology

Abstract

"Text analysis makes an essential contribution to the analysis of media discourse and its hidden or manipulative power" (Xia 2019: 3). This contribution discusses the representation of China and Hong Kong in European discourse by focusing on online newspapers that reported on the opening of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macau Bridge on October 23, 2018. Twelve online newspapers from five European countries were selected for a qualitative corpus analysis. The theoretical framework for this study is built upon Critical Discourse Analysis (Fairclough 1995). With power being the central concept of Critical Discourse Analysis, it "tends to be defined in terms of negative use of power, articulated through and within discourse and resulting in domination" (Rogers 2011: 3). For this analysis, collocations with and expressions for the lexemes *bridge* and *project* were chosen as well as further positively and negatively connoted words related to the whole project. The results show that the European online newspapers mainly focused on negative aspects related to this large project and that they casted this project in a rather negative light. Both collocations with and expressions for the bridge and project include more negatively connoted words than positively connoted words. This small scale study found that while the whole project in general seems gigantic and fascinating and the big bridge a great way for people to travel much faster between Hong Kong, Zhuhai and Macau, there are also some downsides to this project that should not be neglected. The main focus of the articles was on the delay, the budget overrun, corruption, the political background and the restricted access of the bridge.

Keywords: critical discourse analysis, Hong Kong, China, online articles, online news, newspaper articles, Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macau Bridge

1. Introduction

On October 23, 2018, the Hong Kong-Zhuhai- Macau Bridge (HZMB henceforth) was finally opened. This important event was not only shown on Asian TV stations and reported on in Asian newspapers, but was present in the European media as well. However, whereas this large project was mainly portrayed positively in Asia, it was mainly criticised in Europe. This contribution aims at analysing the representation of the opening of this bridge and the whole project in general in European discourse by looking at several European online newspapers and drawing on Fairclough's (1995) framework of Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA henceforth).

Studies employing CDA have increased greatly in the past years by also spreading to several new disciplines and fields of research (Fairclough, Graham, Lemke & Wodak 2001). CDA is concerned with the analysis of how social and political inequalities are manifested in and reproduced through discourse (Wooffitt 2005: 137) and it allows us to critically examine how news discourse represents social practices and ideologies (Fairclough 2015). CDA challenges us to move from seeing language as abstract to seeing words as having meaning in a particular historical, social, and political context. (cf. van der Bom 2017) Fairclough (1995) argues that media language analyses are an essential element in the research of cultural and social change and should be recognized as such. He draws on the Systemic Functional Grammar (Halliday 1985) and explores how different linguistic dimensions such as genre, style and discourse are linked together. (Fairclough 2003)

"The $20bn, 55km bridge and 6.7km undersea tunnel link Hong Kong's Lantau island to Zhuhai on the southern coast of Guangdong province and the gambling hub of Macau, a popular tourist spot for Chinese visitors opened on October 23, 2018. The mega-structure is supported by three cable-stayed bridges and designed to withstand typhoon-force winds of up to 340km an hour" (Lee 2018 in *The Guardian*, 26.10.2018). This quote from an article from *The Guardian* summarizes this project very well and provides the necessary information needed to understand the dimension of this bridge. In this contribution, I will mainly use the term *project* to refer to the HZMB. This includes the whole process of designing, building, and opening this new bridge.

The main objective of this contribution is to analyse how the discourse about China and Hong Kong is constructed in European online newspaper articles. It will be examined how certain ideologies, so "representations of aspects of the world which contribute to establishing and maintaining relations of power, domination and exploitation" (Fairclough 2003: 218), are (re)constructed in European discourse. The topic of the opening of this new bridge between Hong-Kong, Zhuhai and Macau was chosen because of its prominence in the Chinese and European media and my personal connection to this region in China through an academic partnership. The online newspaper coverage concentrates mainly on delays in the construction of the bridge, budget overruns, corruption, safety issues and restricted access. Many articles portrayed this project as controversial and politically driven. To gain a deeper insight into the representation of this project in European discourse, I compiled a corpus of European (online) newspapers, which contains articles from newspapers from Germany, England, Denmark, Russia, and France published between July and October 2018, both in German and English. Hereby, German articles are compared with articles from the above-mentioned countries. The main focus is on collocations with the lexemes *bridge*/*Brücke* and *project/Projekt* and expressions for the bridge and the whole project as well as additional positively and negatively connoted lexemes and phrases regarding the project.

The subsequent section will focus on the theoretical background of this study, namely CDA. Beginning from section 3, the data collection, the methodology, the qualitative analysis, and the interpretation of the results of this corpus analysis are presented and discussed.

2. Theoretical Framework

2.1. Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA)

The articles will be analysed within the framework of CDA in order to better understand the ideology embedded in the selected newspaper articles. Generally speaking, CDA analyses "the role of discourse in the (re)production and challenge of dominance" (van Dijk 1993: 249). Language itself does not have power, but it becomes dominant and powerful through the people who use it to communicate in a certain way. (cf. Wodak 2001) This kind of research can show how language is systematically used by powerful entities and related actors to create certain attitudes and social realities, to construct ideologies and to influence a society by their way of presenting facts.

While not being a conventional method as such, CDA is a type of research that "primarily studies the way social power abuse, dominance, and inequality are enacted, reproduced, and resisted by text and talk in the social and political context" (van Dijk 2001: 352). It describes discourse as "a form of social action" (Fairclough & Wodak 1997: 271f.), focuses on social problems and political issues and offers a different, often critical, perspective of analysing and theorizing discourse in various areas such as pragmatics, sociolinguistics, media analysis and conversation analysis. (cf. van Dijk 1993, 2001; Fairclough & Wodak 1997)

As CDA is not a specific method in scientific research, there are various approaches and diverse types that look at genres and contexts ranging from conversations to news reports and school lessons. (cf. van Dijk 2001) The different approaches to CDA focus on similar aspects, but nevertheless differ in their specific foci and methodologies (Fairclough 2010, Jäger 2012, Meyer 2001, Reisigl & Wodak 2001, Scollon 2001, van Dijk 1993). Van Dijk (1993: 253) summarizes that "ultimately, its success is measured by its effectiveness and relevance, that is, by its contribution to change". As previously mentioned, I have adapted Fairclough's (1995) approach to CDA. He connects his approach and ideas among others to the theory of language, namely Systemic Functional Grammar (Halliday 1985).

Meyer (2001) also states that CDA mainly relies on linguistic categories. Next to a content-based structure analysis, a detailed language-oriented analysis is very common. (Jäger 2012) Hence, not only the general topics, but mainly also the context, linguistic features, and rhetorical means play an important role. (ibid.) This problem-oriented critical research draws on "a range of theoretical traditions and recontextualises these within distinct research programmes" (Wodak & Forchtner 2017: 147).

Since CDA allows us to study the media representation of political discourse, this study explores how China and Hong Kong are represented in European news by analysing a number of online newspaper articles in detail. The aim of this contribution is to identify and analyse the underlying ideologies in the online articles on the selected topic through a qualitative analysis of their choices of words. Such an analysis helps to investigate and understand why certain words are chosen over others and how they influence or are influenced by society.

2.2. Combining Critical Discourse Analysis and Corpus Linguistics

"Critical Discourse Analysis has often proved fruitful in providing insights into the relationship between language and ideology" (Orpin 2005: 37). Despite the effectiveness and wide use of CDA, it has also received various criticism such as having biases related to the selection of features and texts to analyse. (cf. Stubbs 1997, Orpin 2005) A synergy between CDA and corpus linguistics, which can avoid such limitations, has been proposed and adopted by several researchers (e.g. Baker 2006, Baker et al. 2008, Mautner 2009, Orpin 2005). In the last decade, there has been an increasing attention towards conducting CDA through corpus linguistics methods (Chen 2013, Ebermann 2020, Mautner 2015, Nartey & Mwinlaaru 2019, Schmied 2017). "[C]orpus-based CDA presents both discourse analysts and corpus linguists with a robust methodology to tackle research questions bordering on discursive reflections of social issues and to identify new sites of public discourse for systematic analysis" (Nartey & Mwinlaaru 2019). Adopting methods from corpus linguistics to conduct a CDA has scientific relevance because it enables researchers to analyse larger collections of texts of different genres, which enable the presentation of broader generalizations. Baker et al. (2008: 285) add that:

> CL [corpus linguistic] processes can help quantify discoursal phenomena already recognized in CDA; that is, establish their absolute and relative frequencies in the corpus, through the examination of the different linguistic means utilized to express them. Even when the CL analysis does not set out to examine existing CDA notions, it can utilize a CDA theoretical framework in the interpretation of the findings.

All the previously mentioned benefits of interweaving CDA with corpus linguistics methods led me to conduct this corpus-based CDA on the representation of China and Hong Kong in European discourse.

3. Data and Methodology

3.1. Corpus Compilation

For the present small-scale study, twelve online newspapers (including one radio station) from five different European countries were selected for critical discourse analysis. Due to the small size of the corpus, this study is only qualitative. Overall, I downloaded 85 articles from the following online newspapers and radio station: *Die Zeit Online, Spiegel Online, Der Tagesspiegel, Stern* (Germany); *BBC, The Independent, The Guardian, The Telegraph* (England); *France 24, Radio France International (RFI)* (France)*; The Copenhagen Post* (Denmark); and *Russia Today* (Russia). These countries and online newspapers were chosen for my corpus because of the availability of their articles in English and German and their different locations in Europe. Other European newspapers that were checked did either not provide articles in English or did not write about the topic under discussion. Newspapers that only wrote about China or Hong Kong once were also not selected. I tried to include the most widely circulated and known newspapers from the selected countries. I also decided to include articles published by the radio station

RFI to make the number of articles from France more balanced. The articles were retrieved from the respective official websites of the newspapers and the radio station. They mainly focus on three topics, namely the opening of the HZMB, the missing Interpol Chief and the US-China trade war. The initial idea was to analyse how China and Hong Kong are represented in European discourse in general. However, later it was decided to only focus on the representation of the opening of the HZMB for this study to go deeper into the topic.

The corpus I compiled with these articles is named ENCO - European (Online) Newspaper COrpus. I divided the corpus into a German and an English sub-corpus as I was able to collect many German articles related to my topic of interest. The German sub-corpus consists of 53 articles and 26,033 words and the English one of 32 articles and 15,431 words (see Table 26). Since my mother tongue is German, I decided to include articles published in Germany and written in German rather than in English. A direct comparison of the selected countries was not possible as the number of words and articles per country was too small and too skewed. The aim of this contribution is merely to give an overview of the representation of the selected topic in European discourse.

online newspapers	**number of words and articles**
in German: *Die Zeit Online, Spiegel Online, Der Tages- spiegel, Stern*	**articles:** German sub-corpus: 53 English sub-corpus: 32 total no. of articles: 85
in English: *BBC, The Independent, The Guardian, The Telegraph, France 24, RFI, The Copenhagen Post, Russia Today*	**words:** German sub-corpus: 26033 English sub-corpus: 15431 total no. of words: 41464

Table 26 List of newspapers and number of words and articles included in ENCO.

The corpus was compiled by searching for the keywords *China, Hong Kong, Hongkong, Asia, Interpol, bridge, opening, Brücke, Zhuhai* and *Macau* via the search function of the respective websites and collecting all the articles on topics related to China and Hong Kong. For this study, I chose the period between July and October 2018 because the opening of the HZMB took place on October 23, 2018. Most of the articles were published shortly before, on the day of and shortly after the opening of the bridge, but some newspapers started reporting on this topic already in July.

3.2. Methodology

To analyse the newspaper articles with the concordance program AntConc 3.5.7. (Anthony 2018), all articles were converted into text files and given a proper file name. To gain an insight into how European newspapers represent the selected project, I firstly got an overview by looking at the word lists of both sub-corpora via the Word List tool of AntConc. I then created a table with all variables related

to the project (e.g., *delay, complain, concern, boost, development*) and different expressions used to refer to the bridge or project. After checking the contexts via the Key Word in Context (KWIC) tool, I ranked all applicable instances as either positively or negatively connoted. During this process, I decided to focus on the following three aspects:

1. collocations with the lexemes bridge/Brücke and project/Projekt
2. positively and negatively connoted lexemes and phrases related to the whole project of the HZMB
3. expressions for the bridge and the whole project

In order to rank the variables as positively or negatively connoted (2), I checked all contexts manually. In most cases, it was clear. However, to present accurate results, it is always necessary to check the context. Several lexemes, as for example *significantly, mega, authority, grow* in my case, could be ranked as both positively and negatively depending on the context. Of course, some words are neither positive nor negative. These were excluded from my analysis. For 1 (collocations), I mainly checked for adjectives, but also for other collocations with *bridge/Brücke* and *project/Projekt*. I started by checking three words to the left and right from the variable and then extended my search to the sentence level. For 3 (expressions), I combined my search with and the findings from the Word List tool with a manual search. As the articles are not extensively long, checking them manually was feasible. All findings were documented in an excel sheet.

3.3. Limitations

This contribution is limited in several aspects. This study aims at investigating European discourse. However, I was only able to include five different European countries for several reasons mentioned under 3.1. The newspapers are also not equally represented. From some, I was only able to collect between two and five articles, and from *Die Zeit*, for example, I could download 36 articles. Hence, my corpus is not ideally stratified, which could lead to minor skewed results. Furthermore, the concordance program AntConc also has its limitations. For example, the number of hits in the KWIC tool is slightly different from the number of hits in the Word List tool. Since all hits have been analysed manually afterwards, this did not display a major problem.

Another limitation is the way people express themselves differently in their mother tongue (L1) compared to a second or foreign language (L2). Many articles included in my corpus are in English, partly as an L1 and partly as an L2, but an even higher number are in German as an L1. As German is my mother tongue, I decided to include articles in German, not in English, from German newspapers. If the articles were written in their mother tongue, the authors of the articles (in English) from France, Russia and Denmark might have made different linguistic choices (see Connor 1996, Hyland 2003: 35).

Statistical tests were not necessary or applicable for such a qualitative analysis. As the corpus is very small, a quantitative analysis was not carried out because the results would have not been very representative. My data does not render a deeper or comparative analysis as the articles are unevenly distributed and as I was not able to collect more articles from other European countries. Nevertheless, the qualitative analysis reveals some good findings, which are presented in the next chapter.

4. Data Analysis and Discussion

In this chapter, selected examples from my corpus will be analysed and discussed according to the CDA discussed in section 2.1. I will go according to the three aspects mentioned in 3.2., namely 1) collocations, 2) further positively and negatively connoted lexemes and phrases, and 3) expressions. I have checked the Word List and manually analysed all selected KWIC. The findings are presented in the tables below.

It is commonly known that the choices of words in newspapers are not arbitrary. The press coverage online of the opening of the largest bridge in China is analysed here at a lexical level as the choice of words is essential in presenting certain information about an important event to readers. No matter if explicit or implicit, it hints at the stance of the newspaper and their ideology. As it was not possible to collect more articles on this topic from several more different countries, this small-scale study does not aim at comparing the ways in which the same project is covered in the press of different countries. It merely aims at providing an oveerview of how this project is represented in European newspapers.

4.1. Collocations with *bridge*/*Brücke* and *project*/*Projekt* found in ENCO

Table 27 and Table 28 present collocations with the lexemes *bridge/Brücke* and *project/Projekt*. While Table 27 shows all direct collocations (adjectives), Table 28 allows a better insight by showing complete phrases found in the same scope with these variables. The English translations for all German words and phrases have been provided in parenthesis. As can be seen in the first table below, these collocations do not show a clear tendency yet.

A few neutral terms such as *newly-opened*, *brand-new* and *world's longest*, several positive terms such as *gigantic*, *stable*, *sensational* and *important* as well many negative terms (*politically-driven*, *ambitious*, *highly criticized*, *delayed*, *utopian*) only hint at the overall tone and stance of the articles. Therefore, a more extended search and scope was necessary (results are presented in Table 28). Table 27 further shows that the German newspapers used stronger adjectives such as *gigantic*, *spectacular*, and *utopian*, and adverbs (*highly*, *incredibly*) to boost them whereas the articles in the English sub-corpus did not use very strong adjectives or other boosters.

German sub-corpus	English sub-corpus
bedingt nutzbar (of limited use)	*ambitious*
deutlich teurer (significantly more expensive)	*brand new*
gigantisch, riesig (gigantic, huge)	*expensive*
heftig kritisiert (heavily criticised)	*high*
hochumstritten (highly controversial)	*long-awaited*
neu (new)	*magnificent*
prestigeträchtig (prestigious)	*new*
spektakulär (spectacular)	*newly-opened*
überflüssig (redundant)	*politically driven*
ungeheuer groß/lang (incredibly large/long)	*stable*
utopisch (utopian)	*world's longest*
verzögert (delayed)	
weltweit größte/längste (world's largest/longest)	
wichtig (important)	

Table 27 Collocations (adjectives) with *bridge/Brücke* and *project/Projekt* in ENCO.

When reporting on the project, the newspapers expressed mainly concerns and issues about the project. Table 28 gives a more detailed overview of the representation of the project in European discourse and the concerns and issues addressed.

After searching for adjectives that co-occur with *bridge*/*Brücke* and *project*/*Projekt*, the search window had been extended. The issues related to this big project that most newspapers focused on (see Table 28) are, among others, restricted access (*cars only with special permit*), budget overruns, delay of the whole project, safety issues (*workers died, many injured*), environmental issues (*a major intervention into nature, threatened species of dolphins*), and political issues (*Beijing's desire to bring regions more firmly under its control, more control of mainland, serves political purposes*). While the whole project itself seems gigantic and fascinating and the big bridge a great way for people to travel much faster between Hong Kong, Zhuhai and Macau, it cannot be neglected that there are also some downsides to this project. My results show that the European newspapers mainly focused on these negative aspects and casted this project in a rather negative light. The European newspapers acknowledge that this bridge connects the three cities involved much better and that the travelling time is much shorter, but other than that, there are not many more positive aspects that have been mentioned as will also be discussed in the next sub-chapter. Nouns such as *concern*, *conflict, control, costs,* and *criticism* often found within the same scope as the two variables underline this aspect.

German sub-corpus	English sub-corpus
besser vernetzten (*link better*)	*aims to bring autonomous regions closer to mainland*
erleichtert Menschen in allen drei Orten größeren Austausch und Handel (*facilitates greater exchange and trade for people in all three places*)	*Beijing's desire to bring regions more firmly under its control*
für Bürger nur bedingt nutzbar (*of limited use to citizens*)	*serving political purpose*
gefährdete Delfinart (endangered species of dolphins)	*should generate economic benefits*
bedroht (*endangered*)	*would boost flows of people, logistics, trade and money*
großer Eingriff in die Natur (major intervention into nature)	*blamed for falling numbers of the threatened Chinese white dolphin*
hohe Kosten (*high costs*)	*cameras monitoring drivers*
Kritik (*criticism*)	*car only with a special permit*
mangelnde Transparenz (*insufficient transparency)*	*restricted access*
Korruption (*corruption*)	*cherished freedoms are being eroded*
Tod mehrerer Bauarbeiter (*death of several construction workers*)	*complain**
dient politischen Zwecken (*serves political purposes*)	*fears grow*
mehr Kontrolle vom Festland (*more control of mainland)*	*concern**
stößt auf politische Bedenken (*raises political concerns)*	*designed to withstand winds of up to 340km an hour*
Versuch, die autonome frühere britische Kolonie enger an die Volksrepublik China anzubinden (*attempt to link the autonomous former British colony more closely to the People's Republic of China*)	*great convenience*
	lawsuits and budget overruns
wichtige Wirtschaftsregion noch mächtiger (*important economic region even more powerful)*	*safety issues*
	workers died
neuer Platz für Fabriken, Wohntürme und Infrastrukturprojekte (*new space for factories, residential towers and infrastructure projects*)	*many injured*
schneller zu erreichen (*quicker to reach*)	
Fahrtzeit schrumpft (*travel time shrinks*)	
spezielle Busse (*special busses*)	
Streit (*conflict*)	
Zweifel (*doubts*)	
vorgeworfen (*accused*)	

Table 28 Collocations with *bridge/Brücke* and *project/Projekt* in ENCO.

4.2. Further positively and negatively connoted lexemes and phrases related to the HZMB

The following lexemes and phrases did not co-occur with the variables *bridge*/*Brücke* and *project*/*Projekt* within the same scope but are found throughout the whole corpus and are related to the project of the HZMB. They were found via the Word List tool and a manual check. Even though some of them are repeated, they were additionally included as they allow an even broader insight in the representation of China and Hong Kong in the selected newspapers and in how far they try to influence the reader. Already a first glance at Table 4 and the collocations

discussed before shows that the newspapers predominantly made use of negative lexemes and phrases and hence influenced the reader's opinion. The representation is far from being objective and factual.

Positively connoted		**Negatively connoted**	
German sub-corpus	**English sub-corpus**	**German sub-corpus**	**English sub-corpus**
reduzierte Fahrzeit (*reduced travel time*) *spektakulär* (*spectecular*) *verbessert* (*improved*) *wirtschaftliches Kraftpaket* (*economic powerhouse*)	*boost business* *cut travel time* *feasible* *promotes economic development*	*Bauverzögerung (construction delay)* *Druck* (*pressure*) *fürchten* (*fear*) *hochfliegende Träume* (*soaring dreams*) *Kostenüberschreitung* (*cost overrun*) *Milliardenbau* (*billion Euro construction*) *never-ending story* *Problem* (*problem*) *Profit/proifieren* (*profit*) *Sicherheit* (*security*) *Sorge* (*concern*) *tödliche Unfälle* (*deadly accidents*) *überdimensioniert (oversized)* *überlastet* (*overloaded*) *umstritten* (*controversial*) *utopisch* (*utopian*) *vage* (*vague*) *weiter stärken* (*strengthen further*) *(zu) teuer* ((*too*) *expensive*)	*Beijing-driven strategy* *controversial* *criticize* *critics accused government* *deaths of workers* *delay* *fears grow* *giving away territory* *hastily announced* *huge investment* *increasingly assertive Beijing* *left in the dark* *money* *not open to us all* *political pressure* *prosecution* *quality* *redundant* *taxpayer* *using the HK taxpayer's money*

Table 29 Further positively and negatively connoted lexemes and phrases in ENCO.

A closer look at Table 29 shows that several concerns and fears were addressed as well as criticism voiced, as has been mentioned before. The project has been described as *utopian, controversial,* and *oversized*. *Left in the dark, using the taxpayer's money* and *not open to all of us* shows that also the citizens of Hong Kong, Zhuhai and Macau were addressed in the articles. Instead of mainly highlighting the benefits for all people involved (e.g., *cut travel time, economic development*), the authors discussed all disadvantages and concerns in detail. *Never-ending-story, construction delay, increasingly assertive Beijing, Beijing-driven strategy,* and *critics accused government* also point at the longer duration of the project as well as the political issues regarding the project. That the whole process and the con-

struction of the bridge took much longer than planned is obvious and a fact. However, whether Beijing, which is a metonymy that stands for the political leaders of China, really intends to use this bridge to gain more power over Hong Kong, is only an assumption. Yet, several newspapers used this assumption as a focus of their articles and hence shifted the focus to the disadvantages and issues related to the project. How this project and the bridge are often referred to in the articles, is discussed in the next subchapter.

4.3. Expressions for the bridge and the whole project

To refer to the same event, project or bridge, different terms have been used as shown in Table 30.

German sub-corpus	**English sub-corpus**
ambitionierte Infrastrukturprojekt (*ambitious infrastructure project*)	*costly white elephant*
Ding (*thing*)	*engineering marvel*
gigantische Brückenprojekt (*giant bridge project*)	*first major marine bridge-and-tunnel project in China*
gigantisches Verkehrsprojekt (gigantic infrastructure project)	*interesting experiment*
Hongkong-Zhuhai-Macau-Brücke	*mammoth infrastructure projects*
Mammutprojekts (*mammoth projects*)	*mega bridge*
Mega-Projekt (*mega project*)	*mega transport infrastructure*
Milliardenbau (*billion Euro construction*)	*mega-project without urgent need*
Milliardenprojekt (*billion Euro project*)	*mega-structure*
never-ending story	*multi-billion-dollar bridge*
Prestigeprojekt (*prestige project*)	*politically driven mega-project*
Rekordbau (*record construction*)	*second major infrastructure project*
Rekordbrücke (record bridge)	*snaking road bridge*
Riesenprojekt (*giant project*)	*world-beater*
Riesenverkehrsprojekt (*giant traffic project*)	*Y-shaped link*
Science-Fiction-Brücke für die Fabrik der Welt (*science fiction bridge for the factory of the world*)	
Superbrücke (*super bridge*)	
Transportverbindung (*transportation link*)	

Table 30 Expressions for the bridge and the project found in ENCO.

Expressions that often occurred were *multi-billion-dollar bridge*, *billion-dollar project, mega bridge, mega-structure, record bridge* and *gigantic infrastructure project.* These show that the newspapers mainly focused on the financial aspect as well as the size and the dimension of the project when they reported about it. While it can be argued whether these terms have a negative connotation or not, other expressions found in my corpus are obviously negatively connoted. Examples are *politically driven mega-project, ambitious infrastructure project, never-ending story,* and *prestige project*. Nevertheless, many expressions also highlight the great

job the Chinese have done with the bridge itself. It is a *super* or *mega bridge*, a *record construction* and an *engineering marvel* which is a *world-beater* that consists of a bridge and a tunnel below the water and serves as a link.

4.4. Sample sentences from my corpora

As Rogers (2011: 6) explains, "systemic functional linguistics as a theory of language is oriented toward choice and privileges [sic.] meaning makers (language users) as agents making decisions about the social functions of their language use". This implies that people constantly create meanings in the way they want and that they have a large repertoire to choose from. Discourse here can "construct and represent the social world" (Rogers 2011: 6). The following examples that were chosen for my qualitative analysis summarize the overall stance and opinion of the articles published in the five selected European countries. The first four were taken from the German sub-corpus (translations by the author of this contribution are provided directly after each example) and examples (1) to (8) from the English sub-corpus.

(1) Skandale hatten den Bau des Prestigeprojekts überschattet… Das Großprojekt war nicht nur wegen der hohen Kosten in die Kritik geraten. Den Planern wurde auch mangelnde Transparenz, Korruption und der Tod mehrerer Bauarbeiter vorgeworfen. (ENCO_Sp_G_HKBr_1)
['Scandals had overshadowed the construction of the prestigious project ... The major project was criticized not only because of the high costs. The planners were also accused of lack of transparency, corruption and the death of several construction workers.']

(2) Kritiker des Mammutprojekts beklagen die hohen Kosten, Korruptionsfälle bei den beteiligten Behörden und Sicherheitsmängel, die zum Tod mehrerer Arbeiter führten. (ENCO_Stern_G_HKBr_1)
['Critics of the mammoth project complain about the high costs, corruption cases among the involved authorities and security deficiencies, which led to the death of several workers.']

(3) Vor allem in Hongkong stößt die Brücke auch auf politische Bedenken: Kritiker sehen das Bauwerk als weiteren Versuch, die autonome frühere britische Kolonie enger an die Volksrepublik China anzubinden. (ENCO_Stern_G_HKBr_1)
['Especially in Hong Kong, the bridge also raises political concerns: Critics see the building as a further attempt to tie the autonomous former British colony closer to the People's Republic of China.']

(4) Als das [Kritikpunkte] am Dienstag ein CNN-Reporter in seinem Fernsehbericht aus Zhuhai erwähnte, schwärzten sich in Peking plötzlich die Fernsehbildschirme. Die Zensur hatte zugeschlagen. (ENCO_TagSp_G_HKBr_2)
['When a CNN reporter mentioned this [criticisms] on Tuesday in his report from Zhuhai, the television screens suddenly blackened in Beijing. The censorship had struck.']

(5) Critics say the new multi-billion-dollar sea-bridge is one more way to integrate Hong Kong into China as fears grow that the city's cherished freedoms are being eroded. (ENCO_Fra24_E_HKBr_1, cf. ENCO_Guard_E_HKBr_1)

(6) Supporters of the project promote it as an engineering marvel that will also boost business and cut travel time, while others see it as a politically driven and costly white elephant. (ENCO_Fra24_E_HKBr_1)

(7) Building began in 2009 and has been dogged by delays, budget overruns, corruption prosecutions and the deaths of construction workers. (ENCO_Fra24_E_HKBr_1, cf. ENCO_Guard_E_HKBr_3, cf. ENCO_Indep_E_HKBr_3)

(8) As well as being the longest bridge of its type, stretching 55km, the $20bn Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macau bridge is also one of the world's most unusual roadways, with cameras to detect yawning, drivers forced to wear heart monitors and access restricted to the political elite and charity donors. (ENCO_Guard_E_HKBr_1)

These eight examples serve as a summary of the points discussed so far. Examples (1), (2), (7), and (8) address the issues and scandals that overshadowed the whole project. *High costs, insufficient transparency, delays, budget overruns, corruption, restricted access*, and *the death of construction workers* are the main issues addressed by several newspapers. As discussed before, the project is often not simply named as such, but many different expressions, several with a negative tone, are used to talk about the project. *Prestige project* (1), *mammoth infrastructure project* (2), *multi-billion-dollar sea-bridge* (5) and *politically driven and costly white elephant* (6) are the ones found in my examples. As the latter expression and example (3) suggest, building this long bridge could also be a way of the mainland to gain more control over Hong Kong, which is a political issue. Several newspapers voiced similar concerns and criticism. According to them, *the city's cherished freedoms are being eroded* while trying to connect Hong Kong, which lays on an island, to the mainland of China (see example (5)). It cannot be denied that this new link, the bridge, will bring along political advantages, especially for the mainland. Furthermore, example (6) includes some advantages of this *engineering marvel*, namely that it *cuts travel time* and *boosts business*.

To summarize, my findings show that the articles paint a rather negative image of this large project by directly addressing and reporting about the criticism and issues related to the HZMB. According to Blommaert's (2005: 2) "power differentiates and selects, includes and excludes". Discourse is also a form of power that can influence and manipulate people and to some extend influence their way of thinking and action. As carriers of knowledge, authors of journal articles can decide what to write about in their articles and how to phrase and frame it. The newspaper articles in this study mainly included negative connoted lexemes and did not focus much on the advantages of the project. Hence, the reproduction of the knowledge about this whole project in this way in this form of discourse is what shapes the opinions of the readers.

5. Conclusion

This contribution has attempted to unravel how European online newspapers represent the opening of the HZMB in their articles. The basis for this small-scale study formed a corpus of 41,464 words and 85 online articles taken from twelve online newspapers (including one radio station) from five different European

countries. Through a critical discourse analysis of these online articles it was found that while the whole project in general is gigantic and fascinating and the big bridge a great way for people to travel much faster between Hong Kong, Zhuhai and Macau, there are also several issues overshadowing this project that should not be neglected.

My results show that the European newspapers mainly focused on these negative aspects and casted this project in a rather negative light. The European newspapers acknowledge that this bridge connects the three cities involved much better and that the travelling time is much shorter, but other than that, there are not many more positive aspects that have been mentioned. The main focus of the articles was on the delay, corruption, the budget overrun, the political background and the restricted access of the bridge. By mainly focusing on the negative aspects of this project by using negatively connoted words, the newspapers influence the reader's opinion. Certain positive aspects were either not extended on or not included at all while many downsides were elaborated on. This representation is neither objective nor factual. The aim of this contribution was to provide an overview of the representation of the project under discussion in European newspapers. Further studies could focus on the representation of this project in China as well and compare the representation in European and Chinese or Asian newspapers.

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English Language Features of International Communication Magazines in China: Based on Halliday's Systemic Functional Grammar – Taking Beijing Review as an Example

Zhang Min & Zhang Xinlei

Chemnitz University of Technology

Abstract

The present paper takes *Beijing Review* as an example to analyze the language features of international communication magazines in China from the perspective of Halliday's Systemic Functional Grammar. Both quantitative and qualitative approaches are applied in this study. In the quantitative study, based on Halliday's Systemic Functional Grammar, the paper studies language features of *Beijing Review* from three aspects: modality system; transitivity system; classification system. And it concludes that *Beijing Review* emphasizes the usage of modal verbs with medium value, material process, and indirect speech with accurate sources; In the qualitative study, with regard to Hofstede's Value Dimension, it explores the underlying reasons behind the language features of communication magazines in China: in *Beijing Review* verbal process mainly appears in the form of news reported speech with explicit and clear source. And this is in agreement with the culture to refrain from uncertain and ambiguous things.

Keywords: International Communication Magazines; Beijing Review; Language Features; Halliday's Systemic Functional Grammar

1. Introduction

In the age of globalization, it is imperative to strengthen international communication. International communication magazines play a key role in introducing China to the world. Magazines of this particular genre can provide an all-round information about China, thus broadening mutual understanding, and increasing friendship and cooperation.

Since 1978, China carried out reforming and opening-up policy. From then China's international communication has made unquantifiable progress, but it still far lag behind the developed countries. Though still left far behind western countries, China now has more diverse means in international communication than before. Newspapers, magazines, news, and brochures in English have been booming in China. However, it should be pointed out that the effect of international communication in China has not achieved satisfactory influence on foreign countries. Among the factors leading to this problem, language factor is the least studied one, thus researching the English language features could compensate the limitation.

Beijing Review, a national English news weekly, occupies an important position in China's international communication magazines. In view of its importance, scholars both at home and abroad have made numerous studies in this field since 1980s. However, most of the relevant studies focus on communicational perspectives, paying not too much attention to linguistic angles. In order to compensate for the limitation, the current research attempts to combine linguistic perspective (Halliday's Systemic Functional Grammar) with international communication, exploring the English language features of international communication magazines in China, taking Beijing Review as an example, based on Halliday's Systemic Functional Grammar from the three aspects: modality system, transitivity system and classification system.

2. Literature Review: Systemic Functional Grammar

Systemic Functional Grammar (SFG) is sociology-concerned. In the 1970s, M. A. K. Halliday brought up the Systemic Functional Grammar based on former linguistic theories. Systemic Functional Grammar includes systemic aspect and functional aspect, which are sequentially founded and mutually contained. These two integral parts weave a network of linguistic theory based on the assumption that human choice-making in language systems must be social-interaction bound. Languages in reality are investigated as objects. During 1964 and 1971, the linguistic framework of Halliday developed greatly. The notion from Firth was modified.

Systemic grammar is a system net composed of many subsystems, which are connected to meaning and alternative to people. So it is also called meaning potential. In Systemic Grammar, language is regarded as a "system of systems". According to Halliday, a system is a range of options, a set of possibilities with an entry condition which have something in common. Despite of their distinctions, these items in a particular system belong to the same area of meaning. Each system has two basic characteristics. First, each system is finite. Second, the meaning of each item is determined by other items in the system. Generally speaking, there are chain system and choice system. The axis of chain represents the syntagmatic relation while the axis of choice represents the paradigmatic relation.

Halliday views language from an inter-organism perspective, concerning with people's behavior in social interaction. His interest is in how people use language to accomplish social life. He holds that making choices is influenced by the social and cultural context as social demand of language function shapes the language structure. In other words, language is what it is due to the function it serves. Halliday's Systemic Grammar contains a functional component. Halliday sees these functions as particularly relevant to analysis of text.

According to Halliday, a sentence is realized by three functions. Owing to the ideational function, language could be applied to all the specific contexts involving experience communication. Due to the interpersonal function, language could be used to all the social interactions. A prerequisite to these two functions is the textual function, without which language could not be related to context, or text could not come into being.

Ideational function is often used to communicate novel information or contents to other unknown or unfamiliar listeners or hearers. Ideational function is quite necessary because a person has to consult his experience in the world when a person uses language to express ideas. The ideational function generally includes "transitivity" and "voice", etc.

The ideational function is generally realized by the experiential function and the logical function. The experiential function means that the speakers have a lot of grammatical choices or options and speakers can make meanings to express the world nearby outside us or even in our hearts:

> Most obviously, perhaps, when we watch small children interacting with the objects around them we can see that they are using language to construe a theoretical model of their experience. We should stress, I think, that the grammar is not merely annotating experience; it is construing experience (Halliday 2003: 15-16).

Halliday holds that the evolution of language is due to human being' creating meaning. And during the procedure, language gradually develops and finally comes to be mature. Thus, the human species had to "make sense of the complex world in which it evolved: to classify, or group into categories, the objects and events within its awareness" (2003: 355). These categories are not given to us through our senses; they have to be "construed". In taking this position on the active role of grammar in construing "reality", Halliday was influenced by Benjamin Lee Whorf. He believes that the systems which come under the logical function are logico-semantic relations.

The textual function, through which meanings are formed and ideas are expressed. The textual function belongs to a distinct category of function, which needs careful study and research. Many researches about the textual function has found that the key of the study about this function is the cohesive linking or ties, which put different elements in a clause together both grammatically and semantically. These cohesive ties or bounding ties bind various parts in a logical way and make it (the text or discourse) a clear and logically structured text or discourse.

The textual function has drew huge attention from many scholars. Most of their studies center on the study of the analysis of the discourse, what we call discourse analysis. The discourse analysis normally includes two closely linked steps: the first step is to have a good understanding of the literal meaning of the text. The second step is to make comments about the discourse, during which the underlying cultural reasons and relevant certain context should be seriously taken into account. The analysis of a certain discourse must be put into a certain context, because the change of a certain context could possibility change the meaning of a whole discourse. Therefore, context determines the meaning of a certain text or discourse to a certain degree in a definite way. And careful illustrations of some examples are strongly needed, which plays a key and vital role in illustrating the usage of the textual function.

The textual function provides the possibility for the language speakers or readers to make a bridge and linking between language and the exact context. In this way, the language could be unified and ordered. And the textual function is also closely linked with any other grammatical choices because the realization of the

function should also need to depend on the wide usage of many grammatical choices. The text or the discourse should be a grammatical readable text or discourse first, then there exists the possibility of being a well-organized text or discourse.

The interpersonal function means one of the metafunctions which could be used to express certain or various social relations. A speaker or the reader first should be a person who is willing to communicate or talk with others, therefore the interpersonal function is a must to communicate social relationship of friendships. Language is not a object by itself, because it could be used to express the world, the facts as well as certain relations. The social networks in the world we live and experience provide the wide space for individuals to communicate and talk with others in a certain way. And through the usage of the function, the degree of the similarity of the relationship could also be seen clearly and obviously. So the function is a must for the survival of human beings. Halliday argues that these encounters:

> range all the way from the rapidly changing microencounters of daily life-most centrally, semiotic encounters where we set up and maintain complex patterns of dialogue-to the more permanent institutionalized relationships that collectively constitute the social bond. (Halliday 2003: 16)

These metafunctions belong to groups, in other words, they belong to the same category. These three metafunctions work simultaneously and automatically. Theoretically speaking, any sentences or clauses can be analyzed from these three function systems, that is the ideational function, the interpersonal function, and the textual function. Due to these three metafunctions, it is possible that different parts of a sentence could be organized into a coherent sentence or clause. Hence these functions provide a mechanism and way for language speakers or writers to organize an utterance into a logical one in a logical way, which is the symbol of adults' language. Halliday holds that any sentence or clause is a balance between these functions.

3. Research Design

According to statistics, in recent 10 years, the growth rate of GDP (Gross Domestic Product) is the highest during the period 2010-2014, and the research subjects are texts on economy. Therefore, our research period ranges from 1st January, 2010 to 3rd March, 2013. And many important events occurred during this period, which drew media's widespread attention: Shanghai Exposition 2010, celebration of the CPC's (Communist Party of China) 90th anniversary and so on.

Beijing Review has a total of 167 issues from 1st January, 2010 to 3rd March, 2013. As a result of the large target population, conducting sampling survey is necessary. After careful analysis of the news text and considering the disadvantages and advantages of different sampling methods, the paper adopts systematic random sampling method. *Beijing Review* has a total of 167 issues from 1st January, 2010 to 3rd March, 2013. The 167 issues are taken as 167 elements. Choose an element with a random start and take it as the first sample. Each issue works as a sampling unit. The sampling interval is 2. After the sampling process, 84 elements are chosen, with a total of 1,304 pieces of news article. The texts are

further divided according to the following categories: a. Financial Policies and Planning; b. Economy at Home and Abroad, Financial Conferences; c. Economic Situation and Economic Construction; d. Finance, Business Cooperation and Conflicts; e. Chinese Enterprises and Multinational Corporations; f. Others.

4. Data Analysis

In order to reveal *Beijing Review*'s focus on China Economy and Finance more deeply, the thesis further classifies the reports on China Economy and Finance into sub-topics. The details are as follows:

Topics	Percentage
Financial Policies and Planning	30.18
Economy at home and Abroad, Financial Conferences	6.80
Economic Situation and Economic Construction	36.98
Finance, Business Cooperation and Conflicts	11.54
Chinese Enterprises and Multinational Corporations	7.40
Others	7.10

Table 31 Distribution of Topics about China's Economy and Finance from 2010 to 2013

Table 31 shows that *Beijing Review* has the largest amount of coverage about China's economic situation and economic construction with a total number of 125 articles, accounting for 36.98%. This is because under the impact of world economic crisis, the global economy experienced downturn, while China's economy maintained steady growth. As an external communication publication with the CPC's central level, *Beijing Review* has the responsibility to report promptly the latest developments of China's economy.

The ideational function means language is used to communicate and convey information and it mainly consists of "transitivity system", "voice", "classification system", and "transformation system". The interpersonal function involves the the function to show the speaker's or writer's status, position, attitude, or even inference. And it is mainly realized by mood and modality system. Modality system can be used to express the speaker's or writer's attitude or opinion to show the authority. The textual function mainly concerns the organization and structure of the discourse or the text. And it is mainly realized by the thematic structure, information structure and cohesion. Considering the relevance, this paper mainly explores "transitivity system", "modality system" and "classification system".

4.1. Modality System

Halliday holds that modality system is a useful way to express interpersonal meaning. The modality system of interpersonal meaning further reflects the social interaction between social participants. The speaker or the writer can communicate his or her attitudes and go a further step to influence the hearer's or reader's attitudes

and actions. The speaker judges the success and validity of his or her own proposition, request the other party to undertake the obligations, or expresses his or her own wishes in proposal.

Analysis of modality system has two purposes: (1) to clarify the speaker's or the writer's responsibility and obligation on the authenticity of discourse proposition. (2) to understand the speaker's or the writer's attitudes towards the hearer (reader) to show the social distance between the speaker (writer) and hearer (reader).

Modal verbs, modal adjectives, adverbs, tense, and personal pronouns can be used to express modal meaning. Taking correlation into account, the paper focuses on the analysis of the choice of modal verbs. Halliday classifies modal values into three types: "Low Value", "Medium Value" and "High Value" based on the the speaker's or the writer's responsibility and obligation on the authenticity of discourse proposition. The speaker's or the writer's tone of seriousness can also be revealed by classifying modal values.

Modal Verbs	**Frequency**	**Value**	**Total Frequency**	**Percentage**
Can	24	Low Value	39	19.40
Could	9			
May	6			
Will	75	Medium Value	133	66.17
Should	42			
Would	9			
Will not	3			
Is to	2			
May not	1			
Should not	1			
Must	10	High Value	29	14.42
Need to	8			
Have/Has to	6			
Can not	5			
Total	**201**		**201**	**100**

Table 32 Modal Verbs Counting

Table 32 reveals that modality verbs of medium value have the highest frequency, accounting for 66.17%. Modality verbs of low value have the second highest frequency, accounting for 19.40%. Among all the modality verbs of medium value, 'will' has the highest frequency with a total of 75 times, and mainly involves two aspects: speculation about the future and promise-making. Examples for speculation are as follows.

(1) To be more specific, the Chinese economy **will** score a higher growth rate in the first half of this year than in the second half. The annual GDP growth is expected to reach 9 percent. The growth of investment **will** remain high, but may experience a slow down compared to 2009. The growth for fixed seeets is expected to exceed 20 percent this year.

(2) China's interaction with the rest of the world must be taken into account. As China's role in the global economy increases, including through increased outward investment, its development and policies **will** have increasing impacts on global markets and other countries, which needs to be factored into policy-making. Meanwhile, working in concert with other countries, China **will** be involved in tackling a range of issues on global and regional public goods, including matters concerning the environment.

The reporter expects to express the following ideas through the usage of 'will': China will maintain economic growth and still be the engine of world economic recovery in spite of the world economic crisis; China will have a stronger saying in and influence on world economic affairs, changing the world economic structure.

Examples for promise-making can be found below:

(3) Chinese president Hu Jintao told a celebratory rally held in Shenzhen on September 6 that the Central Government **will** always support the country's special economic zones embarking on brave exploration in their roles as first-movers.

(4) In the 12th Five-Plan period, China **will** press ahead with a series of businesses, such as banking, logistics, hi-tech services and tourism. Moreover, it pledged to enhance financing support to the sector and push forward ferorms to make productive service companies eligible for a deduction in value-added tax.

'Will', a medium value verb, is mainly used to express the promises about the economic development made by central government leaders. The reporter attributes China's economic development to the efforts of the central government, thus presenting an image of a powerful central government with vigorous leaders.

It also should be pointed out that 'will' mainly appears in the form of news reported speech in *Beijing Review*'s coverage, which make news coverage seem objective and convincing.

(5) Wang Wei, chief editor of Hexun.com, published the Hexun 2013 Forecast on Macro Economy, predicting that China's GDP **will** rise 7.8 percent in 2013, which is the same as the previous predication of the Standard Chartered Bank.

(6) According to a survey by the global investment banking and securities firm Goldman Sachs, China's consumption on luxury goods **will** reach 14.6 billion U.S dollars in the next five years, and the number of people who are willing to pay for luxury goods **will** exceed 100 million.

The reporter expresses his or her wishes and confidence in China's economic development through quoting words by the authority. The reporter reveals the idea that China's economy is full of vigor and energy, which is highly recognized both home and abroad. The Chinese economy still develops fast in a balanced way and with the controllable speed. Huge achievements have been made, despite the fact that there has been many obstacles and difficulties during the process of the development. Especially China's scientific development has been catching up with other developed countries.

4.2. Transitivity System

Transitivity is a key and necessary mode of language which can be used to represent another function of language, that is, the ideational function. The world that we live in consists of a lot of procedures or processes. We human beings have a lot of experience about the world we live in. Therefore, these predictable and manageable processes could be used to express the unmanageable experience that we human beings have. Normally when scholars analyze the transitivity system, they often are concerned about the participants or the phenomena, etc.

Transitivity system (the grammar experience) normally includes six types of processes: material process, verbal process, mental process, relational process, behavioral process and existential process. Different processes has its own features. Our consciousness world and the real world we human beings live in may distinguish the different processes. Material process, mental process and relational process are the three most important processes.

Material process involves actions, that is, the process of doing something, and usually consists of target (goal), actor, and action verb. Our consciousness world often involves the unreal things like human beings' imagination, thinking or brainstorming. It is closely related to human beings' inner experience. This particular type of process is named mental process. Then there is a third type of process: we learn to generalize, to relate one fragment of experience to another. It does this by classifying or identifying: this is that, this is one of that. There are three non-major processes. They are verbal process, behavioral process, and the existential process.

These three processes have its own characteristics, but may share some common features with one or the other. There is not any definite border or distinction between them. The behavioral process means the doing-things or the outer representation of inner consciousness or inner ideas. The behavioral process is closely related to the inner mind and thinking and it is much more concerned with the physiological conditions.

Verbal process belongs to another distinct category. It is concerned with the language speaking and communicating. And through this process the ideas and information are delivered and passed on from the speaker to the hearer in an oral way. Finally, there exists the existential process, which is closely related to the state of being existing or just being. And this process lies in the border between the material process and the relational process.

After studying the text, the thesis finds out that material process and verbal process appear frequently. The details are as follows:

Media / Processes	*Beijing Review* Times
Material Process	240
Verbal Process	35

Table 33 Material and Verbal Processes Counting. For convenience, the thesis analyzes the processes of main clauses instead of subordinate clauses.

Table 33 shows that the material process appears 240 times. Material process involves actions, that is, the process of doing something, and usually consists of target (goal), actor, and action verb. Material processes in *Beijing Review* are used to describe the performance and operation of china's national economy, as shown below:

(7) This year (2010), credit will not **shrink** dramatically. Monetary liquidity will still **suffice**. It is estimated that the M2 increase will **hit** 18 percent, and new loans will **total** 8 trillion yuan.

(8) Unemployment was fundamental **mitigated** and employment, especially for migrant workers, **improved** dramatically.

(9) Once a small fishing village, Shenzhen has **evolved** into a large city over the past three decades. It is home to the Shenzhen Stock Exchange as well as headquarters of many hi-tech companies. Shenzhen's population has **grown** from less than 40,000 to nearly 14 million over the past three decades. In 2009, Shenzhen's GDP **reached** 820.1 billion yuan ($120.6 billion), 979 times more than that of 1979, **representing** an annual growth rate of 25.8 percent.

The reporter paints a dynamic economy of China by using a series of material verbs. Material verbs are often connected with actions or doing things. Through using these material verbs to describe the economy of China, it seems that the reader or the hearer can just experience the fast growth and movement, the new outlook that the economy is facing. He or she could be a witness who in person has witnessed the achievements that the economy has achieved.

Verbal process appears 35 times in *Beijng Review*'s coverage. Verbal process means the act to talk, to express ideas, to communicate ideas through chattering, talking and orally communicating. And through this process the ideas and information are delivered from the speaker to the hearer. It is usually realized by the usage of news reported speech. News reporting, as a kind of message text, emphasizes the source types of news reported speech, which makes news coverage appear objective and true. Different source types reflect different views and attitudes. Reporting forms and source types of news reported speech are as follows:

Sources / Reporting Forms	Academic Experts	Government Officials	Senior Corporate Executives	International Organizations
	Explicit Source			Implicit Source
Indirect Speech	8	9	6	1
Direct Speech	5	3	2	0

Table 34 Reporting Forms and Source Types of News Reported Speech

Table 34 reveals that the source types of news reported speech mainly involves two kinds: explicit source and implicit source. There are 33 news reported speeches which originate from explicit source, while only 1 news reported speech originates from implicit source. Explicit source mainly includes academic experts, government officials, senior corporate executives and international organizations, which make the news coverage appear more authoritative and definitive, for example,

(10) "We hope to promote the growth of credit consumption with the launch of new projects," said Wu Enlong, General Manager of the Beijing Branch of Suning Appliance Co. Ltd. (Corporate Executive)

(11) Shenzhen has played a role as bridge for the mainland to strengthen exchanges and cooperation with Hong Kong, Macao and Taiwan for the nation's prosperity, stability and peaceful reunification under the principle of "one country, two systems," Hu Jintao said. (Government Official)

(12) Chen Xikang, a research fellow at the Chinese Academy of Sciences said at the forum that the World Bank's predication is reasonable. "But only if domestic and international circumstances are stable, and there is no deviation of national policies, can China witness an 8.4-percent growth rate," he said. (Academic Expert)

Another conclusion can be made is that indirect speech is used more frequently than direct speech. Indirect speech appears 24 times, while direct speech only appears 10 times. Indirect speech is a retelling of the speaker's words, thus may be inconsistent with the speaker's original intentions. The teller is much more free to interfere in other words by using indirect speech rather than direct speech, thus making readers feel confused. The reporter then can express his or her views covertly, for example,

(13) In the government work report delivered on March 5, Premier Wen Jiabao also stressed China still faces an extremely complex economic situation this year. (Indirect Speech)

(14) According to Li Chang'an, associate professor at the School of Public Administration of the University of International Business and Economics, the root cause of China's weak domestic demand is structural imbalance in demands. (Indirect Speech)

4.3. Classification System

Hallliday holds that classification is one of the ways to express the ideational function of language. It refers to understand, classify the world and then assign meaning and order to the world. It is the most fundamental way to know the world. The classification system usually refers to the naming, description of people and events by discourse and is mainly realized through the variety of the vocabulary. However, language is not always objective, so it may not reflect the events and people's innate characteristics because it may be influenced by language users' cognitive level and emotions, etc. Different views towards the world lead to different principles of classification.

The high frequency content words in news coverage can reflect the themes of the coverage and the intentions of the reporter to a certain degree. The thesis finds out the most frequent content words and counts their relevant frequency of the eight pieces of news articles in the descending order, and lemmatizes them where needed through making use of the Word Counter. The details are as follows:

Content Words	**Frequency**
Growth	80
Economy	55
Price	48
Consumption	38
Government	36
Policy	32
Increase	31
Investment	31

Table 35 High Frequency Content Words (Descending Order)

These content words of high frequency in the above news coverage reflect China's economic situation. During China's economic development, there exist a lot of problems, such as high commodity price and inflation, etc. However, it is an indisputable fact that China's economy has maintained steady growth, even under the impact of global economic crisis: domestic investment keeps increasing and booming; domestic demands, especially domestic consumption have become the engine of economic growth. China's economic miracle is attributed to the government's efforts, such as effective policies.

5. Discussion

Hofstede defines the individualism and collectivism as:

> "Individualism stands for a society in which the ties between individuals are loose: Everyone is expected to look after him/herself and her/his immediate family only. Collectivism stands for a society in which people from birth onwards are integrated into strong, cohesive in-groups, which throughout people's lifetime continue to protect them inexchange for unquestioning loyalty. (Hofstede 2001: 225)"

The news report reflects one country's political system. China belongs to collectivism country. Andersen and his colleagues describe the traits of individualism and collectivism as follows: "Collectivistic cultures emphasize community, collaboration, shared interest, harmony, tradition, the public good, and maintaining face. (2003: 77)"

While individualistic countries stress freedom, privacy, critical comments, and members in these cultures firmly hold that the rights and freedom of the individual can not be deprived. The paper finds out that in terms of modality system, modal verbs are especially emphasized. Modality verbs of medium value have the highest frequency, accounting for 66.17%. Modality verbs of low value have the second highest frequency, accounting for 19.40%, while modality verbs of high value appear the least. Just as Andersen and his colleagues describe community, harmony, and maintaining face are important key words for collectivism, thus modality verbs of medium value and low value are much more preferred to than modality verbs of high value. Modal verbs of medium value and low value are less compulsive and stressful than modal verbs of high value, which is consistent with Andersen and his colleagues' description.

Mulder (1977) holds that power distance means "the degree of inequality in power". It reveals that China is a country of high power distance, which relates to another term "hierarchy". Chinese people get used to being consistent with the authority, the power consciously or unconsciously, therefore in terms of transitivity system, verbal process mainly appears in the form of news reported speech with explicit source, which originates from academic experts, government officials, senior corporate executives, and international organizations. Academic experts, government officials, senior corporate executives, and international organizations all belong to the authority, and the power to a certain degree.

Different cultures in the world have distinct attitudes towards uncertainty and other things that the human beings do not know or are not familiar with. In some cultures, most of the members are afraid to face the changes and new things and they think it is stressful of them to confront with uncertainty. However, in other cultures, most of the members tend to be willing to face new changes and potential possible obstacles and difficulties. In other words, they feel less stressed or would not feel threatened and intimidated by new or unexpected things. In high uncertainty avoidance cultures, individuals attempt to refrain from uncertain and ambiguous things through forming strict principles, bills and prevent non-mainstream behaviors and things from happening. In these cultures, individuals normally have higher and stronger degree of fear, anxiety, and worries.

6. Conclusion

After careful analysis, the research finds out that the English language of Beijing Review has the following features: (1) in terms of modality system, modal verbs are especially emphasized. Modality verbs of medium value have the highest frequency, accounting for 66.17%. Modality verbs of low value have the second highest frequency, accounting for 19.40%. Among all the modality verbs of medium value, "will" has the highest frequency with a total of 75 times, and involves two

aspects: speculation about the future and promise-making. (2) in terms of transitivity system, material process appears the most frequently, with a total of 240 times. Verbal process mainly appears in the form of news reported speech with explicit source, which originates from academic experts, government officials, senior corporate executives and international organizations. Another conclusion can be made that indirect speech is used more frequently than direct speech. Indirect Speech appears 24 times, while direct speech only apperas ten times. (3) in terms of classification system, the choice of high frequency content words is strongly emphasized.

China is a country of high uncertainty avoidance, therefore, in *Beijing Review* verbal process mainly appears in the form of news reported speech with explicit and clear source. And this is in agreement with the culture to refrain from uncertain and ambiguous things.

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One City, Two Stories: Competing Discursive Constructions of Post-colonial Hong Kong in Chinese and American Newspapers

Liu Ming

Sun Yat-sen University

Abstract

This article gives a corpus-assisted discourse study of the representations of post-colonial Hong Kong from 2000 to 2017 in one Chinese English newspaper, i.e., China Daily (CD), and two American newspapers, i.e., the New York Times, and the Washington Post. Through a combination of corpus linguistics and the discourse-historical approach of critical discourse analysis, this study examines not only their preferential choice for frames, topics, and discourses but also the discursive strategies employed for the constructions of the key parties concerning Hong Kong, i.e., people, government, and Chinese mainland. The findings suggest that these newspapers tend to align with their national interests in constructing their own stories of post-colonial Hong Kong.

Keywords: Hong Kong, corpus-assisted discourse study, critical discourse analysis, news media, China, the US

1. Introduction

Twenty years have passed since China resumed the exercise of sovereignty over Hong Kong on 1 July 1997. Despite all the challenges and difficulties, Hong Kong still maintains a high degree of autonomy and its status as an international financial hub. However, worries and concerns over the future of Hong Kong as promised by the Sino-British Joint Declaration and the Basic Law never ceased (Cheng & Lam, 2010, 2013). Hong Kong was thus subject to the extensive scrutiny of dominant Western media, and any incident in Hong Kong had the potential of turning into global media events (Bhatia, 2015, 2016). It strained the nerves of the Chinese government, because it could bring damages to its international image, an issue of great concern to the Chinese government in recent years as it tried to cultivate a friendly international environment for its domestic development. It spurred the Chinese government to communicate to the external world its own stories about Hong Kong with its own official English news media. In this sense, the "news war over Hong Kong" (C.-C. Lee, Chan, Pan, & So, 2002), instead of simmering, still lingered on in the last two decades.

Viewing discourse as a social practice, critical discourse analysis (CDA) argues that international newsmaking is both socially shaped and socially shaping (Fairclough, 1995; van Dijk, 1988a, 1988b). Rather than a mere objective reflection of reality, it serves as an important site of ideological struggles and conflicts, under

the influence of a host of social, economic, political, and ideological factors (Shoemaker & Reese, 1996). This contributes to the different or even competing representations of the same issue by news media from different socio-political backgrounds, which can shape public understandings of a certain issue in a particular discourse community and contribute to a discourse community's self-imaginations (Li, 2010). Therefore, the last two decades have witnessed the growing interest in the critical examination of the representations of the same issue by media from different socio-political grounds (Haarman & Lombardo, 2009; Li, 2010; Murata, 2007; Seo, 2013). Apart from the particular ways of representing the same issue, these studies have also revealed the intricate relations between discourse, power and ideology and the role of media discourse in the production and reproduction of power abuse and dominance (Van Dijk, 2001).

Previous studies on press representations of Hong Kong's handover in 1997 demonstrated that the representations of the event in news media from different countries tend to be filtered by the local prism of national interests (Cao, 1999, 2000; C.-C. Lee, Chan, Pan, & So, 2000; C.-C. Lee et al., 2002; Shi-Xu & Feng, 2003). Given the great changes that have taken place in Hong Kong during the last two decades, there is still little information about whether the same trend continued in Chinese and Western media's representations of post-colonial Hong Kong. This study gives an extensive corpus-assisted discourse study of the representations of Hong Kong in Chinese and American English newspapers from 2000 to 2017. It has three objectives: (1) to examine their preferential ways of representing Hong Kong at different levels of discourse; (2) to explicate the socio-political factors behind their ways of representations; and (3) to contribute to the growing literature of corpus-assisted discourse studies.

2. Contextualization of the present study

The US media's strong interest in post-colonial Hong Kong is not surprising in view of the substantial economic and political interests the US has long maintained in Hong Kong (Martin, 2007). As early as in 1992, the US Congress passed the United States-Hong Kong Policy Act (P.L. 102-383) in the name of protecting Hong Kong's autonomy, prosperity, and way of life after its handover. It promised to treat a special entity from the rest of China if Hong Kong could maintain its autonomy after handover, and empowered the President of the US to determine the status of Hong Kong's autonomy (Martin, 2007). In so doing, the US volunteered to be the "guardian" of Hong Kong after its handover in 1997 (C.-C. Lee et al., 2002), and the representations of Hong Kong in US news media affect not only US public understandings of post-colonial Hong Kong but also US government's policies on Hong Kong.

Therefore, in their coverage of Hong Kong's handover in 1997, the US media tended to align with their national interests to "bang the democracy drum" in their representations of the event (Lee, Pan, Chan, & So, 2001). By emphasizing the threat of the erosion of the freedom and democracy in Hong Kong under Chinese rule, they constructed the US a new "guardian" of Hong Kong in an emerging war between the West and China. They were inclined to represent Hong Kong as a

legacy of British colonial rule and a "bequest" to the Chinese government, and advised the Chinese government to keep its hands off Hong Kong so that it can be rewarded economically and politically (Shi-Xu & Kienpointner, 2005). By contrast, Chinese news media preferred to represent Hong Kong as a victim of British colonial rule and the Chinese government as the savior of China (Cao, 2000).

However, with the smooth transfer of Hong Kong's sovereignty to Hong Kong, scholarly attention to media representations of Hong Kong has gradually cooled down. There were only some case studies on media representations of a certain issue or event in post-handover Hong Kong, such as the Umbrella Movement (Bhatia, 2015), the right-of-abode issue (Flowerdew, Li, & Tran, 2002; Pan, 2002), national education debate (Cheng & Ho, 2014), the 2005 Chief Executive Election (Zhang & Mihelj, 2012), democracy debate (Oksanen, 2011), and demonstrations (Chan & Lee, 2006; Flowerdew & Leong, 2010). Few studies gave an extensive examination of Western media representations of Hong Kong over a long period of time (Cheng & Lam, 2010, 2013), and even fewer are these studies devoted to an extensive comparative study of the representations of post-colonial Hong Kong in Chinese and American news media. Besides, the majority of these studies took either quantitative content analysis or qualitative critical discourse analysis as their main analytic approach, with only few exceptions (Cheng & Lam, 2010, 2013; Zhang & Mihelj, 2012). This study is going to fill the gap by giving a CADS study of the representations of Hong Kong in Chinese and American newspapers from 2000 to 2017.

3. Corpus-assisted discourse studies

The potentials and benefits of using corpus linguistics (CL) methods in (critical) discourse analysis have been widely discussed in recent years (Mautner, 2009, 2016). However, unlike previous studies of using CL methods in CDA, a CADS approach has been known for its emphasis on the "synergy" or "balanced" combination of CL and CDA (Baker et al., 2008; Partington, 2004; Partington, Duguid, & Taylor, 2013). It means that one discipline should not be subordinate to the other, and the methods and theories in both disciplines should be integrated in a balanced way in order to make the most efficient analysis of the large quantities of data. In other words, it values not only the efficient and automatic quantitative analysis of large quantities of data with corpus linguistic theories and methods, but also the detailed qualitative analysis of some linguistic patterns in their specific contexts of use. Therefore, the analyst has to move constantly between results generated by automatic corpus-analytic software and the contextualized analysis of some linguistic patterns in order to present ingenious analysis for the research undertaken (Morley & Bayley, 2009).

This study combines the discourse-historical approach (DHA) (Reisigl & Wodak, 2016) with CL methods. DHA distinguishes itself from other approaches in CDA by its emphasis on the analysis of discourse in its socio-historical contexts. It values not only the analysis of contradictions and paradoxes in text-internal or discourse-internal structures but also the explanation of the manipulative nature of language in terms of its socio-historical contexts. It proposes to analyse texts at

three different levels: (1) the *content* and *topics* of a specific discourse; (2) *discursive strategies*; and (3) *linguistic means* (as types) and context-dependent *linguistic realizations* (as tokens). The typical discursive strategies identified include nomination or referential strategy, predication, argumentation, perspectivization, and intensification/ mitigation (Reisigl & Wodak, 2016). Besides, DHA has also been noted for "its endeavor to work with different approaches, multi-methodically and on the basis of a variety of empirical data as well as background information" (Wodak, 2001, p. 65).

The CL methods employed for the present study include keywords, collocates, concordance, semantic preference, semantic prosody. Keywords refer to these words which are statistically more frequently used in one corpus when compared with their use in another corpus, and it can suggest the "aboutness" of a corpus (Baker et al., 2008). The analysis of keywords in a corpus can reveal not only the preferential topics and themes but also suggest the entry points for further analysis. Collocates refer to these words which occur at both sides of a lexical item under investigation within a pre-determined span (usually five words), and the relations between the two words are called collocation (Sinclair, 1991). The collocates of a lexical item can suggest the semantic preference and semantic prosody of a lexical item. Semantic preference refers to the tendency of a lexical item to co-occur with items with similar semantic features, while semantic prosody refers to the consistent attitudinal meanings associated with a lexical item (Louw, 1993, p. 157). They can further suggest the discursive strategies employed in the construction of a certain social actor or phenomenon (Baker et al., 2008).

4. Methodology

This study is based on two large corpora: the CD corpus and the NW corpus. The NW corpus collects all the news texts with *Hong Kong* in two influential American quality newspapers, i.e., the *New York Times* and the *Washington Post*. The two newspapers are selected due to their agenda-setting influences in both the US and the international world. The CD corpus collects all the news texts containing *Hong Kong* in *China Daily* (CD). As the most influential English newspaper in China, CD shoulders the responsibility of communicating the voices of the Chinese government to the external world, and represents a typical party organ. The exact time span set for data collection is from 1 January 2000 to 30 July 2017. All the news texts were extracted from the electronic news database *Lexis-Nexis* with the keyword search of *Hong Kong*. They were further examined manually in order to exclude the irrelevant news texts, and built into two large corpora: the CD corpus (2,325,730 tokens) and the NW corpus (2,033,823 tokens).

This study proposes a bipartite analysis of the corpora with a view to presenting complementary perspectives for the analysis of the discursive constructions of Hong Kong in two large corpora. It starts from a bottom-up keyword analysis of the corpora in order to identify their preferential frames, topics, and discourses in their representations of Hong Kong. Framing refers to the practice of "*select[ing] some aspects of a perceived reality and make them more salient in a communicating text, in such a way as to promote a particular problem definition, causal*

interpretation, moral evaluation, and/or treatment recommendation [Italicized in the original]" (Entman, 1993, p. 52). Since frames can be revealed through the presence and absence of certain keywords, so the two corpora were first compared with each other with the corpus-analytic tool Wordsmith 7.0, and two keyword lists were produced. The keyword list ranks the keywords by their keyness values. The higher a keyword's keyness value is, the more statistically significant the keyword is. The present study focuses on the top 100 keywords in each corpus, and they were first classified into different semantic fields based on the meanings they express. They can suggest their different preferences for frames. Besides, a close examination of these keywords in each semantic field can also reveal their different choice of topics and discourses. Discourses here refer to the representation of social reality from a particular perspective (Fairclough, 2003).

The keyword analysis is further complemented by a collocate analysis of the key lexical item *Hong Kong* in the two corpora. With the help of Wordsmith 7.0, the concordance lines of Hong Kong in both corpora were further extracted, and its collocates were further computed in order to examine what aspects of Hong Kong were emphasized in both corpora. Then the key parties emphasized in both corpora, as suggested by the strong lexical collocates of *Hong Kong*, were further examined with the view of examining to what extent the two corpora vary in their representations of these key parties. In so doing, this study gives a close analysis of the two corpora at different levels in order to reveal the particular ways of representing Hong Kong in the two corpora. A bipartite analysis of the corpora is supposed to reveal the differences at both the macro and the micro levels, thus yielding more illuminating findings.

5. Findings

5.1. Analysis of the keywords in the two corpora

As Table 36 below shows, the top 100 keywords in both corpora are categorized into five groups: (1) political, (2) Economic, (3) Place, and (4) Others. The exact keywords in both corpora are shown in Table 36. In CD, there are only 5 political keywords, including *NPC, CPPCC, vice, premier,* and *principle*. *NPC* refers to "National People's Congress", CPPCC to "the Chinese People's Political Consultative Conference". *Principle* refers to the principle of "one country, two systems". The prominence of these political keywords in CD is unsurprising, because they are typical expressions in the Chinese political context. However, CD is noted for its preference for economic keywords (38), suggesting that CD prefers to represent Hong Kong with an economic frame. The preference for an economic frame is consistent with the Chinese government's wish to depoliticize the city through the promotion of economic stability and prosperity of Hong Kong (Vickers & Kan, 2003). By contrast, NW shows the predominance of political keywords (44) but the scarcity of economic keywords (6). Among the six economic keywords, the majority refer to the telephone companies "Cable Wireless HKT" and the "Pacific

Century CyberWorks". The preference for representing Hong Kong with a political frame is also in line with the US government's emphasis on democracy and freedom as the basis for Hong Kong's continued prosperity (Flowerdew, 2012).

Types	CD	NW
Political	*NPC, CPPCC, vice, premier, principle*	*democracy, movement, demonstrations, colony, democratic, umbrella, crackdown, freedom, liberties, civil, legislature, politics, censorship, vigil, spray, umbrellas, pepper, freedoms, charges, protests, elections, tear, communist, party, protesters, officials, vote, leaders, leader, Snowden, student, activists, advocates, candidates, parties, supporters, politicians, democrats, critics, activist, arrest, protest, controlled, demonstrators*
Economic	*yuan, development, CO, IPO, products, cooperation, service, operation, index, tourism, CEPA, RMB, securities, IPOS, GDP, projects, exhibition, EXPO, belt, quality, denominated, innovation, LTD, prosperity, mega, exchanges, turnover, CEO, enterprises, CORP, Hang, Inc, management, Seng, BOC, listed, forum, initiative*	*cable, wireless, HKT, cyberworks, dollars, telephone*
Place	*HK, US, Shanghai, administrative, SAR, Macao, special, Shenzhen, region, UK, overseas, Guangdong, HKSAR, regions, capital, province, center, Guangzhou, mainland's, zone, offshore, sectors, sector, Zhuhai, Delta, River, Qianhai, SAR's, provincial, Pearl, bridge*	*Tiananmen, States, American, British, Beijing's, territory's, territory, streets, Britain, Square, apartment, Macau, neighborhood, Washington, prison, Vatican, harbor*
Others	*photo, music, dance, festival, games, actor, actress, opportunities, stability, connect, launch, boost, launched, cross, promote, enhance, provided, cent, per, yesterday, total, due, km, pm, implementation, says*	*disease, fear, concessions, illness, anger, web, newspaper, journalists, Google, twitter, say, Kongers, crowd, Bradsher, Joshua, Keith, Falun, spread, wrote, Mr., pro, Ms., here, Dr, Mrs., thousands, appeared, hundreds, seemed, appears, semiautonomous, they're, prominent*

Table 36 Top 100 keywords in CD and NW

Since CD is concerned with the economic development of Hong Kong, its topics include Hong Kong's economic performances (i.e., *development, GDP*, *prosperity*), stock market (*IPO*, *Index*, *securities*, *turnover*, *IPOS*), currency exchanges (*yuan*, *RMB*, *denominated*, *exchanges*), the cooperation between Hong Kong and China's mainland (*CEPA*, *co*, *operation*, *cooperation*), exhibition (*exhibition*, *EXPO*), and the Belt and Road Initiative (*belt*, *initiative*). They help to construct Hong Kong as an international financial hub. The political topics in NW include democracy (i.e., *democracy*), the elections of Chief executives (i.e., *candidates*, *elections*, *vote*), the legislation (i.e., *legislature*), individual freedoms (i.e., *freedom*, *freedoms*), and the protests and movement (i.e., *movement*, *demonstrations*, *umbrellas*, *protests*), and the crackdown on the protests (i.e., *crackdown*, *vigil*, *spray*, *tear*, *peppers*). They help to construct Hong Kong as a place of political turmoil.

Therefore, CD is characterized by a harmony-driven discourse (Wu, Huang, & Liu, 2015). It prefers to represent Hong Kong from a positive perspective by focusing on the development, prosperity, stability, and opportunities in Hong Kong. This can also be seen from the verb keywords in CD which carry positive evaluative meanings, such as *implementation*, *connect*, *launch*, *boost*, *launched*, *promote*, and *enhanced*. They all emphasize what has been done and improved, thus suggesting the achievements that have been made in Hong Kong. NW features the preference for conflict-driven discourse (De Vreese & Tobiasen, 2007; Wu & Ng, 2011). It prefers to highlight the conflicts occurring in Hong Kong, especially the protests (*movement*, *demonstrations*, *protests*, *protesters*, *protest*), and the crackdown on these protests (*crackdown*, *vigil*, *spray*, *tear*, *charges*, *arrest*, *controlled*). It can also be seen from the emotion keywords *fear* and *anger*, and the emphasis on diseases that took place in Hong Kong (i.e., *illness*, and *disease*). In other words, CD tends to represent Hong Kong in the positive light, UW always in the negative light.

5.2. Analysis of key parties concerning Hong Kong

An examination of the lexical item *Hong Kong* in both corpora finds that it has 31,372 instances in the CD corpus and 22,796 instances in the US corpus. Table 37 shows the most frequent lexical collocates of *Hong Kong* in both corpora.

Rank	CD		NW	
	Collocates	**Freq.**	**Collocates**	**Freq.**
1	*Mainland*	2,130	*Said*	1,243
2	*Said*	2,039	*China*	1,212
3	*Hong*	1,463	*Hong*	1,091
4	*Macao*	1,401	*Chinese*	1,030
5	*Kong*	1,360	*Kong*	960
6	*Special*	1,326	*People*	837
7	*Administrative*	1,249	*Government*	824
8	*Region*	1,172	*Dollars*	779
9	*People*	1,084	*Mainland*	604
10	*Government*	1,067	*Democracy*	586

Table 37 Top 10 collocates of Hong Kong

Among the top 10 lexical collocates, six lexical collocates can be identified in both corpora, including *mainland*, *said*, *Hong*, *Kong*, *people*, and *government*. The frequent collocation of the lexical item *Hong Kong* with *Hong*, *Kong*, and *said* can be attributed to the facts that both corpora are news texts about Hong Kong, and that news texts frequently resort to the speeches of others in their representations. However, the other three collocates *mainland*, *people*, and *government* suggest that both corpora value people and government in Hong Kong and Hong Kong's relations to China's mainland in their representations of Hong Kong. However, in CD, *mainland* (2,130) ranks first, followed in turn by *people* (1084) and *government* (1,067); in NW, *people* (837) ranks the first, followed in turn by *government* (824) and *mainland* (604). Their different rankings suggest the two corpora's different perspectives in the representations of Hong Kong: CD values the relations between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, whereas NW highlights the people and government in Hong Kong. In order to further examine how they vary in the specific ways of representing the three parties concerning Hong Kong, the following sections give a close examination of the concordance lines of the collocation of *Hong Kong* and *people*, *government*, and *mainland* in turn. With Wordsmith 7.0, the concordance lines of the collocation of *Hong Kong* and *people*, *government*, and *mainland* in the two corpora were further extracted respectively, and the collocates of *Hong Kong* in these concordance lines were further computed. The statistical test MI3 (i.e., the mutual information score with the minimum set at 3) was employed to measure the strength of collocation.

5.2.1. *Analysis of the collocation of Hong Kong and people*

Table 38 shows the top 10 lexical collocates of *Hong Kong* in the concordance lines of the collocation of *Hong Kong* and *people* in the two corpora. These collocates suggest that CD emphasizes Chinese policies towards Hong Kong, i.e., "Hong Kong people governing/administering Hong Kong", "one country, two systems", and "a high degree of autonomy". However, while NW also emphasizes Hong Kong people, it is noted for its preference for using intensifying strategy to

highlight the large number of Hong Kong people (such as *many*, *thousands*, and *most*) and the predication strategy to emphasize the young Hong Kong people (e.g., *young*). Besides, an examination of the collocate *ruling* in NW finds that NW prefers to use "Hong Kong people ruling Hong Kong" rather than "Hong Kong governing/administering Hong Kong". *Ruling* differs from *administering*/*governing* in its emphasis on the sovereignty of Hong Kong people, which is certainly against the policy of "one country, two systems".

Rank	CD			NW		
	Collocates	**MI3**	**Freq.**	**Collocates**	**MI3**	**Freq.**
1	*people*	29.13	1084	*people*	27.92	832
2	*Governing*	24.13	95	*Many*	16.92	56
3	*Administering*	21.77	42	*Thousands*	15.89	26
4	*Systems*	20.12	84	*Young*	15.7	26
5	*Degree*	18.95	40	*Hong*	14.61	64
6	*Kong*	18.95	200	*Hong*	14.47	66
7	*Hong*	18.71	196	*Want*	14.17	20
8	*Govern*	17.86	16	*Most*	13.97	26
9	*Country*	17.4	54	*Ruling*	13.92	13
10	*High*	17.17	53	*Said*	13.9	48

Table 38 Top 10 lexical collocates of *Hong Kong* & *people*

A further examination of the collocates of *Hong Kong* in CD finds that the collocation of *Hong Kong* and *people* carries a positive semantic prosody, as can be seen from these collocates, such as *compatriots* (10), *interests* (15), *pride* (7), *enjoy* (12), *support* (18), *unite* (5), *understand* (9), *patriots* (4), *happy* (7), *patriotic* (4), *welcome* (5), and *proud* (4). They emphasize the solidarity between Hong Kong people and the Chinese government. Hong Kong people are nominated as *Hong Kong compatriots*. Not only are the Chinese government concerned with the interests of Hong Kong people, but also Hong Kong people understand the policies of the Chinese government and feel proud of being Chinese. Examples are as follows:

(1) Central government leaders genuinely have the **interests** of Hong Kong *people* at heart. (CD)

(2) The white paper said the policy enjoys growing popularity in Hong Kong, winning the wholehearted support from Hong Kong compatriots as well as *people* in all other parts of China. (CD)

(3) Hong Kong people feel deservedly proud of this accolade. It is not only a recognition of Hong Kong's status as the leading financial center in the region, but also an affirmation of the "one country, two system" principle. (CD)

However, the collocation of *Hong Kong* and *people* in NW carries a negative semantic prosody, as can be seen from these lexical collocates, such as *democracy* (23), *want* (20), *protest* (11), *infected* (9), *right* (9), *rights* (9), *fighting* (7), *freedom* (7), *marched* (7), *arrested* (6), and *killed* (6). They emphasize that Hong Kong

people are dissatisfied with the current state of Hong Kong. They are protesting and fighting for more democracy and rights, and the support for the Chinese government is decreasing. Examples are as follows:

(4) But the most powerful weapon in winning **democracy** for Hong Kong is the *people* of the Umbrella Generation. (NW)
(5) And this is exactly the sore point: Many Hong Kong people simply do not want to be part of mainland China. (NW)
(6) Thousands of *people* marched in Hong Kong on Sunday to **protest** an expected decision by the Chinese government that would effectively block two newly elected politicians from taking their seats in the semiautonomous territory's legislature. (NW)

In both corpora, *young* appears as an strong collocate in these concordance lines. It has 24 instances in CD, and 26 instances in NW. It suggests that both corpora value the role of young people in their representations of Hong Kong. Although CD sometimes gives a general positive evaluation of young Hong Kong people (see example (7)), it emphasizes that they can take advantage of the opportunities brought by Chinese mainland rather than indulge themselves in complaining. Therefore, CD attributes the responsibility for the young people's development to themselves. Examples are as follows:

(7) He also expressed confidence in the **young** people of Hong Kong, saying they are "aspiring, capable, responsible and very promising". (CD)
(8) A growing number of people from Hong Kong, especially **young** entrepreneurs, are seeking opportunities on the mainland. (CD)
(9) "Mainland youngsters are constantly fighting against the clock to build the next major business empire; but **young** people in Hong Kong are still so obsessed with complaining." (CD)

However, NW foregrounds the difficulties of young Hong Kong people and their growing dissatisfaction towards the Chinese government. However, it puts the blame on the Chinese government for turning young Hong Kong people against it. Examples are as follows:

(10) In Hong Kong, **young** people have a real issue with education and jobs. (NW)
(11) "The Chinese Communist Party has turned a whole generation of **young** Hong Kong people against it," Mr. Leung said. (NW)
(12) Mr. Lau said that he and other **young** people in Hong Kong had come to see themselves not as Chinese, but as belonging to a distinct Hong Kong identity. (NW)

5.2.2. *Analysis of the collocation of Hong Kong and government*

In both corpora, the collocation of *Hong Kong* and *government* refers primarily to the Hong Kong government. There are 342 (32.1%) instances of *government* occurring immediately at the R1 position (i.e., the first position to the right) of *Hong Kong*, 490 (59.5%) in NW. However, CD also resorts to other ways of referring to Hong Kong, such as *the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government*,

the Hong Kong SAR government, and *the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (HKSAR) Government*. It can be seen from the collocates *Administrative* (248), *Special* (254), *Region* (234), *SAR* (169), and *HKSAR* (60) in the top 10 lexical collocates of *Hong Kong* (see Table 4). Besides, the top 10 lexical collocates of *Hong Kong* in both corpora also suggest that *government* is also used to refer to the Chinese central government. CD refers to the Chinese central government as *the central government*, and *the Central People's government*, as can be seen from the collocates *central* (176), and *people's* (43). NW refers to the Chinese central government as *the Chinese government*, *Beijing*, *the Beijing government*, and *the central government*, as can be seen from the collocates *Chinese*, *Beijing*, and *central* in the top 10 lexical collocates.

Rank	**CD**			**UW**		
	Words	**MI3**	**Freq.**	**Words**	**MI3**	**Freq.**
1	*Government*	28.96	1,066	*Government*	27.72	824
2	*Administrative*	24.05	248	*Chinese*	17.29	85
3	*Special*	23.82	254	*Said*	16.47	86
4	*Region*	23.32	234	*Beijing*	16.35	57
5	*SAR*	23.04	169	*Headquarters*	16.12	21
6	*Central*	21.98	176	*Central*	15.76	33
7	*HKSAR*	19.34	60	*Official*	13.85	19
8	*Said*	17.21	112	*Talks*	13.59	12
9	*People's*	16.85	43	*Officials*	13.42	22
10	*Support*	16.61	38	*Grope*	13.14	2

Table 39 Top 10 lexical collocates of Hong Kong

However, CD foregrounds the support of the Chinese central government to Hong Kong and the Hong Kong government, as can be seen from the lexical collocates *support* (38), and *supports* (13), *supporting* (5). Examples are as follows:

(13) The central *government* should firmly **support** the Hong Kong SAR government in dealing with all kinds of illegal deeds committed by the opposing factions.

(14) The central government firmly adheres to the One Country, Two Systems policy and **supports** the Hong Kong *government* and chief executive in ruling the city based on the Constitution and the Basic Law, he told Leung.

CD also highlights the policy of "one country, two systems" and the authority of the Hong Kong government. This can be seen from the verb collocates which highlight the power and authority of Hong Kong, such as *issued* (12), *denounced* (2), *shelved* (8), *released* (7), *signed* (7), *welcomed* (7), *dispatched* (3), *donated* (6), *hopes* (6), *maintain* (6), *organized* (6), *commissioned* (3), *urged* (6), *curbing* (2), *committed* (5), *condemned* (5), *decided* (5), *improve* (5), and *promised* (5). In the concordance lines of these collocates, the Hong Kong government often serves as the "Actor" of the action verbs (such as *issued*, *shelved*, *released*) or the "Sayer" of the speech verbs (such as *denounced*, *urged*, and *condemned*) (Fowler, 1991;

Halliday, 1994). Besides, intensifying strategy has also been used to emphasize the Chinese government's support to the Hong Kong government and the power and authority of the Hong Kong government, as can be seen from such adverb collocates as *firmly* (12), *strongly* (7), *steadfastly* (2), and *highly* (6). Examples are as follows:

(15) The Hong *Kong* government has **shelved** highly anticipated talks with student leaders after the latter pledged to continue disruptions to the public. (CD)
(16) The Hong Kong *government* has **dispatched** a 120-strong search team to trace Hong Kong residents, said Secretary for Security Ambrose Lee. (CD)
(17) In a statement, the Hong Kong *government* strongly **condemned** the "violent acts" for endangering public safety and showing a "blatant disregard for the law". (CD)

However, NW foregrounds both the alignment of the Hong Kong government and the Chinese government and the latter's control of the former. The Hong Kong government is either predicated as *Beijing-aligned* (see Example (18)) or occurs together with the Chinese government or Beijing with the conjunction *and* or *or* (see Example (19)). Besides, it even states that the Hong Kong government receives direct order and pressure from the Chinese government, thus suggesting the Chinese government's control of the Hong Kong government and intervention with Hong Kong affairs (see Example (20)).

(18) The traditionally rambunctious news media here faces growing pressure to soft-pedal coverage of Beijing and the **Beijing-aligned** Hong Kong *government*.
(19) "Other pro-establishment parties only blindly support the *central government* **and** the Hong Kong *government*, but the Liberal Party is different," said Mr. Luk, the programmer.
(20) But the demonstrations eventually fizzled after the Hong Kong *government*, under orders from *Beijing*, refused to give any ground, and police moved in to arrest the final protesters and clear the streets.

However, NW downplays the power and authority of the Hong Kong government by emphasizing the talks and negotiations between the protesters and the Hong Kong government, and the challenges and criticisms towards the Hong Kong government, as can be seen from such strong lexical collocates as *talks* (12), *grope* (2), *protesters* (18), *democracy* (20), *advises* (3), *warn* (4), *heed* (3), *promised* (7), *wants* (6), *concessions* (5), *urged* (5), *request* (5), *protest* (8), *challenging* (3), and *criticized* (4). The Hong Kong government often serves as the "Target" of such speech verbs as *advises*, *urged*, *request*, *challenging*, and *criticized*, so it is thus represented as the target of verbal attacks (Fowler, 1991; Halliday, 1994). Examples are as follows:

(21) The **talks** in Hong Kong between pro-Chinese *government* officials and pro-democracy student leaders are aimed mainly at easing tensions in the streets. (NW)
(22) Ms. Quat urged the Hong Kong *government* to **heed** the results of the survey and adopt a complete ban on the ivory trade. (NW)

(23) Ms. Quat **urged** the Hong Kong *government* to heed the results of the survey and adopt a complete ban on the ivory trade. (NW)

(24) Some Hong Kong residents **criticized** the *government* for not providing information about the disease. (NW)

5.2.3. *Analysis of the collocation of Hong Kong and mainland*

In both corpora, the collocation of *Hong Kong* and *mainland* foregrounds the relations between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, as can be seen from the collocates *Chinese* in both corpora (see Table 40). However, *China* can be found in the top 10 lexical collocates of *Hong Kong* in NW rather than in CD. This can be attributed to the different ways of referring to Chinese mainland: *Chinese mainland* in CD, but *mainland China* in NW. The former represents an official Chinese term for Chinese mainland, but the latter represents a popular term which has been widely used in the Western world. The two terms carry different implicatures. *Chinese mainland* implies there is only one China, of which Chinese mainland is a part, while *mainland China* implies that there are different Chinas. Therefore, *mainland China* has now been rarely used in Chinese English media. Likewise, while NW uses *mainland Chinese* to refer to people from Chinese mainland, it is rarely used in CD.

Rank	**CD**			**NW**		
	Collocates	**MI3**	**Freq.**	**Collocates**	**MI3**	**Freq.**
1	*mainland*	30.1	2130	*mainland*	27.45	604
2	*Chinese*	23.69	471	*China*	21.27	205
3	*Taiwan*	20.04	115	*Chinese*	19.36	127
4	*Listed*	19.92	100	*Tensions*	15	12
5	*Companies*	19.68	131	*Visitors*	14.86	16
6	*Macao*	19.06	103	*Birth*	14.37	8
7	*Closer*	18.92	60	*Residents*	14.05	18
8	*Partnership*	18.81	53	*Taiwan*	13.68	17
9	*Arrangement*	18.52	49	*Mothers*	13.56	6
10	*Residents*	18.07	68	*Listed*	13.34	10

Table 40 Top 10 lexical collocates of *Hong Kong*

CD carries the semantic preference for economic cooperation, and it highlights the economic cooperation between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, as can be seen from the collocates *closer* (60), *partnership* (53), *arrangement* (49), and *economic* (83), and *CEPA* (34). CEPA refers to *the Mainland and Hong Kong Closer Economic Partnership Arrangement*. It is an economic agreement signed on 29 June 2003 by the Hong Kong government and the Chinese government, which gives qualifying products, companies and residents of Hong Kong preferential access to the mainland Chinese market. Other strong lexical collocates also emphasize the cooperation and connections between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, such as

cooperation (63), *ties* (24), *link* (14), *connect* (17), *links* (10), *agreement* (13), *integration* (10), *collaborations* (4), and *relationship* (10). By contrast, NW foregrounds the tensions and conflicts between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, as can be seen from the collocates *tensions* (12), *influence* (10), *resentment* (4), *pained* (2), *divides* (2), and *influenced* (2), as in the following:

(25) The dispute also taps into deeper **tensions** between Hong Kong and mainland China in recent years over the influx of mainlanders to Hong Kong, bringing business but also competing with local residents for housing and goods such as baby formula. (NW)
(26) Groups like his have mixed their demands for unfettered self-government in Hong Kong with **resentment** of mainland Chinese immigration and influence. (NW)

Besides, while both corpora emphasize the interaction between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, different actors are emphasized in CD and NW. Although both corpora represent the companies and firms listed in Hong Kong and visitors, tourists and residents from Chinese mainland, CD puts more emphasis on companies and firms than on tourists and visitors, but NW shows the opposite trend. Besides, NW foregrounds mothers and parents coming from Chinese mainland to give birth in Hong Kong, which caused great dissatisfaction from Hong Kong people.

1. **CD**: *companies* (131), *residents* (68), *tourists* (52), *investors* (57), *visitors* (37), *enterprises* (38), *universities* (25), *students* (35), *firms* (27), *women* (21), *travellers* (15), *shoppers* (11), *filmmakers* (12), *banks* (22), *people* (37), and *authorities* (20)

2. **NW**: *visitors* (16), *residents* (18), *mothers* (6), *tourists* (10), *people* (24), *companies* (15), *authorities* (13), *investors* (12), *officials* (14), *government* (19), *women* (6), *buyers* (5), *parents* (5)

Finally, while both corpora use intensifying strategies to highlight the large number of people coming to Hong Kong, different intensifying strategies are used. CD frequently resorts to figures and comparatives to emphasize the growing number of people, as can be seen from such collocates as *closer* (60), *more* (66), *number* (31), *percent* (41), *most* (22), *million* (22), *further* (14), and *many* (18). These concordance lines usually carry a positive semantic prosody, suggesting that the growing number of people are desirable. Examples are as follows:

(27) Huang said earlier the scheme would likely push the **number** of mainland tourists to Hong Kong from *6 million* last year to *10 million*. (CD)
(28) Wu expects the number of mainland visitors to Hong Kong would reach **1.1 million** during the upcoming holidays, an eight percent increase over last year. (CD)

Although NW also resorts to figures to the dramatize the large number of people visiting Hong Kong from Chinese mainland, such as *many* (19), *more* (20), *than* (17), it frequently uses metaphors to present a negative representations of the large number of people coming to Hong Kong from Chinese mainland, as can be seen from such collocates as *flooded* (3), *influx* (4), *flock* (2), and *flood* (2). Examples are as follows:

(29) Last year, **nearly 17 million** mainland Chinese visited Hong Kong, compared with just over 2 million in 1997.
(30) Mainland tourists have **flooded** Hong Kong in the past year, taking advantage of a relaxation of Chinese exit-visa rules that was intended to help the economy here.
(31) After a strong **influx** of mainland tourists in Hong Kong during the summer, there was a sudden rebound in business travel.
(32) Similarly, retailers who want to cater to the many mainland Chinese who **flock** to Hong Kong every month have no choice but to pay the excruciating rents that landlords are demanding.

These concordance lines often carry a negative semantic prosody, which suggest that the large number of people are undesirable. This can also be witnessed in the above metaphors which conceptualize people from Chinese mainland as either flood (i.e., *flooded*, *flood*, *influx*) or birds (i.e., *flock*) (Flowerdew et al., 2002).

6. Conclusion

To sum up, this study has given a corpus-assisted discourse study of the representations of post-colonial Hong Kong from 2000 to 2017 in Chinese and American English newspapers. The findings suggest that they vary not only in the choice of frames, topics, and discourses but also in their particular ways of constructing key parties concerning Hong Kong, i.e., people, government, and Chinese mainland. CD prefers to represent Hong Kong with an economic frame and focuses on the topics of economic cooperation and prosperity, whereas NW is inclined to represent Hong Kong with a political frame and focuses on the topics of democracy and the struggles involved. CD is thus characterized by a harmony-driven discourse, NW by a conflict-driven discourse. This can also be witnessed in their ways of constructing three key parties concerning Hong Kong, i.e., people, government, and Chinese mainland. Although both corpora value the three key parties in their representations of Hong Kong, CD underlines Hong Kong's relations to Chinese mainland, while NW values the people and government in Hong Kong. In their representations of Hong Kong people, CD highlights Hong Kong people governing Hong Kong and Hong Kong people's pride of being Chinese, but NW underlines the growing dissatisfaction of Hong Kong people towards the current state of Hong Kong and the Chinese government. As regards the Hong Kong government, CD values the Chinese government's support to the Hong Kong government, and the power and authority of the Hong Kong government, while NW foregrounds the control of the Hong Kong government by the Chinese government and downplays the power and authority of the Hong Kong government. Meanwhile, CD tends to underscore the cooperation between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, and the benefits brought by people visiting Hong Kong from Chinese mainland, whereas NW tends to highlight the tensions between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, and the troubles and problems brought by people from Chinese mainland.

Their systematic differences in the representations of Hong Kong can only be explained in terms of the different ideological positions of these newspapers. American newspapers tend to align with the national interests of the US in playing

the "guardian" role of Hong Kong. Compared with Hong Kong's economic development, they are concerned about Hong Kong's political development. They prefer to highlight such topics as democracy, freedom and individual rights, because they are considered as the basic components of British legacy to Hong Kong and cornerstones for Hong Kong's success and continued prosperity (Flowerdew, 2012). In other words, they are concerned about Hong Kong's autonomy rather the growing integration of Hong Kong with Chinese mainland. That explains why they always align with protesters and demonstrators in Hong Kong and give a negative representation of the Hong Kong government, the Chinese government, and these people visiting Hong Kong from Chinese mainland. However, as an official Chinese English newspaper, CD shoulders the responsibility of a positive image for the Chinese government and Hong Kong. Therefore, in order to demonstrate the success of "one country, two systems", it highlights the economic cooperation and prosperity of Hong Kong and downplays the political disputes in Hong Kong. While underlining the central government's support to the Hong Kong government and the benefits brought by Chinese mainland to Hong Kong, it also suggests Hong Kong people's growing satisfaction of being Chinese and puts the blame of young Hong Kong people's problems on themselves.

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Competing Discursive Constructions of Hong Kong in Chinese and US Newspapers: A Corpus-assisted Discourse Study

Wang Yunzhe

Sun Yat-sen University

Abstract

This article presents a corpus-assisted analysis of the representations of Hong Kong in one Chinese newspaper, China Daily, and two American newspapers, The New York Times and The Washington Post during an 18-year period from 2000 to 2017. The findings suggest that both Chinese and American news media have a wide coverage on Hong Kong but show different ideologies through certain linguistic patterns and semantic choices. The Chinese media shows preferences for economic interactions and cooperation between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland and reinforces their solidarity. The American newspapers, however, show preferences for conflicts and tensions between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. The general discursive strategy of positive-self and negative-other representations has been used in both corpora to construct their respective ideological positions.

Keywords: Hong Kong, media discourse, corpus-assisted discourse study, critical discourse analysis

1. Introduction

Hong Kong, with a complicated history, celebrated its 21st anniversary of its return to China on July 1, 2018. As a former British colony and one of the special administrative regions in China, Hong Kong is "governed under a unique and unprecedented political arrangement referred to as 'One Country, Two Systems'" (Ling & Yap 2015: 31) guaranteed by the Sino-British Joint Declaration signed in 1984. The Declaration also ensures the practice of capitalist system in Hong Kong during a 50-year period, from 1997 to 2047, despite the socialist system in Chinese mainland. Under the intertwining influences of Britain, Chinese mainland and the local (cf. Chu 2016, Ma & Fung 2007), Hong Kong, different from other Chinese cities, still maintains its distinctive socio-political cultures in spite of its increasing integration into the Mainland's economy (W. Cheng & Ho 2014, Flowerdew & Leong 2010).

As a global city and one of the most prosperous cities in China, Hong Kong has attracted the attention from domestic and foreign news media. News discourse, however, is not objective, but instead, is "biased" (Lin, Lo, & Wang 2011) as "a particular form of social, institutional practice" (van Dijk 1988: 176) because events are selected, reconstructed and presented from a particular perspective in news media due to distance (see Guo 2011), source of information (see Krumbein

2015), ideologies and stereotypes (e.g. M. Chan 2012, M. Chan 2013, Lee, Pan, Chan, & So 2001, Stewart, Pitts, & Osborne 2011, van Ginneken 1998).

This study aims to compare the discursive constructions of Hong Kong in Chinese and US newspapers with the corpus-assisted discourse study (CADS) approach, "a methodological synergy combining critical discourse analysis (CDA) and corpus linguistics (CL)" (Baker et al. 2008). CDA deals with the relationship among language, power and ideology whereas CL methods ensure a higher degree of objectivity (Baker et al. 2008). Chinese and US news media are selected for comparison for two reasons. For one thing, they represent different stances and ideologies. For another, Hong Kong is an important part of China whereas the US claims to be the guardian of Hong Kong after its return (Lee et al. 2001).

2. Media Representations of Hong Kong

Media, under ideological influences, plays a significant role in shaping and representing images by "capturing the imagination of audiences" (L. Zhang & Wu 2017: 30). Image, according to Nimmo and Savage (1976: 8), is "a human construct imposed on an array of perceived attributes projected by an object, event, or person". The object, event or person reported in newspapers is not facts, but ideas, beliefs, values, theories, propositions and ideology (Fowler 1991). According to Cao (1999: 71), events reported in news media are "site[s] of struggles among various 'discursive communities' for dominance over meanings". Therefore, the same event is reported differently in different media (see Du 2016, Fang 2001).

Media representations of Hong Kong have gained some interests from scholars at home and abroad, especially in the field of media and communication (e.g. Chu 2016, Flowerdew & Leong 2010, Fong 2010, Fung 2002). In terms of news media, however, most of the researches only focus on a specific event (e.g. Cao 1999, Cao 2000, M. Chan & Lee 2007, Q. J. Cheng & Yip 2012, W. Cheng & Ho 2014, Feng 2017) or a particular group of people (e.g. W. L. Chan & He 2016, Ladegaard 2013, L. F. Lee 2004).

For example, news reports on one of the most significant events – Hong Kong's return – attract many scholars' attention. For one thing, Cao investigates the representation of Hong Kong's return respectively in British media (1999) and Chinese media (2000) by analyzing the themes and discursive strategies. Findings suggest that the British media emphasizes "the predominant history-oriented nostalgia and the more substantiated present-oriented uncertain future of Hong Kong" (Cao 1999: 85) whereas the Chinese media highlights "the predominant history-oriented victimhood and the more substantiated present-oriented only-the-CCP-can-save-China" (Cao 2000: 676). For another, Lee et al. (2001) come to the conclusion that the US media endeavors to "bang the democracy drum in Hong Kong" in the news reports on the return after a content analysis.

Two previous researches focus on the constructions of Hong Kong identity in news media, both of which apply a CADS approach. On the one hand, M. M. Zhang and Mihelj (2012) focus on the Hong Kong-Mainland relation indicated in a corpus of local newspaper coverage of the 2005 Chief Executive election by analyzing collocations of certain identity labels. Findings suggest that the relation is

constructed differently under the influence of "the newspaper's ownership, the presence/absence of commercial imperatives and newspaper type" (M. M. Zhang & Mihelj 2012: 506). On the other hand, W. Cheng and Lam (2013) attach great importance to the diachronic change of western perceptions of Hong Kong since Hong Kong's return by comparing the Western and Chinese media discourses. The result demonstrates a shift in the Western media discourse from "negative views about political issues and a stronger focus on the general business environment of Hong Kong in 1996-1998" to "an increasing emphasis on political-related issues and individual political views in 2006-2008" (W. Cheng & Lam 2013: 186).

However, although W. Cheng and Lam (2013) compare the representations of Hong Kong in Western and Chinese news media, they give more emphasis on the Western perceptions whereas the Chinese one serves as a reference. Other previous researches focus on only a particular event or a group of people in the news media. The present study, on the other hand, intends to give a thorough comparison on the representations of Hong Kong between Chinese and US news media within the framework of CADS.

3. Data and Methodology

3.1. Data Collection

Two large corpora have been built in this study, the CD corpus and the US corpus. In order to make the sizes of the two corpora comparable, one Chinese newspaper and two American newspapers are chosen for analysis. The CD corpus is a collection of news articles in *China Daily* (*CD*) whereas the US corpus comprises the news articles in *The New York Times* (*NYT*) and *The Washington Post* (*WP*). Chinese and US news media are chosen in this study for the two countries' influences and wide coverage on Hong Kong (Krumbein 2015, Lee et al. 2001). *CD* is the leading English-language newspaper of China which represents the stance of the Chinese government to the outside world and imitates the reporting style of American newspapers (Li 2009). *NYT* and *WP* are chosen because of their national and international influences and their "reputation for excellent journalism" (Krumbein 2015: 160).

Data were collected from a period of 2000-2017 from the electronic database Lexis-Nexis and the Wise News, a source of newspaper articles from Greater China by searching the keyword "*Hong Kong*". The news texts were built into the two corpora respectively (Table 41) after a manual selection and elimination of the texts based on their relevance to Hong Kong (e.g., deleting irrelevant information such as copyright and load date and irrelevant texts in which "HK" only serves as a unit of monetary measurement).

	CD Corpus	US Corpus	
		NYT	***WP***
Number of texts	4,749	2,257	665
Tokens	2,289,839	1,560,648	454,815
Total of tokens	**2,289,839**		**2,015,463**

Table 41 General information on the two corpora

3.2. Methodology

This study adopts a CADS approach, which is frequently applied to the analyses of media discourse about events (e.g. W. Cheng & Ho 2014, Salama 2011, Yang & Fu 2018) and people (Baker et al. 2008), as well as to the analyses of discursive constructions of collective identities (e.g. W. Cheng & Lam 2013, Freake, Gentil, & Sheyholislami 2011, Prentice 2010, M. M. Zhang & Mihelj 2012).

The CADS approach emphasizes a "balanced combination" (Liu & Li 2017) of CL methods such as keyness, collocate and concordance and CDA methods. CL involves using "computer software to examine frequencies and relationships between words in (often large) sets of authentic texts that have been electronically encoded" (Baker & Ellece 2011: 25), restricting cognitive biases to some extent (Baker 2006: 12). CDA, or, more specifically in this study, discourse-historical approach (DHA), is to interpret a smaller size of discourses, especially the salient linguistic patterns in the socio-historical context, and exposes the ideologies behind the constructions (see Liu & Chang 2018). Ideologies, according to van Dijk (2006: 120), are "foundational beliefs that underlie the shared social representations of specific kinds of social groups". Therefore, CL methods and CDA methods are complementary in that CL "identifies regular discursive patterns that characterize particular corpora of texts" whereas CDA interprets them and "suggests how they might be involved in the reproduction of power hierarchies" (M. M. Zhang & Mihelj 2012: 510-511).

With the analytic tool Wordsmith 7.0, this study mainly consists of three main stages (cf. Baker et al. 2008: 295). Firstly, a keyword analysis of the top 100 keywords in the two corpora is conducted. The top 100 keywords of the two corpora are extracted and ranked according to their keyness values (or log-likelihood) by comparing the two corpora respectively with the general corpus, British National Corpus (BNC) 5 million sampler corpus. Keywords mean "the statistically significantly higher frequency of particular words or clusters in the corpus under analysis in comparison with another corpus" (Baker et al. 2008: 278). Therefore, the keyword analysis, aiming to imply the "aboutness" variety in the corpus (Baker 2006: 128), can help to identify semantic preferences of the corpus. Secondly, some of the top 100 keywords are selected and further analyzed in terms of collocates and concordances in order to figure out the discursive strategies and linguistic means used to construct certain aspects or concepts. Collocates refer to the frequent co-occurrences of certain words (Baker 2006: 95) whereas concordances mean "the occurrences of a particular search term in a corpus, presented within the context that they occur in" (Baker 2006: 71). Finally, the references to the most significant

event in Hong Kong, the return in 1997, in the two corpora are compared based on the assumption that ideological meanings and stances can be conveyed through particular referential strategies. However, although generally having three main stages, the present study is not restricted but including a continuous shift from the CL methods and the DHA methods, from the quantitative to the qualitative, in order to give a more convincing interpretation of the data.

4. Findings

4.1. Keyword Analysis

Type	CD	US
Topic	international, global, center, market, stock, central, economic, foreign, law, photo, securities, trade, financial, largest, SARS, shares, tourism, development, film, connect, renminbi, exchange, cooperation, investment, basic, trading, listing, index, world's, economy, growth, stocks	democracy, protests, pro, SARS, united, communist, protest, internet, center, global, democratic, legislature, elections, virus, former, foreign, news, colony, territory, political, occupy, art, law, movement, party, territory's, rule, disease, legislative, suffrage, Tiananmen, streets, media, demonstrations, stock, crackdown
Place	Hong, Kong, China, mainland, Chinese, HK, Kong's, Shanghai, Beijing, China's, Shenzhen, Guangdong, Macao, region, Asia, province, Taiwan, administrative, SAR, overseas, Guangzhou, Asian, special, city's, city, cities, HKSAR, Singapore, mainland's	Hong, Kong, China, Chinese, Beijing, Kong's, mainland, China's, Asia, Taiwan, city's, states, Asian, Beijing's, Shanghai, city, Singapore, Pacific, Guangdong, American, York
People	investors, tourists, chief, Li, executive, Leung, Zhang, Chan, Wang, people's, director, Tsang, residents, Tung, Liu, Chen, Wong, vice, Cheung	protesters, official, Mr, officials, chief, Leung, executive, Ms, police, Li, Tung, Wong, Chan, leaders, Snowden, residents, Xi, students, Tsang, Lam, student, demonstrators, candidates, Lee, Wang, investors, analysts, Lau, activists
Institution	listed, LTD, government, co, IPO, companies, bank, university, NPC	government, university, Alibaba
Other	said, yuan, pecent, billion, year, according, million, daily, including, com, yesterday	said, percent, billion, dollars, million, according, reported, Tuesday, Monday, google, Wednesday

Table 42 Top 100 keywords[a] of CD and US corpora

Compared with the general corpus BNC respectively, the two corpora differ in their respective top 100 keywords. As shown in Table 42 above, the top 100 keywords are categorized into 5 domains, i.e., topic, place, people, institution and other. In all domains, the two corpora demonstrate diverse preferences in that Hong Kong is "a theater, a site, and a moment for various national media communities to engage in a discursive struggle" (Lee et al. 2001: 345).

In terms of topic and people, the two corpora suggest different semantic preferences. On the one hand, the CD corpus demonstrates a preference for economic development and interactions with such words as *investors*, *economic*, *companies*, *trade*, *financial*, *development*, *cooperation,* and *growth*. It indicates that in the CD corpus Hong Kong is depicted both as a business and financial center attracting investments and cooperation from all over the world and as an open region willing to interact with others. Since its return in 1997, Hong Kong has been perceived as a financial center in Asia thanks to its free market and capitalism, which serve as "the backbones of Hong Kong's economic success" (Tai 2018: 3). More importantly, the CD corpus puts an emphasis on the increasing interactions and cooperation between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, especially in the economic sectors (cf. Cao 1999: 77). As Flowerdew (2012: 6) argues, Hong Kong plays a significant role as "a funnel for mainland trade and investment". Solidarity between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland is highlighted in the Chinese media.

On the other hand, the US corpus shows a preference for conflict and tensions with keywords such as *democracy*, *protestors*, *protests*, *pro*, *police*, *occupy*, *movement*, *demonstrators*, *streets,* and *activists*. Those keywords are highly related to the "Occupy Central" movement in 2014 which receives a wide coverage from the US media. Said (1993: 5) argues that the US and its media always regard itself as "a righter of wrongs around the world, in pursuit of tyranny, in defense of freedom no matter the place or cost". In this study, the US media constructs a positive image of freedom-fighters in Hong Kong and a negative image of "communist" Chinese mainland, emphasizing the difference between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. It is in line with the findings of Lee et al. (2001: 347), stating that Chinese mainland has been continuously depicted as "an invariant dictatorship" in the US media. Nonetheless, Hong Kong is perceived and presented as a "pro-democratic" region that fights for their rights through "protests" and "demonstrations". Moreover, Hong Kong is also depicted as a region with "law" and "rule" in the US media, serving as a justification for the protests or demonstrations. Rule of law is often regarded as one of the most important British legacies (e.g. Flowerdew 2012, Sin & Chu 1998). *Former* and *colony* indicate that US media frequently refer to Hong Kong as a former colony. Both above suggest a reinforcement of Hong Kong's solidarity with Britain and, furthermore, western countries such as the US.

SARS is one of the top 100 keywords in both corpora since SARS was "a global threat", attracting attention even in the regions and countries "where the disease did not establish itself" (Wallis & Nerlich 2005: 2629). However, apart from *SARS*, health-related words such as *virus* and *disease* are only in the top 100 keywords list of the US corpus, which implies that different from the Chinese media, the US media highlights the severity and spreading of the disease and virus, suggesting a negative representation of Hong Kong in the US media.

As for the keywords related to place, although sharing such words as *Hong Kong*, *China*, *mainland*, *Beijing* and *Shanghai*, the two corpora demonstrate different preferences. Keywords such as *Shenzhen*, *Guangzhou* and *Macao* are only in the CD corpus. Frequent references to other cities in China, along with topical keywords, indicate an intimate and cooperative relationship between Hong Kong and its neighboring cities, as well as between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. In the US corpus, place-related keywords include only a limited number of cities or regions in China, i.e. *Beijing*, *Shanghai*, *Taiwan* and *Guangdong*. Instead, keywords related to Asian regions and countries and America are in the top 100 keywords of the US corpus. This suggests that Hong Kong is more depicted as a rather independent region cooperating with other countries and that the mainland-Hong Kong relation is mitigated. According to van Dijk (1988), stances and ideologies are revealed not only by what is mentioned but also by what is not. In short, the Chinese and US media put emphasis on different perspectives of Hong Kong. The former presents it as a city in China and highlights its relation with other cities in China whereas the latter constructs it as an international region, or "one of the world's main financial city-states" (Fung 2002: 78), and emphasizes its cooperation and interaction with other regions and countries.

4.2. Selective Analysis of Keywords

Three of the top 100 keywords, *law*, *democracy* and *market*, are selected for a closer analysis because of their significance to Hong Kong (e.g. Flowerdew 2012, Sin & Chu 1998, Tai 2018). The three aspects, together with freedom of individual, have gradually become integrated into Hong Kong's distinctive identity after being promoted as British legacies and lasting contribution to Hong Kong during the governorship of the last British governor Chris Patten (Flowerdew 2012).

4.2.1. *Basic Law*

Law, primarily referring to the Basic Law or rule of law, is one of the top 100 keywords in both corpora. The Basic Law, drafted by China, is viewed as the guarantee of "a distinct Hong Kong identity" (M. M. Zhang & Mihelj 2012: 509). Rule of law is attached great importance to (e.g. W. Cheng & Lam 2013, Flowerdew 2012, Lee et al. 2001, Sin & Chu 1998) and regarded as the "secret of the success of Hong Kong" and "the key to Hong Kong's future prosperity" (Sin & Chu 1998: 148). Although being the top 100 keywords of both corpora, *law* occurs much frequently in the CD corpus (2539 times) than the US corpus (1689 times).

Table 3 shows the top 15 lexical collocates of *Basic Law* in the two corpora. The collocates are ranked according to the MI (mutual information) score, i.e. the strength of the collocation between these lexical words and *Basic Law* (Baker 2006). The two corpora share such collocates as *constitution*, *article*, *Hong Kong* and *interpretation*, implying that both media have a wide coverage of the interpretation and implementation of the Basic Law (cf. Flowerdew 2012: 189-190).

NO	CD			US		
	Collocate	**MI score**	**Freq.**	**Collocate**	**MI score**	**Freq.**
1	BASIC	30.36	1,303	BASIC	27.09	386
2	LAW	29.66	1,329	LAW	25.53	408
3	ARTICLE	21.52	101	CONSTITUTION	22.35	95
4	CONSTITUTION	21.03	71	MINI	21.47	63
5	INTERPRETATION	20.34	73	KONG'S	17.00	78
6	ACCORDANCE	20.07	67	INTERPRETATION	16.97	23
7	HONG	19.75	325	HONG	15.71	107
8	INTERPRET	19.52	38	DRAFTED	15.70	12
9	HKSAR	19.23	77	MINICONSTITUTION	15.66	7
10	DECISIONS	19.22	45	INTERPRET	15.44	10
11	KONG	19.18	275	VIOLATE	14.28	9
12	PROVISIONS	18.59	38	DRAFTING	13.67	6
13	STIPULATES	18.43	28	CHARTER	13.66	7
14	SYSTEMS	18.25	71	ARTICLE	13.17	13
15	SPECIAL	18.24	92	GOVERNS	12.95	5

Table 43 Top 15 lexical collocates of *Basic Law* in CD and US corpora

However, further analysis of the concordance lines demonstrates that although the two corpora share such collocates as *interpretation* and *constitution*, the Basic Law is represented quite differently in the two corpora, contributing to diverse semantic prosodies, "the consistent aura of meaning with which a form is imbued by its collocates" (Louw 1993: 160). *Interpretation* in the CD corpus seems to have a positive semantic prosody because it collocates with terms with positive meaning (cf. Salama 2011: 320). Specifically, the CD corpus puts an emphasis on the NPC Standing Committee's right and necessity for the interpretation of the Basic Law and its protection for Hong Kong (example (1), (2)) as well as the people's support for the interpretation (example (3)).

(1) The **interpretation** of Hong Kong **Basic Law** is a necessary step to safeguard the legal foundation of the special administrative region. (*CD*, 07/11/2016)
(2) Li stressed that the National People's Congress Standing Committee's **interpretation** of the **Basic Law** is also a constitutional component of the city's legal system. (*CD*, 08/11/2016)
(3) some 40,000 Hong Kong residents took to the street on Sunday to voice their support for the **interpretation** of Hong Kong's **Basic Law**, (*CD*, 14/11/2016)

The interpretation of the Basic Law is represented differently in the US corpus. The right for interpretation is regarded as something in the hand of Hong Kong's highest court or Hong Kong government and perceived as "rare" and illegal for the Chinese government to interpret, see examples below. *Interpretation* here carries a negative semantic prosody with terms such as *rare*, *without being asked to do so* and *charged*. This further suggests the difference between Hong Kong and Chinese

mainland and, at the same time, establishes a negative representation of Chinese mainland (cf. Li 2009).

(4) It is rare, however, for the Chinese government to issue an **interpretation** of the **Basic Law** without being asked to do so by Hong Kong's highest court or by the Hong Kong government. (*NYT*, 5/11/2016)

(5) China's move came in the form of a rare **interpretation** of the **Basic Law**, (*NYT*, 8/11/2016)

(6) Democracy activists in Hong Kong charged that Beijing's **interpretation** of the **Basic Law** actually amended it, (*WP*, 15/4/2004)

Constitution refers to different entities in the two corpora. In the CD corpus, it refers to the Constitution of China. The CD corpus demonstrates that the Basic Law, in accordance with the Constitution, guarantees the rights of Hong Kong people. This, in turn, suggests common interests and solidarity between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. In the US corpus, the Basic Law is regarded as "mini-constitution", indicating its independence from the Constitution of China and, furthermore, enlarging the distance between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. Referential strategies (Wodak 2001: 73) used here contribute to an overall representation of positive self and negative other.

4.2.2. *Democracy*

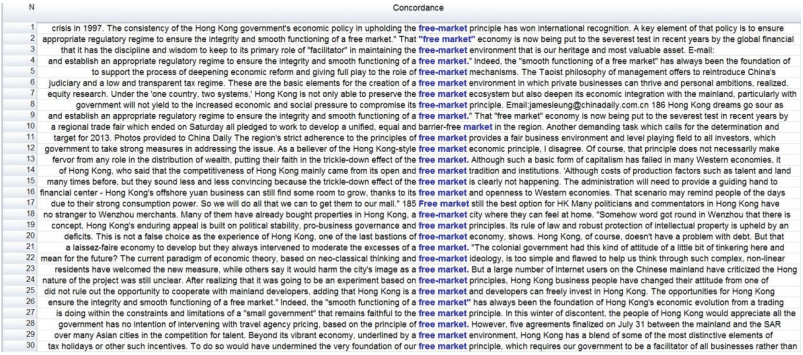
Democracy is one of the top 100 keywords only in the US corpus, indicating that this concept attracts much attention in the US media (cf. W. Cheng & Lam 2013, Lee et al. 2001), whereas the Chinese media seems to avoid mentioning democracy. Democracy is an essential component of "western liberal values" (Flowerdew 2012: 45) introduced as the British legacy to Hong Kong by Chris Patten in the 1990s, who was regarded as "the protector of Hong Kong's fragile democracy sailing into the dark" (Lee et al. 2001: 358).

This term is analyzed with a special focus on the predication strategies (Wodak 2001: 73) and semantic prosody in order to figure out how this most important concept in Hong Kong is evaluated and predicated in different news media. According to Wodak (2001), predication strategies are to attribute features and traits. Therefore, the top 20 lexical collocates at the L1 position of *democracy* (Table 4) in the two corpora are compared.

NO	CD		US	
	Collocate	**Freq.**	**Collocate**	**Freq.**
1	PAN	27	PRO	1227
2	PRO	20	GREATER	119
3	FULL	9	FULL	69
4	ADVANCING	8	KONG'S	50
5	DEVELOP	8	KONG	45
6	ADVANCE	6	GENUINE	20
7	KONG'S	6	TRUE	16
8	PROMOTE	6	REAL	13
9	PROMOTING	6	CHINESE	11
10	DEVELOPING	4	LONGTIME	9
11	HK	4	STYLE	9
12	REAL	4	FAKE	8
13	SOCIALIST	4	LOCAL	8
14	ABDUCTED	3	WESTERN	7
15	GENUINE	3	CITY'S	6
16	GOOD	3	DEMANDING	6
17	BAD	2	LED	6
18	BRING	2	PROMINENT	6
19	DENYING	2	TERRITORY'S	6
20	ENJOY	2	WANT	6

Table 44 Top 20 lexical collocates at the L1 position of *democracy* in CD and US corpora

As shown in Table 44, several collocates, including *pro*, *full*, *real*, *genuine*, and *hk* (*kong*, *kong's*), can be identified in both corpora. This indicates that the real democracy in Hong Kong is concerned by both media. However, the differences of the top 20 lexical collocates at the L1 position are obvious in the two corpora. The semantic prosody is positive in the CD corpus in that collocates carrying positive implications only occur in the CD corpus such as *advance*/*advancing*, *develop*/*developing*, *promote*/*promoting* and *enjoy*. This suggests that the Chinese media constructs Hong Kong as the one that enjoys real democracy and, at the same time, highlights the efforts made by Chinese mainland to advance and ensure the democracy in Hong Kong. However, *democracy* has a negative semantic prosody in the US corpus. Collocates with negative implications can be identified only in the US corpus such as *greater*, *longtime*, *fake*, *local*, *demanding* and *want*. *Greater* and *fake* indicate that democracy in Hong Kong at present is not enough or "fake" whereas *demanding* and *want* show the local people's aspiration for democracy. These collocates contribute to the construction of a negative image of Chinese mainland and the justification of the fights for democracy in Hong Kong.



N	Concordance
1	crisis in 1997. The consistency of the Hong Kong government's economic policy in upholding the **free-market** principle has won international recognition. A key element of that policy is to ensure
2	appropriate regulatory regime to ensure the integrity and smooth functioning of a free market." That **"free market"** economy is now being put to the severest test in recent years by the global financial
3	that it has the discipline and wisdom to keep to its primary role of "facilitator" in maintaining the **free-market** environment that is our heritage and most valuable asset. E-mail:
4	and establish an appropriate regulatory regime to ensure the integrity and smooth functioning of a **free market.**" Indeed, the "smooth functioning of a free market" has always been the foundation of
5	to support the process of deepening economic reform and giving full play to the role of **free-market** mechanisms. The Taoist philosophy of management offers to reintroduce China's
6	judiciary and a low and transparent tax regime. These are the basic elements for the creation of a **free market** environment in which private businesses can thrive and personal ambitions, realized.
7	equity research. Under the 'one country, two systems,' Hong Kong is not only able to preserve the **free market** ecosystem but also deepen its economic integration with the mainland, particularly with
8	government will not yield to the increased economic and social pressure to compromise its **free market** principle. Email:jamesleung@chinadaily.com.cn 186 Hong Kong dreams go sour as
9	and establish an appropriate regulatory regime to ensure the integrity and smooth functioning of a **free market.**" That "free market" economy is now being put to the severest test in recent years by
10	a regional trade fair which ended on Saturday all pledged to work to develop a unified, equal and barrier-free **market** in the region. Another demanding task which calls for the determination and
11	target for 2013. Photos provided to China Daily The region's strict adherence to the principles of **free market** provides a fair business environment and level playing field to all investors, which
12	government to take strong measures in addressing the issue. As a believer of the Hong Kong-style **free market** economic principle, I disagree. Of course, that principle does not necessarily make
13	fervor from any role in the distribution of wealth, putting their faith in the trickle-down effect of the **free market.** Although such a basic form of capitalism has failed in many Western economies, it
14	of Hong Kong, who said that the competitiveness of Hong Kong mainly came from its open and **free market** tradition and institutions. 'Although costs of production factors such as talent and land
15	many times before, but they sound less and less convincing because the trickle-down effect of the **free market** is clearly not happening. The administration will need to provide a guiding hand to
16	financial center - Hong Kong's offshore yuan business can still find some room to grow, thanks to its **free market** and openness to Western economies. That scenario may remind people of the days
17	due to their strong consumption power. So we will do all that we can to get them to our mall." 185 **Free market** still the best option for HK Many politicians and commentators in Hong Kong have
18	no stranger to Wenzhou merchants. Many of them have already bought properties in Hong Kong, a **free-market** city where they can feel at home. "Somehow word got round in Wenzhou that there is
19	concept, Hong Kong's enduring appeal is built on political stability, pro-business governance and **free market** principles. Its rule of law and robust protection of intellectual property is upheld by an
20	deficits. This is not a false choice as the experience of Hong Kong, one of the last bastions of **free-market** economy, shows. Hong Kong, of course, doesn't have a problem with debt. But that
21	a laissez-faire economy to develop but they always intervened to moderate the excesses of a **free market.** "The colonial government had this kind of attitude of a little bit of tinkering here and
22	mean for the future? The current paradigm of economic theory, based on neo-classical thinking and **free-market** ideology, is too simple and flawed to help us think through such complex, non-linear
23	residents have welcomed the new measure, while others say it would harm the city's image as a **free market.** But a large number of Internet users on the Chinese mainland have criticized the Hong
24	nature of the project was still unclear. After realizing that it was going to be an experiment based on **free-market** principles, Hong Kong business people have changed their attitude from one of
25	did not rule out the opportunity to cooperate with mainland developers, adding that Hong Kong is a **free market** and developers can freely invest in Hong Kong. The opportunities for Hong Kong
26	ensure the integrity and smooth functioning of a free market." Indeed, the "smooth functioning of a **free market"** has always been the foundation of Hong Kong's economic evolution from a trading
27	is doing within the constraints and limitations of a "small government" that remains faithful to the **free market** principle. In this winter of discontent, the people of Hong Kong would appreciate all the
28	government has no intention of intervening with travel agency pricing, based on the principle of **free market.** However, five agreements finalized on July 31 between the mainland and the SAR
29	over many Asian cities in the competition for talent. Beyond its vibrant economy, underlined by a **free market** environment, Hong Kong has a blend of some of the most distinctive elements of
30	tax holidays or other such incentives. To do so would have undermined the very foundation of our **free market** principle, which requires our government to be a facilitator of all businesses rather than

Figure 28 Selective concordance lines of *free market* in the CD corpus

4.2.3. *Market*

Market is chosen for a closer examination since it is one of the top 100 keywords only in the CD corpus and that Hong Kong is known for its free market (see Flowerdew 2002, Flowerdew 2012, Goodstadt 2010, Lee et al. 2001, Tai 2018). *Free market* occurs 45 times in the CD corpus, whereas the frequency in the US corpus is only 27. In other words, the Chinese media refers to Hong Kong's role as a free market more often than the US media. This suggests that Hong Kong's role as a free market is more intensified in the Chinese media than in the US media. Goodstadt (2010) states that free market, the distinguished feature of Hong Kong, plays a crucial role both in Hong Kong's economic success and in China's modernization (see also Flowerdew 2004).

However, the two corpora show different ways of framing Hong Kong's role as a free market. As for the CD corpus, the semantic prosody is mostly positive. Concordance lines of *free market* in the CD corpus (Figure 28) illustrate that Hong Kong's role as a free market is a globally recognized fact or a presupposition (see Fairclough 1989: 152) and that efforts are continuously made by both the local and the central governments to protect it. As displayed in Figure 28 (Line 1 to 10), facing challenges to its role as a free market, Hong Kong, together with Chinese mainland, is making every effort to preserve the free market and ensure its "integrity and smooth functioning". The efforts are supported and recognized not only locally but also internationally. Other lines in Figure 1 demonstrate that the free market principle in Hong Kong is the foundation for Hong Kong's economy, based on which other arguments are formed. Besides, argumentation strategies – justification and intensification – are adopted to intensify the advantages of Hong Kong's role as a free market and convince people that free market is best for the local (Line 11 to 30). In short, the Chinese media constructs a positive image of Chinese mainland that supports and promotes Hong Kong's free market economy as well as an intimate and mutual-benefiting relationship between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland.



N	Concordance
1	of newspapers and magazines. Hong Kong also gave Mr. Lai the freedom to air his political views: free market and fiercely anti-Beijing. His newspaper, Apple Daily, has rankled the Chinese
2	the need to ensure that the semiautonomous city would maintain a vigorous rule of law and a free market. "We will be watching it very closely," Secretary of State Madeleine Albright said then.
3	to build consensus highlights contradictions inherent in Beijing's effort to run Hong Kong as a free market without the institutions of a full-fledged representative democracy. Hong Kong's chief
4	offshore Internet gambling. Despite its reversion to China in 1997, Hong Kong still views itself as a free-market bastion. Some opponents of the legislation say the government has no business
5	, putting at risk the political stability and rule-based governance that have made Hong Kong a free-market mecca. China intervened to effectively block two politicians, Sixtus Leung, 30, and Yau
6	the past few weeks, four words have further shaken the story line that this former British colony is a free-market nirvana. Food Truck Pilot Scheme. Hong Kong, a culinary paradise that is arguably
7	market report for the European Fine Art Fair this year in Maastricht, the Netherlands, Hong Kong's free market and its lack of taxes on imports or exports of art have contributed to drawing these
8	city with a free press and other rights has been central to its cultural vitality and success as a free-market economy. Ensuring it stays that way is in the interest of China, the business
9	Hong Kong to China in 1997. But Hong Kong allows investments to flow in and out freely and a free-market economy characterized in recent years by slow growth and falling prices, while China
10	was not a democracy under British rule, and that China has not tampered with its court system and free-market economy. But China promised to allow for a gradual political liberalization in Hong
11	of their rivals. Britain returned Hong Kong to Chinese rule in 1997, but Hong Kong retains a heavily free-market economy with a completely separate banking system and currency from mainland
12	ending the crisis in a way that will enhance Hong Kong's political stability, reassure investors in its free-market economy or prevent future upheavals. Instead, the costs of the regime's rigidity
13	agreement with China outlining a formula of "one country, two systems" that let Hong Kong keep its free-market economy, legal system and other rights alongside the mainland's repressive
14	." The mounting confrontation has put Hong Kong in an awkward position. The authorities in this free-market city pride themselves on not meddling in business. But the dispute threatens to spoil
15	that Beijing, while retaining its own Communist system, was willing to allow a separate system of free-market economics and broad political autonomy in Hong Kong. A similar arrangement was put
16	on the mainland. The agreement signed by Britain and China allowed Hong Kong to retain its free-market economy, a legal system with an independent judiciary and other rights, including
17	in Hong Kong feared that those civil liberties would be whittled away. Now, though, Hong Kong's free-market philosophy has taken root in much of China. President Jiang Zemin even recently
18	the buyers came from Asia, Mr. Perlis said. "In Asia, where emerging companies are building on free-market capitalism, Steve stands for these things in a very powerful way. Steve is revered,
19	and his followers, we wouldn't be subject to these kinds of restrictions," Mr. Kan said. Publisher's Free-Market Fervor Drives Him to Taiwan Jimmy Lai has just flown in from Hong Kong, where the
20	spending, which has risen along with the economy, making Hong Kong somewhat less of the free-market bastion than it used to be. The private sector has stumbled because of intense
21	tycoons -- at the top of the hierarchy in a city that has for decades been ranked as one of the most free-market economies in the world -- have long feared that democracy would lead to the
22	that characterized business in Hong Kong during 154 years of colonial rule. "This is not the free-market city that people always talk about," said Michael DeGolyer, the director of an academic
23	with democracy. No matter how well conservatives do in elections, no matter how thoroughly free-market ideology dominates discourse, there is always an undercurrent of fear that the great
24	that to happen immediately. And even the Chinese government is wary of making some of the free-market moves that would enable the renminbi to take its place alongside the dollar, euro and
25	companies, LinkedIn, which is based in Mountain View, Calif., has promoted itself as dedicated to free-market principles. Too much censorship could cause users to flee. What's more, if LinkedIn's
26	called the world's freest economy. But the post-1997 government, despite paying lip service to free-market principles, has undermined this cornerstone of Hong Kong's past success. The
27	Kong's Future in Doubt; Editorial Hong Kong has long been considered an Asian jewel, a vibrant free-market economy and global financial center known for its rule of law and democracy. Yet now,

Figure 29 Concordance lines of *free market* in the US corpus

Concordance lines in the US corpus (Figure 29), on the other hand, show an overall negative semantic prosody with such expressions as *bastion*, *mecca*, *nirvana* and *lip service*. *Bastion*, a word related to war, implies an opposition between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. *Mecca* and *nirvana*, related to religions and beliefs, give a hint that Hong Kong's role as a free market may not be a fact but an illusion that the government creates and makes people believe. *Lip service* indicates that the local government does not take actual actions to promote free market principles. In a word, Hong Kong's role as a free market is represented negatively in the US media.

Moreover, as demonstrated in Figure 29, in the US media, Hong Kong is constructed as a "semiautonomous city" whose rule of law and free market will be supervised and protected by the US (see also Lee et al. 2001). Specifically, Hong Kong's role as a free market is suspected or conditional in the US corpus. The free market in Hong Kong is "allowed" by the central government. The contradiction between "free" and "allowed" contributes to the emphasis on the difference of the concept "free market" between the western countries and Hong Kong, meaning that the free market in Hong Kong is not de facto free and should be defended and consolidated continuously (Tai 2018). Furthermore, this helps to construct a negative image of Chinese mainland and, meanwhile, enlarge the distance between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland.

4.3. Hong Kong's Return

The event of Hong Kong's return is of great significance in that "it became the site of struggles among various 'discursive communities' for dominance over meanings" (Cao 1999: 71) and that it has been attracting "unprecedented coverage from the press" (W. Cheng & Lam 2013: 173), especially during its anniversaries. The event of Hong Kong's return to China in 1997 is referred to differently in the two corpora (Table 45), which is called referential strategies (Wodak 2001: 73). The US corpus refers to the event not only more frequently but also with much more diverse expressions than its CD counterpart. The more frequent references to the event suggest that the US media looks back to the past and compares the situations

in Hong Kong before the return with that after the return in order to further illustrate that it might not be good for Hong Kong to return.

NO	CD			US		
	Word	**Freq.**	**%**	**Word**	**Freq.**	**%**
1	*RETURN	363	61.8%	*RETURN	455	39.5%
2	HANDOVER	124	21.1%	HANDOVER	322	28.0%
3	REUNIFICATION	39	6.6%	*HAND	118	10.2%
4	*RESUME	34	5.8%	*REVERT	71	6.2%
5	TRANSITION	10	1.7%	*TRANSFER	69	6.0%
6	*TRANSFER	6	1.0%	*TAKE	25	2.2%
7	RESUMPTION	6	1.0%	*RESUME	17	1.5%
8	RECOVERS	1	0.2%	*REGAIN	15	1.3%
9	RESTORED	1	0.2%	TRANSITION	11	1.0%
10	REGAINING	1	0.2%	REVERSION	10	0.9%
11	ENDORSE	1	0.2%	TURNED	9	0.8%
12	TAKEOVER	1	0.2%	*RECLAIM	9	0.8%
13				REUNIFICATION	6	0.5%
14				RESUMPTION	3	0.3%
15				RECOVERY	3	0.3%
16				CEDED	2	0.2%
17				GAINED	2	0.2%
18				TAKEOVER	2	0.2%
19				ACQUIRED	1	0.1%
20				ASSUMED	1	0.1%
21				RESTORATION	1	0.1%
TOTAL		587	100%		1152	100%

Table 45 References of Hong Kong's return in CD and US corpora
*representing lemma, e.g., *RETURN includes "return", "returns", "returned" and "returning"

Both corpora overwhelmingly use the expressions *return* and *handover* to refer to the event, implying that the two expressions are most commonly used in both China and Western countries. However, the agent of *return* is Hong Kong whereas the agent of *handover* is Britain. The frequency of *return* is almost third times as many as that of *handover* in the CD corpus, implying its own stance, i.e., reporting from the perspective of Hong Kong. Furthermore, the expression *hand*, the verb form of *handover*, is not used to refer to the event in the CD corpus. In the US corpus, on the other hand, the total frequency of *handover* and *hand* is almost the same as that of *return*, suggesting that when referring to this event, the US media switches between the perspectives of Hong Kong and Britain, putting them into a subject position. As W. Cheng and Lam (2013: 176) argue, "western media discourses seemed to characterize Hong Kong in ways that matched with their own interests and simultaneously restricted the Cultural Other's freedom of thinking and speaking".

Another distinctive difference is the use of *reunification*, which accounts for 6.6% in the CD corpus but only 0.5% in the US corpus. The expression *reunification* means joining together again and carries some sentimental meanings, which implies that Hong Kong is always a part of China and that people were longing for Hong Kong's return. This further helps to construct an intimate relationship and solidarity between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland in the Chinese media.

5. Conclusion

This paper adopts a CADS approach to compare the discursive representations of Hong Kong in the Chinese and US media, revealing both the similarities and differences as regards semantic choices, linguistic patterns, and discursive strategies. Overall, the Chinese media shows preferences for economic interactions and cooperation between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland and constantly reinforces their solidarity. The American newspapers, however, show preferences for conflicts and tensions between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland, and continuously highlight their differences by giving a negative representation of Chinese mainland as well as establishing alignment with Hong Kong.

Closer analyses of certain keywords in the two corpora reveal that various discursive strategies such as predication strategies, referential strategies and argumentation strategies are applied to construct different aspects of and, furthermore, stances towards Hong Kong in both corpora. Hong Kong is represented as a democratic city characterized by its rule of law and free market in the CD corpus whereas democracy and free market in Hong Kong are questioned and negatively represented in the US corpus. Moreover, both media try to align with Hong Kong through an overall strategy of positive-self and negative-other representations. The Chinese media highlights the solidarity and alignment between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland whereas the US newspapers put an emphasis on the intimacy and similarities between Hong Kong and western countries and at the same time the differences and distances between Hong Kong and Chinese mainland. The CADS method adopted in this study helps not only to reveal the discursive representations of Hong Kong from a micro linguistic perspective but also to explain the constructions from a more macro perspective by referring to the socio-historical contexts.

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British Media Representations of Hong Kong Twenty Years on: A Modern Diachronic Corpus-assisted Discourse Study

Jiang Cong

Sun Yat-sen University

Abstract

Since its return more than two decades before, Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (HKSAR) has been a platform connecting China with the world and contributing to the evolving Chinese image. This paper aims to study how Hong Kong is represented by the British media based on the four dimensions of British colonial discourse summarized by Flowerdew (2012). By adopting the theoretical framework of modern diachronic corpus-assisted discourse study (MD-CADS), the study is to examine twenty years of The Times and capture the diachronic British perceptions of the "former colony". The analysis uncovers that the four dimensions, although decreasing in occurrences, are preserved as to maintain the British legacy and promote the liberal identity of Hong Kong in an increasing contrast with Chinese Mainland. This study may offer some empirical contributions to the less-explored area of the British media representation of Hong Kong and add to the understanding of the Sino-British power dynamics.

Keywords: Hong Kong, media representation, modern diachronic corpus-assisted discourse study

1. Introduction

The history of Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (HKSAR) started on 1 July 1997 when the British colonial administration ended and the Chinese government resumed sovereignty over the territory. The transition aroused divided sentiments in Chinese and British national press, as previous scholars indicated (Pan 1999; Cao 1999; Lee et al. 2001). China, on the receiving end, celebrated the return of the region as a victory of New China and reunification of Chinese people and territory. Britain, on the delivering end, expressed a sense of nostalgia and regret of departing the former colony. The present paper is interested in whether the British nostalgia and responsibility are preserved in the twenty years after the handover and how the "former colony" is perceived and represented from the British perspective.

Since its return to China, Hong Kong was allowed a high degree of autonomy to preserve the previous way of life within the capitalist system. The past two decades have been a continuous exploration within the "one country, two systems" framework. China has now rapidly developed into the world's second largest economy, and HKSAR has also boosted to and prospered along the tide. The connection between Chinese Mainland and Hong Kong SAR has reached a new level, but incidents sometimes happen, causing conflicts and discord. It is understandable that the image of Hong Kong is fascinating and complex from the start, as it is related

to multiple social and historical factors. The British representation of Hong Kong under Chinese sovereignty not only relates to the British post-colonial discourse but also influences the understanding of China by the global audience.

There is a range of studies investigating representations of Hong Kong and Hong Kong people from linguistic and media perspectives (e.g. Cao 1999; Flowerdew 1998, 2004; Chan & Chan 2007; Flowerdew & Leong 2010; Cheng & Lam 2013). An examination of the existing literature, however, reveals a dearth of investigating an extensive diachronic corpus of British data. Most previous works analyze the data within the Chinese community, while exclusive British perceptions of Hong Kong are scarcely explored. To conduct an updated analysis of Hong Kong representations, the thesis models on the approach of MD-CADS (Partington 2010, 2012; Duguid 2010a, 2010b) and corpus-assisted discourse study (hereafter CADS; Partington 2004, 2013; Baker 2006; Baker et al. 2008; Cheng & Lam 2010, 2013; Freake, Gentil & Sheyholislami 2011) to analyze *The Times* coverage on Hong Kong from 1997 to 2017. This diachronic study may reveal a different image of Hong Kong and offer clues to better understand the Sino-British discursive struggle.

2. Contextualization of the Present Study

This study is built on the article of Flowerdew (2012) and aims to examine the continuation of Patten's discourse of colonial withdrawal in the British newspaper. Through an extensive study of Patten's public discourses in Hong Kong (speeches, interviews, broadcasts, public meetings, etc.), Flowerdew summarizes four main themes that continually recur: the market economy, the freedom of the individual, the rule of law, and democracy. These four themes construct a "myth" of the British legacy before the forthcoming transition and constitutes a significant and dignified British withdrawal from its last major colony. Through strategies such as presupposition, involvement, and lexical reiteration, Patten constructs a highly positive prosody of the four dimensions as "self-evident and universal truths" integrated in Hong Kong society (ibid. 49) and aligns himself with the pro-democracy camp against the Chinese Central Government. In addition, the four dimensions are interrelated in Patten's discourse that it is impossible to maintain one dimension without the others. Collectively, they construct Hong Kong as an embodiment of a set of Western liberal values. Flowerdew (2012), however, observes that despite the construction of British significance, much colonial "legacy" was left out of the picture such as draconian laws and official corruption.

The present study replicates the four dimensions in Flowerdew's work and attempts to investigate media representations of Hong Kong through these dimensions in the wider range of time and broader socio-historical contexts. Relevant topics have been studied since the transition period. Cao (1999) carefully delineates British press representations of Britain, China, and Hong Kong in the transition. British is represented with righteousness and significance and departs Hong Kong with colonial legacy and nostalgia; China is discursively constructed as the communist "Other" that may undermine the values of democracy and freedom; and Hong Kong is situated in the uncertain future of sovereignty transition and

needs protection from Britain. The "future uncertainty" is echoed in Pan et al. (1999) which examines the Hong Kong press narrative of the transition event. Flowerdew (1997) and Lee et al. (2001) address the ideological and cultural divide in Hong Kong between the Chinese discourse of harmony and authority and the Western discourse of democracy and freedom. After the first ten years, diachronic studies are conducted to capture the changing social aspects in Hong Kong. Cheng and Lam (2010) indicate the rise of Hong Kong SAR and China as sources of information instead of objects of criticism concerning human rights issues. Cheng and Lam (2013) discover that Western negativity towards Hong Kong changes from its unfavorable economic and political situation to China's influence on the region. Generally, two directions are less explored in the linguistic research of Hong Kong representations: the first is diachronic analysis conducted with the corpus-assisted approach, and the second is the specific British perspective.

The review of previous works in the field has offered insights into the complex image of the region and its relationships with Chinese Mainland and with the world. In recent works, however, the diachronic British perspective is missing to a large extent: diachronic research of Hong Kong media representation is rare by itself; the British discourse is often grouped within the Western media community and not thoroughly discussed for its special relation to Hong Kong. The research dearth reserves the space for an updated diachronic study of post-colonial Hong Kong.

3. Modern Diachronic Corpus-Assisted Discourse Studies

3.1. Theoretical Background

Modern diachronic corpus-assisted discourse studies (MD-CADS) is a sub-discipline of CADS which aims at a synergy of corpus linguistics (CL) and critical discourse analysis (CDA). Generally, corpus approaches use computer software to investigate recurrent patterns in the wide-scale data, while critical discourse analysis examines specific stretches of the text and identifies the discursive strategies and linguistic means within. Based on increasing theoretical and empirical research in the area (Stubbs 1994; Partington 2004; Baker 2006; Gabrielatos & Baker 2008; Baker et al. 2008; Freake et al. 2011; Kim 2014), the synergy of CDA and CL is proved practical based on their shared objective of studying linguistic patterns and their complementary perspectives and methods.

On the one hand, CDA studies have been criticized of basing on a small number of selected texts, lacking rigorous and systematic framework, and depending on the personal interpretation of the author (see Stubbs 1994; Tenario 2011). Equipped with CL, the expanding size of data as well as the capacity of data processing provides more evidences for understanding and interpreting findings. On the other hand, corpus analysis does not normally take into account the social, political, historical and cultural context of the data (Baker et al. 2008: 293). Detailed discourse analysis adds to the areas that may be overlooked under the macro scope and optimizes the explanatory power of corpus results. The synergy is not simply turn-taking employment of two methods but combination of mutual strengths

which is a process of moving back and forth between (new) hypotheses and (new) findings.

MD-CADS employs relatively large corpora of a parallel structure and content from different moments of contemporary time in order to track changes in modern language use but also social, cultural, and political changes as reflected in language (Partington 2010: 83). With the large corpora, more possibilities are opened for study as more internal linguistic patterns and external socio-historical factors are included. Partington (2010, 2012) and Duguid (2010a, 2010b) have investigated the SiBol Corpus of more than 2 million words and across 12 years, and explored diachronic changes in meaning and form. As a nascent discipline, MD-CADS is expected to develop new methodological practices in the growing number of works.

CDA takes a particular interest in the dialectical relation between language and society, especially the power struggle reflected and constituted by discourses (Fairclough 1992, 2010; Wodak 2001a; Wodak & Reisigl 2015; Van Dijk 2006). The power of discourse, in the present case, can be exercised by the accumulative effect of the structural organization of media coverage. Newspaper is an important social media for its efficiency in spreading ideas and shaping public opinions because journalists or others who have access to the position of "spokesman" can influence their readers by producing their own discourses or reshaping existing ones (Baker 2006). Drawing from one of the largest British national newspapers, the corpus-assisted analysis of news discourse can illustrate how images of Hong Kong are discursively represented and transmitted in social thinking.

3.2. Data and Methodology

In the present study, the data for analysis are *The Times* news related to Hong Kong, within a two-decade period from July 1997 to July 2017. *The Times* is one of the leading British quality newspapers and its stance is commonly perceived as conservative. The original data were retrieved from the LexisNexis database, including all news items that contain the search word "Hong Kong". These items were manually sorted by their actual relevance and the resulting item, namely the TT *(The Times)* corpus. It contains a total of 798,672 tokens in the form of report, brief, editorial, etc. The 20 years of texts were diachronically divided into four successive periods of the Hong Kong government administration: Period 1 (1997.07-2002.06), Period 2 (2002.07-2007.06), Period 3 (2007.07-2012.06), and Period 4 (2012.07-2017.07).

After four sub-corpora were built, each is processed by the corpus software WordSmith (Version 7.0) to generate a keyword list in comparison with the other three combined. The keyness is calculated by Log Likelihood (LL), with its threshold set at 6.63 in our analysis. Keyword analysis reveals words that are either relatively significant or absent in each sub-corpus, offering a starting point to test the four dimensions we set out at the beginning and to overview diachronic patterns and meanings. With the keywords identified, we will examine their collocates and concordances. Collocates are calculated by the default setting of WordSmith, which is words co-occurring within the range of 5 words to the left and right at

least 5 times. These methods afford the examination of frequent and prominent meanings related to keywords and lead to the notion of semantic preference (the relation of co-occurrence between the phrasal unit and words from characteristic lexical fields) and semantic prosody (the function of the whole extended unit) (Stubbs 2009: 125).

Period	**Token**
P1 (1997.07-2002.06)	305,742
P2 (2002.07-2007.06)	176,268
P3 (2007.07-2012.06)	145,302
P4 (2012.07-2017.07)	171,360
Total	**798,672**

Table 46 Corpus Size

Particularly, the study draws from Cheng (2006) and Cheng & Lam (2013) in the analysis of semantic preference and prosody. With the general understanding of patterns of a specific token, its concordances are semantically categorized in terms of the related semantic field and attitude (positive, negative, and neutral). The statistical difference of these categories and the discursive construction they achieve can illustrate the British perception of Hong Kong. MD-CADS, as we have discussed in the last section, integrates approaches of CDA and CL. The focus lies in the balanced complementation of strengths on both sides and the constant interaction between hypotheses and findings. Methods or procedures are not necessarily applied in any exact order. The results are interpreted in the specific socio-historical contexts to yield more comprehensive outcomes.

4. Findings and Discussion

4.1. Diachronic Keyword Analysis

To discover the diachronic change of prominent themes in the twenty years, each five-year corpus is compared with the other three combined and four keyword lists are produced with each top 10 keywords (ranked by their LL values) shown in Table 47. This method of keyword analysis yields more topic-specific words which may not stand out in the comparison with a general corpus. It is useful to capture both the major and marginal patterns for mapping the research.

In the first period, the salient topics are basically the handover and the Asian financial crisis. The theme of colony and handover is evoked by words such as *Patten* (2nd), *governor* (7th), and *Chris* (10th). As for the Asian financial crisis, the event relates to multiple issues such as currency speculation and financial institutions (e.g., *currency*, *IMF* and *Peregrine*).

For the second period, words centered around the event of SARS dominate the list. The top ten keywords, except for *Tung* (8th) which refers to the chief executive at the time, can be grouped into the semantic category of the virus outbreak. Their frequency and LL value surpass that of other keywords, revealing a highly concentrated topic selection at the time.

	P1		P2		P3		P4	
N	**Keyword**	**LL.**	**Keyword**	**LL.**	**Keyword**	**LL.**	**Keyword**	**LL.**
1	*pounds*	677	*SARS*	1,034	*Rusal*	256	*protesters*	348
2	*Patten*	333	*disease*	230	*Geoghegan*	170	*Jutting*	286
3	*currency*	153	*outbreak*	200	*Google*	162	*Snowden*	246
4	*IMF*	148	*virus*	198	*aluminium*	157	*Xi*	237
5	*Jardine*	142	*health*	193	*AIA*	150	*police*	234
6	*dollar*	138	*infected*	174	*listing*	134	*protests*	188
7	*governor*	127	*cases*	174	*Pru*	126	*ivory*	182
8	*speculators*	111	*Tung*	142	*Rusal's*	126	*occupy*	169
9	*Peregrine*	104	*respiratory*	130	*Prada*	119	*movement*	142
10	*Chris*	103	*deaths*	127	*Deripaska*	89	*tear*	139

Table 47 Keywords of Each Sub-corpus

For the third period, a primary focus is the economy, but major events are seemingly obscure given the relatively low indexes of the LL value. Most tokens refer to various brands and companies which either had branches located in Hong Kong or went on listing there. Google (the 3rd token) terminated its search service in the mainland for disagreements with the government on information transparency.

For the fourth period, the protests and campaigns on democracy issues are foregrounded in the text, relating to events such as the Occupy Central and Umbrella Movement. Other events include the sex abuse and murder committed by Rurik Jutting (the 2nd token), the U.S. intelligence leakage by Edward Snowden (the 3rd token), and the illegal ivory trade caught by the Hong Kong customs (the 7th token).

Through the topics extracted from the keywords, we may observe that the four dimensions are underlying in *The Times* coverage on Hong Kong, for example the economic and financial vocabulary, tokens related to democratic movements, and topics of rights and freedom such as the Google and Snowden incidents. Baker (2006) observes that social power may be manifested through the prerogative of the press to decide on the amount of coverage to be given to particular incidents. The four dimensions are among the major resources exploited to represent and transmit the image of the city. Investigation into their semantic and attitudinal aspects can provide concrete evidences of the British representation of Hong Kong. For reasons of length and focus, we have selected four relevant tokens, namely *economy*, *democracy*, *freedom,* and *rule of law*, for detailed analysis.

Figure 30 illustrates the diachronic variation of the four tokens in question. The line of *democracy* fluctuates most dramatically, high in P2 and P4, relatively low in P1 and P3. The climax in P4 can be explained by the keywords of democratic movement in the previous chart. The value of *economy* is in constant decrease over the years, yet higher than other three tokens in P1 and P3. The variations of *rule of law* and *freedom* are generally stable with relatively low value of frequency. Both of them demonstrate the similar variation trend as *democracy*, with the drop in P3 and rebound in P4, illustrating the political-inclined association of these two principles. In the following sections, the concordances of these four tokens are examined in terms of their semantic preference and prosody.

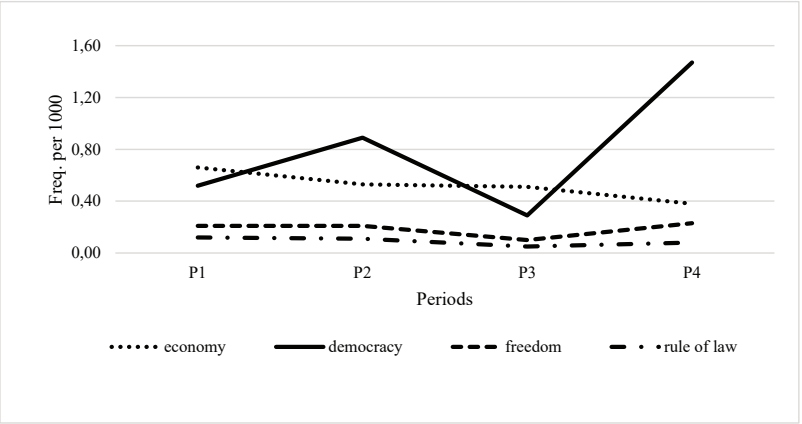


Figure 30 Standardized Frequency of the Four Dimensions

4.2. Analysis of *economy*

The concordance tool sorts out 424 concordances of *economy*, 198 in P1, 90 in P2, 72 in P3, and 64 in P4. The frequent collocates include *world's* (28), *world* (28), *global* (26), *Chinese* (25), *China's* (21), *largest* (18), *market* (18), *China* (13), *US* (12), *growing* (10), *recession* (9), *biggest* (9), *political* (7), *mainland* (7), *grew* (6), *growth* (6), *strong* (6), *booming* (6), *slowing* (5), *problems* (5), and *crisis* (5). The linguistic environment of *economy* seems mixed with positive and negative themes, with a particular focus on *world economy* and *Chinese economy*. The relevance meets the anticipation that Hong Kong, as an international financial center, plays an important role in the intersection between the Chinese developing economy and the global market and economies.

The semantic preference of *world economy* is most prominent in the first period (91 out of 198 instances, 45.9%) mostly because the Asian financial crisis brought destructive and lasting impact to international economies. A number of 40 instances associate Asian countries negatively in the semantic prosody of "recession and crisis" and both the US and UK are presented as the minor victims. *World economy* stably accounts for around 30% of the concordances in the following three periods, which concerns the economic condition of various countries and regions as well as situates Hong Kong economy in the international dynamics. A balanced prosody of positivity and negativity presents in P4 while the first three periods are generally characterized by problematic economies under financial and epidemic (e.g., SARS) crises.

(1) The message from these companies is that, beneath the **financial market turmoi**l, there remains a **resilient** economy that is **capable** of weathering the storm - unlike the corporate sectors of many of its near neighbours. (P1)

(2) Certainly, the financial crisis has strengthened the belief that **China and Hong Kong are two parts of a single economy**, which will flourish of fail together. (P1)

(3) In the optimistic model, China would be **fully intregrated into the world economy**, as a customer, supplier and investor, and with a "greater weight and voice in international institutions". (P1)

(4) Hong Kong remains **central** to the banks' expansion plans, and the outlook from the corporate headquarters in central Hong Kong across the border to the Chinese mainland and **its burgeoning economy**, appears increasingly rosy. (P2)

(5) The re-emergence of **the Chinese super-economy** after the death of Mao Zedong has also created **widespread fears** that its thirst for energy has unpalatable implications for global warming. (P3)

(6) People are **losing confidence** in the idea Hong Kong will keep its freedoms and its independent judiciary – that's what **threatens** the economy." (P4)

(7) Kerry Brown, a China expert at Chatham House, said that **the mainland's spectacular rise**, becoming the world's second-largest economy, means that **Hong Kong "has diminished in importanc**e over the years to the point that maintaining at least some semblance of 'one country, two systems' is almost like **an act of charity**". (P4)

The semantic preference of *Chinese economy* constitutes a minor part in the first two periods (18.1% in P1 and 21.1% in P2) yet the semantic prosody is largely positive (positive and neutral prosodies account for 80.6% and 94.7%). As shown in example (3) & (4), China is expected to integrate into the "liberalized world economy" and the rapid growth of Chinese economy is fully recognized with frequent predications such as *booming, burgeoning*, *strong*, and *significant*. In addition, the relationship between Chinese economy and Hong Kong economy is constructed in the theme of "integration and collaboration" as shown in example (2). Chinese Mainland supports Hong Kong and Chinese-Hong Kong economy is nominated as "the world's largest and strongest developing economy".

In the third and fourth period, *Chinese economy* accounts for respectively 45.8% and 46.9% of the instances and becomes the major semantic preference. The continuous growth creates "miracles" yet induces "fears" as shown in example (5). The prosodies of both Chinese and Hong Kong economy tend to be more negative in P4 with the economic slowdown, the high-priced property, and more importantly, the represented political and social tension as in example (7) and the excerpt below.

(8) The Chinese economy is 11 times larger than at the time of the handover, while Hong Kong has become **more dependent on the mainland**. Chinese visitors are **resented** in Hong Kong not just because they spit in the street but because they are no longer in awe of this capitalist oasis. Beijing is i**ncreasingly impatient** with what it sees as a whingeing, southern, semidetached metropolis. **The deal** signed with Britain (the Hong Kongers were not at the table) is deemed **irrelevant**. (P4)

Market economy is situated under the threat of political suppression and the rise of mainland's economy is not as supportive as before but becomes the power of Chinese Mainland to freely dispose the "one country, two systems" principle

promised to Hong Kong. The economic interrelation is interpreted as in the dependency of Hong Kong economy and the manipulation of Chinese economy.

In a word, the perception of Hong Kong economy is generally optimistic in the first three periods but more pessimistic in P4. Hong Kong is maintained as a free international financial center though susceptible to changes in the global market. Its association with the Chinese economy is previously represented in the semantic preference and prosody of "integration and collaboration" but partly changes to "dependency and manipulation" in the last five years.

4.3. Analysis of *democracy*

Related to *democracy*, there are 154 instances in P1, 153 in P2, 40 in P3, and 245 in P4. Frequent collocates include *pro* (220), *full* (41), *protesters* (37), *Beijing* (35), *activists* (34), and *movement* (33), which illustrate the major topic, action, and participant in the represented pro-democracy movement. *Full* is a consistent collocate (Gabrielatos & Baker 2008; Baker et al. 2008) and constitutes the phrase of "full democracy". It refers to the universal suffrage of the chief executive and the legislative council, running through the twenty years of democratic pursuit as the eventual goal. The concordances of democracy can be placed in three major semantic categories: *democratic development in Hong Kong*, *influence from Chinese Mainland*, and *influence from Britain*.

The positive and neutral prosody of Hong Kong democracy witnesses a general decrease since P1 when 44.8% of the instances show a more optimistic expectation of democratic development in Hong Kong. The semantic prosody of *fundamental importance* highlights the significance of democracy and constructs it as the "inevitable future" which Hong Kong people desire and deserve. As shown in example 8, democratic pursuits are maintained till P4 as a universal value upheld not only in Hong Kong but across the world. On the contrary, negative prosody is on the rise, occupying for 12.9%, 35.9%, 25%, and 55.5% in the four periods. The theme of *protest and confrontation* stands out in P4 (106 out of 245 instances, 43.3%) and depicts how the brave and resilient pro-democracy group contests the controlling Central Government. Against the background of intensifying confrontation is the fundamentally pessimistic turn of British evaluation of Hong Kong democracy. Predicates such as *real* (6), *fake* (3), and *genuine* (2) appear at the L1 position of *democracy* which was predominantly filled with *full*, *more*, and *greater*. The concern of the "degree" of democracy is replaced by the question of its "authenticity".

(9) Western-style democracy is the **inevitable way of the future**. The Hong Kongers know it is just a matter of time before **democracy sweeps the whole of China** in an onward march of freedom **around the world**. (P1)

(10) For the **first time** in modern China, a multi-party election has just taken place on Chinese soil. (P1)

(11) On the seventh anniversary of the handover of the former British colony, **noisy but peaceful** protesters **chanted** "Return power to the people", a slogan that Beijing regards as **hostile** to the Communist Party. (P2)

(12) Hong Kong's constitution sets out full democracy as an **eventual goal**, but gives **no timetable** and critics have long **accused** the territory's Government of dragging its feet. (P2)
(13) But President Hu Jintao, making his first visit to the former British colony, **urged loyalty** to the motherland and **offered no timetable** for democracy. (P3)
(14) The streets of Hong Kong heaved with demonstrators yesterday as **tens of thousands** marked the anniversary of the former British colony's fifteenth year under Chinese rule by **venting their anger, disappointment and fear**. (P4)
(15) Pro-democracy activists in Hong Kong are preparing for **a major showdown** with Beijing **amid fears** that free speech and the rule of law are under threat. (P4)
(16) The demands of the pro-democracy movement are a reminder that political liberty is a universal, and not a culturally specific, cause. (P4)

Similarly, *influence from Chinese Mainland* is vested with negativity. Contrast to P1 when China is expected to embark on the course of democratization, the Central Government in the following years is represented as reacting to democratic movements with "indifference" and even "hostility", and casting them in the opposite of political stability. Besides the negative prosody concerning the protests, instances also refer back to the Tiananmen incident with words such as *crash*, *crackdown*, and *massacre*. The historical reference manifests the recontextualization of the past knowledge to situate the current reality (Bhatia 2015) of the constructed resistance against the Central Government's influence over the region's democratic future.

The semantic preference of *influence from Britain* is most prominent in P1 with 38 instances (24.7%) debating on the British democratic reform in the former colony. On the one hand, Britain is represented to foster and develop democracy; while on the other hand, Patten is criticized at home for the controversial effect of antagonizing the mainland and the possibility of earlier establishment of democracy. The theme gradually decreases to 8 instances (3.3%) in P4. Post-colonial British involvement in democracy is moderately represented as Britain basically avoids harsh criticism of democratic issues or explicit responsibility to Hong Kong. In representing critical movements, *The Times* is mindful of distinguishing the pursuit of full democracy and that of independence.

In general, Hong Kong democracy is constructed in the intensifying confrontation between the pro-democracy group which constantly calls for full democracy and the Central Government which is characterized by reluctance and intervention. The British perception becomes more pessimistic as the authenticity of democracy is questioned, but the British newspaper takes a careful stance in terms of supporting liberal pursuits and resisting independence attempt.

4.4. Analysis of *rule of law*

The rule of law is seemingly not a frequent topic in TT as it only occurs 37 times in P1, 19 in P2, 7 in P3, and 12 in P4. Across the four corpora, it most frequently co-occurs with *preserve** (5), *freedom** (5), *democracy* (5), and *threat* (4), which manifest the integration of four dimensions and two opposite semantic prosodies.

The positive association is evoked by the former three collocates as well as *important*, *vital*, *cornerstone*, *foundation*, *protect*, *respect*, and *support*, representing the significance of the rule of law and its functioning in Hong Kong. The negativity is expressed by words such as *threat*, *weakened*, *erosion*, *uncertainty*, and *concerns*, referring to problems and threats that the rule of law encounters.

(17) **Preserving** the rule of law is of **crucial importance** to Hong Kong's future. (P1)
(18) Hong Kong is the **only Chinese community** in the world that enjoys the rule of law," Mr Lee said in an interview yesterday. (P1)
(19) Many Hong Kong Chinese looked back with gratitude on **what Britain had done for them**, on the good government, rule of law and impartial civil service that has provided a framework for the prosperity of this once barren island. (P1)
(20) The Hong Kong chief noted that the former colony still enjoyed the **basic democratic benefits of its British legacy**—the rule of law, freedom of the press and religion and a thriving capitalist system. (P2)
(21) "But in the background was the sneaking worry about creeping corruption and the **gradual undermining of Hong Kong's greatest asset**: the rule of law." (P2)
(22) Hong Kong enjoys real autonomy, a functioning rule of law and a liberal press and media that have **no equivalent in most of China**. (P3)
(23) "Rule of law is the **cornerstone** of an open and fair society," he said. "Hong Kong's success is underpinned by its independent judiciary and respect for rights and freedoms." (P4)
(24) Although we never had the sense to give Hong Kongers the vote, we **fostered a culture** that upheld the rule of law, the independence of the judiciary and electoral democracy as **fundamental** to a decently run state. (P4)

The positive association accounts for respectively 70.2%, 70%, 85.7%, and 50% of the concordances in the four periods. The semantic prosody of *fundamental importance*, which is shown in examples (17), (18), (21), (22), and (23), represents the rule of law as directly associated with the wellbeing and uniqueness of Hong Kong society. The predication and nomination of, for example, "the greatest asset" and "cornerstone", define how the functioning rule of law can influence the region and establish its unique privilege over other Chinese communities. Another semantic prosody of *favorable condition* positively evaluates the status quo of the rule of law. It is commonly attributed to the local respect for the principle and the determination to preserve it, crediting the city as "a free society living under the rule of law".

The theme of *fundamental importance* is most prominent in P1 (16 out of 37 instances, 43.2%), while in P2 and P3, the more practical focus of *favorable condition* prevails and P3 is marked by 6 out of 7 instances (85.7%) of positive evaluation of the development of rule of law. The WTO entry of China is interpreted as a step of modernization of the legal profession in China and the Chief Justice and lawyers' efforts affirm the principle as the "proper and effective protection of rights and freedoms". *Fundamental importance* recurs in P4 (5 out of 12 instances, 41.7%) when the significance of the principle is revoked to voice support against

the pessimistic outlook. The uniqueness of Hong Kong is amplified in the construction of the significant rule of law and the region is differentiated from "most of China" as the privileged member of the democratic world.

The Britain association of the rule of law is also manifested, especially in P1 when 10 instances relate to the British introduction and concern of its democratic legacy. Examples (19), (20), and (24) demonstrate the direct link between the British rule and the rule of law in Hong Kong. The four periods witness a decreasing yet lingering British influence as the theme is maintained in P4 (2 instances out of 12). Negative instances (around 15% in the first three periods and 33.3% in P4) constitute a minor part and relate to events such as the legislation of Article 23 and the Occupy movement. Example 5 presents an interesting site of how negativity is expressed with multiple predications of "sneaking worry", "creeping corruption", "gradual undermining", and "greatest asset". The negative attitude is carefully modified by staging the significant rule of law against its subtle yet terrifying corruption. Generally, the concordances of *rule of law* are situated in a positive environment. The lexical reiteration of co-occurring words constructs the rule of law as the fundamental principle in need of protection.

4.5. Analysis of *freedom*

Among 142 related instances of *freedom* (58 in P1, 34 in P2, 12 in P3, 38 in P4), its frequent collocates include *press* (19), *expression* (16), *speech* (11), *democracy* (8), *political* (7), *religious* (6), *economic* (5), *fear** (5), *erode** (5), *demand** (5). Various aspects of freedom are concerned, with more focus given to the freedom of speech and press. Similar to the semantic preference and prosody of *rule of law*, freedom is upheld as a significant democratic principle and under threat in the course of democratization. The theme of *fundamental importance* constitutes the major part of positive associations of *freedom*, especially in P4 when no positive prosody is attributed to the condition of freedom in Hong Kong. These instances affirm the importance of freedom and, as shown in the last two entries, again construct the uniqueness of Hong Kong as a free capitalist society different from the mainland.

Freedom is also credited as a democratic legacy that is introduced and contributed by Britain as shown in examples (28) & (29). The British responsibility for the "former colony" is preserved in P4 (2 out of 38 instances) but is modified in the balance between supporting the "legitimate" demand for more freedom and "preventing" the trend for full independence. The British concern of democratic development is carefully expressed similar to the representation of *democracy*, siding with the liberal pursuit of Hong Kong people and distancing from the radical attempt that is firmly resisted by the Chinese government.

(25) **The Chinese Government** has tried to **gag** the Hong Kong media in its **strongest attack** on press freedom in the former British territory. (P1)

(26) More than he succeeds triumphantly in demonstrating that "**the Chinese** . . . are not utterly unlike us, whoever we may be, and that freedom from torture, persecution, and spiritual or intellectual coercion is a **common desire among all human beings** and not merely a Western notion." (P1)

(27) Ten years on, Hong Kong has not only **survived** but is **thriving** again as a **defiant outpost of freedom** inside a communist state. (P2)

(28) The first visit by Tony Blair to Hong Kong in five years illustrates what happens to those places where **imperial Britain introduced freedom**, sanitation and a vigorous press. (P2)

(29) **Britain has an obligation** to support the democratic aspirations of Hong Kongers, but an obligation also to prevent a legitimate wish for more freedom turning into a demand for full independence. (P4)

(30) A massive crowd gathered in Hong Kong to commemorate the 1989 Tiananmen Square massacre was told yesterday that **China remained a brutally repressive regime** where "those who fight for freedom always lose their freedom". (P4)

(31) **Hong Kong's people** have a history, and an expectation, of freedom **far greater** than that of their compatriots on the mainland. (P4)

(32) Either course would destroy **Hong Kong's unique status as a beacon of freedom** and 24-hour capital of capitalism. (P4)

The semantic prosody of *freedom* is relatively negative (29.3% in P1, 52.9% in P2, 41.7% in P3, 44.7% in P4) in the sense of "insufficiency" constructed by recurrent words such as *erosion*, *limit*, *lack*, and *under attack/threat*. Freedom is constantly represented in the state of erosion among calls for more and unfettered freedom, and the Chinese government is positioned as the main culprit for this insufficiency. From examples (25), (27), and (30), the Chinese government is nominated as a "brutally repressive regime" with actions such as "gag" and "attach", while Hong Kong survives as a "defiant outpost of freedom inside a communist state". The contrast between Chinese Mainland and Hong Kong tends to enlarge differences of the "two systems" and mitigate their integration in "one country".

Similar to the theme embedded in instances of *democracy* and *rule of law*, instances of *freedom* preserve the importance of democratic principles and represent Hong Kong as in pursuit of more freedom than the mainland. The condition of freedom is generally negative in the semantic prosody of "insufficiency" which can be attributed to the represented intervention of the mainland.

From our discussion, we may conclude that the four discursive dimensions of Patten's constructed myth of British legacy, namely market economy, democracy, freedom, and the rule of law, are preserved in *The Times*, although the proportion of these four topics are not balanced with more focus on economy and democracy and less on freedom and the rule of law. The media representations are mixed with positive and negative prosodies, but the significance as well as British origin of these principles is consistently affirmed. Across the twenty years, the four dimensions serve to define Hong Kong's uniqueness by foregrounding its association with Western liberal values, in contrast to its identification and integration with China. With Flowerdew having discovered that Patten situates himself against the

Central Government, *The Times* situates Hong Kong against the Central Government, with an increasingly pessimistic evaluation of Hong Kong democratic development.

The diachronic change and stasis of the four dimensions are produced within integrated socio-historical contexts. In 1997, Hong Kong remained Britain's last and most prosperous colony and the handover is generally believed to have signaled the end of the British Empire. The imminent years after the transition is still largely influenced by the discourse of colonial withdrawal which highlights the significance of the previous British rule. Careful confidence is given to Hong Kong for the continuity of British legacy amid political and economic uncertainty. A turning point occurs on July 1, 2007 and the protest is considered the first major protest in the history of HKSAR (Chan & Lee 2007) when Hong Kong people manifested their dissatisfaction over the decade under Mr Tung's governance and towards the legislation attempt of Article 23. Disagreements between Hong Kong people and the Central Government were increasingly expressed in the form of protest and campaign. The third period in question is basically peaceful as no critical events occurred and more economic and national identification between the mainland and the SAR was achieved due to events such as the successful Beijing Olympics (Lai 2011). Democratic movements, particularly the Occupy and Umbrella movement, in the last five years induced the concentrated discussion of democracy across the Western media as a site of the evolving ideological contest.

Previous studies (Flowerdew 2004; Lai 2011; Zhang & Mihelj 2012) have found two inclinations of the Hong Kong identity: one being the harmonious convergence of the local and the national identity and another foregrounding the differences and separation. *The Times* has clearly adopted the second version and focused on the confrontation between the SAR and the mainland. By upholding Hong Kong's uniqueness, the British media discourse maintains Patten's conception of the region as the embodiment of "essentially Western liberal values" (Flowerdew 2012: 42), which manifests and produces Western resistance to Hong Kong's integration. Meanwhile, with its conservative stance as well as the consideration of the Sino-British relationship, *The Times* consciously modifies its expression as a careful observer instead of a fierce critic.

5. Conclusion

From our discussion, we may conclude that the four interrelated dimensions of Patten's constructed myth of British legacy, namely market economy, democracy, freedom, and the rule of law, are preserved in *The Times* and collectively construct Hong Kong as the embodiment of Western liberal values yet with decreasing confidence. Economically, the status of Hong Kong as the international financial center is maintained but confidence is damaged by the political tension with Chinese Mainland in recent years. Politically, democratic confrontations are intensified by questioning the authenticity of democracy in Hong Kong. The unique identity of Hong Kong is buttressed by the four democratic dimensions and *The Times* intentionally underplays the theme of Chinese integration out of a continuous ideological struggle.

The present study captures the diachronic trend of the four democratic dimensions in Hong Kong society that are represented in the British newspaper. The findings suggest a promising site to study modern discursive struggles of ideology and power between China and the Western world. Given the vacancy of recent linguistic research on Western perceptions of Hong Kong, more studies can contribute to the evolving identity of Hong Kong. In addition, the practice adds to the field of MD-CADS by applying the methodology to the analysis of diachronic British media discourse and developing analytical topics from previous research.

Discourses exercise power as they are institutionalized and linked to action (Jäger 2001). These institutionalized discourses provide symbols where people collectively draw from to understand the society and regulate their actions. The study of discourse conduct analysis to reveal the contradictions of what has been represented and what could have been there. Through examining the production of reality which is achieved by British media discourse, we can better understand that the convergence of Hong Kong and Chinese identity still encounters external resistance and requires more internal determination.

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The Discursive Representation of Hong Kong in *People's Daily* (1997-2017): A Discourse-historical Approach

Huang Jingyi

Sun Yat-sen University

Abstract

After the return of Hong Kong to China in 1997, issues of Hong Kong have received a lot of attention from both Western and Chinese media. This study examines the Chinese perception of Hong Kong and the relations between Hong Kong and the mainland of China after Hong Kong's handover in 1997, using the Chinese mainstream newspaper, People's Daily, as an example. Guided by the theoretical underpinning of discourse-historical analysis (hereafter DHA) and drawing on the analytical methods provided in the corpus linguistics, this study examines two textual levels: macro level and micro level, which are respectively associated with an analysis of topics and an examination of specific linguistic strategies. Findings reveal that Chinese perception of Hong Kong is constantly positive during 1997 to 2017 and Hong Kong is discursively constructed as the prosperous and stable. People's Daily's emphasis upon the positive Chinese influence on Hong Kong helps to gain a better understanding of not only the leadership of the Chinese Official Government, but also the role of language in building a patriotic identity.

Keywords: Hong Kong, People's Daily, discourse analysis, DHA, corpus-assisted approach

1. Introduction

Given that language is able to shape political structures and social reality, understanding how it is used in the construction of meaning has been a great concern among linguists for a long time. This study will investigate how Hong Kong image is constructed through Chinese newspaper, *People's Daily* and emphasize on how the media employs various linguistic means and devices to describe and present Hong Kong. It also sets out to examine a corpus spanning from 1997 to 2017, endeavoring to uncover the hidden ideology constructed by *People's Daily* at the deep level, with an analytic tool of corpus-assisted analysis approach, drawing upon the theoretical foundation of DHA.

Hong Kong, described as a city where oriental culture meets with western values (Fung & Pun 2012), has been a concern among scholars who are keen on making an investigation on its urban image. On 1 July 1997, the territory of Hong Kong was officially returned to Chinese sovereignty, which was viewed as a big event all around the world. Most of the western media produced a negative and pessimistic presentation towards Hong Kong's future and the mainland of China's control (Pan 2002), as evidenced by the United States' view on itself as a guardian to retain the Hong Kong's capitalist system from communist society (Chan et al. 2001). They show particular interest in whether Hong Kong could preserve the

capitalist system and enjoy autonomy under the "Basic Law" and the principle of "One Country, Two Systems". However, ten years after the handover, studies on western view towards Hong Kong have changed due to the achievements that Hong Kong made during these ten years. Their focus has shifted to the education reform, the cultural identity and so forth (e.g., Chan 2002, Lui 2007). The negative representations of political issues in Western media have been replaced by an emphasis on individual political views (Cheng & Lam 2013).

Compared with the studies on western media related to the issue of Hong Kong, those of Chinese media discourses are less. Conducted by several scholars of the Chinese University of Hong Kong in 1997, the studies on Hong Kong image have been advanced to place an emphasis on the comparative study of the international news (Chan et al. 2002). However, these analyses do not express awareness of the explanation and interpretation of the discourse which are also tied to the analysis on discursive representation. Therefore, it is of significance to examine how the Hong Kong image is discursively represented by Chinese media, in particular *People's Daily*, the Chinese mainstream press.

2. CDA Research in Media Discourse Studies

Critical Discourse Analysis (henceforth CDA) takes a particular interest in the "relations between discourse, power, dominance, social inequality" (Van Dijk 1993: 249). The start of CDA is marked by the work of Fairclough (1989), which presents the methods of discourse analysis and research objects. The focus of the linguistic analysis, thenceforth, turned to the issues such as the relationship between language and society as well as the linguistic representation in social institutions. Following this trend, a lot of research on different theories in CDA has appeared, including Fairclough's (1992) three-dimensional model, Van Dijk's (2006) sociocognitive framework, Wodak's (2001) discourse-historical analysis and Huang's (2017) ecolinguistics.

Simultaneously, there is also a lot of research focusing on different methodological approaches, involving Halliday's (1994) systemic-functional linguistics (e.g., Fowler 1996, Lemke 1992), conceptual metaphor analysis (e.g., Flowerdew & Leong 2007, Li 2010), conversation analysis (e.g., Hutchby & Wooffitt 2008, Li 2016), argumentation analysis (e.g., Fairclough 2013, Van Rees 2007), genre analysis (e.g., Dowd et al. 2004, Ge 2015, Lamb 2013) and multimodality discourse analysis (e.g., Kress & Van Leeuwen 1996, O'Halloran 2004 2011).

CDA's preference for the discursive practices concerning inequality and control can be shown in the choice of different topics such as political discourse (e.g., Fairclough 1992, Fairclough & Mauranen 1997, Wodak 1989). A lot of research has been made to uncover the ideological variations and conflicts that bring about the social change between different interest communities, for instance, research on racism and immigration (e.g., Van Dijk 1987 1991, Van Leeuwen & Wodak 1999), and on state policies (e.g., Hajer & Versteeg 2006, Marston 2004). In addition, particular attention of globalization in economic discourse is also paid to present the colonization of educational and political fields (e.g., Chouliaraki & Fairclough 1999, Fairclough 1995, Fairclough 2002). Furthermore, CDA is also concerned

with the topics of gender (e.g., Ezeifeka & Osakwe 2013, Lazar 1993), education (e.g., Taylor 2004), literacy (e.g., Barton & Hamilton 1998, Cope & Kalantzis 2000, Martin & Rose 2008), and media discourse (e.g., Hou 2015, Teo 2000).

Recently, CDA studies are also concerned with the national image and identities. For instance, Koteyko (2014) gives a linguistic insight into the construction of the national identity in the media discourse in post-Soviet Russia. In his study, corpus linguistic techniques including concordance and collocation are employed to deal with the large corpus. Findings reveal the discursive representation of the presidencies and the rise of the new authoritarian of Putin in Russia, demonstrating the strengths in combining both qualitative and quantitative analyses in CDA.

3. Theoretical Framework

The present study will draw upon DHA proposed by Wodak (2001) as the theoretical foundation. In DHA, ideology is considered as a significant means to establish and maintain power. Hidden ideology can be uncovered to create awareness of how institutions or agents produce discourse and make people consent to it as well as of how dominant groups present the unequal order as a commonsensical relationship. In considering both social and historical occasions, DHA differs from other approaches of CDA in that it performs a function that is interdisciplinary. Interdisciplinarity involves interdisciplinary theory, methods in order to avoid disciplinary restrictions. Simultaneously, the principle of triangulation of DHA (data triangulation, theory triangulation, triangulation of methods and investigator triangulation) sheds light on different aspects of the object being investigated and offers a thorough and detailed analysis from various fields and disciplines.

Three dimensions featuring this approach include the content or topic(s) of the data, the discursive strategies employed, and the linguistic means used to realize these strategies. Seen as the intentional plans of discursive practice to achieve certain particular political, social and linguistic aims, according to Meyer and Wodak (2016), discursive strategies are composed of nomination, predication, argumentation, perspectivization and intensification or mitigation. Nomination strategy explains how persons, objects, events, actions, and processes are represented linguistically by the use of metaphors, verbs, nouns and so forth. Predication strategy relates to features and characteristics attributed to social actors, objects, and events. Argumentation strategy is served to justify and question claims of truth and normative knowledge. Perspectivization strategy is concerned with stance and positioning of the text producer to express involvement and distance. Intensification or mitigation strategy focuses on to what extent the utterances are presented, whether they are intensified or are mitigated. All these strategies, seen as the analytic tools, can be realized by various levels of linguistic devices, system, and complexity. In other words, investigating the context-dependent linguistic means helps to examine specific discursive strategies that are employed to construct ideology and maintain power within a socio-historical context.

4. Data and Methodology

4.1. Data Collection

This study is based on *People's Daily*, an official newspaper of the Chinese Communist Party covering in all aspects such as economy and culture. As the major organ in China, it is considered as the most influential and authoritative newspaper, aiming to broadcast accurately the latest policies and plans of the Party to people both at home and abroad (Liang 2013). It represents the main voice of the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China. Also, since the newspaper is published in Chinese, language employed in *People's Daily* offers a direct glimpse into Chinese official opinions, which helps to avoid misunderstandings resulted from the translation process. Given that studies on Chinese media discourse is inadequate, let alone studies on Chinese language, this study tends to give a comprehensive analysis on *People's Daily*, in hope of proving some implications on the discourse analysis on Chinese media and Chinese language as well.

In this study, empirical data of this study are derived from all the news coverage closely associated with Hong Kong. The corpus I build and use is in accordance with the subject of Hong Kong. The data are retrieved through a keyword search from the online database of *People's Daily* from July 1, 1997 to June 30, 2017, covering a time span of 20 years. 3886 texts are selected finally for this study, including all articles containing the keywords "香港" (Hong Kong) during July 1, 1997 to June 30, 2017 whose contents center predominantly upon the issues of Hong Kong.

4.2. Methodology

The present study combines quantitative and qualitative analyses. Drawing upon the DHA theoretical framework, the selected texts will be analyzed with respect to its macrostructure (macro-analysis), its microstructure (micro-analysis) and its context (context-analysis). First, the main discourse topics and contents will be identified in the analysis of the macrostructure of the texts, by means of the corpus-assisted approach to examine the statistically significant differences in respect to subjects and topics. Second, a detailed study will be conducted. Different discursive strategies that are located at different levels of linguistic devices will be investigated with the analytical tools proposed by Wodak and other scholars, involving nomination strategy, predication strategy and perspectivization strategy. Both qualitative analysis and quantitative analysis will be conducted to identify different strategies. Third, different results will be interpreted and discussed within the social, historical and political contexts of the discourse, placing an emphasis on the diachronic reconstruction and explanation of discursive change on Hong Kong image.

Wordsmith 7.0 (WS7) is employed in this study to analyze the data for discovering patterns in the texts. Wordsmith is a software package published by Lexical Analysis Software and Oxford University Press. It is realized by three modules including Concord, Wordlist and Keyword. Concord deals with the concordance,

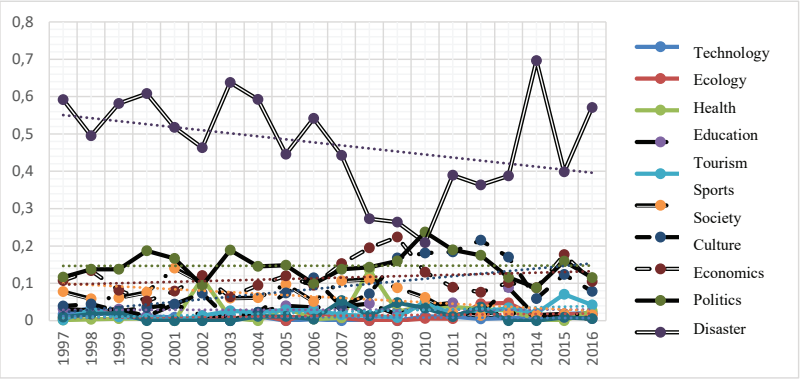


Figure 31 Themes and Topics in *People's Daily* during 1997 to 2017

which provides a context for the selected words. Wordlist is concerned with the most frequent words used in the investigated data, contributing to a frequency analysis for identifying similarities and differences of the corpora. Keyword is related to the themes of the data, which can be used to discover what mainly concerns in *People's Daily* on the issue of Hong Kong in different periods. However, most of the Chinese words correspond to more than one single character, which leads to a necessity of segmenting the Chinese characters into words. NLPIR/ICTCLAS2015, is adopted in this research, devoted to identify meaningful Chinese words.

5. Analysis

5.1. Macro Textual Analysis

This part will give a full exposition of the topics and themes related to Hong Kong in *People's Daily* during July 1997 to June 2017. Figure 31 summarizes the topical variation in the investigated period.

In general, compared to other topics such as economy, culture, sports, tourism and education, *People's Daily* is significantly more weighted towards the topic on politics. This has primarily been due to the newspaper's focus on politics. Reports on politics have typically increased in 1997-98, 2000-01, 2003-04 and in 2014-15, which is in accordance to the happening of the political events. "一国两制 (One Country, Two Systems)，港人治港 (Hong Kong people govern Hong Kong)，高度自治 (a high degree of autonomy)" is largely used when referring to the political issues. This possibly suggests the importance on the correct policies and strategies of development of Hong Kong, which helps both officers and people keep in a correct direction. The media, thus, stresses an important role both in informing readers of the political outlook of Hong Kong and in shaping Hong Kong as a region under the leadership of the Central Government.

Reports on economy and culture remain relatively constant during 1997-2017, reflecting that the government has been constantly showing great concern on the development of Hong Kong in various sectors. However, with the increasingly close ties growing between Hong Kong and the mainland of China, interests of the Chinese Government gradually shift to the social situation of Hong Kong people. Reports on working status and living environment have increased in recent years. The implication of the change is that, there exists a higher level of people-centered awareness and a growing concern over the people-related issues of the Central Government. In addition, advances in economic development of China lead possibly to more attention to the growing communication and stronger connection between the mainland of China and Hong Kong in various sectors. It can also account for the more frequent utilization of people-related themes in the newspaper. The closer tie between the mainland of China and Hong Kong encourages the deeper understanding of each other. The media, thus, evokes images of Hong Kong as a family member.

To make a further investigation, conducting the keywords analysis is able to provide an insight into the specific themes over the period. A four-way comparison is drawn with one of the corpora as the study corpus and the other three corpora as reference corpora to identify the top 100 keywords. Table 48 displays ten keywords frequently used in each period.

Periods	**1997-2002**	**2002-2007**	**2007-2012**	**2012-2017**
Keywords	江泽民、董建华、法轮功、邪教、台独、新疆、西部、贺电、交接、回归	非典、航天、口岸、太空、疫情、载人、医护、感染、英雄、迪斯尼乐园	人民币、奥运、危机、马术、公屋、自助、交易、离岸、个人游、港珠澳大桥	普选、一带一路、占中、暴乱、沪港通、粤港澳、水货客、跨境、债券、国际化

Table 48 Top Ten Keywords in each Period

The most noticeable keywords in 1997-2002 are the political figures such as 江泽民 (Jiang Zemin), the Chinese President at that time, and 董建华 (Tung Chee-hwa), the Chief Executive at that period, who were the main participants related to the major event, the handover of Hong Kong in 1997. Keywords of the first period also confirm a large amount of news reports focusing on this event, as evidenced by the lexical words 贺电 (congratulate by telegram), 交接 (handover), and 回归 (return), which reflects the significance of the change of the bilateral relation between the mainland of China and Hong Kong. Interestingly, other keywords such as 新疆 (Xin Jiang), and 西部 (Western China) are involved, indicating exchanges between the mainland of China and Hong Kong. In 1996, China launched the partner assistance policy in Xinjiang, serving to speed up its development. Hong Kong's active role in supporting the area shows that its concern about the development of the mainland of China. The repeated emphasis on the cooperation between Xinjiang and Hong Kong establishes a frame in which Hong Kong is identified with the supporter in the process of Chinese development which brings

advices to help the area in need. Even more tellingly, this portrayal features Hong Kong as a developed city and shows Hong Kong's ability to assist other areas of the mainland of China.

During the second period, the outbreak of the SARS is the main concern in the news reports, which is evidenced in multiple lexical categories in *People's Daily* such as "医护" (healthcare), "感染" (infection), "疫情" (epidemic). The newspaper puts an emphasis on the positive role of Hong Kong in the resistance against the killer disease as well as the supportive role of the mainland of China which implies both solidarity and harmony between the mainland of China and Hong Kong. Closer cooperation can also be found during the last two periods in other fields including economy, shown by certain keywords like "人民币" (RMB), "交易" (trade), "离岸" (offshore), "港珠澳大桥" (Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge), "一带一路" (One Belt, One Road). It can be seen that the role of Hong Kong is slightly changed, from being a supporter, to an important collaborator in the overall development of China. The development of Hong Kong is gradually integrating into the development of the whole country. However, there is not always a positive evaluation attributed to Hong Kong. From the keywords analysis, the representation of Hong Kong is multifaceted and complex, which is further strengthened by the use of the lexes such as "水货客" (gray goods trader), "占中" (Umbrella Protest), "暴乱" (riot) in the newspaper. It gradually builds up a thorough picture of Hong Kong, both in positive and negative characterization. The description from the mainland of China of the issues of Hong Kong indicates that the representation finally arrives at the two interwoven strands of evaluation deploying with harmonious inscriptions and disharmonious tokens. The use of negative lexis therefore acknowledges the inadequacies in the work of Hong Kong, and difficulties as well as challenges in the society. It not only reflects more attention given to Hong Kong from the Central Government; more importantly, it demonstrates the change of the Chinese media in presenting a more objective picture of a region and acknowledging the imperfection of the society.

5.2. Nomination Strategy and Predication Strategy

Following the analytical methods of DHA, nomination strategy is concerned about relationships between the linguistic projection and the ways people think and perceive. Different referring expression in the discourse is able to predispose readers' conceptual systems, influencing them on certain aspects of reality.

By viewing the most frequent referents and their incidence in each period (Table 49), "中国香港" (Hong Kong China) is dominated by reports that emphasize the political position of Hong Kong. This finding further supports the investigation about the prevalence of the political topics in the media texts. In other words, Hong Kong is overwhelmingly constructed as a SAR of People's Republic of China, directly under the control of Central People's Government, highlighting that, most importantly, Hong Kong is an inalienable part of People's Republic of China. Besides, most of the referents are relevant to the vital position of Hong Kong, illustrated by "中心" (center), "枢纽" (hub), "窗口" (window), "桥梁" (bridge), "自

由港” (free port) and “超级联系人” (super-connector). The rest of them are related to the comments and impressions on Hong Kong, as seen in “天堂” (paradise), “大都市” (metropolis) and “福地” (the Promised Land). The media perceptions of Hong Kong are therefore in a positive light. With the positive lexis, Hong Kong is discursively constructed as not only the important and the beneficial to the development of China, but also the impressive and wonderful place to live in. According to Van Dijk (2011), there is a tendency to foreground the good attributes of the in-group. In this view, the Chinese media' high level of positive evaluation toward Hong Kong discursively presents Hong Kong as an in-group “we” and construct the inter-group as well as intra-group relation with Hong Kong.

	1997-2002		2002-2007		2007-2012		2012-2017	
	N	**%**	**N**	**%**	**N**	**%**	**N**	**%**
中国香港 Hong Kong China	1,376	85.15	1,234	83.72	654	73.32	1,265	77.66
中心 center	123	7.61	121	8.21	134	15.02	174	10.68
桥梁 bridge	32	1.98	26	1.76	29	3.25	24	1.47
都市 metropolis	30	1.86	15	1.02	23	2.58	29	1.78
窗口 window	10	0.62	13	0.88	15	1.68	19	1.17
东方之珠 Pearl of the Orient	10	0.62	17	1.15	13	1.46	7	0.43
自由港 free port	23	1.42	16	1.09	10	1.12	11	0.68
枢纽 hub	5	0.31	9	0.61	3	0.34	31	1.90
天堂 paradise	6	0.37	22	1.49	8	0.90	25	1.53
福地 the Promised Land	0	0.00	0	0.00	2	0.22	8	0.49
城市 city	1	0.06	1	0.07	1	0.11	7	0.43
超级联系人 super-connector	0	0.00	0	0.00	0	0.00	29	1.78
Total	**1,616**	**100**	**1,474**	**100**	**892**	**100**	**1,629**	**100**

Table 49 Main Referents for Hong Kong in *People's Daily*

Apart from the similarities, some different referents can also be observed among these four corpora. In the periods of 2012-2017, Hong Kong is considered as the “超级联系人” (super-connector), which is in contrast to no such referents in 1997-2012. It thus not only highlights the status of Hong Kong as a valuable city with great advantage in terms of location, facilities, and professional service, but also indicates the role shift of Hong Kong from 1997 to 2017. To respond to the call of the times for development, Hong Kong is discursively represented as the

super-connector, more actively functioning as a platform for offering professional services especially to the Belt and Road, promoting RMB internationalization and enhancing cultural exchanges for the people along the Belt and Road. The new role of Hong Kong in fact not only values its existing strengths and advantages, but also puts value on its integration with the national development. In this respect, the Chinese media's perception on Hong Kong indicates that Chinese Government gives more attention to the participatory role of Hong Kong in the overall development of the whole country.

Similarly, Chinese perceptions on Hong Kong can also be seen in terms of referents for social groups. Following the analysis, the comparison of the referents of four periods shows more concern of issues related to society, people and their livelihood in recent years. This corresponds to the high frequency of social issues appeared in 2007-17, indicating an emphasis of *People's Daily* oriented upon the public ten years after the return.

The referent, 香港长官 (Chief Executive of Hong Kong) is repeated in all periods but the frequency decreases from 12 to 8 percent. This explains that the newspaper gives an emphasis on the Chief Executive during the first ten years, for he is the main participant in event of the handover of Hong Kong as well as he is in charge of the general political and economic activities. However, the less use of the referents also suggests the change on the focus from the overall political and economic environment to the viewpoints of people, which can explain the more frequent people-related themes in the recent ten years.

Word	**Translation**	**1997.7-2002.6**		**2002.7-2007.6**		**2007.7-2012.6**		**2012.7-2017.6**	
		N	%	N	%	N	%	N	%
香港同胞	Hong Kong Compatriots	306	26.9	290	23.8	178	24.3	158	18.4
香港市民	Hong Kong Citizens	181	15.9	276	22.7	186	25.3	218	25.3
香港各界	Hong Kong People from All Sectors	212	18.6	255	21.0	116	15.8	98	11.4
香港特区行政长官	Chief Executive of Hong Kong	138	12.1	171	14.1	64	8.7	76	8.8
香港居民	Hong Kong Residents	66	5.8	86	7.1	33	4.5	89	10.3
香港青年	Hong Kong Youths	148	13.0	74	6.1	68	9.3	77	9.0
香港人民	Hong Kong People	44	3.9	46	3.8	61	8.3	26	3.0
香港警方	Hong Kong Police	22	1.9	4	0.3	5	0.7	79	9.2
香港学生	Hong Kong Students	20	1.8	15	1.2	23	3.1	39	4.5

Table 50 Referents for Social Groups in *People's Daily*

If the referents of common names are further investigated by examining their attributes by means of the concordance lines, the most significant and central representation of these people can be revealed. Of the three key aspects of evaluable categories concerning emotion and feelings (i.e., negative, positive, and neutral expressions), positive attributes used to describe these people in the newspaper consistently rank the first during these twenty years. For instance, in terms of Hong Kong police, they are overwhelmingly referred in the media due to a major event, namely Umbrella Protest, in 2014. Hong Kong police are presented as "professional" and "controlled", while other participants in this event, protestors are systematically judged unfavorably, which demonstrates ideological conflicts and confrontations between the Hong Kong police and the protestors. For example:

(1) 非法"占中"持续近一个月，**奋战**在维护香港**法治最前线**的警员们，这段日子经历体力和心理的严峻考验。示威期间参与执勤的警员表示，**工作难免受到辱骂和身体损伤**，最重要是调节心态。
警长阿生和阿成都是警龄达 20 年的资深警员，均认为旺角区的示威行动最难处理。隶属冲锋队的阿成说，……，"占中"期间需带上额外装备，加上连续数天、**每天接近 20 小时值勤，后腰磨出多个水泡**，他深知告病假会加重同事的工作负担，故**自行敷药镇痛**，支撑了 11 个工作日。
……
连日来不断**被**示威者**辱骂**，一线警员承认感到不开心。阿成、阿生都表示，要懂得调节心态。此外，**不少警员家庭生活也受到影响**。

A close look at the above example shows that *People's Daily*'s representation of the conflicts between protesters and Hong Kong police is expressed in polarized evaluation, with negative attributes assigned to the protestors and positive attributes to Hong Kong police, as evidenced by "不屈不挠" (persistence) and "奋战" (strive). The evaluation of protestors is less explicit but equally ideological, for example, Hong Kong police are featured as "奋战在维护香港法治最前线" (striving for rules of law), which also contains a negative portrayal of protestors who are presented as "breaking the law" and "sabotaging the peace of Hong Kong". Besides, the attribute "辱骂" (abuse), assigned to the protesters who attempt to achieve their aims by using whatever method they can, is often related to the uncivilized who have no social standards. Furthermore, the conflicts are reinforced in the last two sentences by the explicitly unfavorable description of the unprecedented consequence made by the Protest and the protestors. In this respect, Hong Kong police are considered as "we", while protestors are characterized as "they" who "we" are against with. "We" and "our actions" are evaluated as "reasonable" and "just", while "they" and "their Protest" are judged as "illegal" and "totally wrong". Therefore, different attributes assigned to different participants in the newspaper help to delineate for readers a picture of confrontations between "us" and "them".

The positive portrayals of different groups of Hong Kong in *People's Daily* provoke strong concerns of the Chinese Central Government towards Hong Kong. As discussed previously, Hong Kong city is constructed by *People's Daily* as a modern, developed, and supportive city. Consistent with the attitudes of Hong

Kong, social groups of Hong Kong are positively presented by employing favorable attributes. According to Oakes et al. (1993), stereotypes about in-group members tends to be favorable and out-group members might be unfavorable. In this vein, Hong Kong can be observed in the positive in-group of China, which is treated more positively than another in order to emphasize its similarity to the mainland of China, like the linguistic choice of "香港同胞" (Hong Kong Compatriot), which highlights the similar origin of both Hong Kong and the mainland of China.

5.3. Perspectivization Strategy

Intertextuality, an idea emphasizing how current texts draw on other prior texts, plays an important role in media discourse in evoking a representation of the events and participants (Teo 2000). One of the techniques of intertextual representation is quotation, involving both direct and indirect, employed to influence the ways in which people see the world (Van Dijk 1989). Table 51 that social actors used in the quotations in the media.

It is worth noticing that quotations of Chinese officials are predominant in quantity, which reveals that opinions, comments, and stance of Chinese officials are of the essence in the news concerning Hong Kong. Chinese officials' views on Hong Kong conveys the newspaper's empowerment of the Central Government's influence on Hong Kong, building an image that Hong Kong is a part of China under the control of the government.

Social Actors	**1997-2002**		**2002-2007**		**2007-2012**		**2012-2017**	
	N	**%**	**N**	**%**	**N**	**%**	**N**	**%**
Experts	108	3	221	5	111	5	313	10
Public	484	13	538	13	653	29	938	32
Chinese Officials	1,007	28	1,434	34	787	35	508	17
Hong Kong Officials	1,268	35	696	16	333	15	1,055	35
Mass Media	430	12	1,224	29	288	13	195	6
International Officials	301	8	127	3	65	3	0	0
Total	**3,598**	**100**	**4,240**	**100**	**2,218**	**100**	**3,009**	**100**

Table 51 Social Actors in the Quotations in *People's Daily*

In terms of the quotation of Hong Kong officials, during 1997-2002, *People's Daily* has the high frequency of quoting Hong Kong officials, especially Tung Chee-hwa, the Chief Executive of Hong Kong at that time, who is quoted repeatedly throughout the first corpus. It can be attributed to the need to inform Chinese people of Hong Kong's attitude, stance and plans immediately after the handover. The use of these quotes gives an authoritative voice to Tung Chee-hwa and his words, emphasizing the influence of Tung and his words in interpreting and responding relevant issues of Hong Kong. The role of Sayers attributed to Tung shows the media's attempt to foreground the significance of the voices of Tung when Hong Kong attracted the attention of media and the political leaders overseas. Furthermore, Tung is also playing an important role in articulating voice of

the Central Government as well as framing the perception of the public as the "insider" in the affairs between the mainland of China and Hong Kong (Flowerdew & Leong 2007:9). In this case, Tung Chee-hwa is expected to project Hong Kong as a stable, prosperous, modern, and well-ordered society through commendation and approval. For example:

(2) **董建华**首先对世界各地的记者来香港采访政权交接仪式和特区成立大典、分享香港人的开心与喜悦表示欢迎。**他说**："江泽民主席、李鹏总理带领中央代表团来到香港参加政权交接仪式和庆典，是很让人高兴的事。"(1997/01/03)

(3) **董建华说**，香港的回归是**中华民族**的大喜事，香港的平稳过渡为国际间解决历史遗留问题提供了一个很好的范例，也将对**祖国的统一大业**产生有利影响。他强调，香港的长远利益与祖国的长远利益相一致。香港越繁荣，对**祖国**现代化建设的贡献越大；祖国发展得越好，对香港的繁荣越有利。(1997/01/03)

As seen in the two examples, Tung is quoted both directly and indirectly. In example (2), the use of the direct quotation highlights Tung's happiness towards Hong Kong's handover. However, as a leader of Hong Kong, he conveys a sense of emotion on behalf all citizens of Hong Kong, as evidenced by the use of the referent "香港人" (Hong Kong people) in "分享香港人的开心与喜悦" (share the joys of Hong Kong people), which highlights his authoritative and official status as a representative of the citizens of Hong Kong. Simultaneously, a positive emotion ("高兴" (glad)) is employed to applaud the event as well as to look forward to the future. More interestingly, in his direct quotations, positive attributes are assigned to the Chinese officials' participation of the event. The term "participation" is a nominalization encapsulating an actional process, which is actively focused as a theme for the clause. This seems to suggest that the Chinese influence is one of being relevant and pivotal to the event. Moreover, unlike other nominalizations which are trying to economize on space (Thompson 2014), "participation" in this example have attributes, specifically showing both human doers, the Chinese authority, and the circumstances. It thus can be inferred that the presence of the Chinese officials and their position is viewed as relevance and importance. By the reference of the participants in the nominalization and the theme position of the nominalization, it mirrors that Tung wants to give his reporting context more connection with the national context of China, whose interests closely link to those of Hong Kong. This perspective is further reinforced by the indirect quotation in example (3). The report tends to mention the successful story of Hong Kong as a model, positively evaluating the city's experience in dealing with the regions left by history. The positive evaluation of the success of the handover of Hong Kong and Chinese influence facilitates the linguistic construction of a positive image onto the Chinese central government. In addition, the use of the metaphor "祖国" (ancestral country) focuses on the familial relationship where "祖" emphasizes the ancestor and "国" highlights the concept of the country (Flowerdew & Leong 2007). It suggests a close tie of the concept of the family and indicates that Hong Kong is a part of China, which implies a power variation. In this respect, it can be seen that Tung is chosen by *People's Daily*, serving as a main messenger of the

Central Government to inform the public of the relationships between the mainland of China and Hong Kong.

However, as seen in Table 51, there exists a decreased level of quoting the Hong Kong official during 2002-2012, and the quotation gradually gives way to the public since 2012. These patterns can be due to an enhanced awareness for the public to play a larger role in the development of Hong Kong and Chinese media's growing concern on the public. On the one hand, the "localization of political figures" (Phoenix & Winnie 2013: 187), which indicates a shift of the Hong Kong officials from the foreigners appointed overseas before 1997 to the local people after the handover, is likely to make the public more comfortable to express themselves in their languages as well as to evoke their stronger reactions on the major events in Hong Kong, such as the Financial Crisis in 1997, which is accompanied with the deflation and rising unemployment. Such problems, closely linked to people's livelihood, have brought the society-wide attention, resulting in the active participation of the local community in expressing their views to local leaders. It can explain that unfavorable quotes of the public increase as well. It also suggests the people's growing needs for a better life. The needs to be met for the people to live better are increasingly broad in terms of their demands for fairness, justice, security, and a better environment. On the other hand, having relatively more quotes of the public also reveals the Chinese media's concern on the local community, which is consistent with the people-centered vision acted by the Chinese Government. It reflects that the people's sense of fulfilment has been comparatively stronger and people's participation in the social events are more and more essential. If the frequent quotation of the Chief Executive is devoted to guarantee the smooth transition and handover of Hong Kong in the first ten years, constructing Hong Kong from the official's perspective as a prosperous city under the practice of "One Country, Two Systems", the focus shifting to the quotes of the public places an emphasis on the issues on economy and people livelihood from the perspective of the local, depicting Hong Kong as the region where social and economic matters are gradually taken into people' s own hands. In this respect, the media serves to both inform readers of the outlook of Hong Kong, the change of identities and roles of Hong Kong people in the development of Hong Kong.

Despite its comparatively low frequency in the investigated corpora in *People's Daily*, quoting experts, the mass media and the international officials shows the serious, authoritative feature of the Chinese media. It serves to convince and persuade readers by projecting itself as an objective and unbiased press in presenting the image of Hong Kong. However, citing them in the newspaper is not arbitrary, but serves the central government's purposes. Experts are analysts, focusing on giving the opinion on certain social phenomenon and getting the public's attention by making professional research. They are also seen as the primary definer of the social ideology, framing the public's values and influencing their concept, in this case, perceptions on Hong Kong.

Similar to the experts, quotations of the mass media are aligned with the policies of the Central Government. More interestingly, the mass media is represented

in generic terms instead of specific media, such as “香港媒体” (Hong Kong media), which seems to include all the media of Hong Kong. By using these generalizations of the mass media, it delineates a picture that all the media of Hong Kong is the supporter of the Chinese Government.

Attitude	Reporting Verbs	1997-2002		2002-2007		2007-2012		2012-2017	
		N	%	N	%	N	%	N	%
Neutral	谈，发表讲话，表示，认为，公布，说，指出，呼吁，解释，透露，发表谈话，显示，评述，致电，宣布，评价，称，回应，强调	3,308	91	3,944	93	2,089	94	2,794	93
Negative	敦促，批驳，抨击，揭批，谴责，痛斥	125	3	132	3	40	2	141	5
Positive	祝福，电贺，勉励，（高度）评价，盛赞	188	5	164	4	90	4	74	2

Table 52 Reporting Verbs in Quotations

A close look at the reporting verbs (Table 52) can reveal that during twenty years, most of the reporting verbs are used neutrally, as seen in “谈” (say), “表示” (express), “认为” (think), and “评价” (evaluate), endeavoring to contribute the discursive construction of a neutral stance. The choice of these verbs implies the neutral and impartial nature of the news media, which is also as a means of showing who is reporting the statements. These statements are largely attributed to government official in indirect quotations, underlining the privilege position of the authoritative official. It contributes to conjure up an image of power and authority, implying that the statements they are reporting are endorsed. Furthermore, the lexical choice of the verbs also has the implication that the view it reports is well informed, for the statement at least “comes from a position of strength or knowledge” (Floyd 2000: 50). For example, in Xi Jinping’s speech, Hong Kong Government has shown its great concern on the development of Hong Kong in spite of its current recession. The verb “指出” (point out) indicates that the efforts made by the Government of Hong Kong are seen and viewed by the Central Government.

In addition to the neutral reporting verbs with low graduation revealed above, which builds up a comparatively unbiased picture for the readers, some neutral reporting verbs are expressed with relatively high grading, as evidenced by such lexical words “宣布” (announce), “公布” (declare), “强调” (emphasize), and “呼吁” (appeal). The reporting verbs “announce” and “declare”, in some cases, are expressed neutrally, but in most cases, they are biased, for an “announcement” or a “declaration” is mainly seen as true, which presupposes, to some extent, the truth of the statement (Floyd 2000). According to Bell (1991), if an announcement or a declaration is pronounced by the people in authority, it can express a news action

which makes the news reporting ideal and newsworthy through a fusion of word and act. What is of significance, in this case, is related to both the reporter and his act. Therefore, it implies a power difference where control may be exercised through approved role to the audience because what has been announced or declared is unchangeable. It uncovers the powerful and privileged position of the reporter, usually from official sources, such as the Chinese President. In other words, some degrees of dependence of the central government is inevitable, for Hong Kong is vested in the Chinese Communist Party, underlining the mainland of China's beneficial role in the development of Hong Kong.

Apart from the neutral reporting verbs which connote positive values, positive reporting verbs have ostensibly favorable attitudes, such as "祝福" (wish), "电贺" (congratulate by telegram), "勉励" (encourage), "（高度）评价" (highly value), "盛赞" (highly praise). In order to yield insight into the positive issues in the eyes of China during these twenty years, semantic preference can be examined to discover the shared semantic feature among different linguistic choices. From the concordance analysis of these words, four main semantic fields are found in the news texts, including: (1) return of Hong Kong, (2) influence of the mainland of China on political reform, development, and system in Hong Kong, (3) Hong Kong political reform, development, and system, (4) Hong Kong business, economy, and tourism. In this view, perceptions of China towards Hong Kong are therefore generally favorable, with positive views on Hong Kong's handover, suggesting the reunion of a big family, as well as the overall progress of Hong Kong in terms of its politics and economy in these years. However, more importantly, the highlighting role of the mainland of China on Hong Kong's political reform, as evidenced by "re-interpretation of the Basic Law" in the Hong Kong's reports on political issues implies the National People's Congress of China's power to amend and interpret the Basic Law. The implication of such texts is that, Hong Kong enjoys the status as an administrative region, under the leadership of the central government. In *People's Daily*, Hong Kong is presented as a city that sticks to the principle and obeys the laws. The positive evaluation of both the China's influence on Hong Kong and Hong Kong's political development is also a favorable connotation of Hong Kong's close interaction with the mainland of China which ensures the prosperity and stability of Hong Kong.

Besides, negative reporting verbs can be also found in *People's Daily*, mostly in high grading, insinuating that some actions are seen negatively in *People's Daily*. By means of the concordance analysis, the most frequent semantic preferences following the negative reporting verbs are identified, namely: (1) overseas/international influence or relation regarding political reform/development/systems in Hong Kong, and (2) events on pro-Taiwan independence, (3) Falun Gong, and (4) Umbrella Protest. These actions are mainly labeled in a negative way. For example:

(4) 中方**敦促**英方切实尊重中方的立场和关切，恪守有关承诺，立即停止以任何方式干涉香港事务，并采取有效措施消除此事造成的恶劣影响，以实际行动维护中英关系和两国合作。(2014/07/17)

(5) 连日来，香港各界纷纷举行座谈、发表谈话，**谴责**台湾极少数人分裂祖国、主张“台独”的言行，呼吁坚持一个中国原则。(2000/04/25)
(6) 香港中资机构继续深入**揭批**“法轮功”充当反华势力工具祸国殃民的本质。(2000/07/27)
(7) 连日来，内地专家学者在接受媒体访问时，**谴责**“占中”破坏香港法治、破坏社会安宁，坚决拥护中央对港方针政策，坚定支持特区政府依法处置，维护香港社会稳定，保护香港市民人身和财产安全。(2014/10/17)

As seen from example (4), the prevalent attitude in *People's Daily* is negative, condemning the UK's inappropriate interference on Hong Kong's affairs as "breaking the commitment" and "influencing the bilateral relations and cooperation". In example (5), the statements about Taiwan's pro-independence is negatively represented, showing the strong disapproval of the separatists who advocates pro-independence in Taiwan and their activities. In example (6), the negative characterization of Falun Gong is evidenced in multiple lexical categories. The activity, for instance, is identified as "a danger of both nation and people" and "a tool for anti-Chinese forces", which tends to reveal negative sides of Falun Gong and to conjure up an image of different ideological camps: The Chinese side and the anti-Chinese forces. In example (7), lexes are found to construct the Central Government as the one that concerns about Hong Kong's stability and its people as well as promotes positive values such as the staunch advocate of peace and vindicator of laws. However, protestors and the movement are classified and identified by *People's Daily* with negative connotations such as violation of laws, defiance, and disobedience. In this way, the description allows *People's Daily* to establish relationships between two participants (the Central Government and Umbrella Protest) and classify their action.

In sum, through the use of the negative reporting verbs, *People's Daily* shows the tough attitude of the Central Government toward activities that interfere internal Chinese affairs, emphasizing that Hong Kong is considered as an internal part of China. It also foregrounds the variation and conflict between the positive in-group and the negative out-group, which constructs a world divided into law-abiding participant/supporter to Hong Kong's development/peacekeeper and disrespectful participant to laws/destroyer to Hong Kong's development/aggressor. This serves to underline the difference and conflict between two groups by assigning the in-group we to positive values as well as assigning the out-group them to negative values. As a result, this type of variation is able to reinforce the links within the group that we form and to exclude the group that they form so as to construct the notion of patriotism and strengthen the national identity within China.

6. Discussion and Conclusion

The handover of Hong Kong in 1997 is a milestone in the history of Hong Kong, and a highlight in the history of China-UK relations, which receives a lot of attention both in the East and the West that focuses on the future of Hong Kong in terms of its political development, economic advances, and people's livelihood. This study uses *People's Daily*'s reports of Hong Kong during 1997-2017, within the

theoretical framework of DHA and analytic tools of corpus-assisted approach to find out the Chinese perception of Hong Kong.

A strong focus on the political issues of Hong Kong in *People's Daily* has been found during these twenty years. It places an emphasis on the correct direction and developmental strategies of Hong Kong, in hope of presenting Hong Kong as a stable and prosperous SAR under the principle of "One Country, Two Systems". In this respect, it implies a naturalized state of power variation between the mainland of China and Hong Kong where Hong Kong is under the control of the Central Government. In addition, there also exists an increasing emphasis of the newspaper concerning people-related topic in the recent ten years, showing a growing concern of the Central Government about the public's livelihood of Hong Kong. In addition, the largely dominant views on economy show the significant position of Hong Kong as a business center during 1997-2017. However, change can be observed in an increasing emphasis on the integration of Hong Kong into the development of the mainland of China in the recent years, which has gradually replaced the focus on the role of Hong Kong as a medium during 1997-2002, signifying the mainland of China's development and its closer tie with Hong Kong from the economic perspective. Culture-related, sports-related, and education-related issues can also be found in *People's Daily* during these twenty years, which reveals that Hong Kong is presented multifacetedly in the discourse. It thus suggests the mainland of China's concerns towards Hong Kong and *People's Daily*'s attempt to construct a multifarious image of Hong Kong since its return.

After a close observation of the referents of Hong Kong, it can be seen that Hong Kong is positively described by the Chinese media. The *People's Daily*'s high degree of favorable appreciation towards Hong Kong discursively constructs the successful Hong Kong especially under the leadership of the Central Government. The positive views about the city itself in the first ten years are found to be slowly replaced by an emphasis on the responsibilities of Hong Kong in order to achieve the Chinese Dream in 2007-2017. Through the collocation and concordance analysis, Hong Kong is linguistically presented as the beneficial and the cared, supported by the Central Government at all aspects. In terms of the referents of social groups of Hong Kong, change is mainly seen in an increase in the focus on the Hong Kong's public. Such change, as reflected in the macro-level of discussion, reveals a social and political shift in the Central Government's attitude and positionings towards Hong Kong, a shift from the stronger focus on the political strategy to the concern about individual's views. For the perspectivization strategy, it can be seen that Chinese Government's influence on Hong Kong's issues are of importance. In 1997-2007, Hong Kong is discursively constructed through the eyes of the Hong Kong's officials, helping to articulate the Central Government's political messages. In 2007-2017, Hong Kong is linguistically presented from the perspective of the public, suggesting that Hong Kong is not perfect, but that people are united.

People's Daily is aligned with the mainland of China's policies, which reveals a high degree of positive evaluation towards Hong Kong. Hong Kong is always seen as an in-group member of China which the Chinese Government continues to

support despite some existing social disharmonies. On the contrary, western interfere to Hong Kong is unfavorably presented in the newspaper. Through the negative evaluation of foreign countries' influence on the political development or system of Hong Kong, an ideological polarization is therefore established between the positive "us" and negative "them". Such representation reflects not only the roles of Hong Kong through the eyes of the Central Government but also the mainland of China's attitude towards overseas influence on Hong Kong. As for the intra-group relation, the emphasis on the positive influence of Chinese Government on Hong Kong's development and Hong Kong's political positioning as a SAR constructs not only a status difference but also a power variation between the mainland of China and Hong Kong. As for the inter-group relation, western interference on Hong Kong's political system is negatively constructed as violating not only the internal affairs of other nations but also the international laws. By means of these descriptions, *People's Daily* frames the public's perception, serves the central government's purposes, and constructs the identity as a patriotic Chinese.

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British and American News Reports on Chinese Tourists: A Corpus-based Appraisal Analysis

Yao Ye

Sun Yat-sen University

Abstract

The present study collects relevant reports on Chinese outbound tourists from 2001 to September 2018 from New York Times, Washington Post, the Guardian, and the Independent. Since 2005, the number of reports from both British and American media on Chinese tourists has increased dramatically. The focus is mainly on the size, consumption power and behavior of Chinese tourists. British and American media newspapers have both positive and negative attitudes towards Chinese tourists. The positive evaluation mainly concentrates on the economic contribution of Chinese tourists and the negative evaluation mainly stresses the uncivilized behavior. Finally, the participation of Chinese government is mentioned and it is mostly negatively depicted. The relationship between news language and ideology is hidden behind the texts. It is hoped that this study can fill some research gaps on the discursive construction of Chinese tourists' image, using corpus and Appraisal Theory, and make some contributions on critical discourse analysis of news discourse.

Keywords: Appraisal Theory; corpus; Chinese Tourists; news Discourse

1. Introduction

With the development of China's economy, the number of Chinese outbound tourists has increased day by day, and it has attracted the attention of Western media. The consumption of Chinese tourists abroad has stimulated the economic development of the destination countries, while the impolite behavior of some Chinese tourists has negatively affected the image of China in many countries. The purpose of this study is to collect the news discourse of the mainstream media in the UK and the US since 2005, and use Martin's Appraisal Theory as the framework to conduct critical discourse analysis.

The present study collects relevant reports on Chinese outbound tourists from 2005 to September 2018 from four mainstream western newspapers. The news reports collected are first classified, and the corpus of news headlines and body are respectively built. With the help of Word Smith 5.0, keywords, collocations, concordance, and evaluation of attitudes are analyzed under the guidance of Appraisal Theory. After comparing and summarizing the data of Chinese tourists, a deeper interpretation of the ideology hidden behind the discourse is finally made.

2. Data collection and methodology

2.1. Data collection

The data in the present study include 104 news reports of 75,814 tokens from four English (online) newspapers focusing on the Chinese outbound tourists. The four English newspapers are The *New York Times*, *Washington Post*, *the Guardian*, and *the Independent.*

The selected newspapers enjoy high reputation and popularity around the world with a wide range of topics at home and abroad, which can be used to analyze different perspectives towards Chinese outbound tourists. I choose the quality British and American media rather than tabloids mainly for two reasons: primarily, the quality media conveys more of the mainstream voice, which can better serve the main goal of the present research. Moreover, quality media are less likely to be affected by financial situation and therefore the underlying ideology can be detected objectively.

The research keywords cover "Chinese tourists", "Chinese travelers", "Chinese shoppers", "Chinese visitors", etc. In order to achieve objectivity, validity and manageability of the present study, the news reports are collected in time sequence from 2005 to September, 2018, focusing on Chinese tourists' behaviors and influence on the destination countries.

2.2. Analytic methods and procedure

Qualitative method is adopted to help identify various attitudinal resources. The data of the news reports are grouped into different types under the framework of Attitude System. To get precise results, both identification and classification are grounded on Appraisal Theory's sub-systems.

Wordsmith Tools 5.0 is applied in the present study, which is a program package for linguistic analysis that is widely used in corpus linguistics. The first generation was developed by Mike Scott and first released in 1996. It includes three modules: *Wordlist* (listing all the words that are included in a corpus with the corresponding statistical data), *Concord* (creating concordances, finding instances of a word or a phrase), and *Keyword* (creating a list of all the salient words that occur more frequently and more significantly in one corpus in comparison to another that is taken as a reference corpus). In the present study, Wordsmith Tools 5.0 is used to extract and present the keywords, wordlists, collocates and concordance lines. In order to make sure the semantic significance of selected collocates, function words or semantic insignificant words are eliminated from the result list.

The analytic procedures are as follows:

1. Collect the news reports from the websites and build two corpora, corpus CTH (Chinese tourists headlines), and corpus CTB (Chinese tourists body) with the help of Wordsmith 5.0.

2. Obtain the keyword lists of the news headlines from corpus CTH and make the engagement analysis to find out the focus of the news reports on Chinese tourists and the voices involved in the evaluation.

3. Extract the collocates, cluster and concordance lines from corpus CTB and divide them into groups to make attitudinal analysis, aiming to identify the attitudes of the news reports towards Chinese tourists.

4. Reveal ideologies hidden in the news text on basis of the semantic preference within the framework of Appraisal System and associate the social international environment.

3. Corpus-assisted news discourse analysis

In recent years, the advantages of adopting corpus linguistics approaches in CDA and related fields have already been demonstrated (Baker, 2004a, 2006; Hardt-Mautner, 1995; Koller and Mautner, 2004; Mautner, 2000; O'Halloran and Coffin, 2004, cited in Baker 2008). Corpus linguistics is the 'study of language based on examples of "real life" language use' (McEnery and Wilson 1996: 1). Stubbs (1996) provides detailed studies in one of the fastest growing areas of linguistics – corpus analysis – and shows how computers can be used to reveal culturally significant patterns of language use.

News discourse is of significance in CDA to explore deeply the relationship between language and ideology. With the help of corpus linguistics, the discourse analysis can be more objective and systematic, especially in comparative studies.

Corpus is used as a resource for data analysis, especially in the comparative discourse analysis. Galasinski and Marley (1998) conduct a comparative quantitative content analysis of two corpora from the British and Polish press (10 national daily newspapers and 10 national weeklies from Britain and Poland) to identify agency in foreign news. It suggests that quantitative content analysis may be the most useful means of revealing topics discussed by some of the media coverage of the moment and that two analytical methods can be complementary. Baker and Mcenery (2005) use corpus analysis in a more systematic way to compare the discourses of refugees and asylum seekers from British newspapers and UN websites. The result shows that concordances of the terms refugee(s) and asylum seeker(s) were examined and grouped along patterns which revealed linguistic traces of discourses and the underlying attitudes of the writers towards the subject. Wang (2015) collects the news reports on 2015 China Victory Day Parade from China Daily and British and American mainstream newspapers so as to identify different focuses of Chinese and Western news reports and the reasons behind them. Orpin (2005) carries out an examination on a set of eight words that are semantically relevant to corruption, sleaze, bribery, graft, malpractice(s), impropriety/ties, nepotism, and cronyism, in a corpus of 800 texts from 4 British newspapers: *the Guardian, the Independent, the Times,* and *the tabloid Today*. To process the data, corpus methodology is applied. To be more specific, concordances and collocational tools are used to produce semantic profiles of the words, to emphasize the

connotational differences, as well as to identify the geographical locations that the words refer to.

Diachronic research on news discourse over years also benefits from the corpus-assisted study. Yang and Wu (2012) analyze language forms and discursive strategies adopted by major US media through a method of corpus-based CDA, concentrating on its tendency and attitudes towards Chinese women in the news reports of *New York Times* (1980-2011). Baker, Gabrielatos and Mcenery (2013) use methods from corpus linguistics and CDA to examine patterns of representation around the word Muslim in a 143-million-word corpus of British newspaper articles published between 1998 and 2009.

Identity and ideology study on news discourse is also a popular study subject of corpus linguistics. Zhang and Mihelj (2012) use corpus-assisted approach to explore the discursive construction of collective identity in the Hong Kong press, especially Hong Kong's relationship with mainland China. The aim is not only to develop a representative description and interpretation of discursive patterns, but also to offer an explanation of the discursive construction of Hong Kong identity. The research of Baker et al. (2008) is based on the analysis of a 140-million-word corpus of British news articles about refugees, asylum seekers, immigrants and migrants. It is proved that the processes such as collocation and concordance analysis are helpful to identify common categories of representation of RASIM as well as leading analysts to representative texts in order to carry out a qualitative analysis. Hakam (2009) explores the barely-known discourse site of English-language Arab newspapers. By adopting quantitative methods to process a large amount of data, it reveals specific patterns of how these newspapers replicate, resist and/or challenge mainstream discourse from mainstream European culture. Salama (2011) proposes what is termed a "methodological synergy" (Baker et al., 2008) of corpus linguistics and CDA for exploring how conflicting ideologies have been actualized at collocation level in completely different discourses on Wahhabi-Saudi Islam/Wahhabism since 9/11.

Many researches have provided sensible examples for the use of corpora in news discourse analysis. Besides, it demonstrates the advantages of corpus linguistics in investigating the dialectical relationship between discourse and ideology. Yang (2018) analyzes the news reports in *China Daily* and *New York Times* on "new normal" of the China's economy from 2014 to 2017, and discusses the discourse construction from the view of critical discourse analysis. With the help of the corpus software AntConc, the corpus analysis method is used to explain the reasons for the similarities and differences of the discourse construction methods from the aspects of ideology, international relations and news value.

When it comes to the analytic procedures of corpus-assisted media discourse analysis, Sinclair (1996) comes up with the model of Extended Units of Meaning, ranging over collocation, colligation, semantic preference and semantic prosody. Stubbs (2007: 124) makes it clear that collocation is the relation of co-occurrence of an obligatory core (the node) and individual collocates. Colligation means the relation of co-occurrence between the node and abstract grammatical categories.

Semantic preference is defined as the relation of co-occurrence between the phrasal units and words from characteristic lexical field. It can be used to clarify the topic of the text. Semantic prosody is used to describe the writer or speaker's attitude and discourse function.

4. Analysis and Findings

This study gives a corpus-assisted discourse study of the news reports on Chinese tourists from four western newspapers, drawing upon the Appraisal theory. More specifically, both headlines and body of the news reports are discussed separately In terms of headlines, I use Wordsmith 5.0 to summarize the topics of the news reports on Chinese tourists based on the wordlist data and do the engagement analysis to trace the source of evaluation. Secondly, within the framework of attitude system, I analyze the cluster, collocate and concordance lines centered on "Chinese tourists" in corpus CTH. Finally, since news is, by no means, ideology-free, I tend to explore the ideological meaning displayed in the concordance lines of "Beijing" about the Chinese government.

4.1. Appraisal Analysis on News Headlines

4.1.1. *Wordlist analysis*

Headlines are words set at the head which make the newspaper's own stance clear. From headlines, readers can grasp the main ideas of the news reports in a short time. Therefore, it is effective to collect all the headlines to build corpus CTH and list the wordlist in the corpus so as to analyze the main concerns and general attitude of the British and American media towards Chinese outbound tourists. The diachronic changes of the reports number can reflect the fluctuation of the media's attention degree.

As Figure 32 shows, in general, the number of news reports on Chinese tourists is on the rising trend from 2005. After 2009, the reports number is growing at a rate of several folds, which indicates that the western media pays more attention on Chinese tourists since 2005, especially after 2009. The phenomena may attribute to the fact that since 2008, Chinese government introduced major stimulus programs amid a sagging global economy and Chinese newly wealthy people become a fast-growing presence around the world.

Period	Reports	Wordlists (frequency ≥2)
2005-2009	6	Chinese, Tourists, Big, Wave, New
2010-2014	39	Chinese, Tourists, Taiwan, Big, Wealthy, Bad, Britain, Business, luxury, Could, Don't, Why, If, ect
2014-2018	58	Chinese, Tourists, North, Korea, New, Abroad, Names, UK, Golden, Week, Israli, Charged, Arrested, Crashes, Wealthy

Table 53 Wordlists of news reports from 2005 to 2018

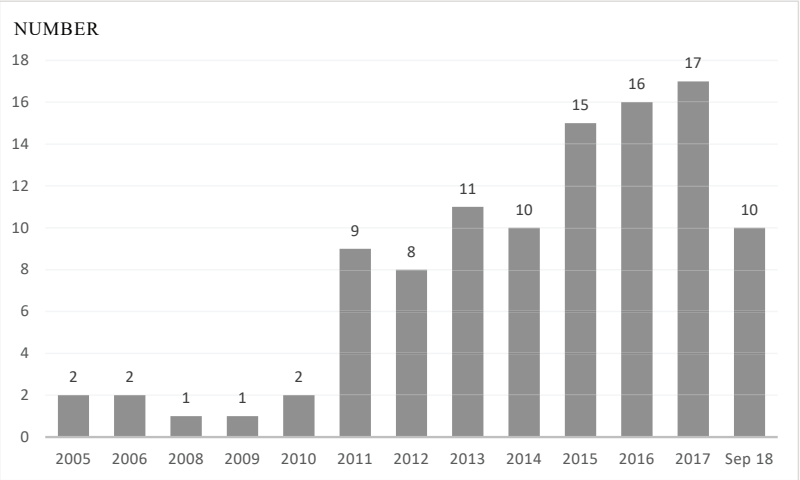


Figure 32 Number of Reports from 2005 to 2018/9

Keywords list demonstrates word frequency and keyness. Keywords serve as a valuable clue to what the text is exactly about, so presenting the keyword list is useful and effective to analyze the focus of the reports. Table 53 presents us a clear picture of the wordlists in the news reports on Chinese tourists. Most of the keywords are geographical nouns and adjective words to describe Chinese tourists and their destination places. It can be noticed that from 2005 to 2009, the British and American media paid a little attention to Chinese tourists when Chinese tourists as a newly-emerged group were growing at the initial stage. They showed welcome attitude towards Chinese tourists while lacking overall knowledge on them. Chinese tourists were not eye-catching and did not carry much weight in the western media. The reason behind the limited media coverage of Chinese tourists in the western reports before 2009 may be related to the fact that at that time, only small amount of Chinese people can afford to travel abroad, especially to the high consumption countries like European countries.

From 2009, British and American news media began to take bigger space on Chinese tourists which to a large extent attribute to Beijing Olympic Games 2008. It can be noticed that some evaluative and descriptive adjective words are used to outline the image of Chinese tourists. The news reports kept a more watchful eye on Chinese tourists and realized that the great potential on them should not be underestimated, especially the consumption potential. More aspects and features of Chinese tourists were pictured. Besides, they started to ask why to analyze the driving force to attract Chinese tourists and make some conclusions for reference. At the same time, the subject participants ranged from hotels, government to the luxury brands, from which we get to know that Chinese tourists were valued enough by the various sectors of the society.

From 2015 till 2018, more news reports began to give detailed attention to Chinese tourists including some accidents and conflicts, as "Charged, Arrested, Crashes" showed in the wordlist. Within the media coverage of Chinese tourist, other Asian countries were mentioned in the news reports on Chinese tourists, which means that the western media took more interests in Chinese tourists all over the world as well as making comparison with visitors from different countries. Some Chinese holidays, the so-called "golden week", became focus for the Europe and America, calling actions of the local businesspeople. Thus, the western media still hoped for the Chinese shoppers to boost consumption under the dilemma of global economic slowdown.

4.1.2. *Engagement Analysis*

The main concern of the Engagement system is that who is making the evaluations, so there may be many voices or one single voice. These resources can be used as a kind of interpersonal strategy to realize the alignment or disalignment with the ideal audiences or readers by the speaker or the writer. More detailed analysis is made to identify the realizations of the evaluative resources under the framework of engagement systems for various linguistic phenomena in the news reports.

Engagement resouces		**Frequency**	**Percentage**	
Monogloss		85	83	83
	contract-disclaim-deny	1		
	contract-disclaim-counter	0		
	contract-proclaim-concur	5	7	
Heterogloss	contract-proclaim-pronounce	0		17
	contract-proclaim-endorse	1		
	expand-entertain	0		
	expand-attribute-acknowledge	11	10	
	expand-attribute-distance	0		

Table 54 General Frequencies of Engagement Words in 103 Samples

It can be found from Table 54 that monogloss in the headlines of news reports on Chinese tourists are largely used compared with heterogloss, in proportion of 83% and 17%. Moreover, in heterogloss, the frequency of contraction resources and expansion resources reach to 7 and 11 times respectively. Obviously, expansion is more frequent used than extraction. Journalists employ contractive resources to challenge and limit the scope of dialogue alternatives. Expansive resources are used as rhetorical strategies by journalists to express objectivity and solidarity. Hence, the reports are inclined to negotiate with other voices in order to be consistent with readers. On the part of different types under heterogloss system, attribute takes up the highest, and concur is the next highest. The reporters add external voices to enhance persuasion, which strengthens their value orientations. Most of

the external voices of the headlines are from authoritative sources including officials, professionals, government, and relevant studies.
Monogloss Examples:

(1) Chinese tourists flock to UK in search of Clarks, fog and the 'big stupid clock (The Guardian 2005/6/27)
(2) Next Wave of Camera-Wielding Tourists Is From China (The New York Times 2006/05/17)
(3) New York Sees Big Potential in a New Wave of Chinese Tourists (The New York Times 2008/06/24)
(4) American Hotels Embrace Chinese Business Travelers (The New York Times 2011/10/04)
(5) New hotel services aimed at Chinese and Indian tourists (The Independent 2011/4/5)
(6) Chinese tourists banned from travelling after plane brawls and other acts of violence (The Independent 2015/12/21)
(7) Disorderly Chinese Tourists on Thai Flight Draw Official Rebuke (The New York Times 2014/12/15)

Examples showed above are under the monogloss system without involving others' opinions or voices. Monogloss is concerned with bare assertions and excludes alternative possibilities. In other words, subjective statements involving only the writer rather than other positions or alternative voices. When the writer expresses his point of view in a monoglossic way, it means that the stated proposition is self-evident, rational, and appropriate. It does not need to consider any other views which are more likely to be challenged, from the audience or readers. In the headlines, the reporter proposes a monoglossic proposition with no dialogistic alternatives to be engaged with. Most of the headlines give account of what happened related to Chinese tourists. Examples (1) & (2) are describing the phenomena that Chinese tourists are attached to taking photos and buying new brands. Examples (3), (4) and (5) report the fact that Chinese tourists are welcome by the local hotels. Examples (6) & (7) show that conflicts occurred for Chinese tourists' improper behaviors. Thus, monogloss takes the main part in the headlines of news reports on Chinese tourists to cover the events or phenomena with only one voice.

Reporters also attempt to incorporate others' words into news headlines and present the sources of the information, so as to show the reliability, truthfulness and factuality of the assertions. It leads readers to have the general impression that the reports are free from personal opinions and thus have higher credibility.

(8) Chinese tourists to Taiwan up 500 percent: govt [heterogloss: attribute: acknowledge] (The Independent 2009/11/26)
(9) Chinese tourists splurge on French tax-free luxury: study [heterogloss: attribute: acknowledge] (The Independent 2010/1/21)
(10) Harold Tillman: 'Chinese tourists can save the high street – if we let them' [heterogloss: attribute: acknowledge] (The Independent 2012/2/15)

(11) Revealed: How Chinese tourists should behave abroad [heterogloss: contract: endorse] (The Independent 2013/10/20)

The external voices quoted in the headlines of news reports on Chinese tourists in the examples listed above are government statement, tourism studies, the local owner and guide book. Attributes, used in the example headlines above, is concerned with the source of speech being expressed as external rather than self, indicating that external opinions and expressions are accepted and recognized by the writer. Examples (8), (9) and (10) ascribe the proposition to external sources and make the proposition from the reporter's internal voice. Example (8) quotes statistics from Chinese government, showing the rapid growth of mainland tourists to Taiwan. The official source is considered much more reliable and accurate than others. The assertion of Example (9) is according to Global Refund, a company targeting tax-free shopping for tourists. The headlines are quoted from the professional and authorized sources, which makes the proposition that Chinse tourists have enormous purchasing power to boost the French luxury industry more reliable and warrantable. Example (10) is attributed to the external voice of Tillman, owner of the clothing labels Jaeger and Aquascutum, who said current visa restrictions were causing shops to lose billions of pounds in potential profits. He also argued that changing the rules for Chinese tourists could boost growth and bolster grim employment figures. The reporter uses the opinion from a store owner to show the real attitudes towards Chinese tourists from the local people, which illustrates the fact that Chinese tourists' consumption stimulates the local economic development and gain popularity from the local merchants. Endorse includes external voice and is responsible to contract the dialogic space. Example (11) comes from a new guidebook outlining social etiquette for Chinese tourists, published by China's National Tourism Administration. The reporter shoulders the responsibility with the cited source to some degree. Reporter quotes the key points from the official guide book to stress that Chinese tourists' behaviors need to improve, which reflects that Chinese government is also conscious of the problems brought by the Chinese tourists' uncivilized behaviors.

4.2. Appraisal Analysis on News Body

Apart from headline analysis, the news body provides more information and attitudinal resources. This section is composed of three parts, cluster, collocate and concordance analysis of "Chinese tourists" to find out the detailed description and attitudes of western media towards Chinese tourists. Besides, the concordance lines of "Beijing" is presented to investigate the hidden ideological meanings in the western news reports.

4.2.1. *Cluster Analysis*

Cluster in Wordsmith 5.0 offers a group of words of the same kind that are very close with the keyword. The present study searches the cluster of "Chinese tourists" in corpus CTB and the result is as follows.

As illustrated in Table 55, the most frequent clusters of "Chinese tourists" are showed above in which the first cluster is "NUMBER OF CHINESE TOURISTS". It reveals that the number of Chinese tourists is the most concerned aspect for the western media.

N	Cluster	Freq.	Length
1	NUMBER OF CHINESE TOURISTS	20	4
2	THE NUMBER OF	15	4
3	A GROUP OF	12	4
4	GROUP OF CHINESE TOURISTS	8	4
5	THAT CHINESE TOURISTS ARE	7	4
6	AND FOUR NORTH	6	4
7	OF CHINESE TOURISTS VISITING	6	4
8	TO ATTRACT CHINESE TOURISTS	6	4
9	CHINESE TOURISTS VISITING THE	6	4
10	CHINESE TOURISTS AND FOUR	6	4
11	32 CHINESE TOURISTS AND	5	4
12	FOUR NORTH KOREANS	5	4
13	OF CHINESE TOURISTS ARE	5	4

Table 55 Top cluster of "Chinese tourists" in corpus CTB

Besides, "CHINESE TOURISTS ARE" is also often used to give a general description or definition on Chinese tourists. Here Chinese tourists are labeled as a collectivity with group characteristics and no individual difference. To some extent, it is related to the fact that Chinese tourists prefer package tour in a group when traveling abroad because of language barriers and convenience, especially the middle-aged people. Most of them may travel abroad for the first time, afraid of the strange places, so travelling in a group with friends or families can give them a sense of safety. However, more importantly, when Chinese tourists misbehave, western media views it as the "quality" of all Chinese as a group. The media is a perceptual amplifier that, through selective coverage, has a distorted perception of the severity of Chinese tourists' misconduct.

4.2.2. *Collocate Analysis*

On one level, collocation is a lexical relation better discernable in the analysis of large amounts of data, and, therefore, it is less accessible to introspection or the manual analysis of a small number of texts (Hunston, 2002; cited in Baker et al., 2008). As Stubbs put forward (1996: 172), the implications of words or phrases

are mostly illustrated by the characteristic collocations. To eliminate judgement by intuitions, Baker (2006: 95) indicates that the salient aspects of concordances should be revealed by the grouping of collocates. According to Stubbs (1986), the typical language resources that are used to convey evaluation are words, phrases, and collocations. Therefore, analyzing the collocate words can closely evaluate the western media on Chinese tourists in various aspects.

The tables below clearly represent that in the self-built corpus CTB, "Chinese tourists/visitors" often collocates with content words -- nouns, adjectives, and verbs. As Table 56 suggests, from the perspective of nouns, it can be noticed that the number of Chinese tourists grabs the western media's eyes most frequently. Besides, the behaviors of Chinese tourists are also the focus of the reports, especially the consuming behaviors. Additionally, some countries and temporal nominals are collocated with Chinese tourists in the reports. Some Asian countries are also mentioned, which suggests that the western media not only pays attention to Chinese tourists in Europe and America, but also some Asian countries. It indicates that the western media is taking a broader view on Chinese tourists from places to places and paying attention to their travelling time, even some Chinese traditional and national holiday, called golden week.

Nouns			
N	**Word**	**With**	**Total**
1	NUMBER	Chinese tourists	23
2	NORTH	Chinese tourists	15
3	GROUP	Chinese tourists	14
4	MILLION	Chinese tourists	11
5	SPENDING	Chinese tourists	8
6	BRITAIN	Chinese tourists	7
7	KOREA	Chinese tourists	8
8	POLICE	Chinese tourists	6
9	WORLD	Chinese tourists	5
10	YEAR	Chinese tourists	9
11	BEHAVIOR	Chinese tourists	5
12	KOREANS	Chinese tourists	5
13	GROUPS	Chinese tourists	5

Table 56 Categorized Nouns Collocates of "Chinese tourists/ Chinese visitors"

Adjective			
N	**Word**	**With**	**Total**
1	MORE	Chinese tourists	12
2	MANY	Chinese tourists	9
3	NEW	Chinese tourists	8
4	POPULAR	Chinese tourists	6
5	ADDITIONAL	Chinese visitors	6
6	WEALTHY	Chinese tourists	5

Table 57 Categorized Adjective Collocates of "Chinese tourists/ Chinese visitors"

As Table 57 illustrated, in terms of adjective words, the top two words "more" and "many" are describing the quantity and the growing number of Chinese tourists, which shows objectiveness. Moreover, the rest of the adjective words "new", "popular", "wealthy" are positive description. It means that generally the western media tends to depict the positive image of Chinese tourists more frequently.

When it comes to the verbs showed from Table 58, apart from the general activities of the travelers, like "TRAVEL", "VISIT", "COME", the media also often uses the word "ATTRACT" to analyze the scenery or things appealing to the Chinese visitors, which shows interests in Chinese tourists' preference. In addition, a consumption behavior "SPEND" is also mentioned frequently to show the media's focal point on economic contribution from Chinese tourists' spending.

Verbs			
N	**Word**	**With**	**Total**
1	VISIT	Chinese tourists	11
2	TRAVEL	Chinese tourists	11
3	SAID	Chinese tourists	10
4	ATTRACT	Chinese tourists	8
5	COME	Chinese tourists	8
6	STAY	Chinese visitors	6
7	SPEND	Chinese tourists	5

Table 58 Categorized Verbs Collocates of "Chinese tourists/ Chinese visitors"

It is worth mentioning that there are no culturally relevant collocates in the corpora. As a civilized ancient country with a long history, China has not received the attention of western media in terms of its culture. In summary, the development of China's economy has made China's image as an economic power, and the image of a cultural power has not been recognized by western media.

4.2.3. *Concordance Analysis*

Emerging lexical patterns, such as key words, clusters, and collocates, leads to the examination of their (expanded) concordances, or, when needed, the examination

of whole texts, which is an approach supported by Stubbs (1994: 212), who stresses 'the need to combine the analysis of large-scale patterns across long texts with the detailed study of concordance lines. The following section will examine the concordance lines of "Chinese tourists", "Chinese visitors" and "Beijing" to explore the detailed and specific description on Chinese tourists and Chinese government in the news reports.

Broadly, both positive and negative attitudes can be identified in the concordance lines. According to Table 59, 24 positive affect resources and 41 negative affect resources appear in the news reports, accounting for 37% and 63% respectively. Obviously, negative attitudes surpass the positive attitudes. Most of the negative attitude is from judgement, specifically propriety. Most of the positive evaluation comes from the capacity aspect, which refers to the scale and the consuming power of Chinese tourists. Hence, it can be concluded that the general attitude of western media towards Chinese tourists is negative mainly because of the unfavorable performance in the destination countries.

The present study searches all the concordance lines of "Chinese tourists", "Chinese visitors" in Corpus CTH and divides them into three sub-systems of Attitude. Attitude focuses on people's feelings embodied in the text, including three sub-systems: affect, judgment, appreciation. Affect refers to positive and negative emotional reactions. Judgment is about attitudes towards people and their behavior. Appreciation is related to the evaluation of things.

Attitude System	**Features**	**Positive**	**Negative**
Affect	dis/inclination	0	4
	un/happiness	0	0
	in/security	0	0
	dis/satisfaction	0	0
Judgment	normality	4	10
	capacity	15	4
	tenacity	0	3
	veracity	0	2
	propriety	2	16
Appreciation	reaction	1	1
	composition	1	1
	valuation	1	0
Total Freq.		**24**	**41**
Proportion		**37%**	**63%**

Table 59 General Frequencies of Attitude Words in 65 Samples

System	Feature	Frequency	Percentage	
Affect	dis/inclination	4	6.15	
	un/happiness	0	0	
	in/security	0	0	
	dis/satisfaction	0	0	6.15
Judgment	normality	14	21.54	
	capacity	18	27.69	
	tenacity	3	4.61	
	veracity	2	3.08	
	propriety	18	27.69	84.62
Appreciation	reaction	2	3.08	
	composition	3	4.61	
	valuation	1	1.54	9.23

Table 60 Attitudinal resources in concordance of "Chinese tourists/ visitors"

As is showed from Table 60, apparently, the distribution of three regions is not balanced. We can easily distinguish the frequency of attitudinal resources. As the Table represents, affect, judgement, and appreciation resources appear in the news materials 4, 55, and 6 times, taking up 6.15%, 84.62%, and 9.23% respectively. Generally, the use of judgement resource is abundant, ranking first. According to Liu (2010), the criteria of judgments are constructed based on the shared community culture and norms concerning how people should behave as members in a society. Within the framework of judgment, it deals with language which praises or criticizes, applauds or condemns the behavior, speech, belief, deed and so on of human individual or groups. In the news reports, it is emphasized on the behaviors of Chinese tourists in the foreign society. Within the category of judgement, normality, capacity, tenacity, veracity, and propriety take up 21.54%, 27.69%, 4.61%, 3.08% and 27.69% respectively. Obviously, capacity and propriety take the largest proportion. According to Martin and White (2005), normality is about how unusual someone is; capacity is about how capable someone is; and tenacity is about how resolute someone is. While social sanction can be classified into veracity which is concerned with how truthful someone is and propriety which is concerned with how ethical someone is. The western media lays much description on Chinese tourists' capacity on consumption and behaviors. The following example analysis will give a more detailed illustration. According to (Painter, 2003), affect system is the main part of attitude system and it is also the basis of the other two sub-systems, judgment and appreciation, for the reason that it is the expressive resource we are born with. However, there is few descriptions of the affect resources in the concordance lines of Chinese tourists. It indicates that people's direct feelings and emotions related to Chinese tourists are not the focus of the news reports. Instead, the reporters give preference to make judgement to measure Chinese visitors and their behaviors according to ethics.

(12) **Chinese tourists** trailing (-Affect) behind a baton-wielding guide through museums and luxury shopping outlets are a common sight in most of the developed world, but in Taiwan this is still very new. The influx of tourists from the mainland is having a real economic impact (+Judgement) — and there is hope that it will begin to soften the relationship between the two historical antagonists.
-- *Chinese tourists boost Taiwan's economy* by Sarah Mishkin August 30, 2012

In example (12), the reporter mentions that it is common to see that Chinese tourists rail behind a baton-wielding guide, which means that Chinese tourists walk slowly, behind other people, tired or bored. The reporter lacks enthusiasm for the traveling ways of Chinese tourists. Driven by the tour guide, Chinese tourists are not really enjoying the trip, but just giving a hurried and cursory glance at the views in the travel destination, which shows a negative attitude towards Chinese tourists on one side. On the other side, it is mentioned that mainland Chinese tourists bring a real economic impact in Taiwan and it is hoped to foster the political relationship between mainland China and Taiwan. The reporter is highly optimistic about the future of mainland visitors to Taiwan for the economic and political effects.

(13) But **Chinese tourists** have also gained a reputation for having poor manners (-Judgement). In recent years, a number of stories of Chinese tourists behaving badly (-Judgement) have caused concern abroad and embarrassment at home.
-- *Disorderly Chinese Tourists on Thai Flight Draw Official Rebuke* DECEMBER 15, 2014

In example (13), both "poor manners" and "behaving badly" are negative judgements towards Chinese tourists' behaviors. The writer employs the negative judgment to convey the proposition that Chinese tourists show poor morality and conduct offensive behaviors when traveling abroad, causing concerns abroad and embarrassment at home with a bad reputation.

(14) A growing number of **Chinese tourists** in Paris — armed (-Judgement) with wads of cash, typically unable to (-Judgement) speak French and still somewhat naïve (-Judgement) about the ways of the West after decades of China's relative isolation — are falling victim to their unrealistic (-Judgement) expectations of the city.
--*China Urges Sweden to Heed Concern Over Tourists Ejected from Hotel* SEPT. 17, 2018

In example (14), the evaluations of Chinese tourists are all negative judgments. "Armed with wads of cash" indicates that Chinese tourists are supplied with a larger amount of money in preparation for buying luxury goods without financial sense and beyond reason to show off the new wealth. "Unable to speak French" and "naïve about the ways of the West" are negative judgments on Chinese tourists who are lacking experience of life, knowledge of the outside world and willing to believe that others always tell you the truth. Besides, the ignorance of the Chinese tourists is ascribed to China's isolation, the government's political involvement.

(15) But mainland parents permitting similar behavior while visiting Hong Kong or Taiwan have triggered a backlash (-Appreciation) among locals who see it as evidence of the harmful influence (-Appreciation) of huge numbers of **Chinese tourists** on their quality of life.
--*Tempest Over a Chamber Pot as Taiwan Scrutinizes Chinese Tourists' Manners* OCTOBER 22, 2014

From example (15), it can be noticed that Chinese tourists are appreciated negatively by the reporter. According to Martin and White (2008: 56), broadly, appreciations can be divided into people's 'reactions' to things or performances (impact and quality), the 'composition' (balance and complexity) and the 'valuation' (evaluation according to social conventions). In the report, Chinese visitors "triggered a backlash" and have "harmful influence", disturbing the local people's life, which can be coded as negative reactions. It is admitted that with the increasing number of Chinese tourists, some conflicts occur in their travel destination. The reporter evaluates the negative influence of Chinese tourists on the local people's life so as to remind the readers to beware of it and take actions.

(16) After mounting reports of **Chinese tourists** behaving badly in public(-Judgement), including defacing ancient monuments, opening emergency doors or breaking into fights on aircraft and disrespecting local customs. The tourism authority announced in April that it had begun drawing up a behavioral "blacklist."
--*China Hopes 'Blacklist' Will Curb Its Travelers' Misbehavior Abroad* MAY 25, 2015

In example (16), reporter makes negative judgement on Chinese tourists and lists the detailed impolite behaviors abroad, emphasizing the bad consequences with a strong sense of picture to convince the readers. By adopting adjectives and verbs with obviously negative meanings, the media skillfully conveys the message that Chinese tourists are of inferior manners, which brings shame on Chinese tourists.

Concordance analysis affords the examination of language features in co-text, while taking into account the context that the analyst is aware of and can infer from the co-text (Baker et al., 2008). The co-text provided by the (expanded) concordances helps in 'limiting the interpretation' to what is contextually appropriate or plausible (Brown and Yule, 1982: 59, cited in Baker et al., 2008). News not only can transform information, but also illustrate some hidden values and political ideologies, especially when reporting foreign nations. Hence, the news discourses are constructed purposefully and lexes are chosen carefully with ideological meanings. According to Fowler (1991), in the news event, the news actor can not only characterize and identify the social role or status of the target object, but also reveal the reporter's evaluation and attitude towards the news actor. The Chinese authorities have voiced concern about the "uncivilized" reputation that many citizens have established abroad. Thus, in the news reports on Chinese tourists, the participation of Chinese government is frequent mentioned when some negative issues are exposed. However, most of the descriptions of Chinese government is negative and ideology-oriented.

Table 61 shows all the concordance lines of "Beijing" which represents Chinese government in the news reports on Chinese tourists. The reports depict it as a strict, tough, controlling, and arbitrary political power by using phrases like *closer scrutiny*, *heavy hand*, *loyal to* and so on. The Chinese government's role in punishing and managing Chinese tourists is exaggerated and Chinese tourists are described as easily manipulated by the government under close scrutiny without full freedom. Besides, some territorial and sovereignty issues are related with Chinese government in the news reports when it discusses the Chinese tourists in Taiwan, Hong Kong and Southeastern Asian area. Beijing is defaced by the western media, showing obvious distortions regardless the efforts made by the Chinese government to regulate outbound tourists' behaviors and provide convenience to promote outbound tourism, which can be a way of ideological infiltration. It can be noticed that ideology plays a crucial part in the choice of the language to represent, the patterns of discourse representation and the setting devices. In the process of formation, construction and dissemination of the national image, the mass media is the most influential and fastest-spreading tool, which directly reflects the basic views of the social elites and political groups. The media spreads to the public and becomes a pioneering influence on them. Hence, from the concordance lines of Chinese government in the reports, it reflects that for the maintenance of UK and US's interest, Chinese government is shaped as a democracy manipulator.

Table 61 Extraction of Concordance Lines of "Beijing" in Corpus C

N	Concordance		
1	tourists how to avoid culture clashes in a way that	Beijing	said insulted the Chinese people
2	social media and an unusually strong response from	Beijing.	"The (Svenska Nyheter) anchor's remarks
3	said, "and they are willing to pay for that.“	Beijing	is counting on travelers like Leng Zhiche
4	is increasingly trendy abroad' a symbol of	Beijing's	growing soft power. It even inspired tourists
5	is Nationalist government and complete what	Beijing	calls the 'wiping clean' of past humility
6	like the Falun Gong, a spiritual movement banned by	Beijing	as an 'evil cult', have also seized on
7	she said of Chileans. "But Miami is so over."	Beijing	Considers Closer Scrutiny for Unruly Chinese tourists
8	by some will damage the so-called soft power that	Beijing	craves. Last year, China Central Television
9		Beijing	considered the practice — whereby mass-market agencies used commissions from retailers to offset deeply discounted package tours — to be misleading
10	Aggravating all this is the heavy hand of the	Beijing	government interfere in Hong Kong's governance
11	citizens' visits to the nearby democracy, which	Beijing	considers a renegade province.
12	What could Washington and	Beijing	possibly have in common?
13	state-owned Chinese media companies or businessmen loyal to	Beijing	have taken over Australia's once vibrant Chinese-language media
14	Clapper recited a list of concerns about Chinese espionage and foreign meddling, which made the challenge from	Beijing	seem anything but benign.
15	For several years now, the government in	Beijing	has expressed growing concern over embarrassing
16	for sale in China[a] was hurting badly, after	Beijing	banned the trade last week to comply with
17	But	Beijing.	will never completely cut the regime's jugular vein, experts said
18	Until 1997, he said,	Beijing	had strict controls on population movement
19	There are now 16 names on	Beijing's	list of embarrassing, 'uncivilized' Chinese tourists

5. Conclusion

The focus of the mainstream British and American media on Chinese tourists is the scale of tourists and their consuming power. Since 2010, news reports from the western media extended the coverage to analyze Chinese tourists' psychologies and preference in an in-depth way, besides luxury consumption and rude behaviors. The media gradually forms the stereotype of Chinese tourists as a whole.

Generally, the western media holds a negative attitude towards Chinese tourists' bad behaviors, while shows positive attitudes to Chinese shoppers' contribution to local economy. Though the selected news reports are centered on Chinese outbound tourist after 2015, the media also treats the Chinese tourists as an important part of the international tourism main-force and makes comparison with tourists from other countries, like Japan. Moreover, the media takes a broader view on Chinese tourists in many places in the world and describes the attitude and reaction from the local people to illustrate the image of Chinese tourists in a more comprehensive way, at the same time revealing huge economic impact on different overseas travel destination.

Language of news discourse is not value free. On the contrary, it is full of ideology, which is able to affect the linguistic choice of journalists. The choice of attitudinal values, the choice of lexical realizations and even the choice of theme are chosen with particular purpose. Media discourse is generally considered as tools of controlling reader's emotions. When it comes to news coverage of China, the politics, history and culture are combined to influence the linguistic choice and attitudinal preference of the western media.

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Western Media Coverage of Confucius Institutes: An APPRAISAL Analysis

Wang Liwei

Sun Yat-sen University

Abstract

This study uses APPRAISAL theory to investigate the appraisal strategies in the western media coverage of Confucius Institutes from 2004 to 2018. Through a descriptive and qualitative analysis of the news reports and editorials in five influential western media, the article identifies the most frequent topics, instant co-text of Confucius Institutes and three dominant strategies: (1) in using attitudinal resources, judgement is the most frequently used resource, followed by appreciation and little affect is involved in the media; (2) attributed resources are prominent in the examples and monoglossia is strategically intermingled with heteroglossic sayings to present a multiple-voiced representation; and (3) graduation is closely related to the expressions of attitude and engagement to achieve an intensified evaluation.

Keywords: Confucius Institutes, media coverage, APPRAISAL, CDA

1. Introduction

With the rapid development and increasing influence, China is considered as an emerging global power, and Chinese has become increasingly popular worldwide. In response to the Chinese craze throughout the world, China has launched a global network of language and cultural centers, namely Confucius Institutes, to serve the purpose of the language instruction and cultural exchange. As non-profit cultural institutions, Confucius Institutes play an active part in promoting multicultural communication and mutual understanding and therefore, further promoting Chinese soft power and constructing a favorable image on the global stage.

The last few years have witnessed a rapid expansion of Confucius Institutes and Classrooms all over the world. According to the latest data on the website of Confucius Institute Headquarters (Hanban), since the founding of the first Confucius Institute in Seoul in 2004, China has already established 525 Confucius Institutes and 1,113 Confucius Classrooms in 146 countries (areas). Despite rapid growth and huge expansion, Confucius Institutes unavoidably involve doubts and controversy (Li & Dai, 2011). On May 17, 2012, U.S. Department of State issued a State Department directive, which possibly forced Chinese teachers in Confucius Institutes to leave the US due to visa problems. In June 2014, the American Association of University Professors called on American universities to terminate or renegotiate the agreements with Hanban. In the same year, University of Chicago and Pennsylvania ended their partnership with Confucius Institutes. On August 14,

2018, the University of North Florida announced the decision to close the Confucius Institute. The international environment of Confucius Institutes evolves to be complex and challenging (Li & Dai, 2011).

APPRAISAL is a framework that evolves within Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL) which maps the resources we can use to give value to social experience (Martin, 2000; Martin & White, 2005; White, 2002). These resources can be realized through a diversity of grammatical structures and lexis. APPRAISAL analysis is a way of comprehensively and systematically capturing the global evaluative patterns that occur within a particular text, set of texts or institutional discourse. The present study aims to conduct a critical discourse analysis of western media coverage of Confucius Institutes within the framework of APPRAISAL developed by Martin (1992, 1995, 1996 and 2000) to unravel the strategic attitudinal construction and embedded ideologies. The data for this research comprise 55 articles published between November, 2004 and August 31, 2018 from five influential western media including *The Independent*, *The Guardian*, *BBC*, *The Washington Post*, *The New York Times* and *The Australian*.

2. Media coverage of Confucius Institutes

In the past few years, studies on Confucius Institutes have received greater attention both at home and abroad in view of the rapid development and increasing popularity of the Confucius Institutes. Focusing on studies at home, Liu (2012) summarizes some popular topics (e.g. a comparison between Confucius Institutes and other language -culture institutes, cultural influence and soft power of Confucius Institutes) while An, Wei, Xu and Liu (2014), involving domestic and foreign studies, find that Chinese scholars mainly focus on the operation and development of Confucius Institutes whereas foreign scholars are more concerned about their political, economic and cultural influence.

With the increasingly far-reaching influence of media, many researchers turn to the study of media coverage of Confucius Institutes. Some studies focus on the public opinion towards Confucius Institutes (Li & Dai, 2011; Chen, 2013; Liu, 2014). Liu (2014) comprehensively analyzes themes, content, types of the reports, authors, and their backgrounds, as well as attitudes, concluding that the compelling views on Confucius Institutes are negative. According to Li and Dai (2011), business and economic opportunities, shared knowledge, exchange, and cooperation are mainly positively evaluated in reports, while communism, propaganda, political tools and threat invoke frequently negative attitudes. Chen (2013) finds that domestic media coverage of Confucius Institutes is primarily positive and that stresses the necessity of improving Confucius Institutes' international image, keeping the quality with their fast growth in scales, ensuring the supply of qualified teaching staff and realizing their localization in foreign countries.

Some studies investigate misinterpretations on Confucius Institutes and their sources (Liu & An, 2014; Ye, 2015; Liu & Zeng, 2017). Liu and An (2014) find out four factors that lead to misinterpretation in British media coverage. Ye (2015) summarizes six major themes on reports on Confucius Institutes: soft power, Chinese craze, education budget, academic freedom, political propaganda. Liu and

Zeng (2017) conduct a critical discourse analysis of American mainstream media coverage of Confucius Institutes to describe cultural communicative and public diplomatic functions of Confucius Institutes and search for beneficial models of cross-cultural communication.

3. APPRAISAL system applied in media discourse and CDA

APPRAISAL evolves within the general theoretical framework of SFL, which maps the resources we can use to give value to social experience (Martin, 2000; Martin & White, 2005; White, 2002). Appraisal/evaluation can be simply defined as the indication of whether the speaker thinks that something is good or bad. It can be realized by lexical choices and across various grammatical categories (Martin & White, 2005). Appraisal categories have not emerged randomly but have arisen through extensive research into the nature of evaluative meanings. Moreover, they are in some cases underpinned by grammatical distinctions. Martin (1992, 1995, 1996 and 2000) has developed the framework of APPRAISAL system and extensively applied it into practice. Idema, Feez and White (1994) investigate the features on news reports, exploring how objectivity and subjectivity are construed in media texts and how different voices or sub-registers of journalistic discourse vary according to different uses of appraisal values. White divides contemporary broadsheet journalism into three voices: reporter voice, correspondent voice and commentator voice, generalizes their specific characteristics and makes a distinction of them based on different preference of values. White (1998) explores the semantics of attitude, evaluation, inter-subjective positioning, and more broadly, the rhetorical properties of the modern news reports, especially an elaborated account of engagement resources. Martin (2004) explores the interpersonal function of evaluation, concluding that evaluation has interpersonal rhetorical power, particularly in constructing and organizing solidarity. Tavassoli, Jalilifar, and White (2018) explore British newspapers' stance towards the Syrian refugee crisis through representations of the Syrian refugee crisis in commentary articles published in two British newspapers with different political orientations. Cavaliere (2018) focuses mainly on attribution and evidentiality, i.e. on the interplay of directly-quoted or indirectly-reported speech that journalistic writers use to attribute viewpoints and versions of events to a variety of external sources, especially potentially controversial meanings largely confined to material attributed to quoted sources.

In China, APPRAISAL theory has been widely applied to news reports, covering various discourse genres, such as editorial, column, and hard news. Through a corpus-assisted critical discourse analysis of news reports on air pollution in China Daily, Wang (2004) studies hard news and analyzes their attitude resources as well as realizing methods. Li (2005) analyzes the attitudinal meanings of English political column texts, finding a strong preference for employing appreciation and judgement rather than affect, as well as a frequent use of the explicit attitude by columnists. Chen (2007/2010) investigates English/Chinese editorials in term of the realization of engagement semantics and its interaction with attitude resources.

Wang (2018) reveals a significant attitudinal shift around the end of 2011 as regards public awareness of increasing air pollution levels in China and related public criticism. Through an analysis of distribution of appraisal resources, APPRAISAL theory contributes to interpreting author's attitudes and uncovering embedded ideologies, which plays a significant role in CDA.

Based on Critical Linguistics (CL) put forward by Fowler et al. (1979), the idea of CDA is first proposed by Fairclough (1989). Believing that there is a determinant relation between ideological processes and linguistic processes, and more specifically, that the linguistic choices which are made in texts can carry ideological meaning, CL examines how underlying ideologies are embedded in linguistic structures such as vocabulary and syntax. CDA argues that the relations between language and ideology are mediated by discursive practices (Fairclough, 1992) and it is distinctive for its overt socio-political stance (Fairclough & Wodak, 1997). It not only emphasizes a close analysis of texts but also addresses broader issues such as the social context of discourse, the role of discourse in social practices, and the function of specific texts (Bloor & Bloor, 2007: 2). Being critical does not mean criticism or exposing the negative side of evaluation (Bloor & Bloor, 2007). Chilton et al. (2010) identifies three interrelated meanings of being "critical": first, it makes explicit the implicit relationships between discourse, power and ideology; second, it highlights putting theory into action; third, it is reflexively self-critical. It considers the analysis as a kind of social practice which can be equally criticized. As Wodak and Ludwig (1999: 12) summarize, being critical does not mean "detecting only the negative sides of social interaction and processes and painting a black and white picture of societies", but "making contradictions apparent" and the emphasis on "self-reflection".

4. Theoretical framework and methodology

According to Martin and White (2005: 22), appraisal is concerned with evaluation: the kinds of attitudes that are negotiated in a text, the strength of the feelings involved and the ways in which values are sourced and readers aligned. The APPRAISAL framework offers a thorough model of analysis to identify and describe the authors' attitudes towards the content of the discourse under analysis (Jullian, 2011). Such a model includes three main systems: attitude, engagement, and graduation, which in turn are subdivided into subcategories focused on specific attitudinal and linguistic aspects. These three systems are looked upon as potential resources of evaluation that should be chosen simultaneously. For example, the evaluative function achieved by the utterance *She is very beautiful* is the result of choosing positive appreciation (attitude), monogloss (engagement) and up-scaling (graduation) at the same time. This idea of choice is inherited from SFL which assumes that language is a system of meaning potential. An overview of these appraisal systems is presented as Figure 33.

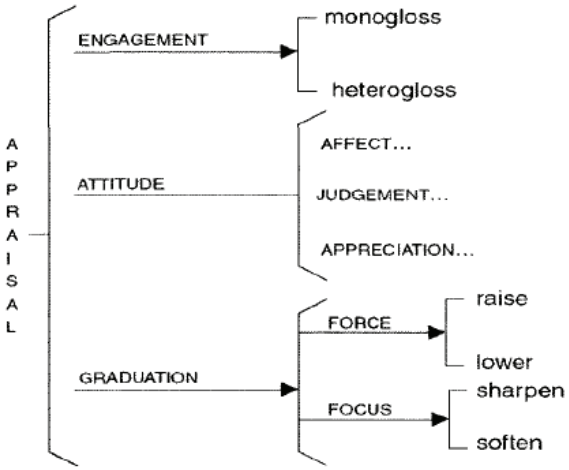


Figure 33 An overview of appraisal resources (Martin & White, 2005: 38)

Within attitude system, the subsystems (i.e., affect, judgement and appreciation) function differently to achieve various ends. Affect is concerned with registering positive and negative feelings, judgement deals with attitudes towards behavior, which we admire or criticise, praise or condemn, and appreciation includes attitudes towards things, entities and phenomena. Through a strategic combination of these attitudinal resources, positive or negative, implicit or explicit, the writers can construct their position and convey their ideology. The engagement system, which is concerned about the sources of attitudes, includes monoglossic and heteroglossic resources, focusing on the framing of the statements as a way to reveal the authors' personal standing. The practice of quoting external sources is often seen as a sign of intertextual positioning to expand the author's voice to acknowledge heteroglossic diversity (e.g., White, 1988, 2003). Graduation system deals with mainly two resources: the resources for adjusting how strongly we feel about people and things (force, e.g., intensifiers, attitudinal lexis, metaphor, swearing) and sharpen or soften categories of people and things (focus).

The data for analysis consist of 55 news articles from five influential western media: *BBC News*, *The Independent*, *The Guardian*, *The Washington Post*, *The New York Times* and *The Australian*. They were published between November, 2004 (the first Confucius Institute was established) and August 31, 2018, all dealing with the theme of Confucius Institutes. 22 out of 55 articles (except BBC News) stemmed from an original corpus downloaded from a LexisNexis Academic search with the key words "Confucius Institute" from November, 2004 to August 31, 2018. The analysis of the current research is restricted to news texts that focus dominantly on the issue of Confucius Institutes, excluding articles that concentrate

instead on related issues such as the economic cooperation between China and other countries, etc. With a complement of 33 relative articles from news website, a total of 55 articles are left for analysis.

This article is primarily a descriptive and qualitative study. Following the APPRAISAL framework, the frequently mentioned topics are first summarized by a close reading of the data. Meanwhile, the sociocultural context within the discourse is listed and analyzed. Second, through a systemic annotation the major evaluative resources are identified. Third, the linguistic means as well as the actual linguistic realizations are examined in order to map out the appraisal strategies. The qualitative analysis is also complemented by contents analysis as well as critical discussions.

5. Analysis and findings

Following the analytical procedure, the main topics covered in the media coverage of Confucius Institutes are listed below. According to Table 62, the most frequently concerned topics are politically inclined, such as Confucius Institutes' international influence and ideological infiltration. Economic influence is also prominent because of the increasingly closer economic connection between China and the world. Then the topic of academic interference, operational pattern and financial funding tends to manifest suspicion on Confucius Institutes, which suggests that the essential roles of Confucius Institutes in cultural communication and language instruction are downsized.

Topic	Examples
International influence	rising new power, public relations, superpower, soft power, prestige, diplomacy, foreign policy, public diplomacy, global influence
Economic influence	economic success, cooperation, power, expansion, opportunity, development
Ideological infiltration	Chinese government, Chinese Communist Party, Communism, Hanban, human rights, propaganda, espionage, spying outpost, political tool
Chinese teaching	Chinese craze, Chinese teaching
Cultural communication	cultural exchange, cross-cultural, mutual understanding, culture export
Academic interference	academic independence, academic integrity, academic autonomy, academic freedom
Financial funding	funding, sponsor, support, teaching staff, textbooks
Operational pattern	Nondisclosure, opaque contract, transparency, embedded in the campus, self-censorship

Table 62 Topics in media coverage of Confucius Institute

In many respects, China's	*Confucius Institutes*	seem like a throwback to the 1950's and 1960's[...]
[...] Confucius has become China's standard-bearer, with dozens of state-sponsored	*Confucius Institutes*	, including one at the University of Maryland, promoting the study of Chinese language and culture.
NEWCASTLE would become the first Australian university to hand over the teaching of Chinese studies to a Chinese government-funded	*Confucius Institute*	, under a proposal to be decided next month.
[...] it would be impossible for you to be involved in research projects with the Chinese-funded	*Confucius Institutes*	, and you may even be denied a Chinese visa.
On May 17, the State Department warned that teachers in the 60-plus Chinese government- sponsored	*Confucius Institutes*	throughout the United States — schools set up to promote Chinese culture[...]
[...] Hanban - the organization under the Chinese Ministry of Education that oversees the	*Confucius institute*	- "are incompatible with a continued equal partnership,"
[...] Xu Lin, the director of Hanban and chief executive of the	*Confucius Institute*	Headquarters.
Pennsylvania State University [...] is cutting ties with China's	*Confucius Institutes*	program, a chain of Chinese language and cultural training centers funded by the Chinese government.
China's	*Confucius Institutes*	should be judged on how they operate in practice, Ms Xu tells me, not by reference to abstract principles.
[...] Ms Xu Lin, a vice-minister level Chinese official in charge of China's worldwide	*Confucius Institutes*	programme.
A number of Western schools and universities have closed the Chinese-funded	*Confucius Institutes*	on their campuses in response to what they considered inappropriate efforts to spread Beijing's views.
Rubio pointed to Chinese government-sponsored	*Confucius Institutes*	on U.S. university campuses [...] often stand accused of interfering in China-related education activities.
[...] accepting money from the Beijing-backed	*Confucius Institute*	has come at the price of academic freedom
Anxiety over China's influence operations in the US has begun to focus on educational institutions, particularly Beijing-sponsored	*Confucius Institutes*	on American college campuses.
Increasing suspicion in the US concerning the reach and influence of China's	*Confucius Institutes*	has prompted a small band of Republican politicians to propose tough new legislation to rein them in.
[...] while failing to campaign against the China-funded	*Confucius Institute.*	
.A proposal by Rep. Joe Wilson (R-S.C.) would force the Beijing-funded	*Confucius Institutes*	[...] to register with the Department of Justice as agents of a foreign government.
[...]mixing the school's Pentagon-funded Chinese language programs and its Chinese Communist Party-funded	*Confucius Institute.*	

Table 63 Concordances of Confucius Institutes

To further investigate the appraisal inclination, the immediate co-textual environment for the mention of *Confucius Institutes* in the collected resources are shown in Table 63.

It is obvious that when referring to Confucius Institutes, the reporters tend to add some political labels, such as state-sponsored, Chinese government-funded, Beijing-backed, Chinese Community Party-funded, etc. These attributes are replicated to emphasize Confucius Institutes' political properties, which is actually not the essential part of them. Not surprisingly, linguistic choices in the construction of the Confucius Institutes are closely related to their ideology.

Western media strategically use appraisal resources to construct the image of Confucius Institutes and the different strategies in the collected resources are discussed in the following part. Since graduation resources are always intermingled with other two appraisal resources, I would like to involve it with the discussion of the two major strategies realized by attitudinal resource and engagement resources.

5.1. Strategy 1: Attitudes are overwhelmingly expressed as judgement and appreciation rather than effect

The raw frequencies and respective proportions of the resources of affect, judgement, and appreciation in the 55 articles are shown in the following table:

System	Subcategory	Frequency	Percentage	
Affect	dis/inclination	3	0.7	6
	un/happiness	12	2.7	
	in/security	8	1.8	
	dis/satisfaction	4	0.9	
Judgment	normality	22	4.8	66
	capacity	28	6.1	
	tenacity	87	18.9	
	veracity	40	8.7	
	propriety	128	27.8	
Appreciation	reaction	27	5.9	28
	composition	17	3.7	
	valuation	83	18	
Total		**459**		**100**

Table 64 Proportions of attitudinal resources

In all three types of attitudinal resources, the proportion of judgement is the largest, accounting for almost two thirds of the whole, followed by appreciation with 28%, and little affect is employed in the texts, occupying only 6%. From the table we can roughly see that judgement and appreciation are the major ways of expressing attitudes in the coverage of Confucius Institute, while affect plays a less important role. Given the genres of the selected articles, this is understandable, because the data are mostly from editorials and commentaries, which utilize basically writer

voice, including correspondent voice and commentary voice (Martin, 2005: 173). According to White (2005), commentator voice usually includes explicit judgement (social esteem and social sanction), commands and explicit cause. However, the delicate choices of such expressions are also meaningful, which can be shown in the following examples.

(1) Nevertheless, some experts are **not comfortable with** [-ve satisfaction] receiving money to spread Chinese government propaganda, as they see it. The institutes are funded by the Chinese government's Language Council International - known as the Hanban.
(TG, 2007/11/06)

In this excerpt, there is a typical non-authorial affect. By concluding that *some experts* (the Emotor) are *not comfortable with* receiving money from Confucius Institutes, the reporter presents a sense of dissatisfaction of Confucius Institutes and *Chinese government propaganda* in this case invokes negative affect. The reporter further adds that Confucius Institutes are funded by Hanban, which suggests an emphasis on their political associations, so as to stimulate readers' suspicious emotions against China and therefore construct alignment.

(2) Among other things, using the name of the country's **oldest and most famous** [intensify, +ve normality] philosopher avoids reference to the official ideology, which remains Marxism. Confucius, who was an educator and quasi-religious figure, also stands for peace and harmony, values that China **insistently proclaims** [intensify, +ve security] today, hoping to disarm fears about its rapid rise.
(NYT, 2006/01/11)

(3) As China becomes a major economic and military power and its diplomacy becomes **more assertive** [force: intensification, +ve tenacity], Beijing is also working harder at winning friends and influencing people.
(NYT, 2006/01/11)

A common appraisal strategy frequently used is that positive comments or some "obvious facts" at the beginning are gradually shifted towards a subtle suspicion. In example (2), instead of directly referring to Confucius Institutes, the writer chooses *Confucius* as the object of judgement. The writer describes Confucius as a famous philosopher and intensifies the normality to the upper-most end with *oldest and most famous*, which is projected as the positive judgement, but instead what the writer really targets at is China's *official ideology*, which invokes negative attitude. Likewise, the author explicitly praises that Confucius *stands for peace and harmony* but hesitates to comment on the behavior of Chinese government to establish Confucius Institutes and use *insistently proclaim* to cast a slight of subtle doubt of the real purpose of Chinese government by employing a maximiser (*insistently*: the highest value for the assessment of usuality), to convey strong writer investment in the proposition. It means that China is hoping to disarm fears about its rapid rise. By nominalization, *rapid rise* indicates a taken-for-granted fact that China is rising and *fear* conveys the universal attitudes toward China's rise. It can be viewed that the writer tends to construct a picture that the world fears the rise

of China. China, therefore, is taking advantage of all its resources to relieve the fear and build a favorable environment. In example (3), the target of judgement is *China* and *Beijing*. First, the author again uses nominalization (*a major economic power and military power*) to state a seemly no-position, taken-for-granted truth, which is to arouse the consciousness of the reader, and then he/she turns to the proposition that *Beijing is working harder at winning friends and influencing people*. The readers are encouraged to think about what Beijing has done, to connect the establishment of Confucius Institutes to the hard work and to unconsciously be aligned with the reporter.

(4) For the moment, Confucius Institutes are **flavour of the month**.[+ve valuation] And not just in education circles. Sheffield United football club has expressed an interest in hosting the next Confucius Institute business breakfast in its city. If a top football club sees the marketing potential, it's got to be **worth** [+ve valuation] universities giving it a try. (TG, 2007/11/06)

In this excerpt, the prominent attitude is realized by appreciation. The target of appreciation is *Confucius Institutes*. They are regarded as *flavor of the month*, which shows that they are positively evaluated as popular. Then the author gives an example of Sheffield United football club's interest in hosting Confucius Institutes business breakfast as a fact token to support the current popularity of Confucius Institutes and finally makes an explicit positive valuation of Confucius Institutes' economic benefit. So far, we can see that western media may also positively appraise Confucius Institutes in the case of economy while keeping biased in the field of politics.

(5) One part of that is compelling public and private universities to reconsider hosting Confucius Institutes, **the Chinese government-sponsored outposts of culture and language training**. (WP, 2018/02/19)

In this excerpt, the target of appreciation is Confucius Institutes, and they are regarded as *the Chinese government-sponsored outposts of culture and language training*. The writer seems to be objective to admit that the roles of Confucius Institutes are culture communication and language training, but he/she uses the word *outpost* to convey a sense of ideological inclination, as well as the attribute *Chinese government-sponsored*, as we have noted in the concordance of Confucius Institutes, to deepen the negative association of the institutes.

5.2. Strategy 2: Monoglossic assertions are strategically intermingled with heteroglossic sentences

(6) **However** [contract: counter], **none** [contract: deny] of these programs are based on university campuses. And **according to** [expand: acknowledgement] Mr. Davidson, **none** [contract: deny] adopt the same homogenous approach to their native cultures found in Confucius Institutes. "**No one** [contract: deny] would regard Zadie Smith or Grayson Perry as someone controlled by the British Council," he said. "The Chinese are **very** [force: intensification] clear on what they are trying to achieve," said Mr. Davidson. "They want to change the perception of China — to combat negative propaganda with positive propaganda. And they use the word 'propaganda' in Chinese. **But** [contract: counter] I doubt they have to say, 'We'll only give you this money if you **never** [contract: deny] criticize China.' The danger is more of self-censorship — which is a very subtle thing," Mr. Davidson said.
(NYT, 2012/03/04)

This excerpt is a mix of monoglossia and heteroglossia. *However* as a contract, captures the attention of the reader. Here the writer tries to compare Confucius Institutes with other language agencies, exaggerating the operational difference between them, i.e., Confucius Institutes are set in the host campus. Then the writer acknowledges Mr. Davidson's opinion on Confucius Institutes and skillfully organizes it into a seemly unbiased viewpoint.

(7) "[...]The Confucius Institute programme, **in so far as** [expand: entertain] it supports culture and outreach, **may** [expand: entertain] be valuable. In **so far as** [expand: entertain] it aims to promote academic research in Chinese studies, it is **fundamentally** [force: intensification] flawed because of its **close** [force: intensification] links with the Chinese government and party. **At best** [expand: entertain], it will result in a dumbing down of research; **at worst** [expand: entertain], it will produce propaganda."
(TG, 2007/11/06)

This excerpt is an attributed resource from a book. It repeatedly adopts formulations of entertain to appraise Confucius Institutes; therefore, these evaluations are less likely to be challenged compared with monoglossic statements such as "*The Confucius Institutes are fundamentally flawed because of its close links with the Chinese government and party*" and "*it will result in a dumbing down of research and will produce propaganda*" They convey a sense of uncertainty on the part of the writer.

(8) Professor Tim Wright, of Sheffield University's Confucius institute, **says** [expand: acknowledgement] it is "**complete nonsense**" [force: intensification, contract: endorse] to suggest the Chinese government or the Chinese Language Council International, which funds it, has **any** [force: quantification] influence over the university curriculum. "The institute is **solely** [contract: counter] aimed at outreach into the community and we've **not** [contract: deny] had **any** [force: quantification] pressure at all on how we teach that either," he says. "**Obviously** [contract: concur], it's **totally unacceptable** [force: intensification, contract: endorse] to have **any** [force: quantification] influence on the university. If they had something to say about how we teach evening classes we **might** [expand: entertain] look at that, **but** [contract: counter] they **haven't** [contract: deny]."
(TG, 2009/04/07)

(9) **But** [contract: counter] **according to** [expand: acknowledgement] journalist Daniel Golden, who wrote a book on intelligence collection on American campuses, the risk is that Confucius Institutes provide the Chinese government opportunities for intelligence-gathering that the United States is **not** [contract: deny] prepared to counter. The faculty at the institutes are, for example, chosen by Hanban, the Communist Party's educational arm, and are subject to government pressure.
(WP, 2018/05/22)

Quotations serve many purposes to the writers. They may be used to give credibility to writers' words, to detach writers from the responsibility of the quotes, to confront different views of the events, to evaluate subtly and so on. Example (8) is attributed to a member of Confucius Institutes via scare quotes and direct quotes and example (9) is an indirect quotation of a journalist. In example (8), they serve to enhance readers' understanding of the situation of Confucius Institutes by offering some credible and warrantable information. With locutions of disclaim (deny, counter), the negative assumption of Confucius Institutes is rejected and positive position is therefore emphasized. Also, it can be noticed that deny and counter often co-occur with each other, with the denying proposition in direct contradiction with the expectation that arises from an immediately prior or posterior proposition. In example (9), it is clear that by framing the evaluation of Confucius Institutes, the negative influences of Confucius Institutes are made much more prominent. Such choices have enormous implications. When the writer chooses to present the proposition from external sources, he/she detaches himself/herself from the content and signals, which is able to delegate the accountability to someone else.

(10) **For some** [expand: entertain], the choice of a **slightly** [force: intensification] fusty name like Confucius Institute, which evokes images of **anything but** [contract: deny/force: intensification (heightened negation)] a rising new power, **might seem** [expand: entertain] odd given Beijing's **increasing** [force: intensification] penchant for high-tech imagery and slick public relations. **Yet** [contract: counter] the **carefully** [force: intensification] selected label speaks volumes about the country's soft power ambitions.
(NYT, 2006/01/11)

In this extract, for example, the writer considers the name "Confucius Institute" *slightly fusty and odd*, which may be aligned with a community of readers who holds the shared value of Confucius, an old sage of China, and the rapid development of China's high-tech industry. And the writer employs *slightly* to reduce the degree of negative quality (fusty), the denial *anything but* to contract the assessment and *might seem* to make place for discussion, involving the readers in the evaluation process. And *yet* presents a counter expectation, formulating a sharp contrast. With a token of attitude, the writer constructs China as the one that purposefully establishes the Confucius Institute program and may have some political ends behind it.

6. Conclusion

In this study, the news reports and editorials from 2004 to 2018 with respect to Confucius Institutes in five influential western media have been investigated to uncover the dominant appraisal strategies and embedded ideologies. It shows that western media tend to evaluate Confucius Institutes negatively. Though they sometimes make it "objective" by applying some appraisal strategies, they still convey some ideological implication i.e., anti-communism and fear of the growth of a stronger China. From the most covered topics we can see the inclination of western media is political and ideological while the essential cultural and language instructing function of Confucius Institutes is ignored. The concordance of Confucius Institutes further shows the bias and ideological sensitivity of the western world. Through a detailed analysis, the major appraisal strategies utilized to construct the image of Confucius Institutes are summarized as: (1) in using attitudinal resources, judgement is the most frequently used resource, followed by appreciation and affect is least employed in the texts; (2) attributed resources are prominent in the examples and monoglossia is strategically intermingled with heteroglossic sayings to present a multiple-voice report; and (3) graduation is closely related to the expressions of attitude and engagement to achieve an intensified appraisal.

Establishing Confucius Institutes is an important cross-cultural project contributing to expanding the communication between China and the rest of the world During recent years, China has witnessed a lot of achievements made by this project. However, due to cultural difference and political systems, conflicts and doubts are inevitable in this process. Now that the challenges are unavoidable, figuring out how western media appraise Confucius Institutes may help improve our comprehensive evaluation and therefore search for a better solution for the challenges. We should keep a clear mind on how they view us, critically consider their feedback and improve our operation to better fit the complex environment while keeping our own characteristic. For example, adjusting governmental engagement and highlighting cultural communication will be a good way.

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The Synergy of Systemic Functional Linguistics and Corpus Linguistics

Chang Chenguang

Sun Yat-sen University

Abstract

Based on the Firthian linguistics tradition, systemic functional linguistics (SFL) and corpus linguistics (CL) share some fundamental principles about the study of language. This chapter focuses on the complementary and synergistic relationship between SFL and CL, with particular reference to discourse analysis. I will start with a comparison of the formal and functional approaches to the study of language, especially in terms of their different views on the nature of the data for linguistic enquiries. Then I will discuss the complementarities between SFL and CL, in terms of both their commonalities and differences. Finally, I will look into SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis, where the strengths of SFL and CL can be usefully combined to make a contribution to our analysis of texts.

Keywords: systemic functional linguistics, corpus linguistics, synergy, corpus-assisted discourse analysis

1. Introduction

There is a natural synergistic relationship between systemic functional linguistics (SFL) and corpus linguistics (CL), as they share the principles of the Firthian linguistics tradition. Stubbs (1996: 23) summarizes some of these principles, and among them the following three are the most relevant for our discussion of the relationship between SFL and CL: (1) the nature of linguistics, (2) the nature of data for linguistics, and (3) the conceptual structure of the discipline. In this chapter, I will focus on the issue of linguistic data as a way into exploring the complementarities between SFL and CL, both of which emphasize that language should be studied in attested, authentic instances of use.

I will start by briefly comparing the two major approaches to the study of language, i.e., formalism and functionalism, with particular reference to their views on the nature of data for linguistics. Then I will discuss the complementarities between SFL and CL, in terms of both their commonalities and differences. Finally, I will explore SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis, where the strengths of SFL and CL can be combined to jointly make a contribution to discourse studies.

2. Formalism and functionalism

If we may categorize the different approaches to the study of language very broadly into formal and functional schools, we can see there are some fundamental differences between them. Halliday (1977) traces this categorization back to ancient Greek, when there were very different views as to the nature of language. The sophists in ancient Greek are more functional, conceiving language as a resource, whereas Aristotle is more formal in seeing language as a set of rules. Both schools have influenced and inspired a large number of followers, and in the European tradition, there has been the foregrounding of either the functional or the formal at different times in history.

One of the fundamental differences between the two schools, which is closely related to our discussion here, is that formalists tend to regard language primarily as a mental phenomenon, whereas functionalists tend to regard it primarily as a social phenomenon. Consequently, functionalists (e.g., Halliday) study language in relation to its social functions and context, whereas formalists (e.g. Chomsky) believe that language can be studied as an autonomous system. As Thompson (2014: 11) puts it, a rigorously formal approach to the description of language leads us towards biology, focusing on the language user's innate competence, whereas a functional approach takes it towards sociology, focusing on the systematic study of relevant features in the culture and society that form the context in which language is used. This difference in orientation has obvious implications on their respective selection and treatment of data in linguistic analysis.

2.1. Chomsky's criticism of corpus linguistics

Chomsky distinguishes between competence and performance and emphasizes that the aim of linguistic research is the account of innate competence not that of performance (Chomsky 1964, 1965). Chomsky (1964) claims, for example, that if we are concerned with real intellectual processes, "it is the question of competence that is fundamental". For Chomsky, linguistics, which is a branch of cognitive psychology and ultimately of biology, can be studied based on intuitive data, since the ideal native speaker has represented in their brain a grammar that gives an ideal account of the structure of the sentences of their language (Chomsky 1964). Thus, Chomsky has a very abstract and indirect concept of data. The study of language in use, according to Chomsky, is essentially useless, because when the speaker is actually faced with the task of speaking, many factors influence his actual performance. Chomsky (1965: 18) argues that information about competence cannot be directly observed nor extracted from data by inductive procedures. In other words, actual linguistic performance is unreliable.

Another reason for Chomsky's rejection of corpus data is that language is infinite and creative in nature, and that the corpus is seriously insufficient. According to Chomsky, a corpus records only what has been said, and is therefore incomplete whatever its size. A native speaker can produce more examples to illustrate a linguistic phenomenon within a matter of minutes than those contained in a corpus. Consequently, Chomsky was critical of corpus linguistics from the very beginning,

believing that an actual corpus is "useless" and can only serve to provide "the most superficial" explanation (Chomsky 1964).

Chomsky's emphasis on the study of competence and his reliance on intuitive and introspective data may have the merit of revealing the complexity of native speakers' knowledge of their language. However, as Stubbs (1996: 28-29) criticizes, native speaker intuitions cannot be reliably used to study "the many aspects of language about which speakers have only inaccurate or simply no useful intuitions at all". It is also a very strange notion of data if we consider scientific research in general, as a scientist is not expected to "make up the data at the same time as the theory, or even to make up the data afterwards, in order to illustrate the theory" (Stubbs 1996: 29).

2.2. Halliday's emphasis on language in use

Different from Chomsky, Halliday has always emphasized the importance of studying language in use. In fact, SFL has been characterized as a theory of text in context. This emphasis on the analysis of attested, authentic instances of use, as whole texts, is in line with the Firthian linguistics principle about the conceptual structure of the discipline, i.e., that the Saussurian dualisms require radical revision (Stubbs 1996: 23). For Halliday, the strict dichotomy between *langue* and *parole* is a mistake with its obsession with the system at the expense of the text.

Halliday puts stress on the complementarity between text and system, a complementarity that is based on the vector of instantiation. On many occasions, he has used the analogy of the relationship between climate and weather to explain this complementarity, arguing that text and system are two aspects of the single phenomenon "language" (Halliday 1992, 2002, 2004a, 2008). System, according to Halliday (2002), is language seen from a distance, as semiotic potential, like the climate, whereas text is language seen from close up, like the weather, as instances derived from that potential. In Halliday (2004a: 27), he elaborates:

> System and text are thus related through instantiation. Like the relationship between climate and weather, the relationship between system and text is a cline — the cline of instantiation... . System and text define the two poles of the cline — that of the overall potential and that of a particular instance. Between these two poles there are intermediate patterns. These patterns can be viewed either from the system pole as subsystems, or from the instance pole, as instance types.

This emphasis on the complementarity between system and text is the reason why Halliday attaches so much importance to the role of the corpus.

In the second edition of *Introduction to Functional Grammar* (IFG), Halliday (1994: xxii) points out, "The grammar is at once both a grammar of the system and a grammar of the text". He refers to the invention of the tape-recorder as "the greatest single event in the history of linguistics, … which for the first time has captured natural conversation and made it accessible to systematic study" (Halliday 1994a: xxiii). Then in the third edition of *IFG*, Halliday (2004a: 33) comments that, in addition to the tape-recorder, a second great invention which was "to change the work of a grammarian" is the computer, because it has made it possible to store and access data in increasing quantities.

According to Halliday (Halliday 2004a: 34-35; Halliday & Matthiessen 2014: 51-53), the corpus is of utmost importance to our attempt at theorizing language, and there are three major advantages of the corpus: the authenticity of its data, its inclusion of spoken language, and the possibility it brings to study grammar in quantitative terms. The first advantage is now obvious to linguists, and corpus-based research has proven that native-speaker intuitions are not always reliable (e.g. Sinclair 1991, Stubbs 1996, Hunston & Francis 2000). As Halliday (2004a: 34) points out, "[W]hat people actually say is very different from what they think they say; and even more different from what they think they ought to say".

Halliday has always stressed the importance of the study of spoken language. At the time when Quirk and Twaddell began to implement the first corpuses of written text in Britain and the United States respectively, Halliday had been recording and analyzing natural speech, both in Chinese (the study of Chinese dialects in the Pearl River Delta in the early 1950s) and English (e.g. 1963, 1967). Halliday (2004b) believes that the spoken language corpus is a crucial resource for theoretical exploration and has a vast potential, as spoken language is "the mainspring of semogenesis: where, prototypically, meaning is made and the frontiers of meaning potential are extended". This point is reiterated in *IFG* (Halliday 2004a: 34; Halliday & Matthiessen 2014: 52):

> …it is in the most unself-monitored spontaneous speech that people explore and expand their meaning potential. It is here that we reach the semantic frontiers of language and get a sense of the directions in which its grammar is moving.

SFL holds that grammatical systems are probabilistic in nature. With the help of the tools and methods provided by corpus linguistics, such as computerized parsing and pattern-matching, it is now possible to undertake quantitative studies of a number of primary systems in the grammar. For example, systems in English, such as POLARITY and TENSE, can each be modeled with certain probabilities attached. This has significant implications for the study of language variation in different contexts of situation, where the differences between registers may be accounted for by the systematic resetting of probabilities (Halliday & Matthiessen 2014: 52). And pedagogically, important insights can be derived for the teaching of foreign languages, especially the reaching of writing.

3. The complementarities between SFL and CL

As we mentioned at the beginning of this chapter, SFL and CL share the principles of the Firthian linguistics tradition. Discussing the connections between the two, Halliday (2006) points out that since SFL has always emphasized the analysis of naturally occurring language data, it is in this sense always corpus-based.

A detailed discussion about the common grounds between SFL and CL can be found in Thompson & Hunston (2006). There is one point that I would like to elaborate a bit further here: the issue of context. Apart from the emphasis on naturally occurring language and with language as text, as we mentioned earlier, another shared feature is the concern with context. However, the SFL and CL have different ways of articulating this concern. One of the distinguishing features of

SFL is the contextualisation of language as a system interacting with other social semiotic systems. As introduced in the International Systemic Functional Linguistics Association website, as a theory of language, SFL emphasizes the interdependence of language and social context:

> Systemic-Functional Linguistics (SFL) is a theory of language centred around the notion of language function. While SFL accounts for the syntactic structure of language, it places the function of language as central (what language does, and how it does it), in preference to more structural approaches, which place the elements of language and their combinations as central. SFL starts at social context, and looks at how language both acts upon, and is constrained by, this social context.
> (http://www.isfla.org/Systemics/index.html)

Halliday (1978) conceives of language as social semiotic, a resource for making meaning in situated contexts of human activity. The relationship between language and social context is regarded in SFL as both bi-directional and deterministic.

Results in corpus searching may often seem far removed from actual context, situational or social-cultural, but the concern with context in CL is reflected in its emphasis on the notion of variation in language. Halliday (2006) maintains that corpus studies underpin the general principle of functional variation in language, and as we discussed earlier, the corpus makes it possible to quantify the lexicogrammatical differences among different registers and to interpret registerial variation as a kind of systematic redistribution of probabilities. This gives us a good insight into how to explain the marked distribution of some lexicogrammatical features in certain registers.

Both SFL and CL have a shared concern with frequency. CL is apparently more explicit in this regard, and as a matter of fact, many of the central findings and insights of CL are closely related to frequency. One of the major advantages of corpus studies is to reveal typical patternings in language, which otherwise would be difficult to retrieve by introspection (Sinclair 1985, 1991; Hunston & Francis 2000). SFL, which sees language as an open-ended meaning potential, is more concerned with probability than with actual frequency. In other words, the actual frequency of occurrence in instances is taken as a realisation of the potential probabilities in the language system (Halliday 1991, 1993). Here lies a complementarity between systemic theory and corpus linguistics. As Halliday (2006) explains, "corpus studies make it possible to study functional variations and to quantify the lexicogrammatical differences among different registers". And SFL can provide sound theoretical explanation for corpus findings on frequency, relating it with function and context.

The complementarities between SFL and CL are also reflected in their different focus of research. Corpus linguists, such as Sinclair, are more concerned with the study of lexis and the grammatical patterns associated with lexis (Sinclair 1991, Francis 1993, Hunston & Francis 2000), whereas systemic functional linguists such as Halliday focus on "building the dictionary out of the grammar" (Halliday 2008). These different perspectives have both contributed important insights to our understanding of the nature of language. The large-scale electronic corpus, as currently designed, is more friendly to the lexicologist, who sees "grammar as generalized lexis" (Hunston & Francis 2000, Partington 1998), but less friendly to the

grammarian, who favours the perspective of "lexis as most delicate grammar" (Halliday 2006, Hasan 1987, Hoey 2006).

Nevertheless, from a grammarian's perspective, the corpus is still a very useful tool. Halliday (2006) points out that, in principle, a corpus may be of any size, tracing the origin of the term to the philologists' *corpus inscriptionum.* He cites Malinowski's record of conversations with the Trobriand Islanders on the cultivation of their gardening plots, *Corpus Inscriptionum Agriculturae Kiriwiniensis*, as an example of a small corpus. Depending on purpose, he argues, a corpus can be treated either as object, or as instrument (Halliday 2006, 2008). In other words, a single text may be studied as object, in which case the text is valued as a discourse in its own right. Then a text can also be treated as instrument, as a window on to the system. In this case, the larger the corpus, the more effectively it will reveal the system. As Halliday & Matthiessen (2014: 29-30) put it:

> As grammarians we have to be able to shift our perspective, observing now from the system standpoint and now from that of the text; and we have to be aware at which point we are standing at any time. This issue has been strongly foregrounded by the appearance of the computerized corpus. A corpus is a large collection of instances – of spoken and written texts; the corpuses now available contain enough data to give significantly new insights into the grammar of English, provided the data can be processed and interpreted. But the corpus does not write the grammar for you, any more than the data from experiments in the behaviour of light wrote Newton's *Opticks* for him; it has to be theorized. Writing a description of a grammar entails constant shunting between the perspective of the system and the perspective of the instance.

Halliday (2004a: 35) cautions against an "anti-theoretical ideology" in some corpus linguists, adding that there is "a dialectical complementarity between theory and data: complementarity because some phenomena show up best if illuminated by a general theory (i.e., from the "system" end), others if treated as patterns within the data (i.e. from the "instance end)". He does not believe that there can be a clear boundary between corpus-based and corpus-driven research, nor does he share the argument that corpus-driven linguistics is a linguistics of *parole,* pointing out that "[O]nce you are 'doing linguistics', you have already moved above the instantial realm" (Halliday 2004b).

In addition, the complementarities between SFL and CL can be reflected in the insights that the theoretical principles from SFL may provide for the designing of a corpus. For example, Halliday & Matthiessen (2014: 71-73) discuss the different registerial and dialectal compositions across the corpuses and text achives used for description and exemplification in the fourth edition of *IFG*. Taking the registerial and dialectal variations into consideration in the sampling of texts will certainly be helpful in compiling a more balanced corpus.

4. Corpus-assisted discourse analysis

In this final section, I will briefly look into SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis, an approach where the strengths of both SFL and CL can be combined to jointly make a contribution to the analysis of texts.

To begin with, corpus-assisted discourse analysis should benefit from SFL's strong theoretical grounding. As reviewed in the second section of this chapter,

Halliday emphasizes the complementarity between text and system for the study of language. For Halliday (2008: 192) discourse analysis is not simply one of the applications of linguistics, rather it is "a proper part of linguistics, the part that consists in the description of particular instances of language". The description a discourse analyst makes about a text has to be based on the underlying system of language. As Halliday (1994: xxii) emphasizes, discourse analysis has to be founded on a study of the system of the language to prevent it from turning into "a running commentary" about a text. In analyzing texts, the analyst has to be able to explain how the meaning potential of a language is exploited in texts. Indeed, SFL provides rich linguistic tools for the intensive analysis of texts, particularly individual texts studied as object, relating them to the overall language system. Such analysis, as Hoey (2006) points out, serves to increase "the conceptual depth of the categories studied" as well as "the riches of the description as a whole".

Yet when text is studied as a window on to the system, a large amount of text data needs to be studied. Here the role of large-scale corpus becomes prominent, as the corpus constitutes a "comparable thickening of the data", both in amount and variation, extending the scope and power of quantitative methods of analysis. It enables us to see more clearly, and more accurately, into the underlying system. Consequently, the more quantitative methodology of CL becomes a very useful addition to a purely qualitative approach to discourse analysis. As Baker (2006: 10-17) summarizes, there are a number of advantages associated with the corpus-based approach to discourse analysis. These advantages are discussed from the following aspects: (1) Reducing researcher bias. Using a corpus may help place restrictions on the researcher's own cognitive biases. (2) The incremental effect of discourse. With the help of a corpus, it is possible to establish the repeated patterns of language use which demonstrate evidence of hegemonic discourses. (3) Resistant and changing discourses. The corpus may also help reveal resistant and changing discourse positions in society. (4) Triangulation. Discourse analysts can use a corpus as a reference to back up or expand their findings based on the analysis of a single text or a small number of texts.

Of course, corpus linguistics should in no way exclude the intensive study of individual texts (Hoey 2006). In fact, the more quantitative methodology of CL can be combined with the more qualitative approach of SFL in what might be called SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis. The most obvious advantage of such an approach to discourse analysis is that it allows us to go beyond focusing on only a small number of texts to analyzing and comparing a large number of them. It also makes it possible for the analyst to do both the macro- and micro-level analyses, to locate particular lexicogrammatical patternings more efficiently and to explain these patternings in concrete social contexts. For example, CL methods such as keywords, collocates, concordance, semantic preference and semantic prosody can help reveal the topics and themes as well as the general attitudinal orientation in texts. The qualitative SFL approach can focus on more detailed multifunctional analysis, such as Transitivity, Modality, Appraisal, Thematic and informational structures, to assist the exploration of discourse strategies used in texts. Obviously, more effort should be made in designing programmes

and tools to annotate corpora automatically for such lexicogrammatical and semantic features mentioned above, so that both quantitative and qualitative analyses can be more efficiently conducted. And as Halliday & Matthiessen (2014: 70) point out, at the current state, corpus tools may be able to handle "certain low-ranking patterns within lexicogrammar" automatically for large volumes of text, but they are not able to handle "full-fledged systemic functional analysis of clauses, and semantic analysis is also beyond its reach", which still needs to be carried out manually for small samples of text.

In SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis, the social semiotic orientation of SFL, with its emphasis on the close relationship between language in use and its social context, is a useful supplement to CL, which may find the association of its findings with social context as a challenge. Moreover, SFL puts emphasis on "social accountability", both in the sense of relating the study of language to its social context and in the sense of putting linguistics in its social context. This foregrounds SFL's social semiotic view of language, emphasizing social motivation in its interpretation of language form and function as well as the social responsibility of the linguist and his discipline. The notion of "social accountability" is thus closely related to Halliday's aim of an appliable linguistics, appliable "in the sense that it can be helpful to at least some of the large numbers of people who are in some way or other engaging with language in the course of their work" (Halliday 2008: 189).

As Martin (2000) points out, as a politicized theory, SFL is a neo-Marxist linguistics designed to engage: it is a way of intervening in social and political processes. Indeed, SFL has been one of the major inspirations and a vital analytical frame for critical discourse analysis. As a mode of intervention in critical social practices, it has proven to be theoretically relevant and significant for new emerging approaches to discourse analysis, such as positive discourse analysis, strategic discourse analysis and ecological discourse analysis.

Take ecological discourse analysis as an example. An important inspiration for ecological discourse analysis is the work of Halliday, whose seminal paper "New ways of meaning: the challenge to applied linguistics" (Halliday 1990) has stimulated linguists to consider the ecological context and consequences of language. In this paper, Halliday urges linguists to "interpret the grammatical construction of reality", asking the fundamental question: "Do linguistic patterns, literally, affect the survival and wellbeing of the human species as well as other species on Earth?" (Steffensen & Fill 2014). Halliday cites examples of discourses in which language construes resources like air, water, soil, and mineral resources as unbounded, pointing out that this has severe consequences for humans and their environment. He also gives examples of "growthism", and the ecologically destructive consequences that this has led to. The Hallidayan approach is now recognized as one of most influential approaches to ecological discourse analysis. In this regard, SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis is highly relevant in that it makes it possible to analyze and compare a larger amount of texts and to expose consumerist stories, stories of economic growthism, advertising stories, stories of intensive farming, and stories which represent nature as a machine or a resource, and so on. According to Stibbe (2015), with reference to a particular ecological philosophy

(or ecosophy, for short), discourses can be evaluated as beneficial in encouraging people to protect the ecosystems that life depends on, or destructive in encouraging behavior which damages those ecosystems. We can also search for new stories to live by through exploring nature writing, environmental writing and indigenous forms of language around the world. As responsible linguists, we can fulfill our social responsibility and make a practical difference in the world through resisting destructive discourses and contributing to the search for new beneficial discourses to live by, an effort which SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis can facilitate.

5. Conclusion

In this chapter, I have reviewed the two major approaches to the study of language, with particular references to their views on the nature of data for linguistic enquiries. The functionalist principle of emphasizing language in use forms the essential common ground for SFL and CL, and between the two there is a symbiotic and synergistic relationship. Then the complementarities between SFL and CL are further discussed, highlighting the advantages of combining the strengths of the qualitative and quantitative research methodologies. The chapter ends with a discussion of SFL informed corpus-assisted discourse analysis, an approach where the powerful theoretical orientation of SFL and the quantitative methodology of CL can work together to make a contribution to discourse studies.

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